

HELMHOLTZ AI

Transformers Workshop

Helmholtz AI Consultants @ HEITEC, IHRS BioSoft, BIF-IGS & HIDSS4Health

26.03.2026

Agenda

- 09:00 - 10:30 Introduction to Language Modeling
- 10:30 - 10:45 Break
- 10:45 - 11:45 Blablador: concept, models description. Optional: integration in VScode
- 11:45 - 12:00 Q&A
- 12:00 - 13:00 Lunch Break
- 13:00 - 14:00 Attention, self-attention, transformer architecture
- 14:00 - 14:15 Pre-training vs fine-tuning and foundation models (intro to the hands-on session)
- 14:15 - 14:30 Break
- 14:30 - 15:30 Hands-on: fine-tune a model on a downstream task
- 15:30 - 16:00 Q&A, Wrap-up, and Conclusion

Outline

1. Overview
2. Preprocessing
3. Attention mechanism
4. Putting it all together
5. Variants of Transformer

Transformer

- NeurIPS 2017
- Originally for machine translation
 - Nowadays, also for many more things
 - Chatbots
 - Vision
 - Etc.

Attention Is All You Need

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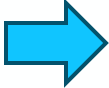
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Our example

- German-English translation

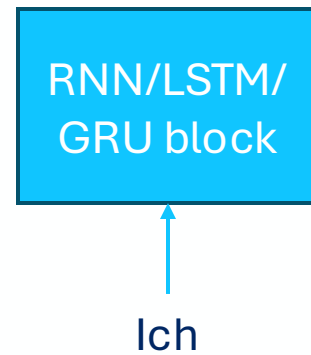
”Ich habe Hunger”  ”I am hungry”

Before Transformer

- Sequential models (RNNs/LSTMs/GRUs)

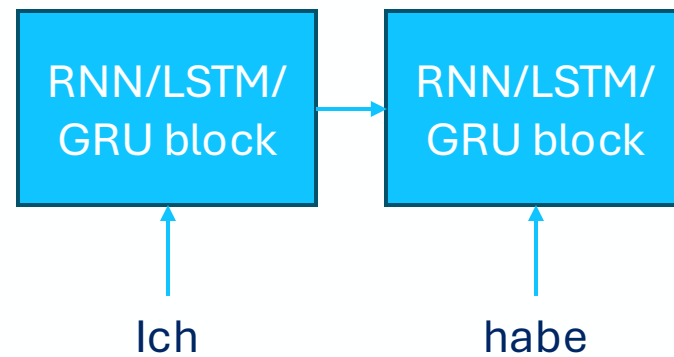
Before Transformer

- Sequential models (RNNs/LSTMs/GRUs)



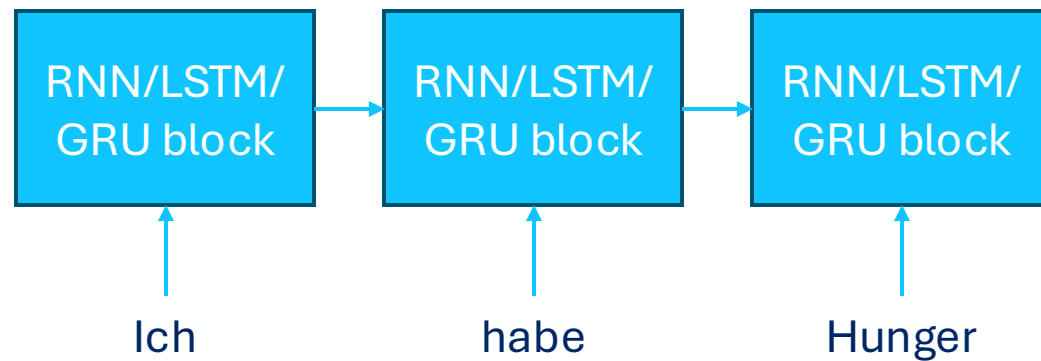
Before Transformer

- Sequential models (RNNs/LSTMs/GRUs)



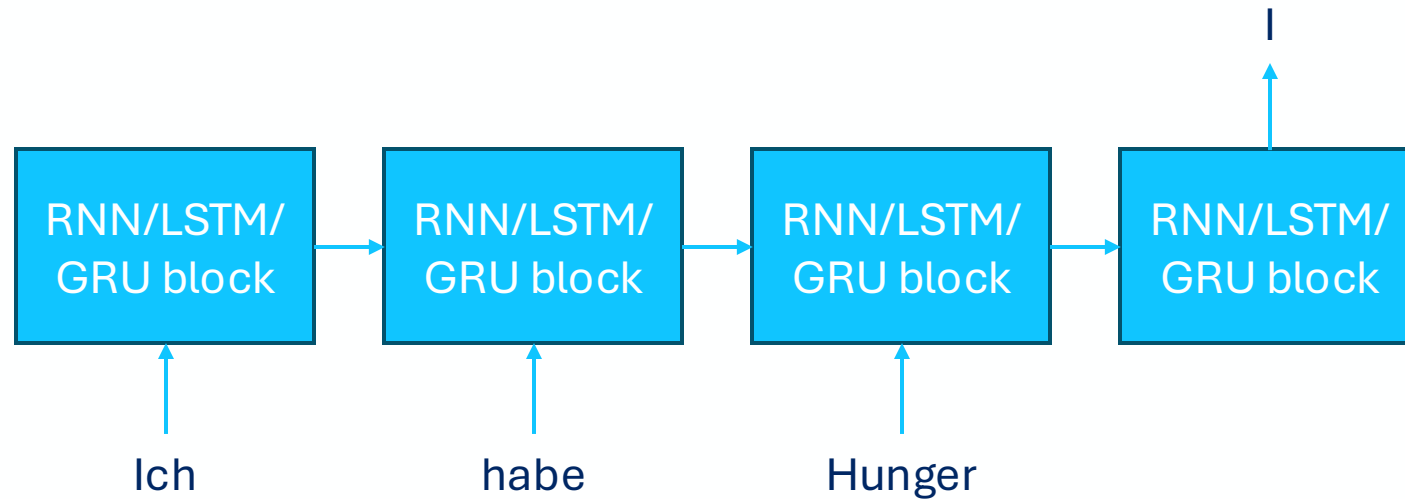
Before Transformer

- Sequential models (RNNs/LSTMs/GRUs)



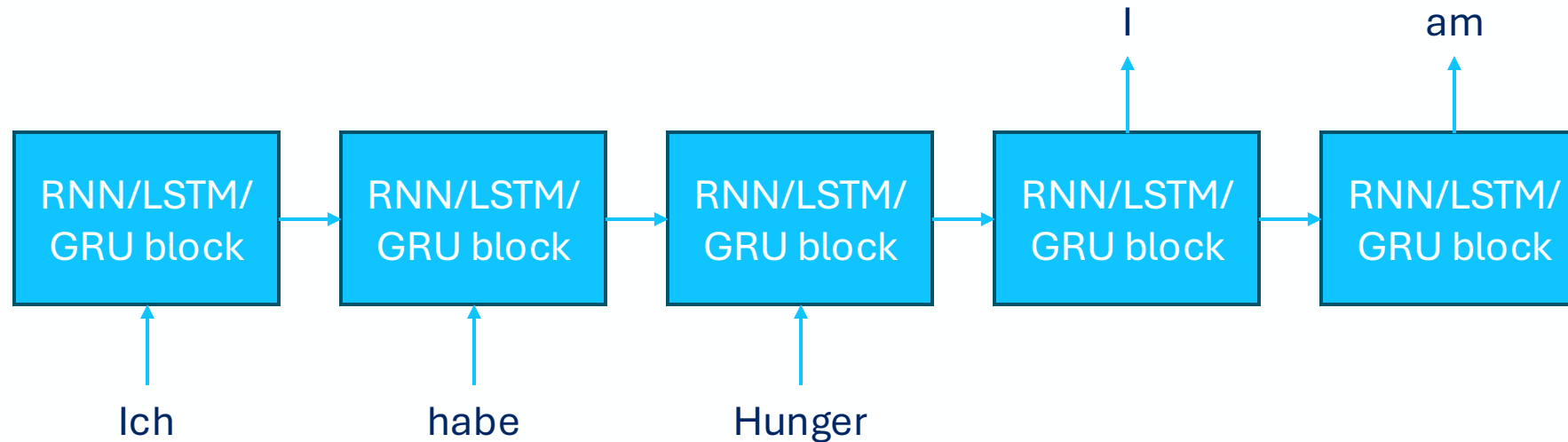
Before Transformer

- Sequential models (RNNs/LSTMs/GRUs)



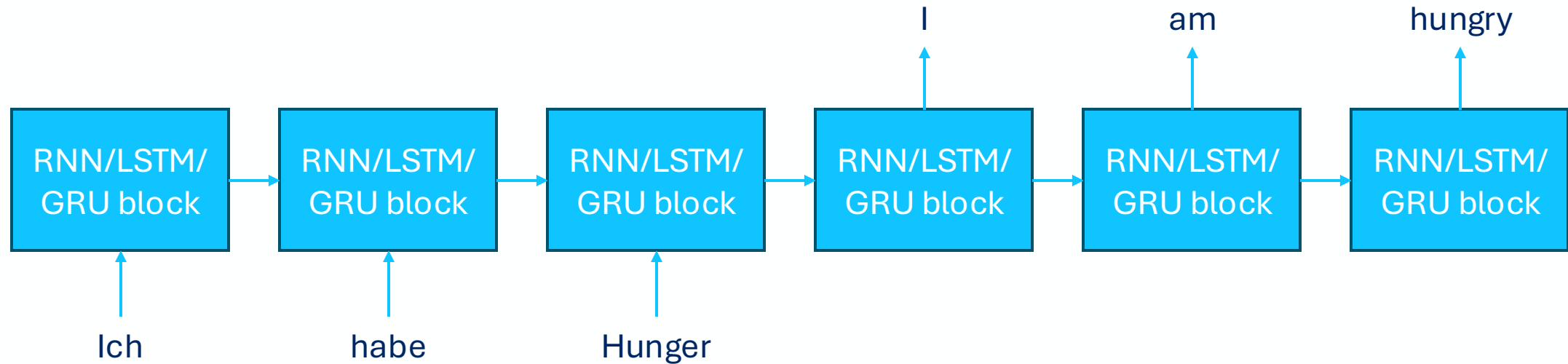
Before Transformer

- Sequential models (RNNs/LSTMs/GRUs)



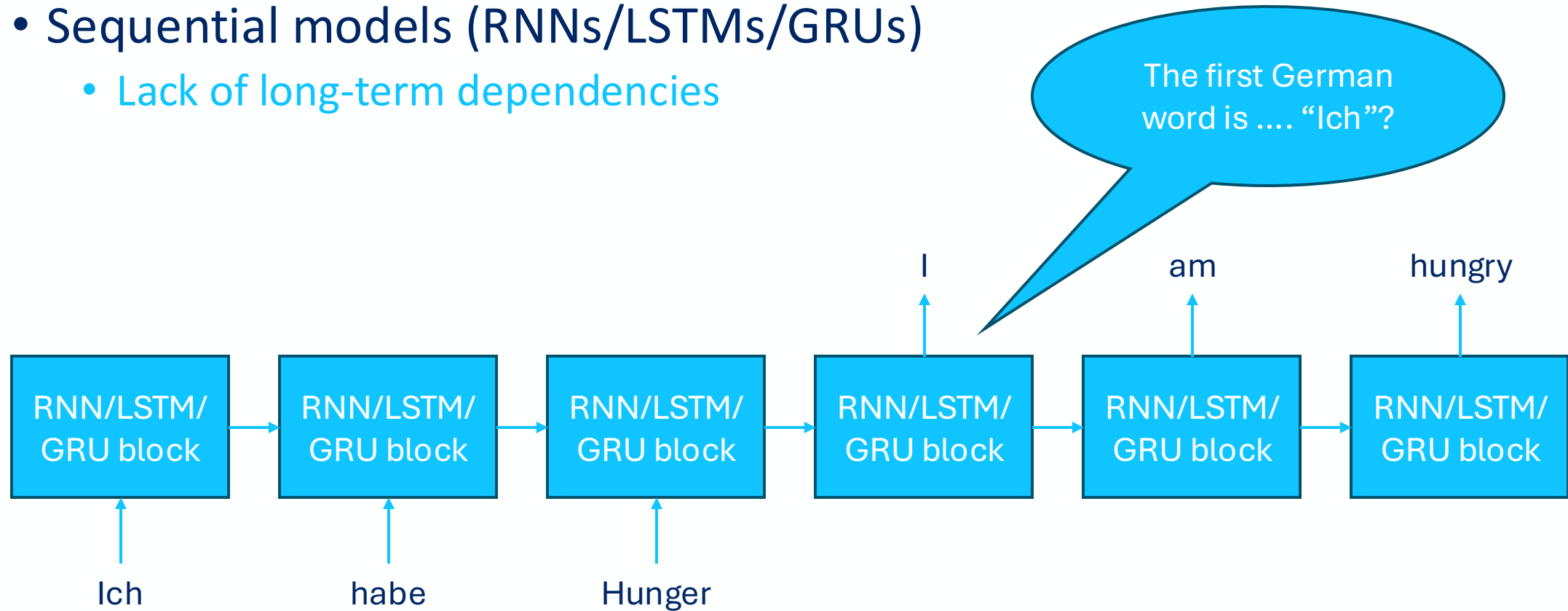
Before Transformer

- Sequential models (RNNs/LSTMs/GRUs)



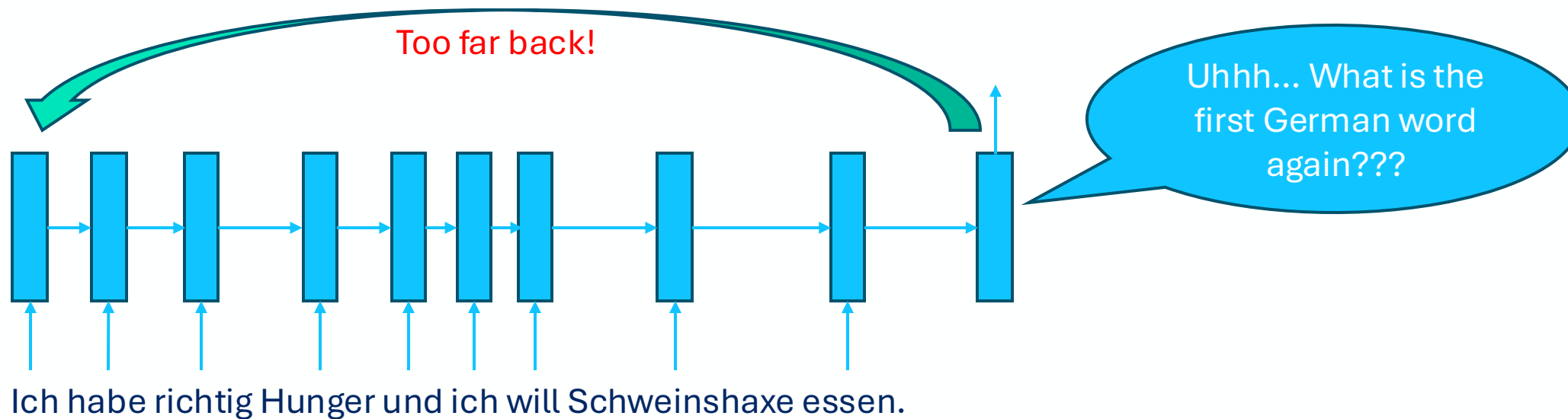
Before Transformer

- Sequential models (RNNs/LSTMs/GRUs)
 - Lack of long-term dependencies



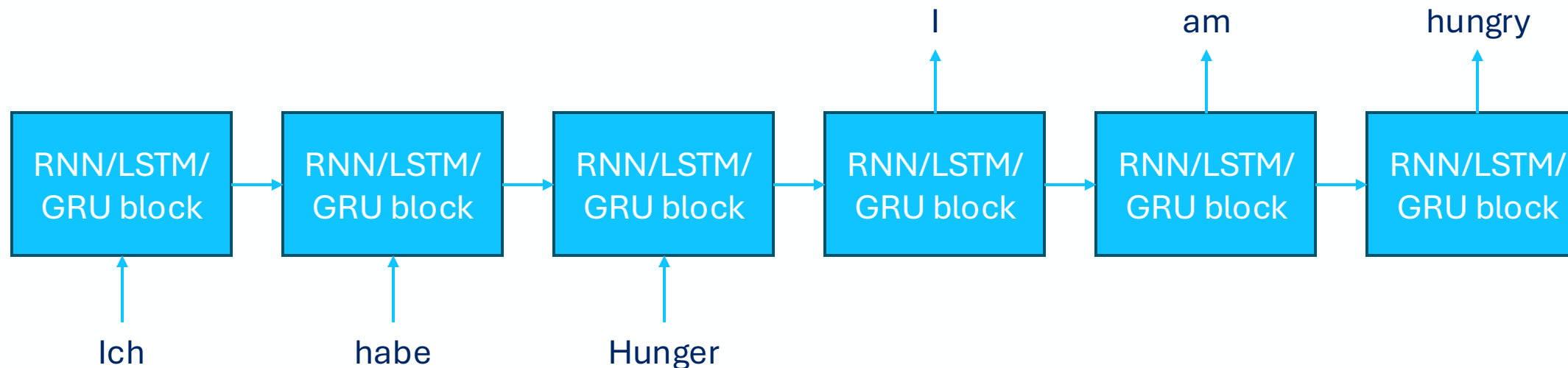
Before Transformer

- Sequential models (RNNs/LSTMs/GRUs)
 - Lack of long-term dependencies
 - Especially when the input is long



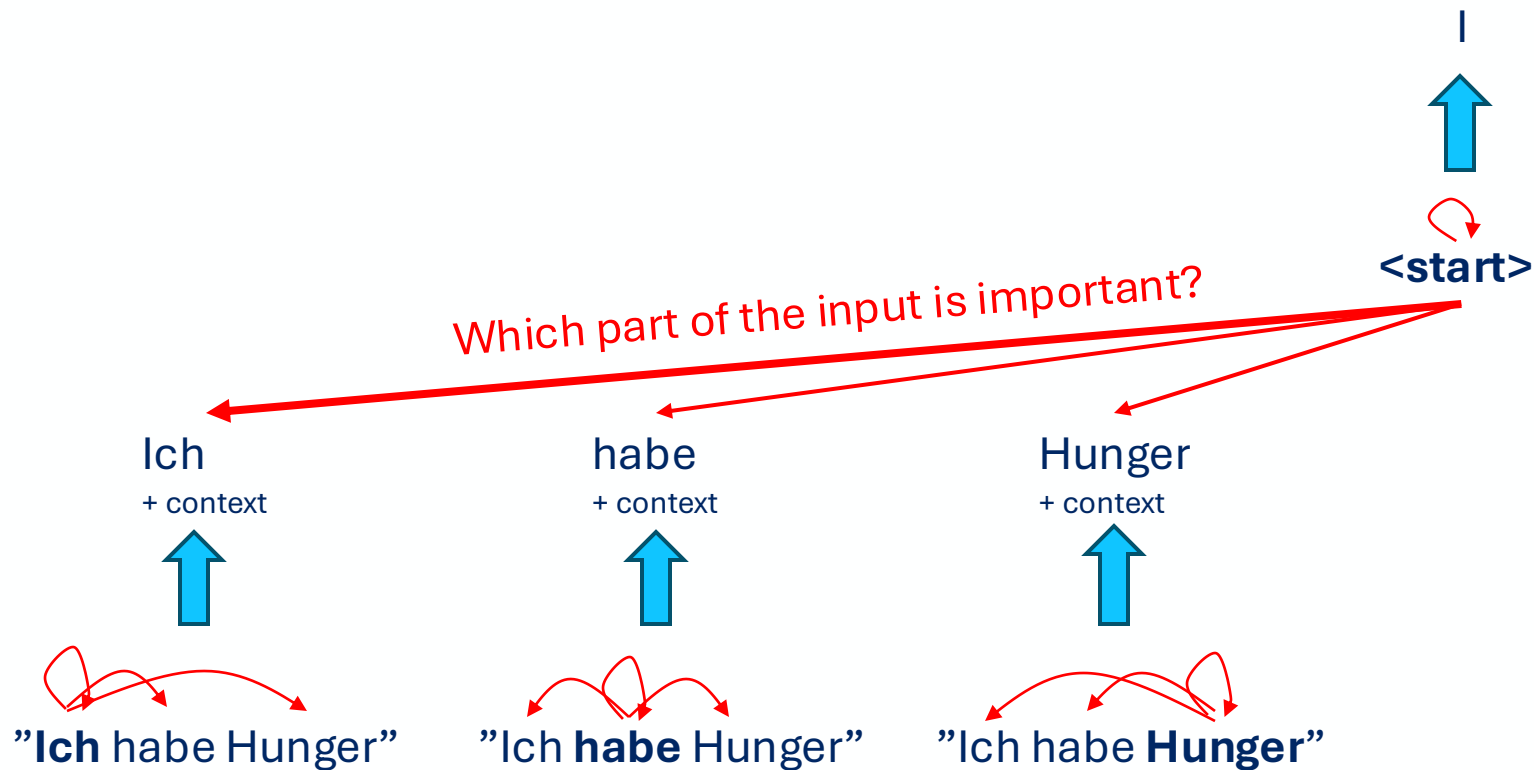
Before Transformer

- Sequential models (RNNs/LSTMs/GRUs)
 - Lack of long-term dependencies
 - Training is slow → sequential, no parallel



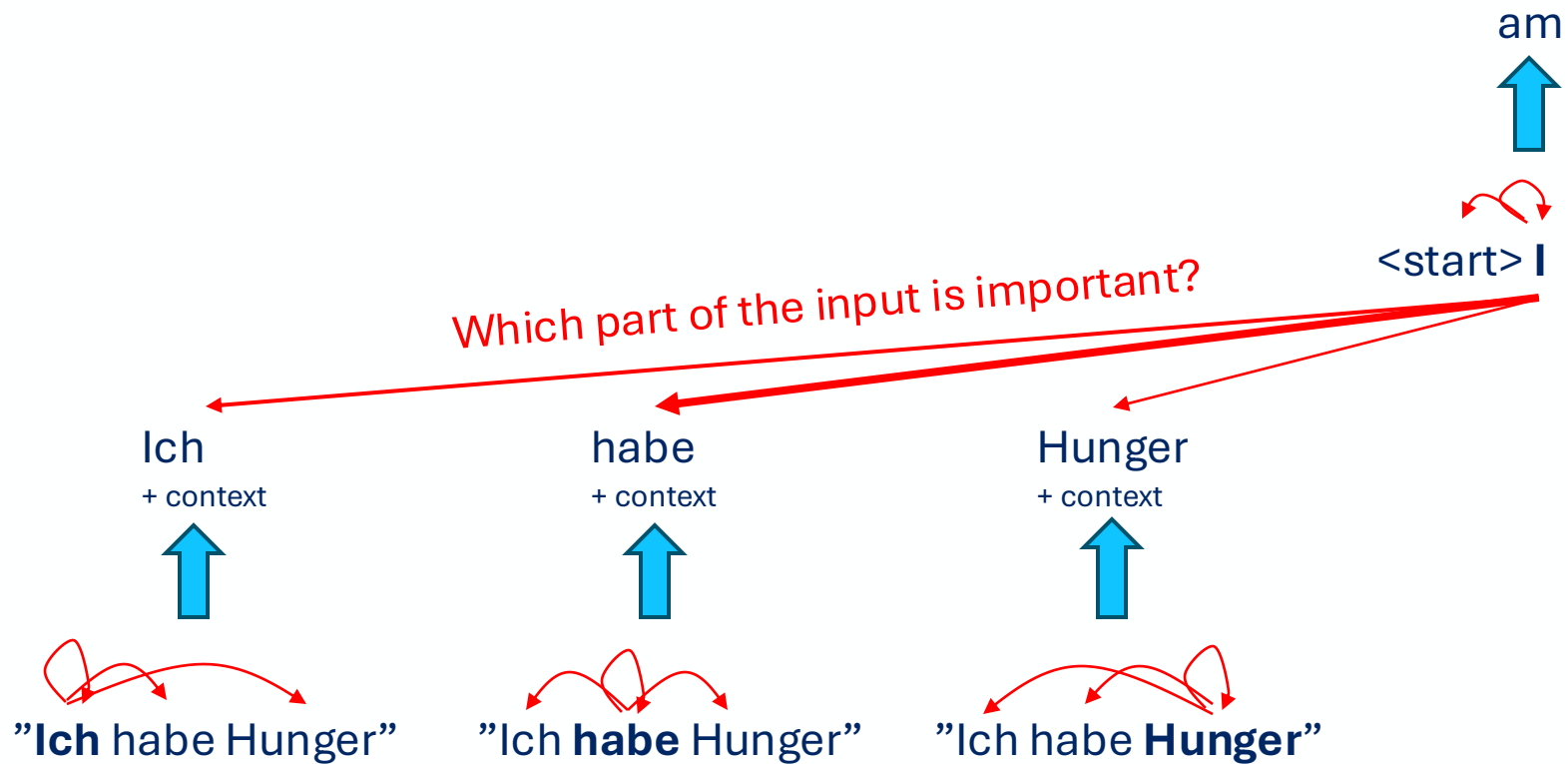
Transformer

- Attention mechanism → Transformer



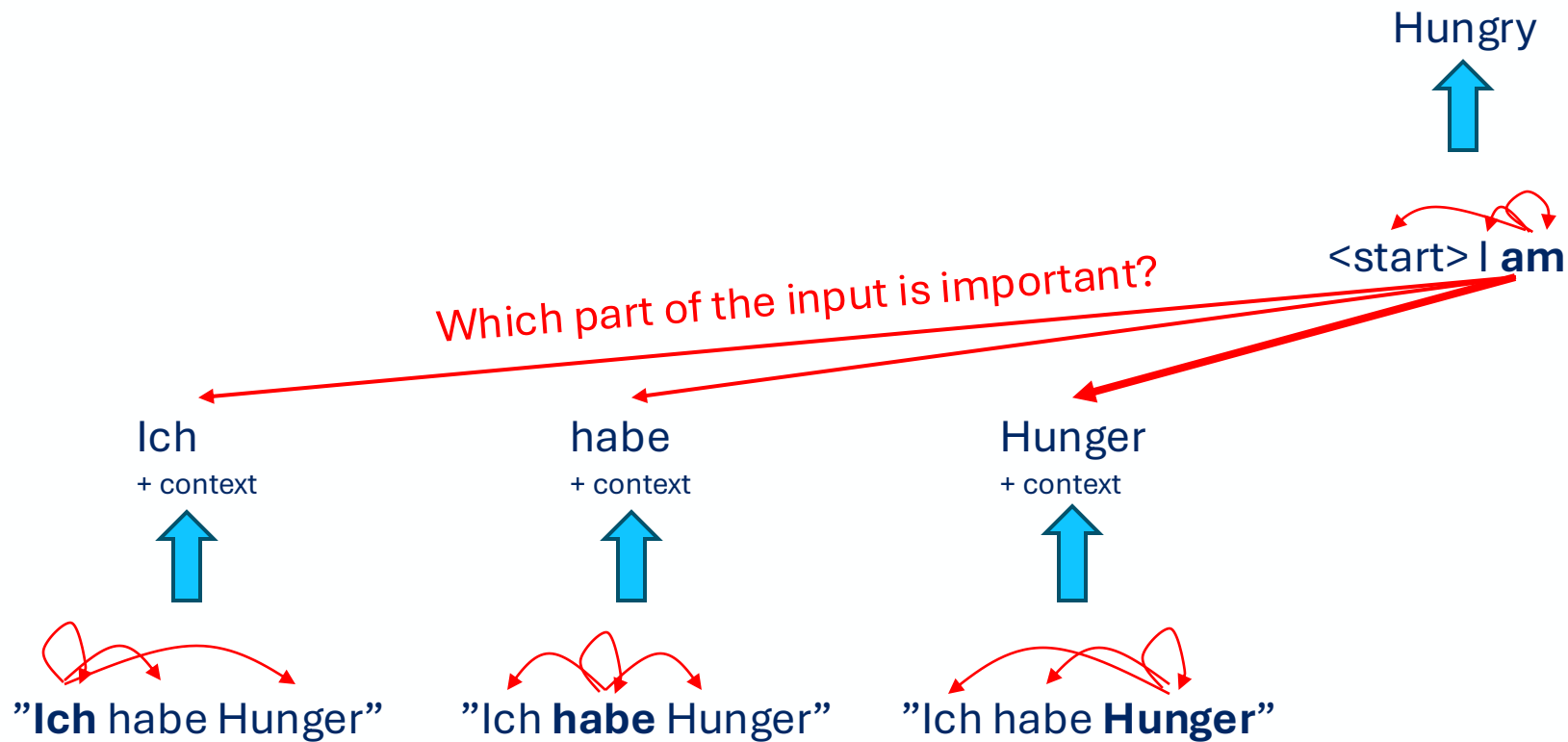
Transformer

- Attention mechanism → Transformer



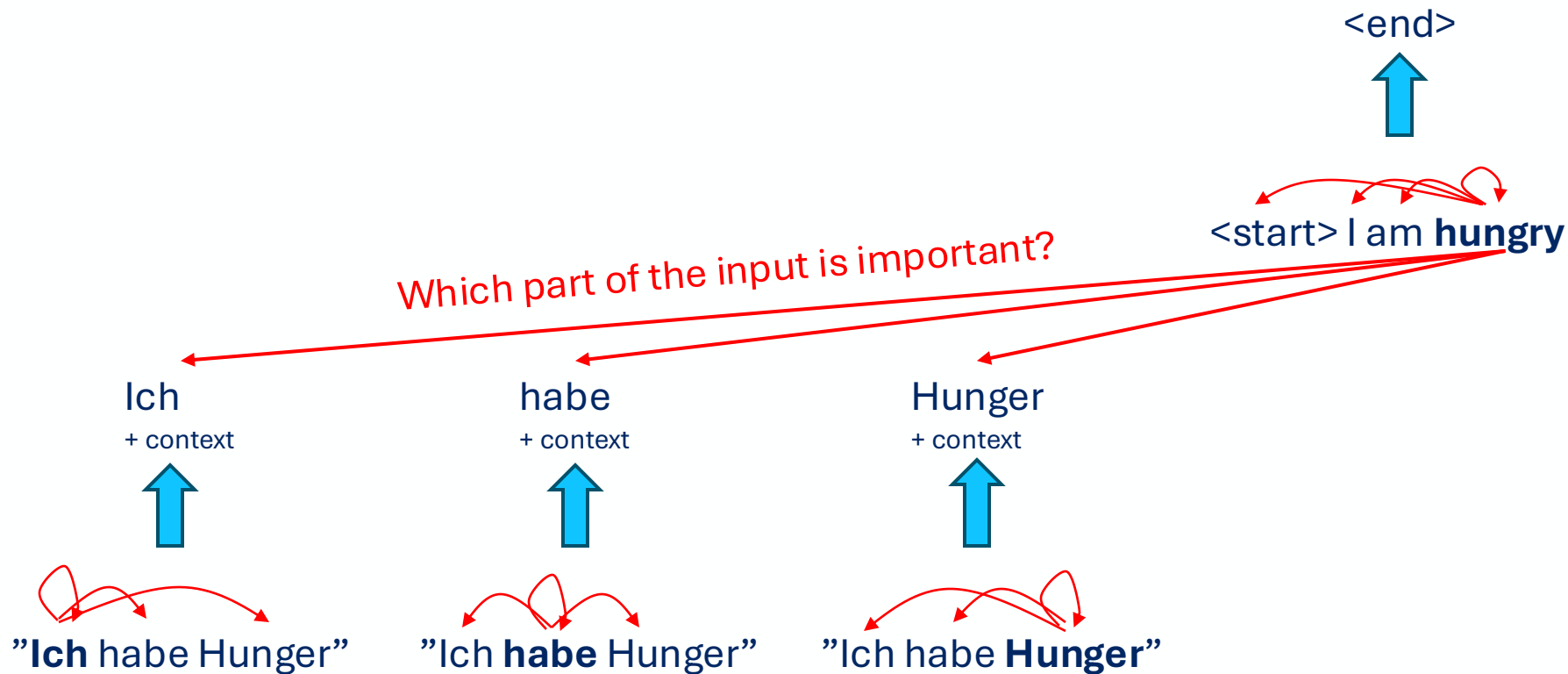
Transformer

- Attention mechanism → Transformer



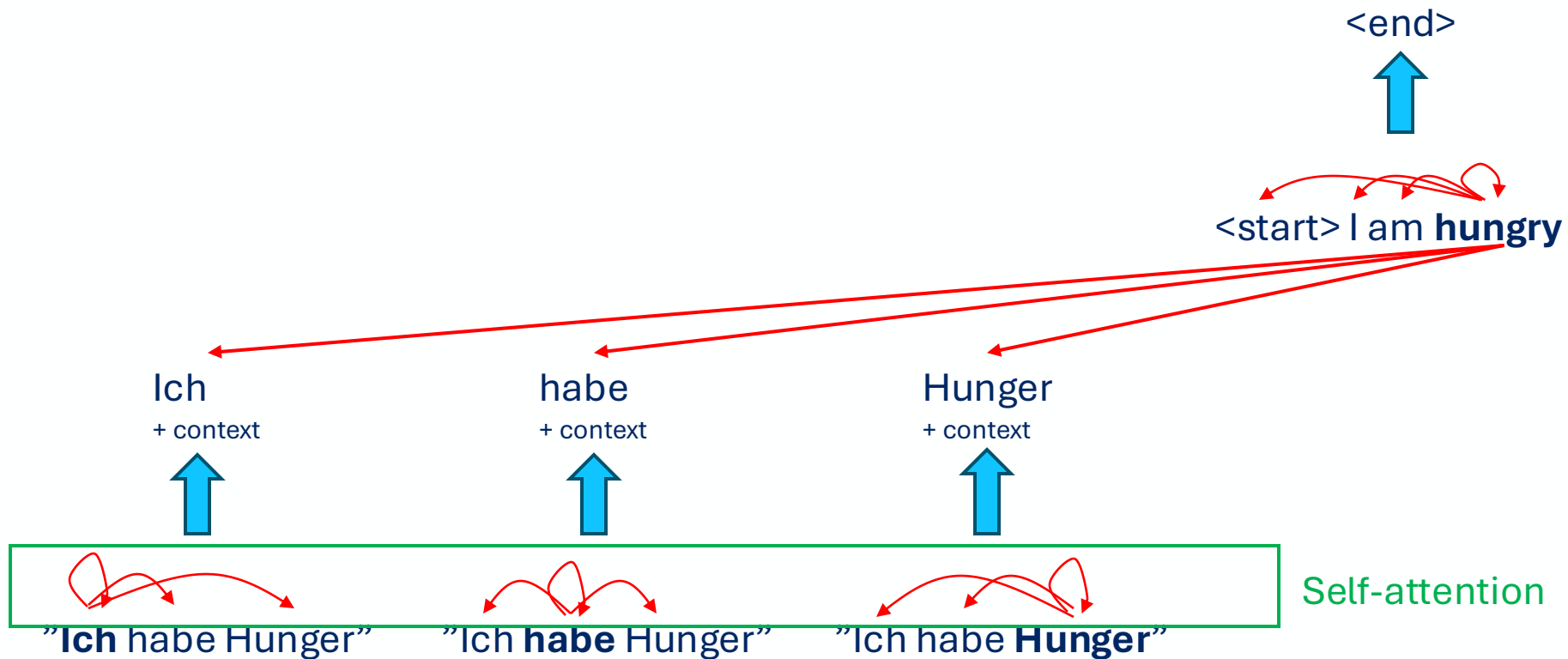
Transformer

- Attention mechanism → Transformer



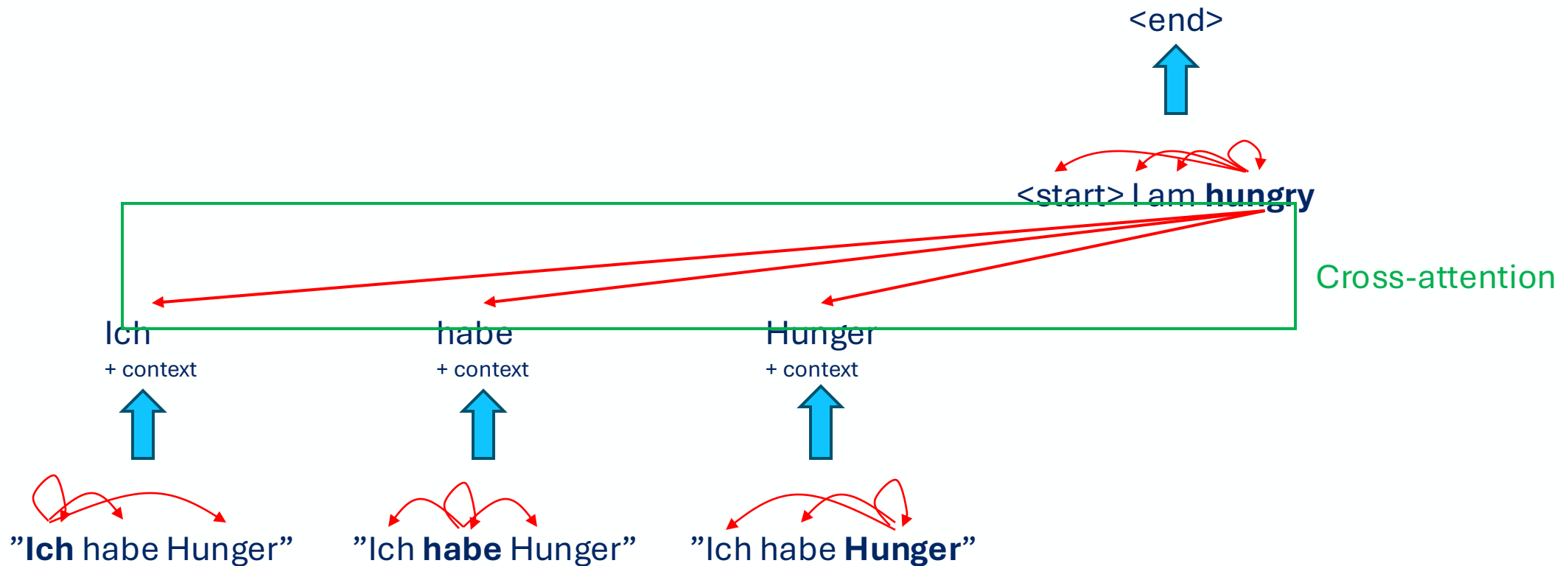
Transformer

- Attention mechanism → Transformer



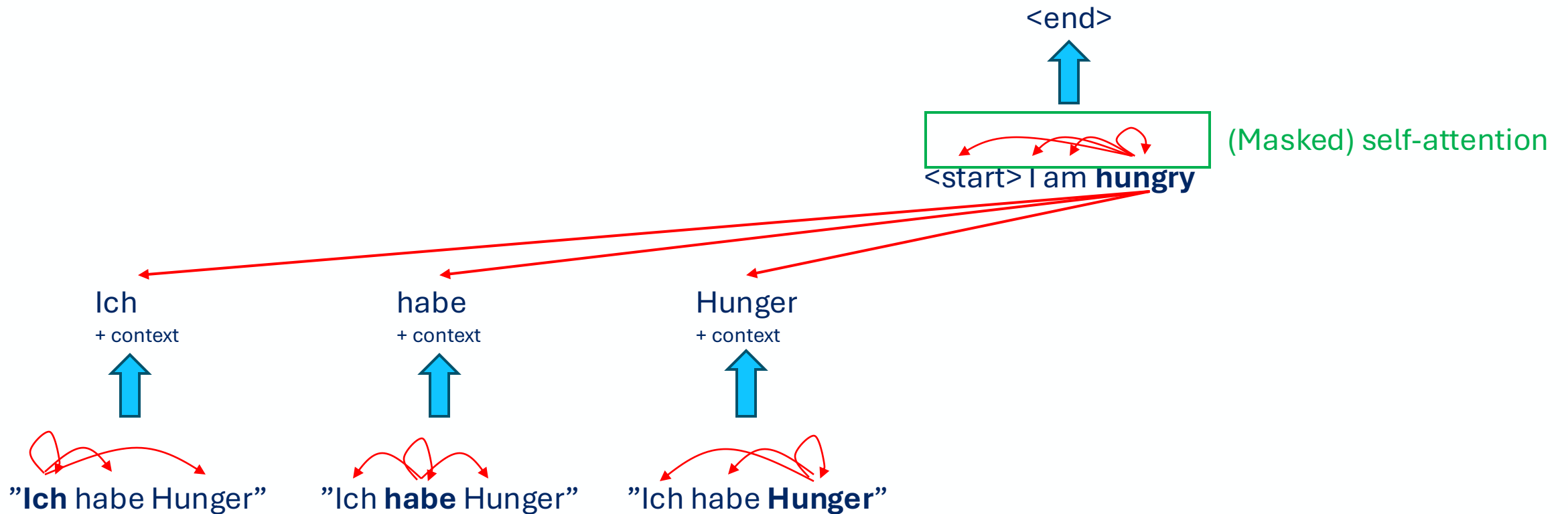
Transformer

- Attention mechanism → Transformer



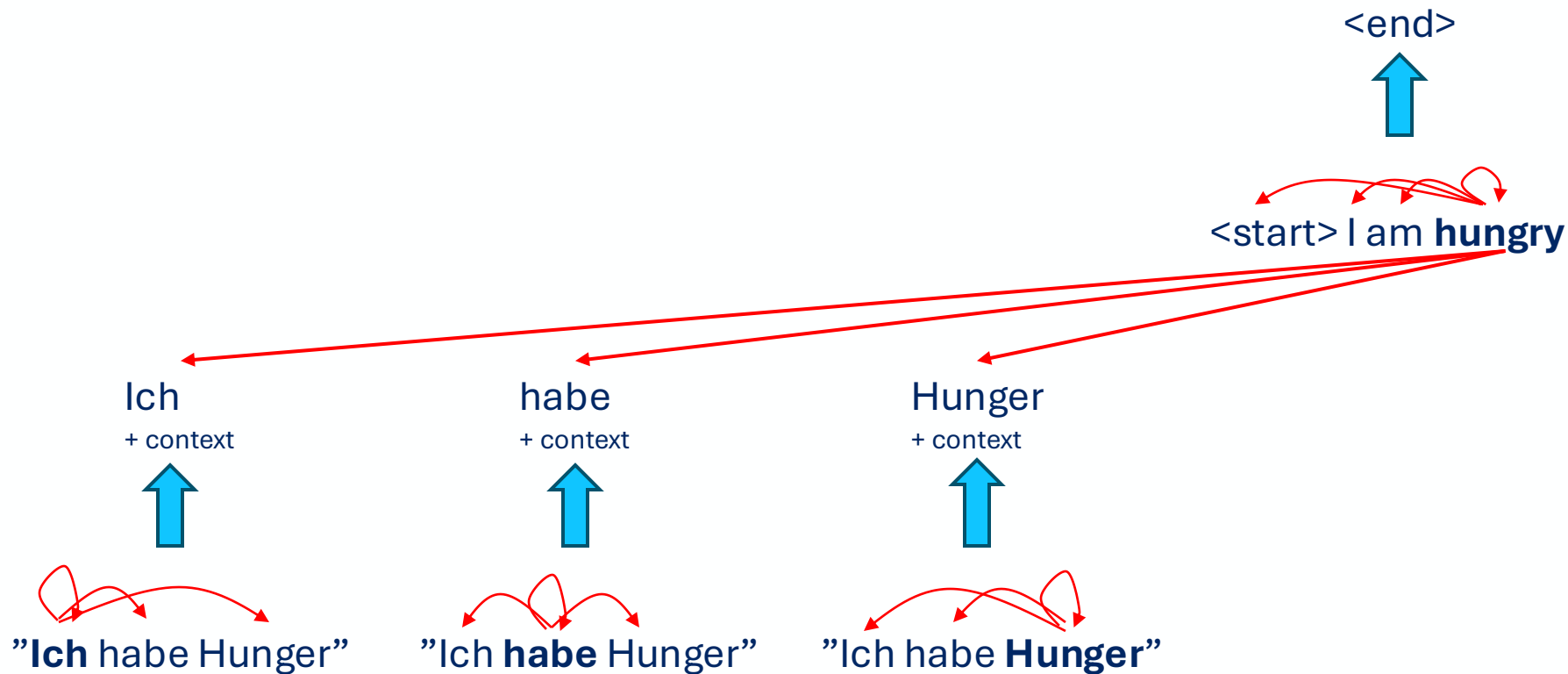
Transformer

- Attention mechanism → Transformer



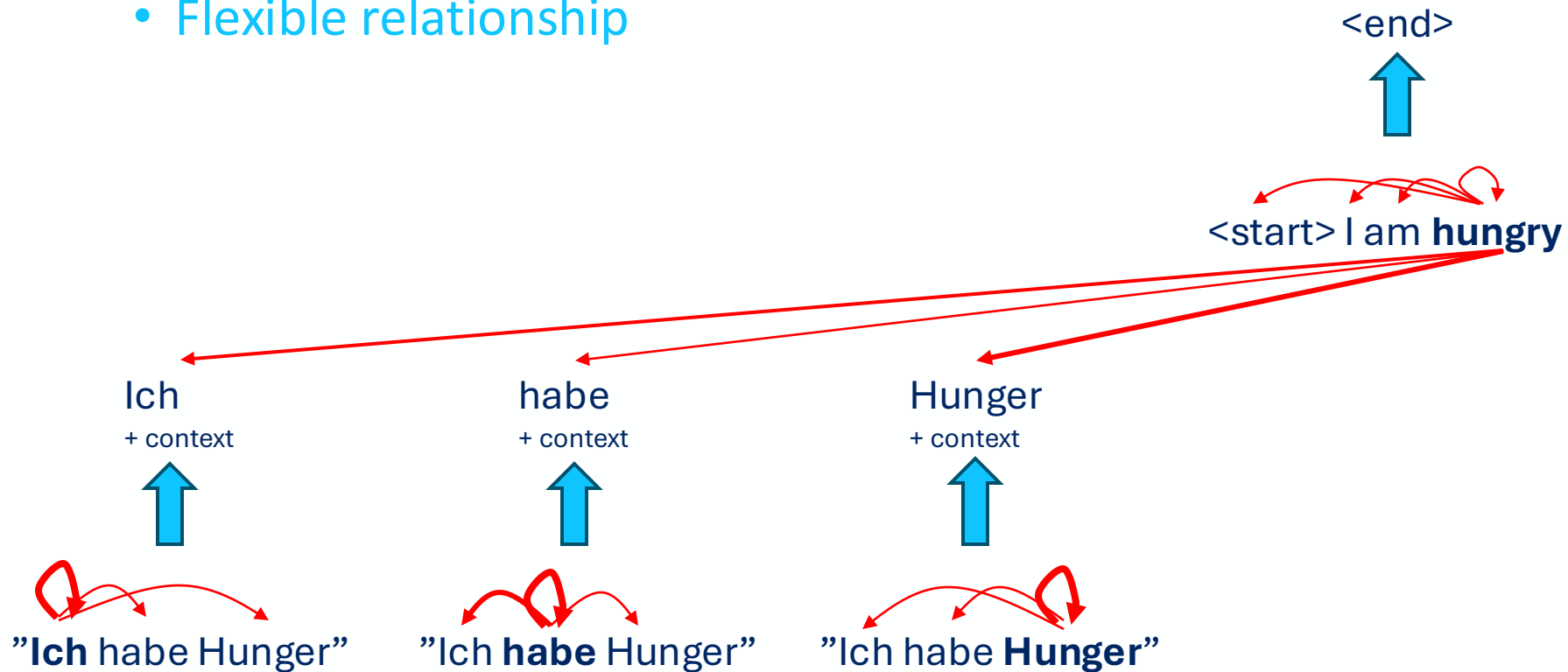
Transformer

- Attention mechanism → Transformer
 - Extract global view



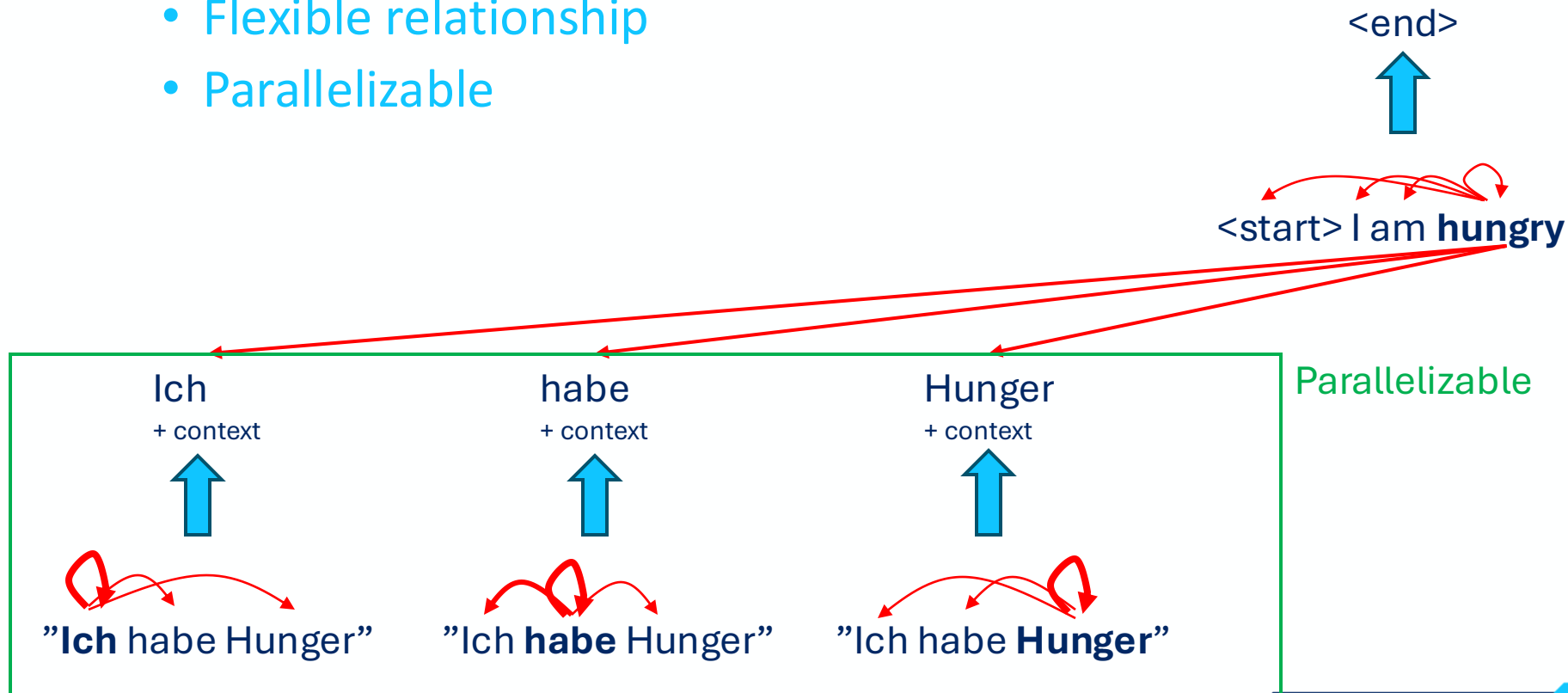
Transformer

- Attention mechanism → Transformer
 - Extract global view
 - Flexible relationship



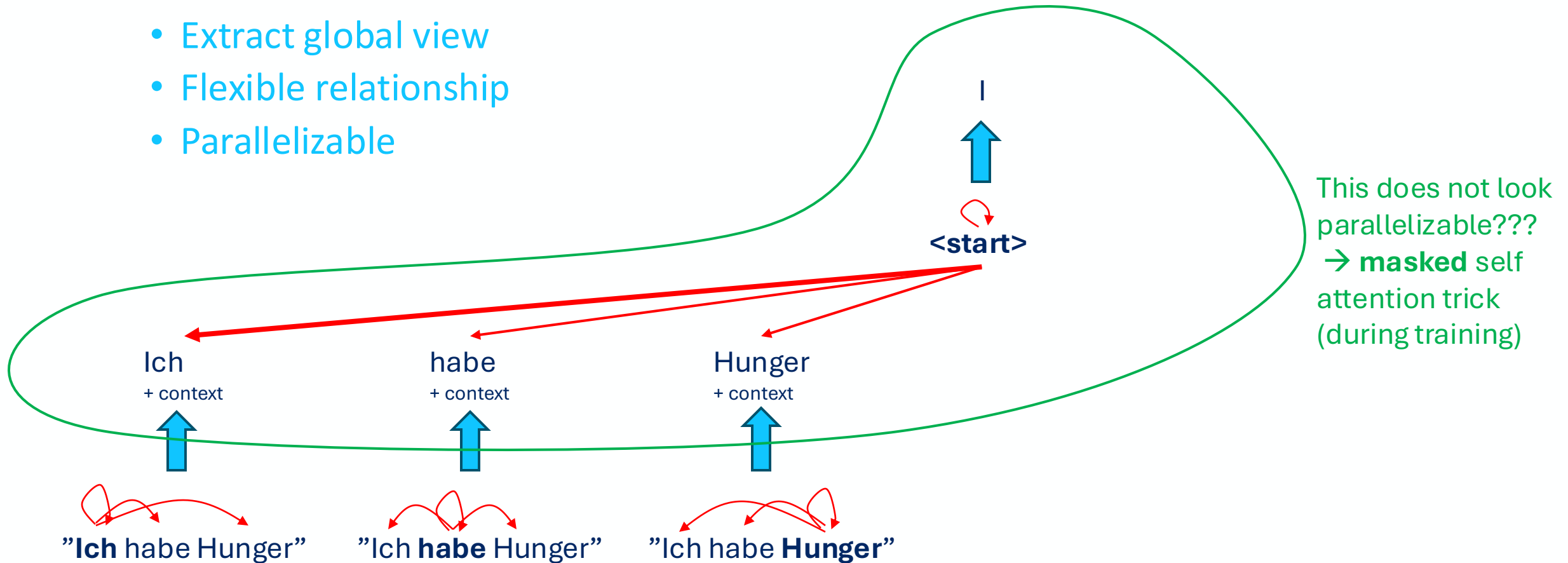
Transformer

- Attention mechanism → Transformer
 - Extract global view
 - Flexible relationship
 - Parallelizable



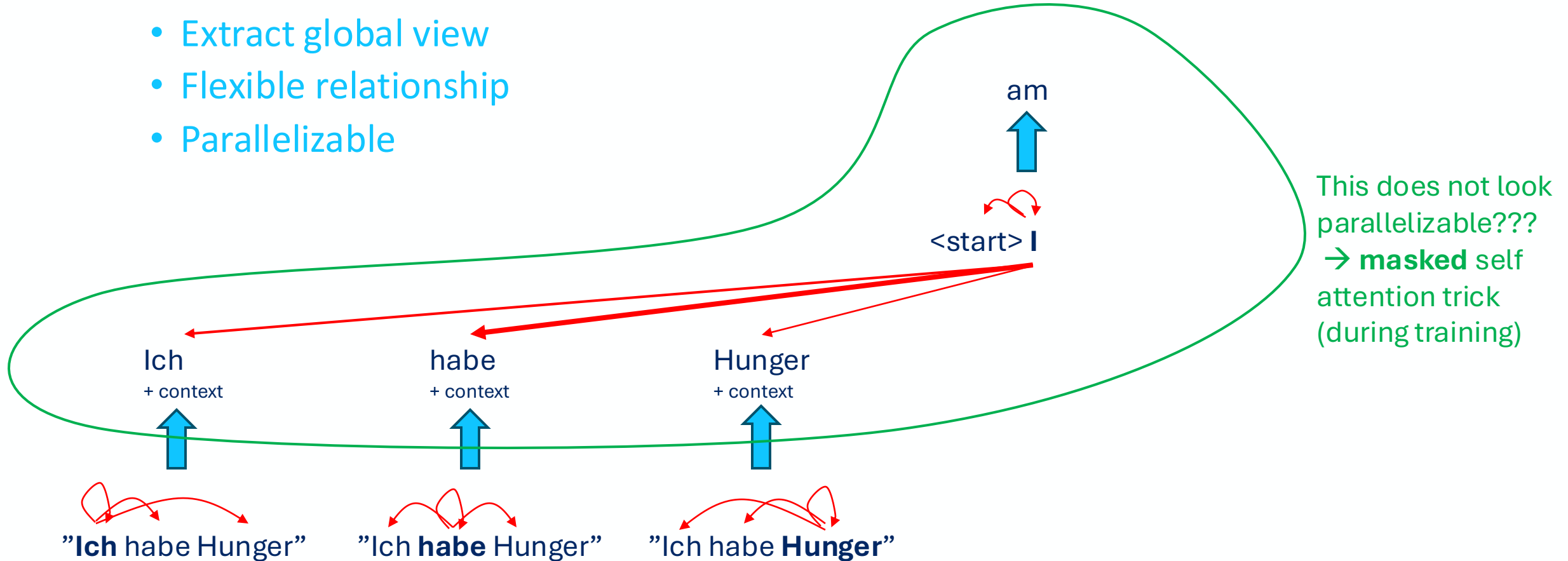
Transformer

- Attention mechanism → Transformer
 - Extract global view
 - Flexible relationship
 - Parallelizable



Transformer

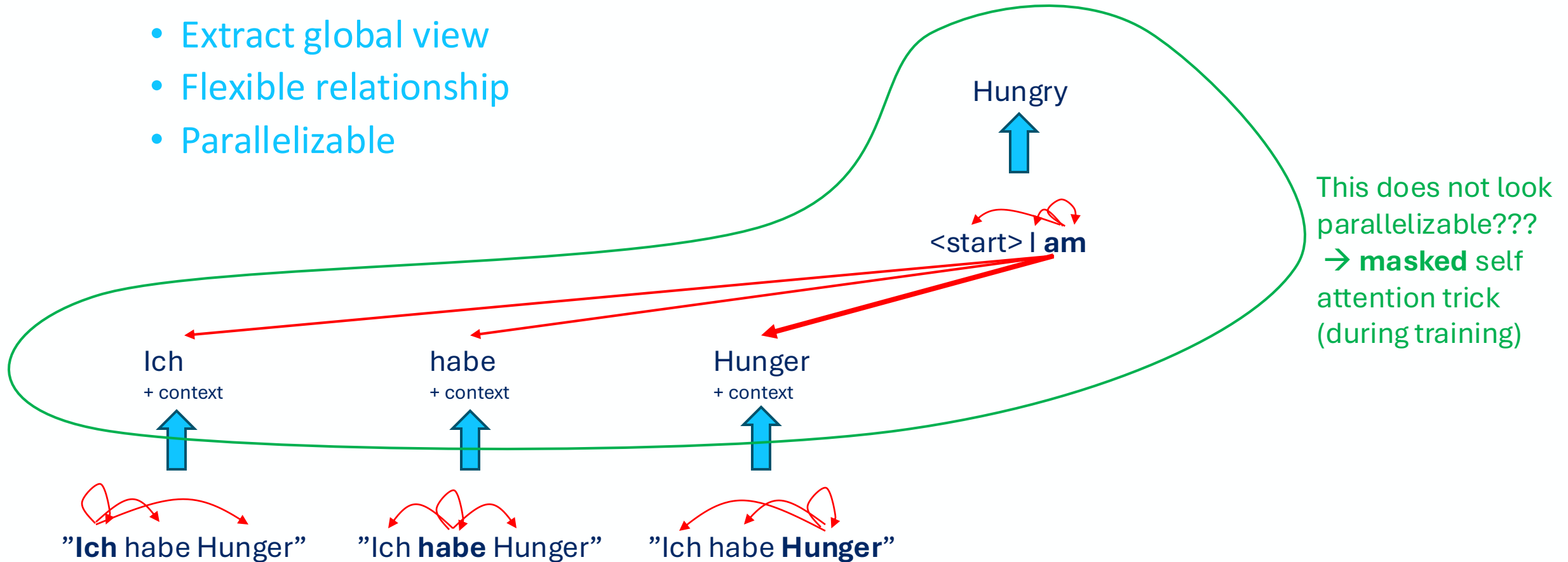
- Attention mechanism → Transformer
 - Extract global view
 - Flexible relationship
 - Parallelizable



Transformer

- Attention mechanism → Transformer

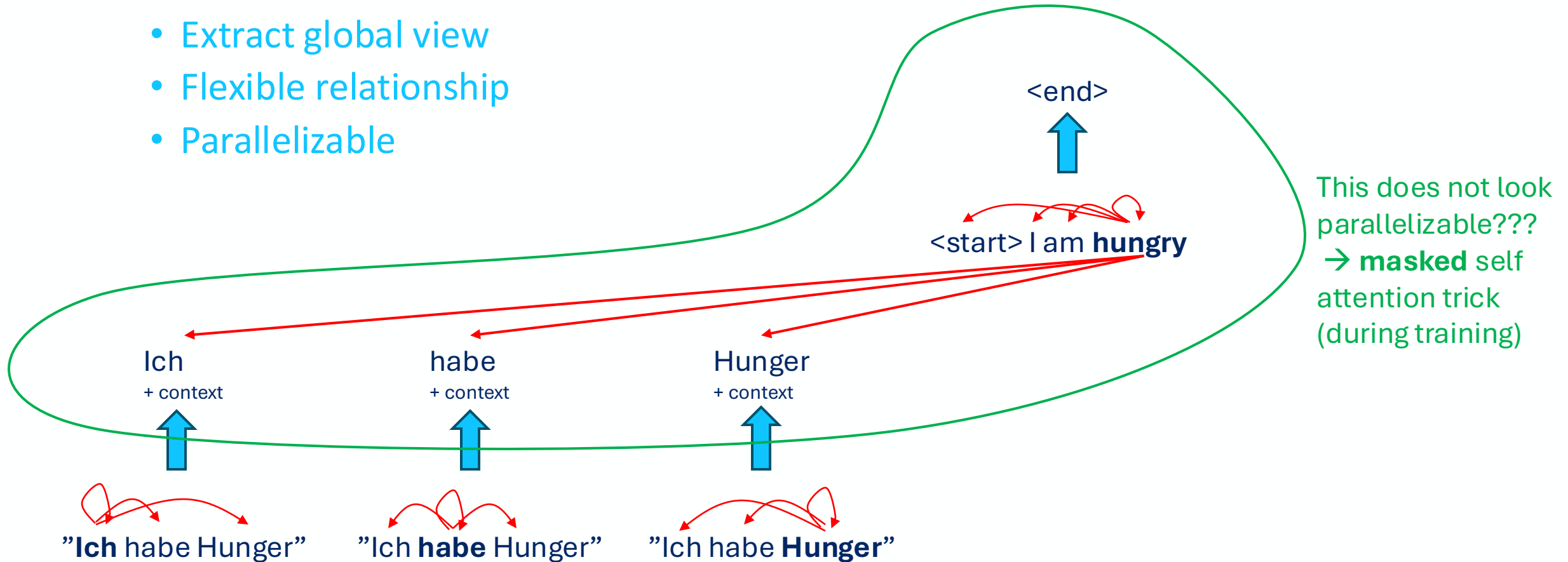
- Extract global view
- Flexible relationship
- Parallelizable



Transformer

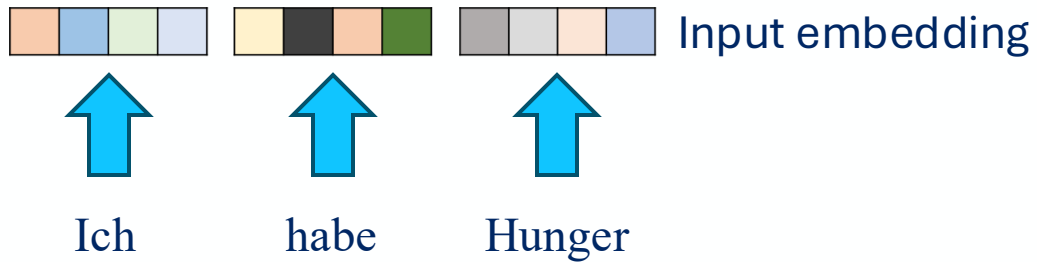
- Attention mechanism → Transformer

- Extract global view
- Flexible relationship
- Parallelizable

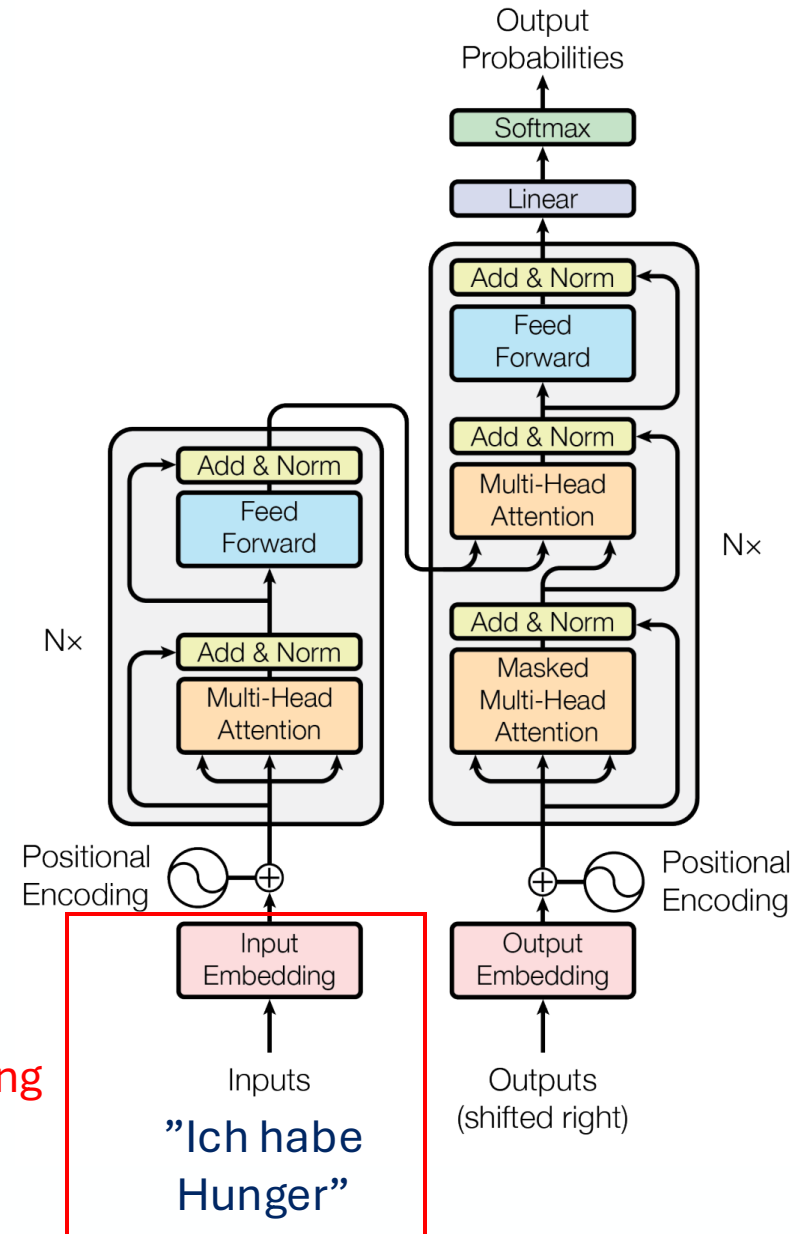


Transformer

- Components:
 - Word embedding

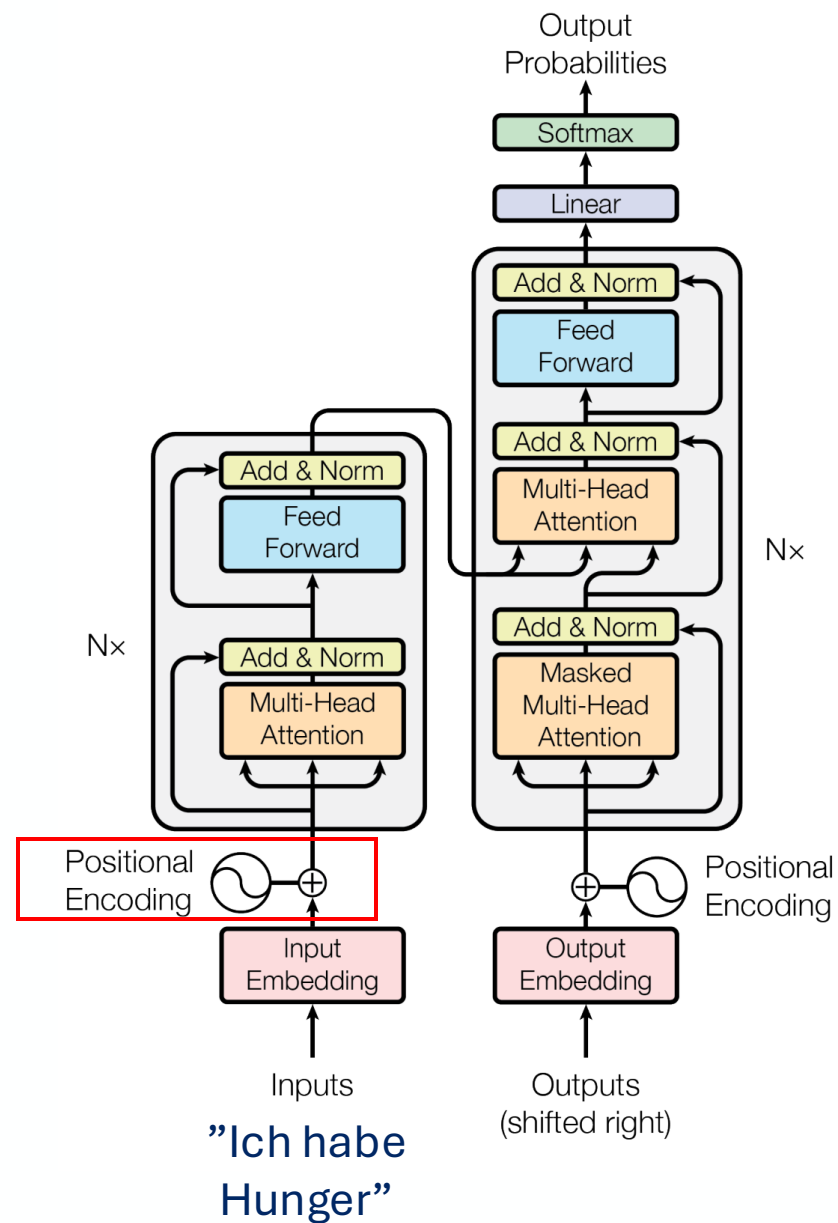


Word embedding



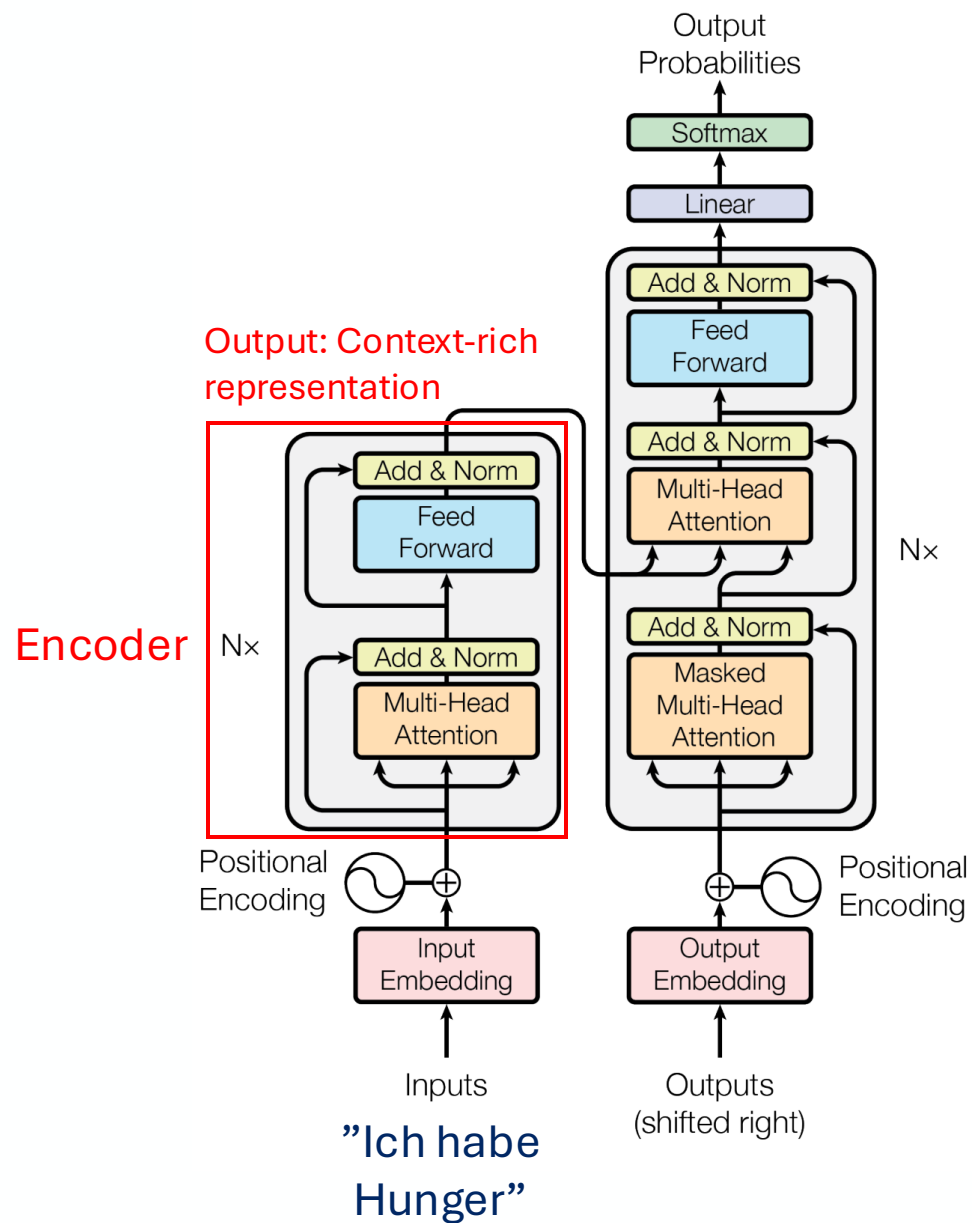
Transformer

- Components:
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding



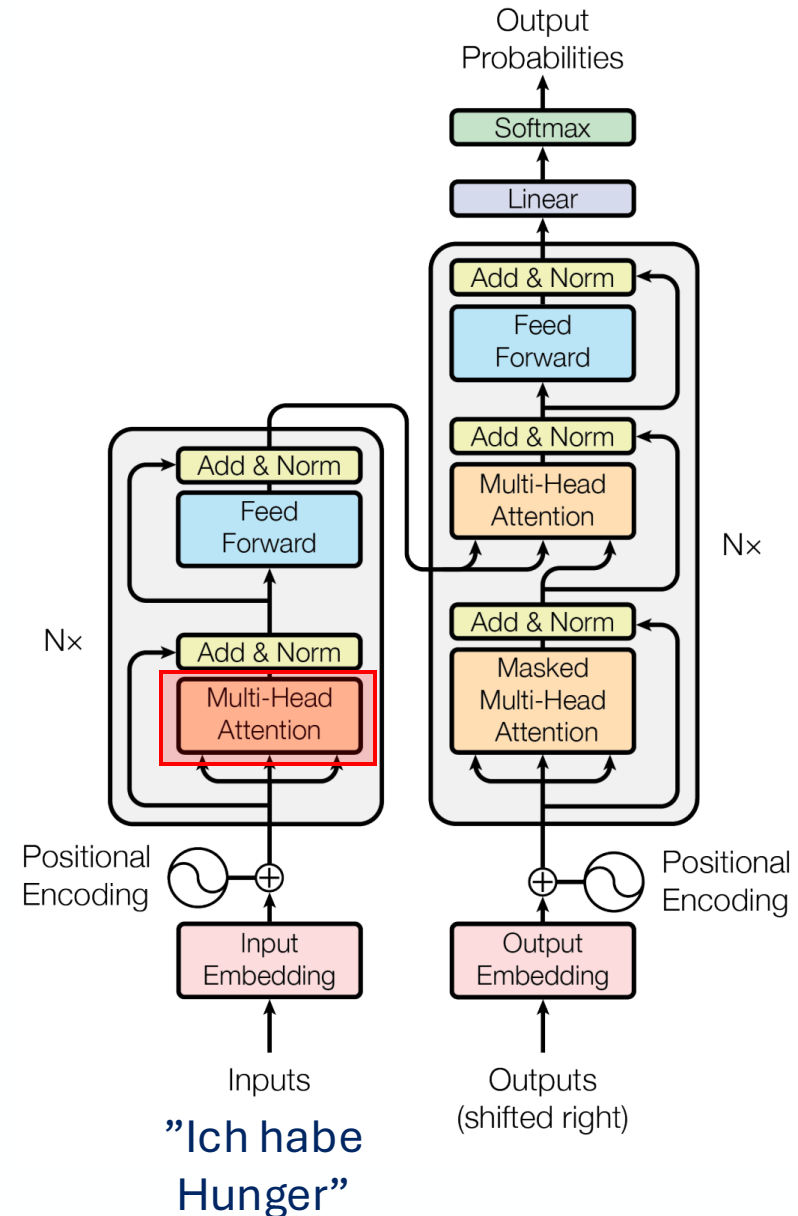
Transformer

- Components:
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding
 - Encoder



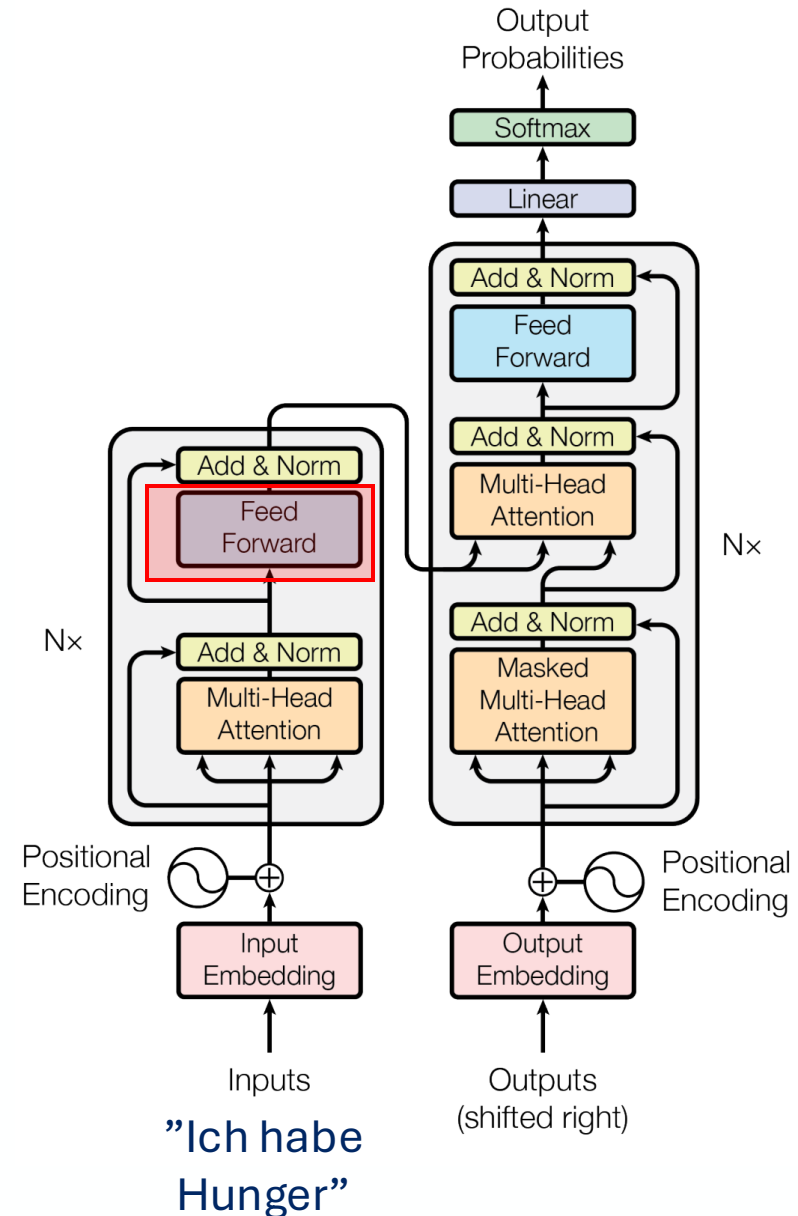
Transformer

- Components:
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding
 - Encoder
 - Multi-head self-attention



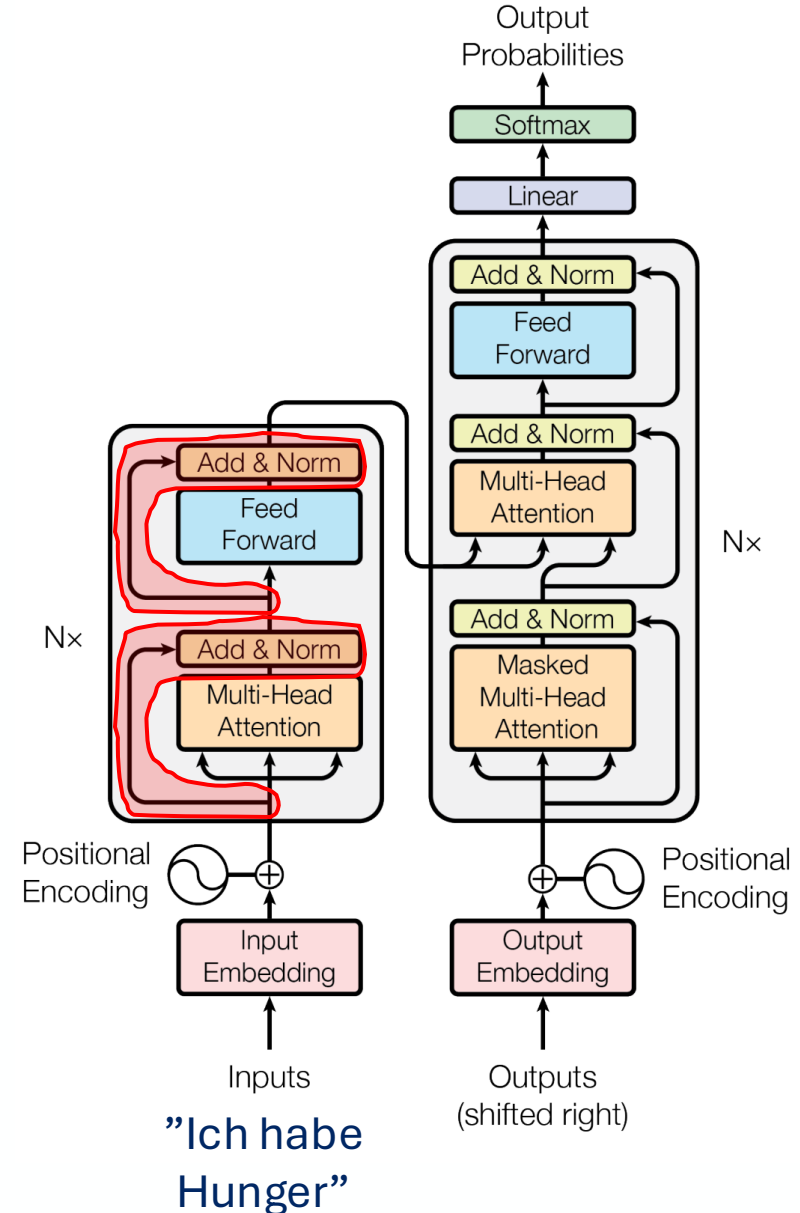
Transformer

- Components:
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding
 - Encoder
 - Multi-head self-attention
 - Fully-connected layer



Transformer

- Components:
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding
 - Encoder
 - Multi-head self-attention
 - Fully-connected layer
 - Skip connection with normalization

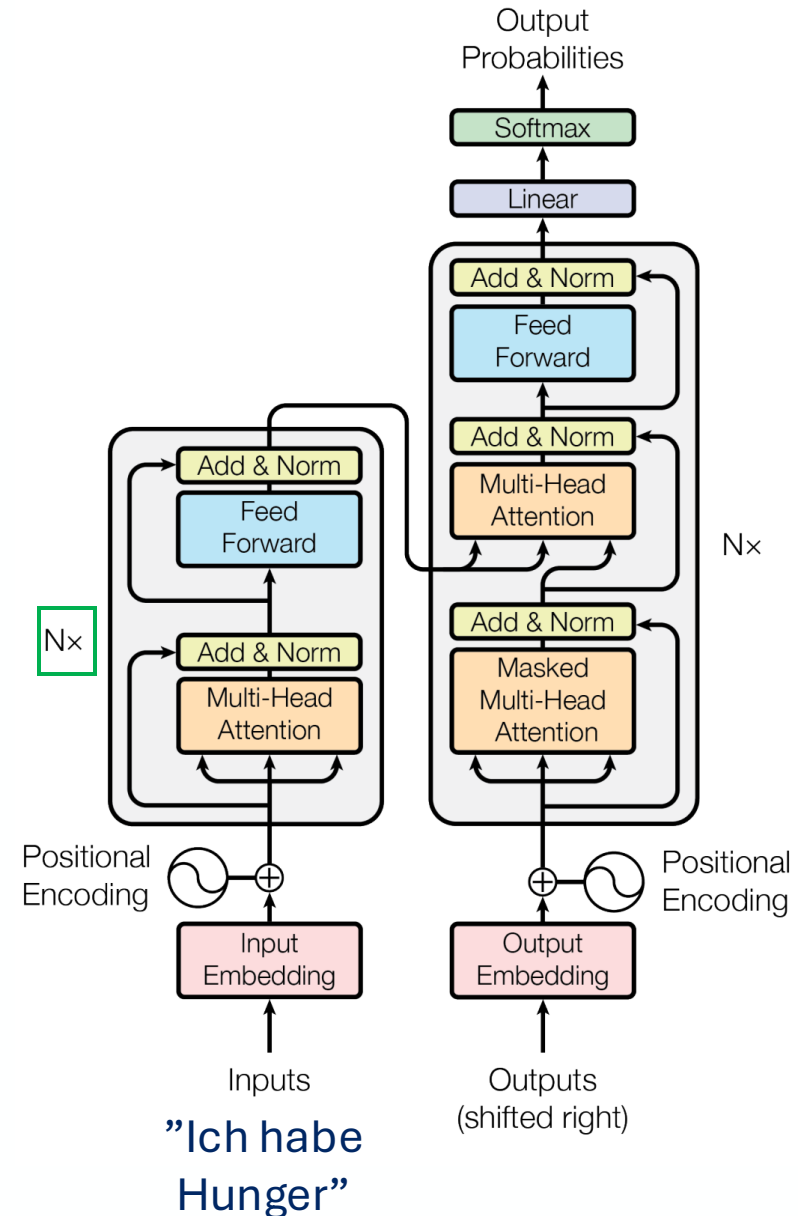
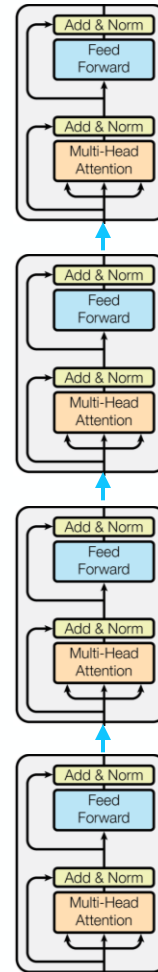


Transformer

- Components:

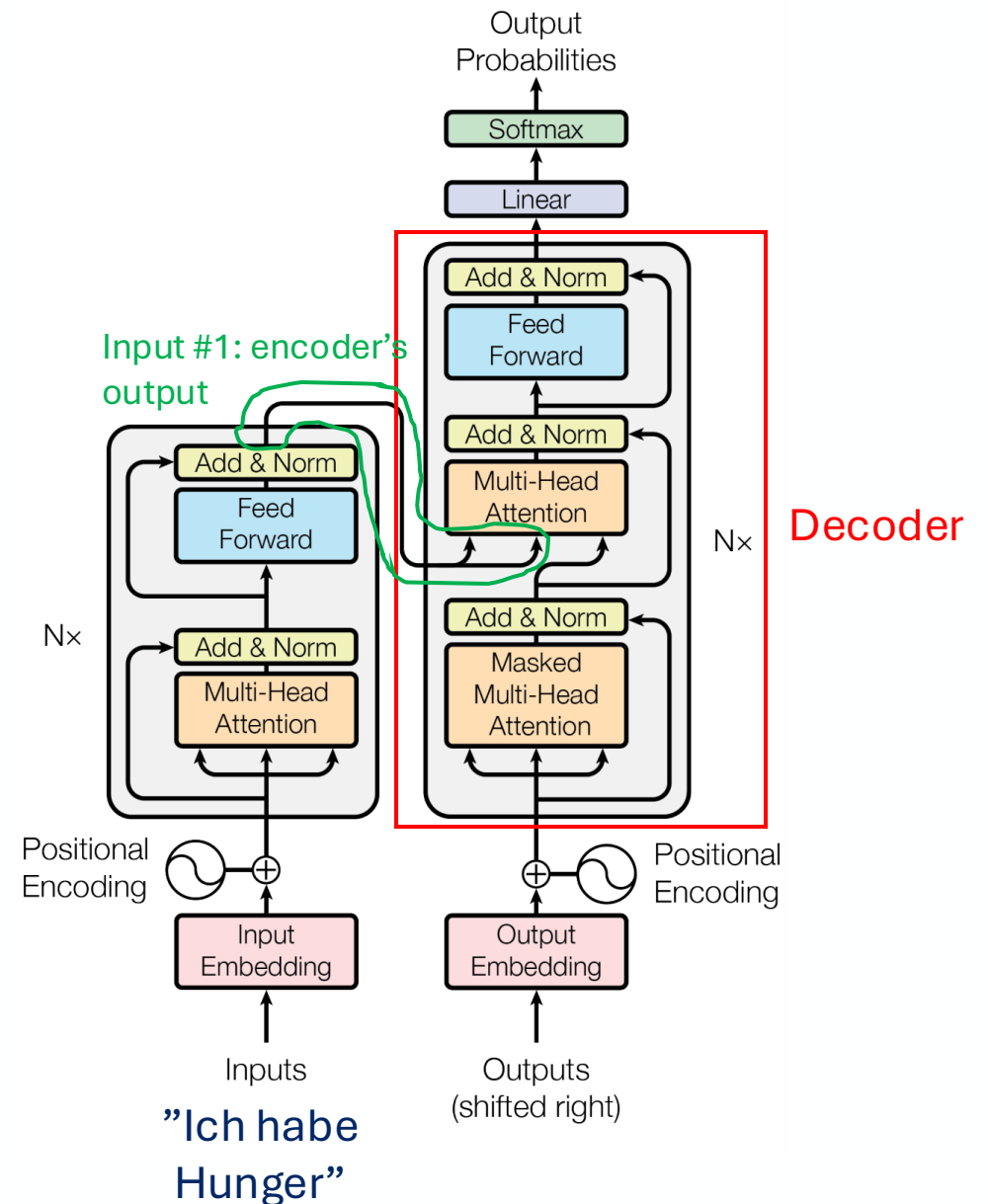
- Word embedding
- Positional encoding
- Encoder
 - N blocks

N=4 looks like



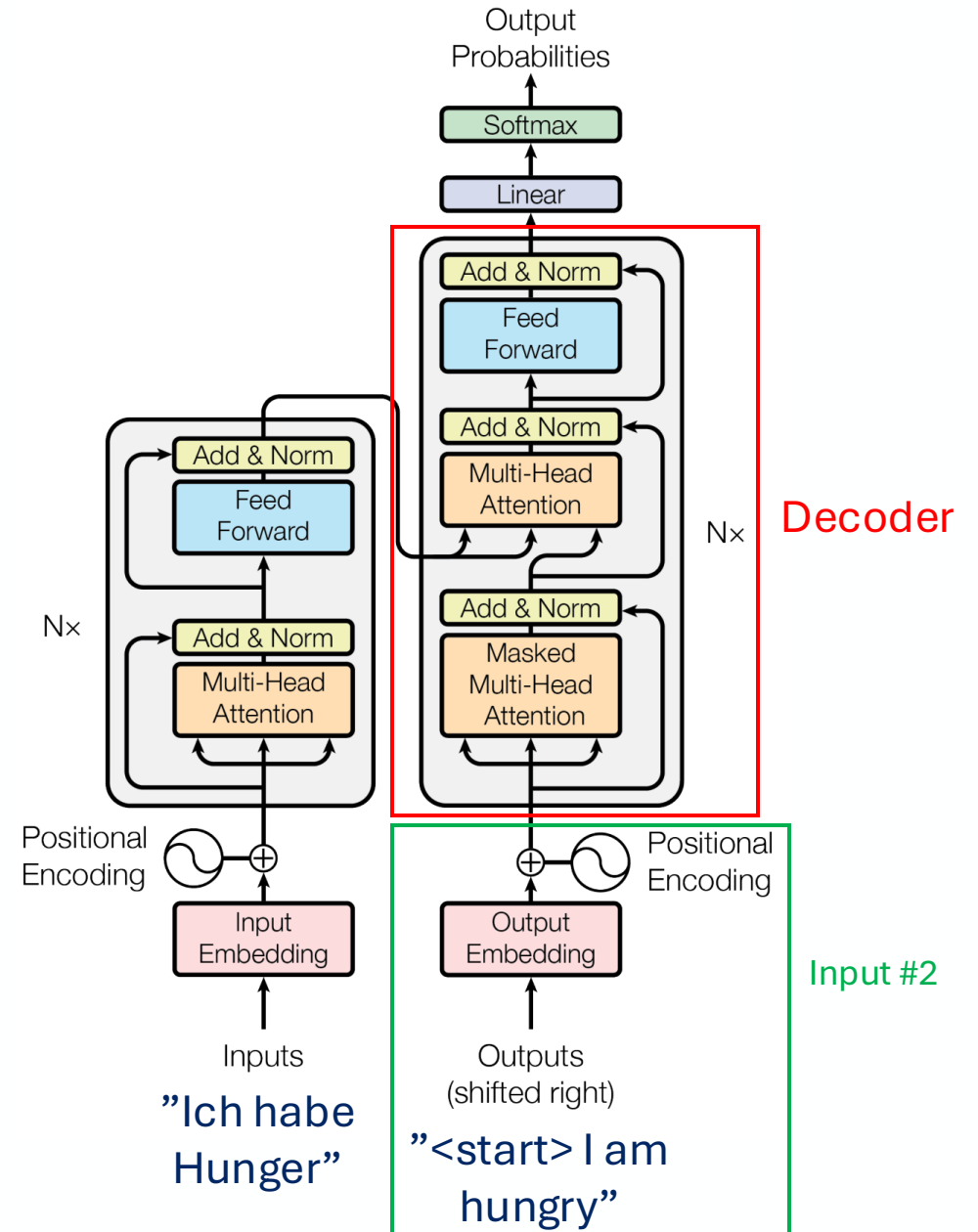
Transformer

- Components:
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding
 - Encoder
 - Decoder



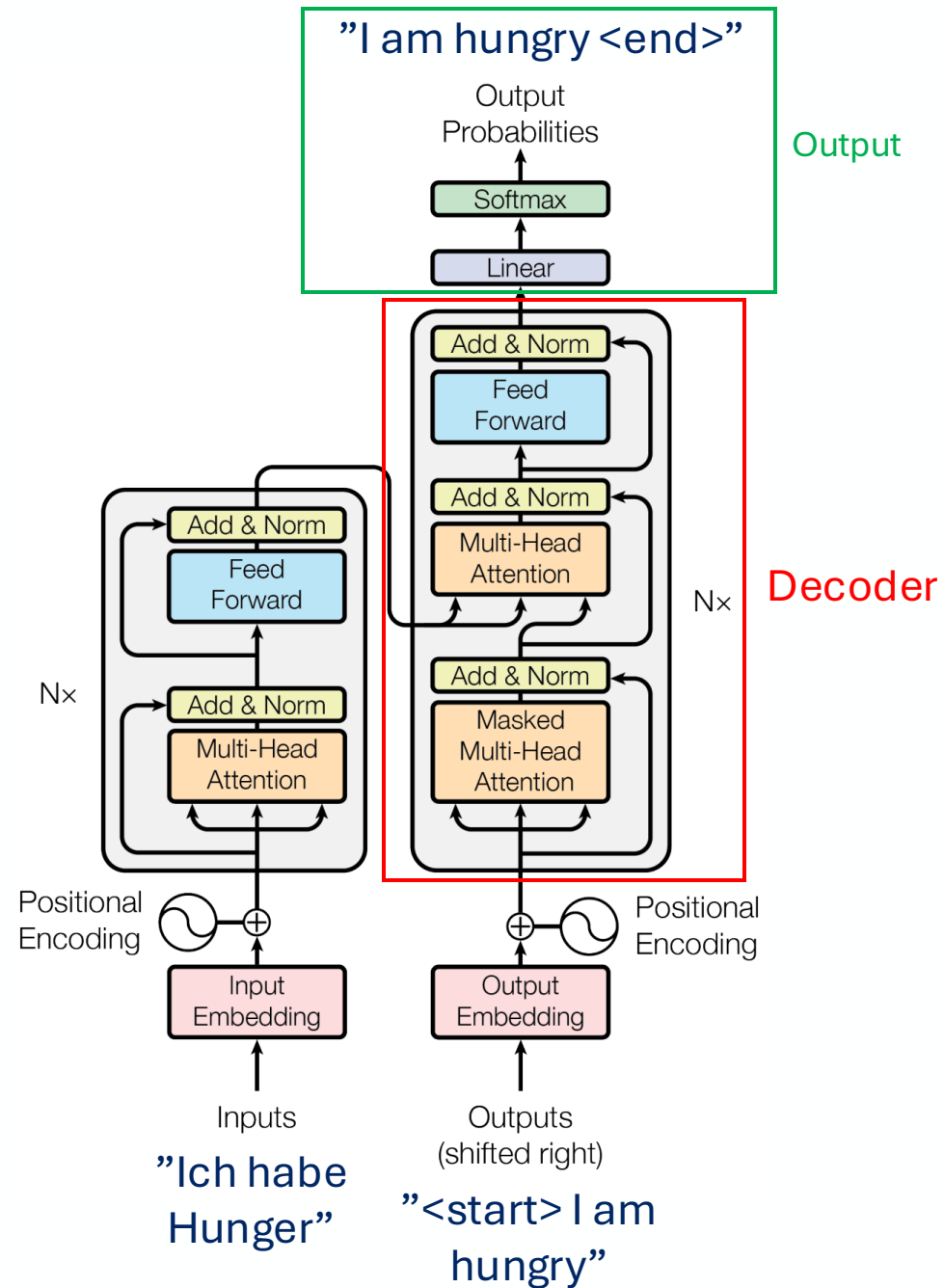
Transformer

- Components:
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding
 - Encoder
 - Decoder



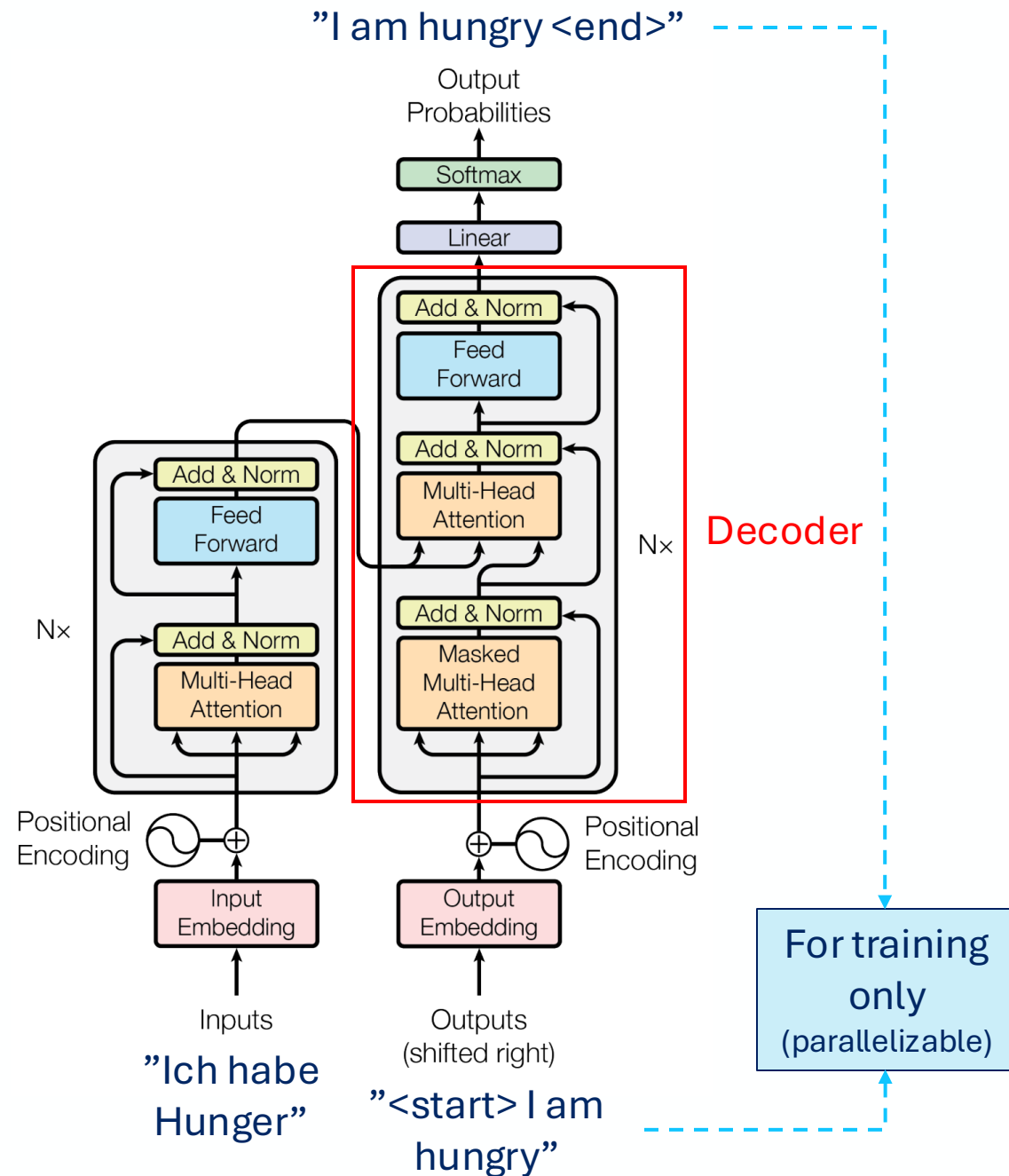
Transformer

- Components:
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding
 - Encoder
 - Decoder



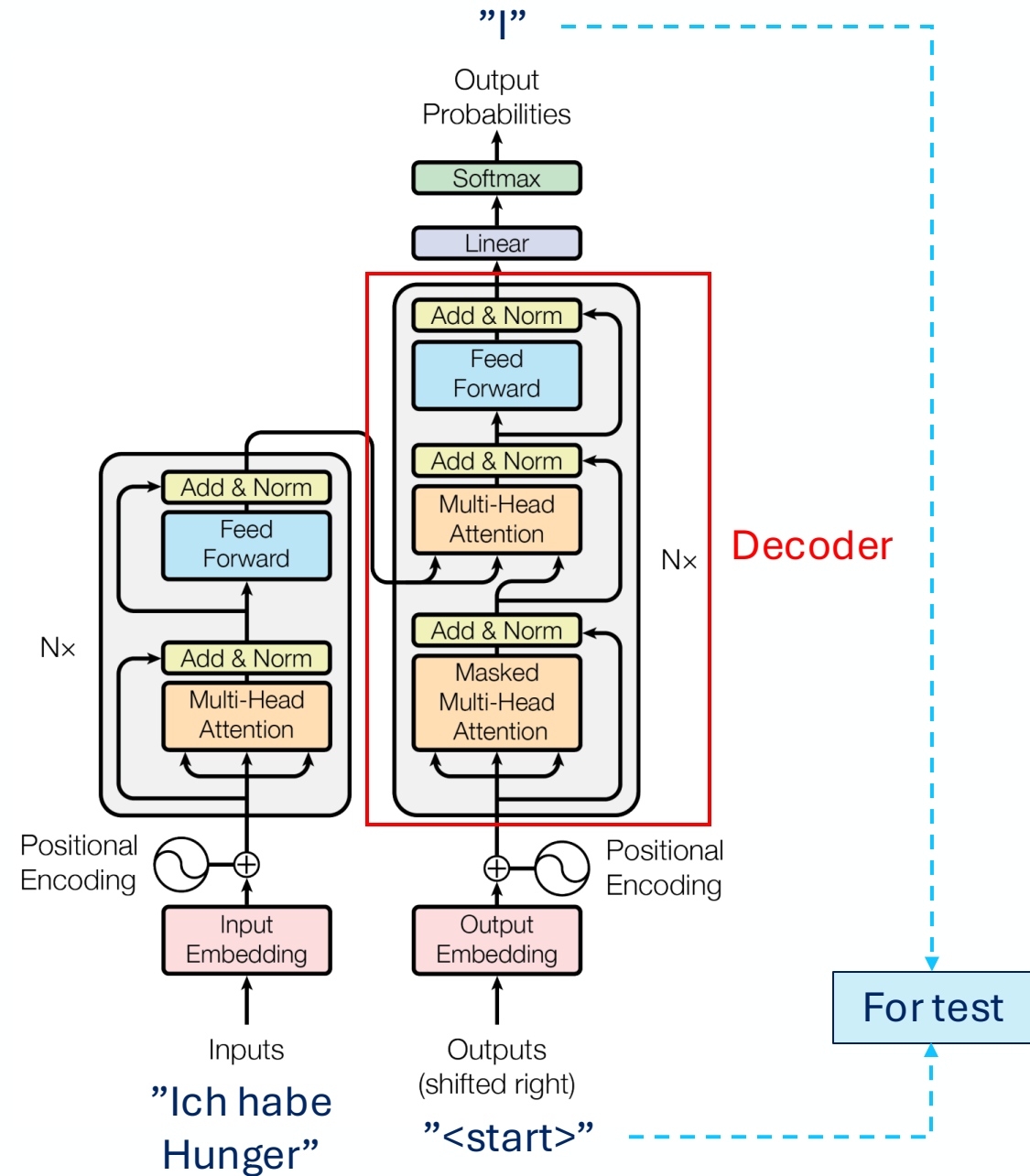
Transformer

- Components:
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding
 - Encoder
 - Decoder



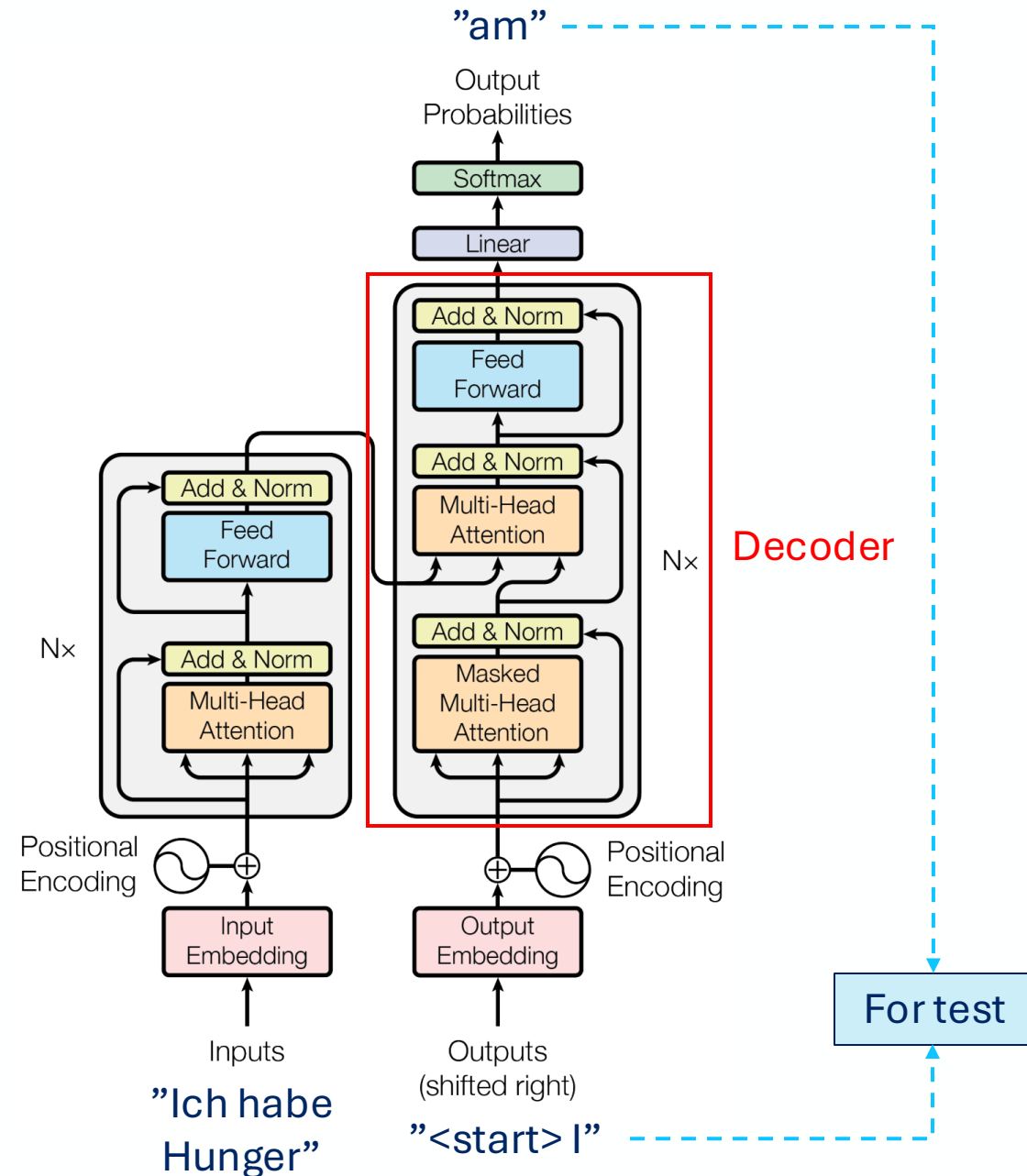
Transformer

- Components:
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding
 - Encoder
 - Decoder



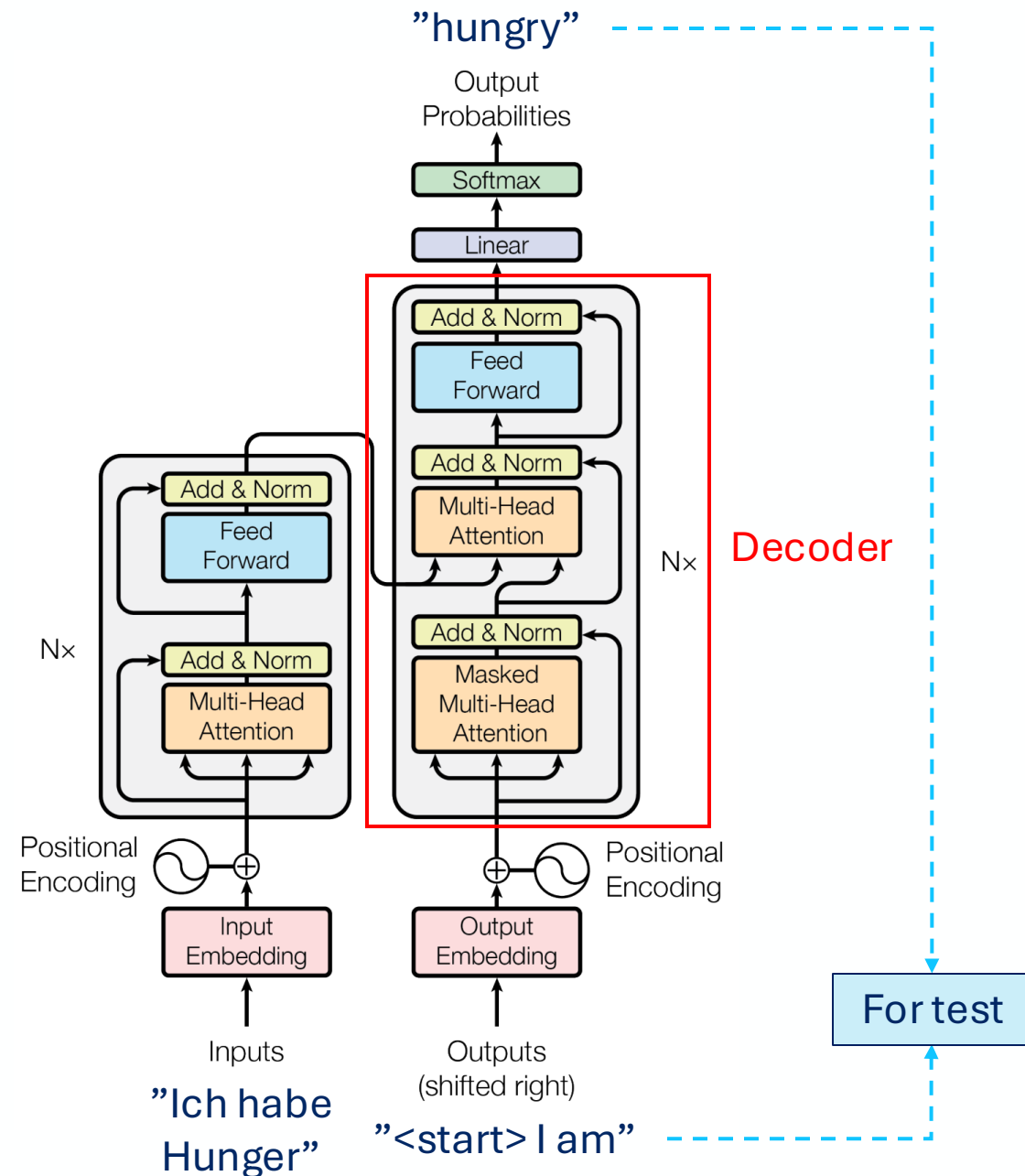
Transformer

- Components:
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding
 - Encoder
 - Decoder



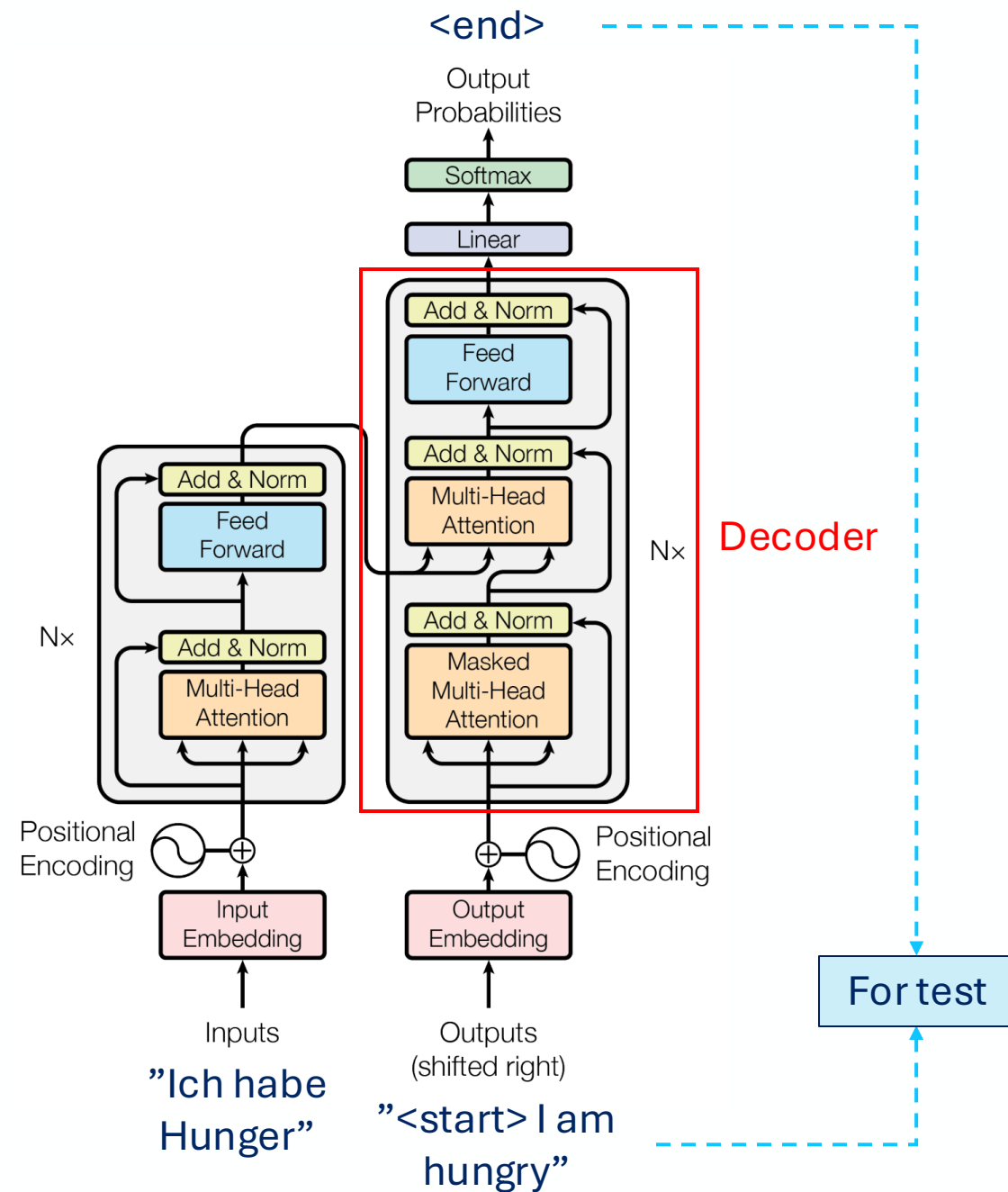
Transformer

- Components:
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding
 - Encoder
 - Decoder



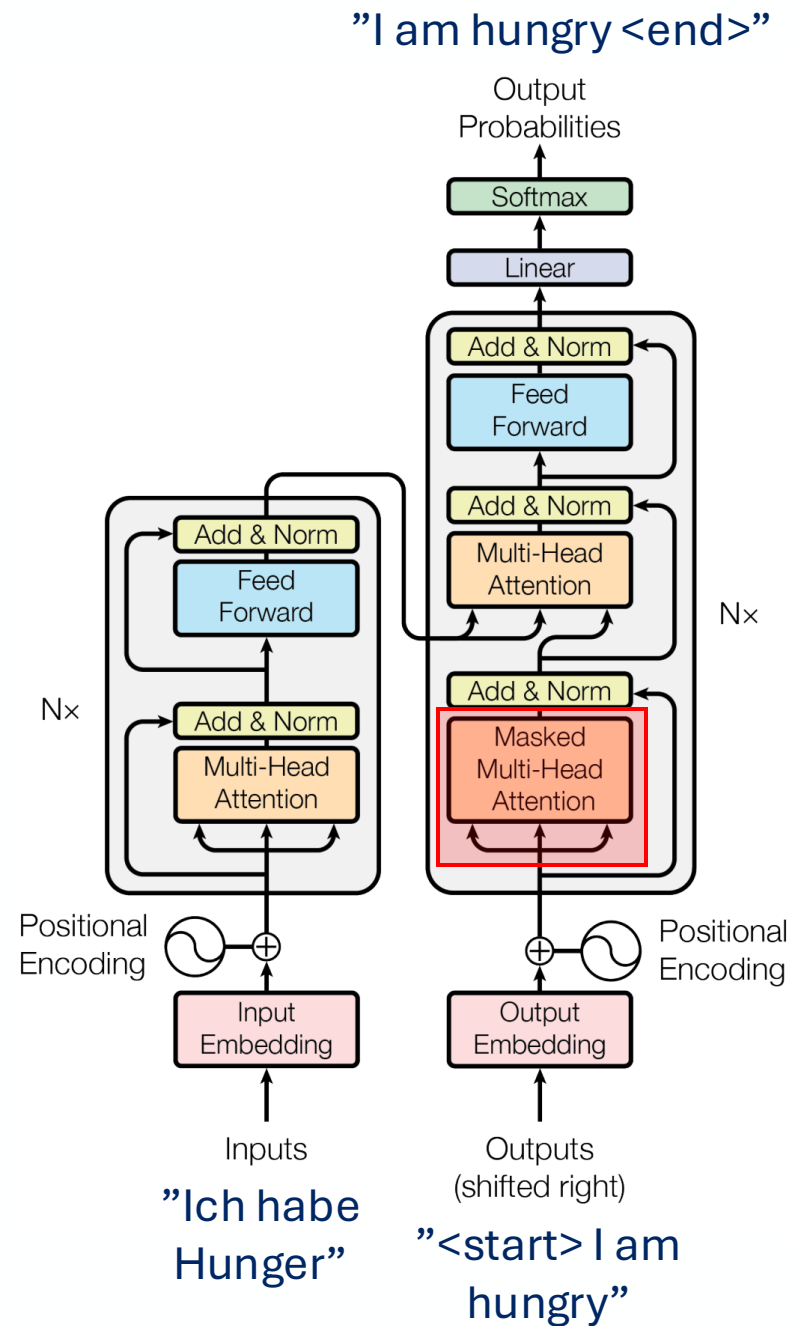
Transformer

- Components:
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding
 - Encoder
 - Decoder



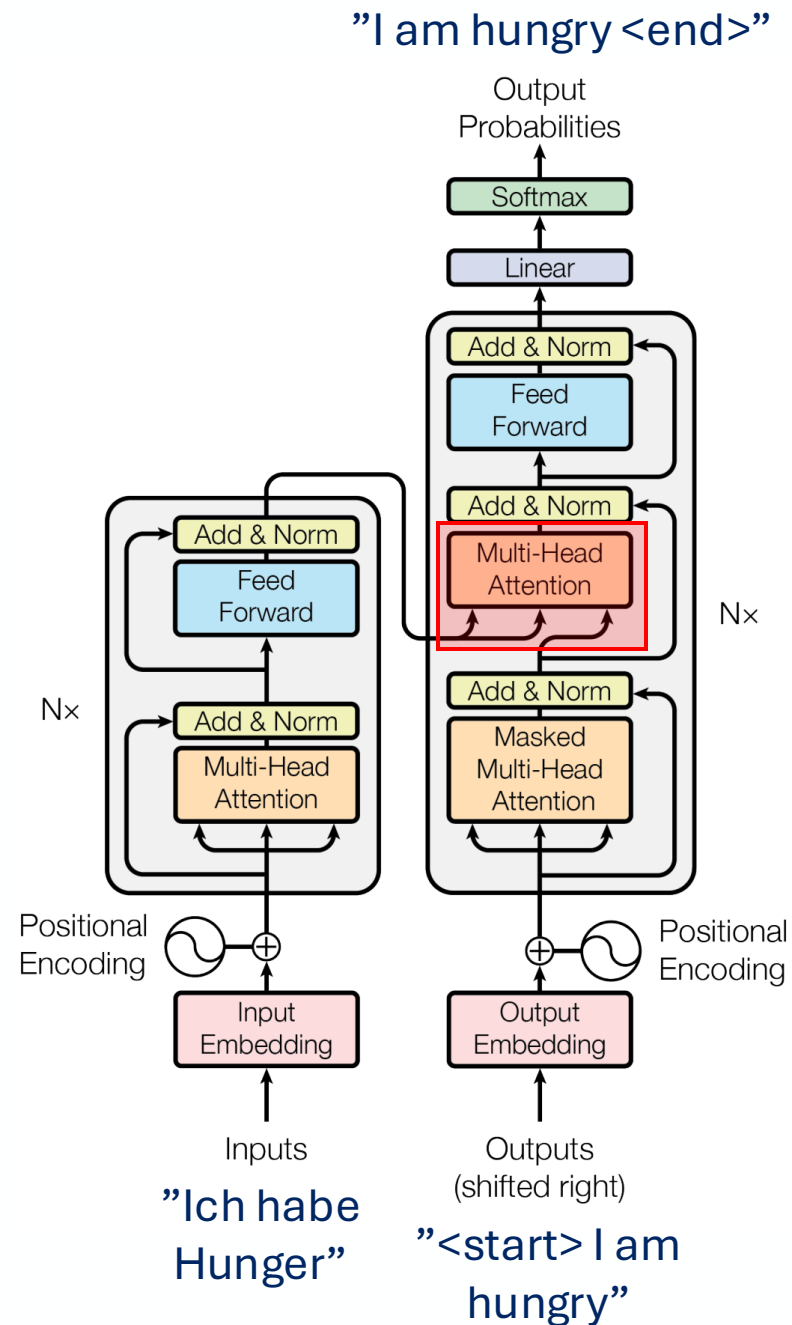
Transformer

- Components:
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding
 - Encoder
 - Decoder
 - Masked self-attention



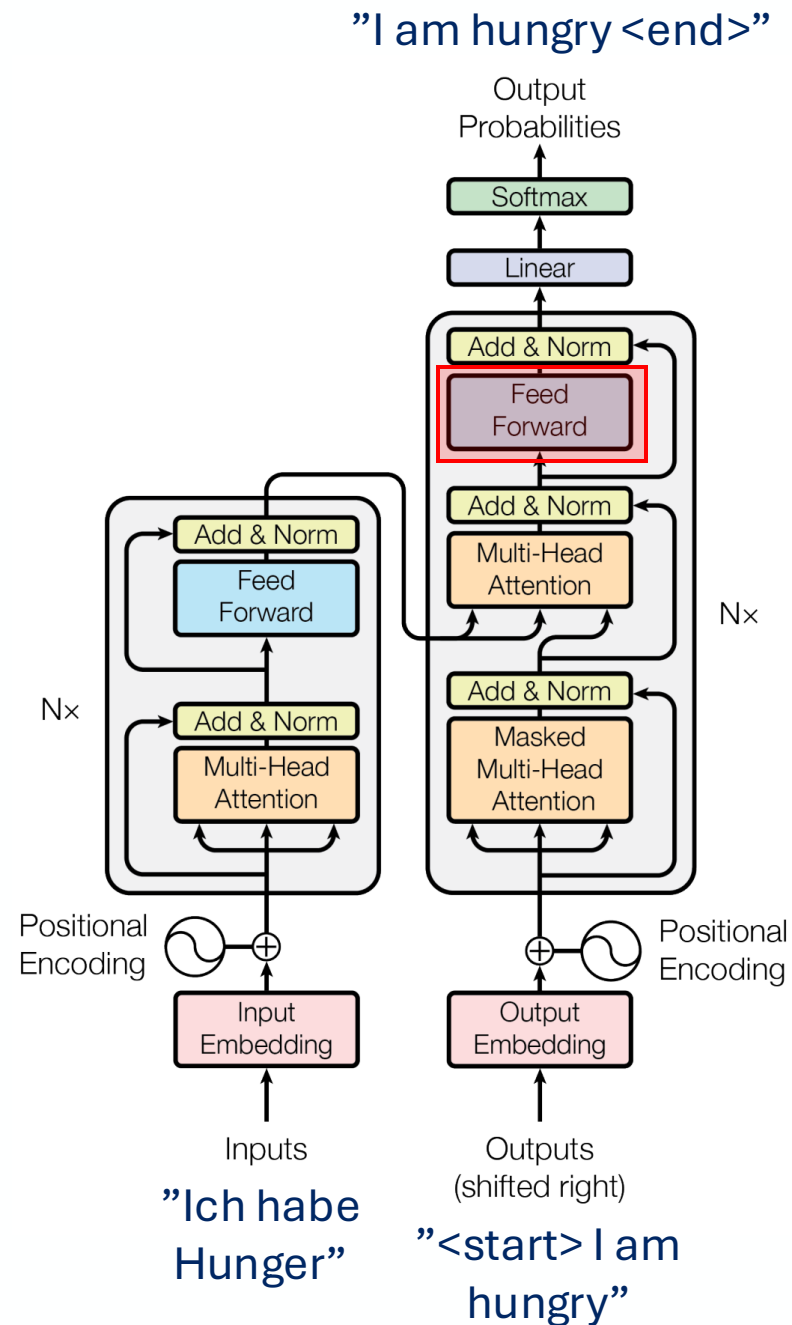
Transformer

- Components:
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding
 - Encoder
 - Masked self-attention
 - Multi-head cross-attention
 - Decoder



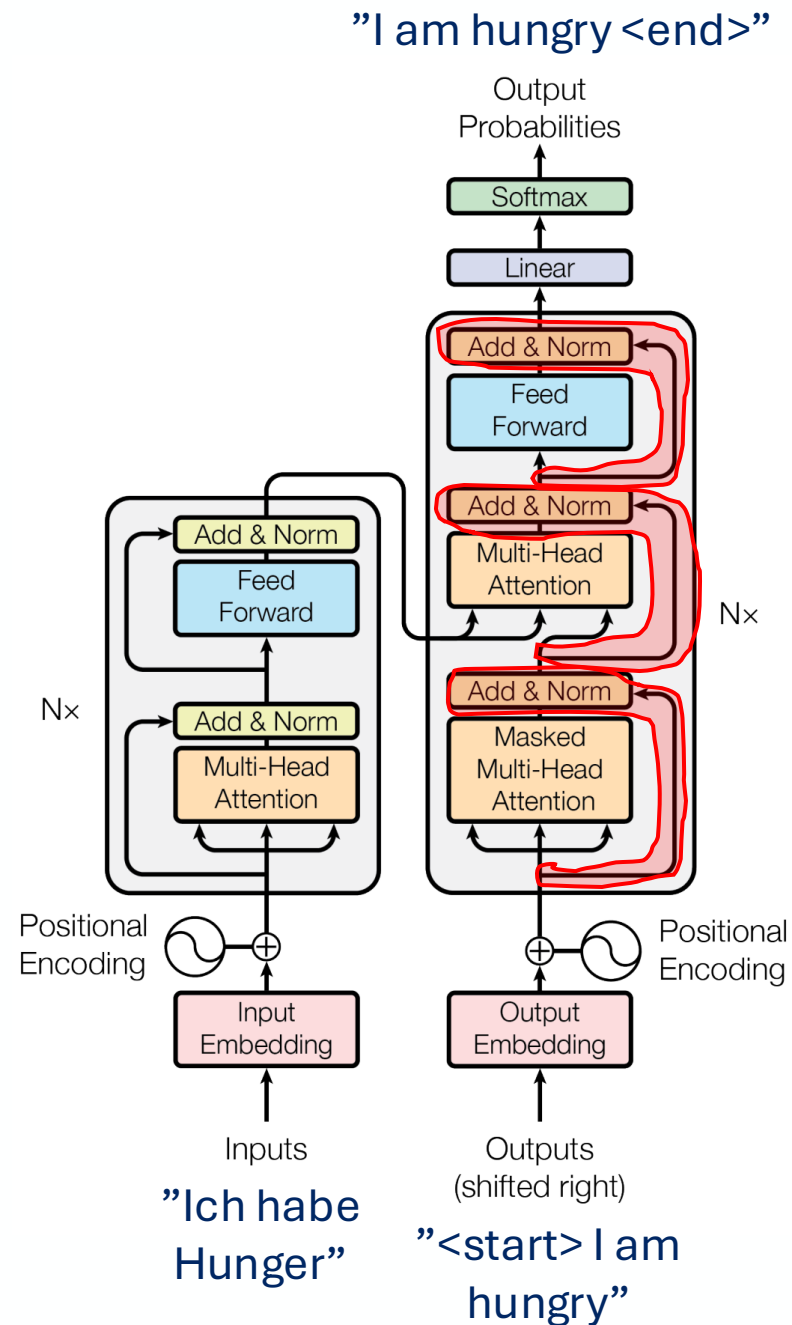
Transformer

- Components:
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding
 - Encoder
 - Masked self-attention
 - Multi-head cross-attention
 - Fully-connected layer
 - Decoder



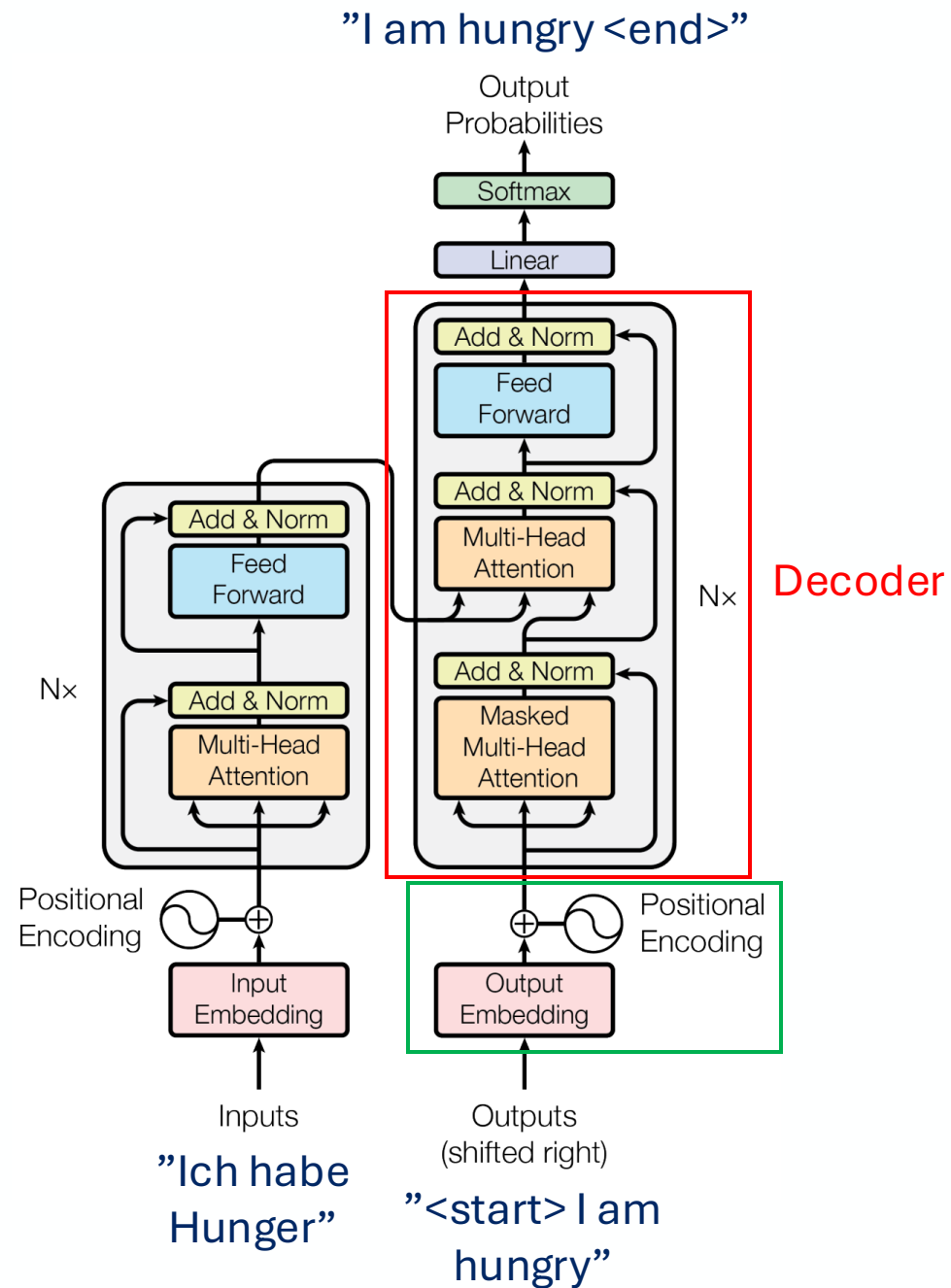
Transformer

- Components:
 - Word embedding
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 - Masked self-attention
 - Multi-head cross-attention
 - Fully-connected layer
 - Skip connection with normalization
 - Decoder



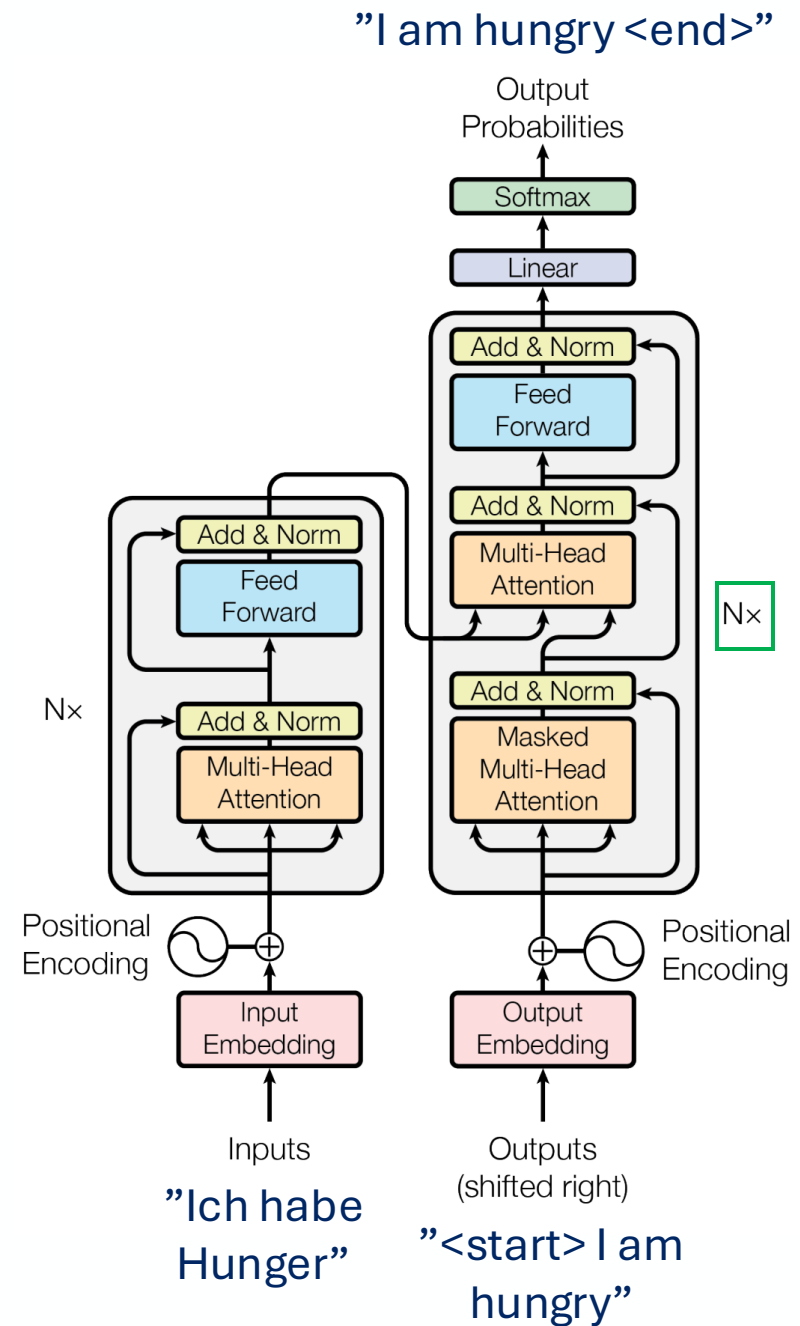
Transformer

- Components:
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding
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 - Decoder



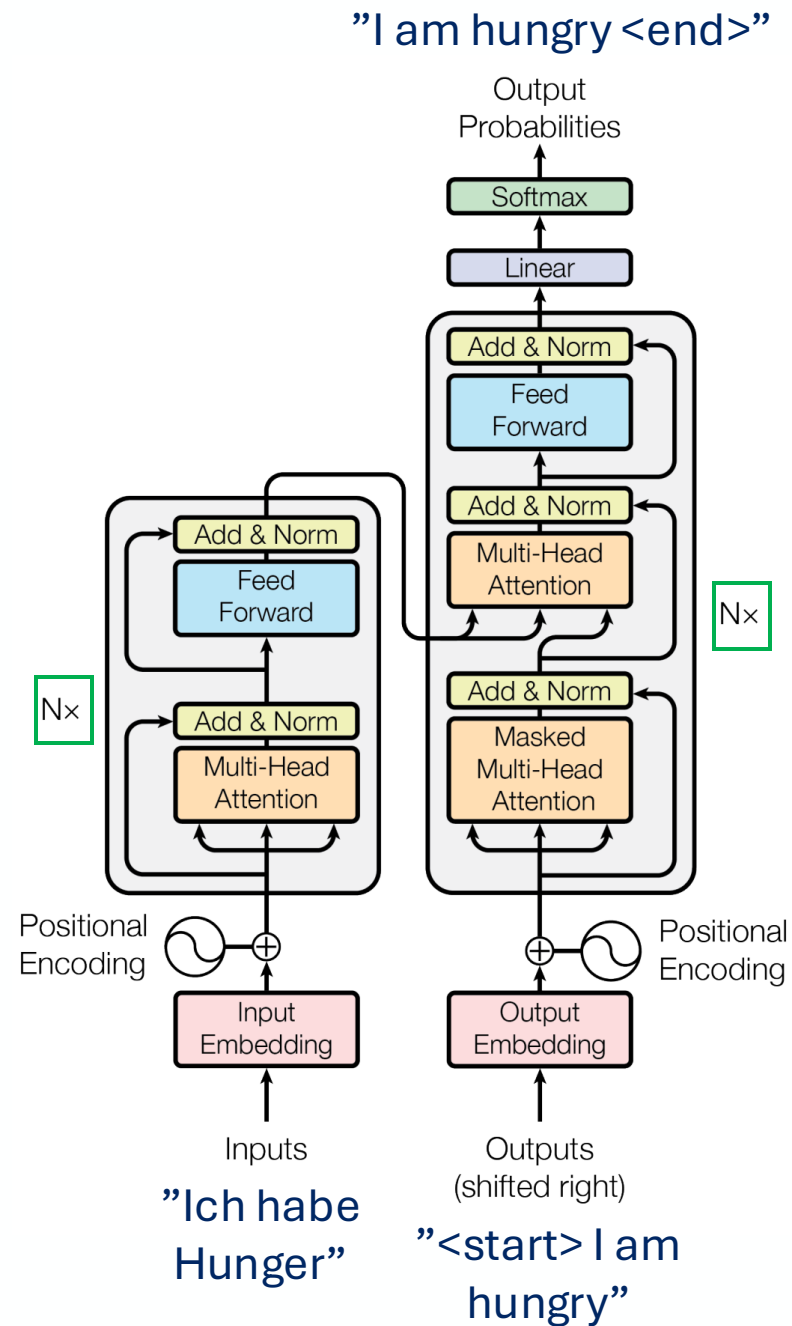
Transformer

- Components:
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding
 - Encoder
 - Decoder
 - N blocks



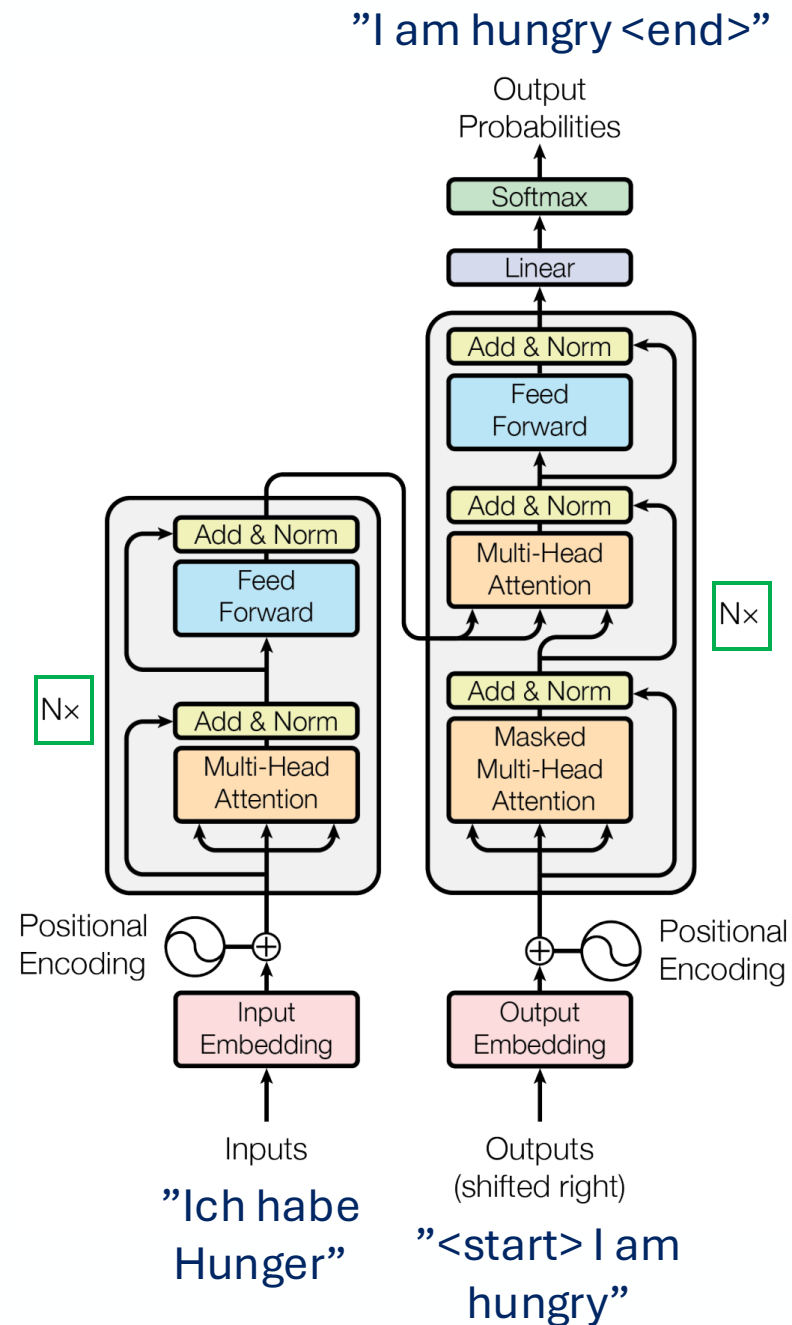
Transformer

- Components:
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding
 - Encoder
 - Decoder
- Originally, $N = 6$



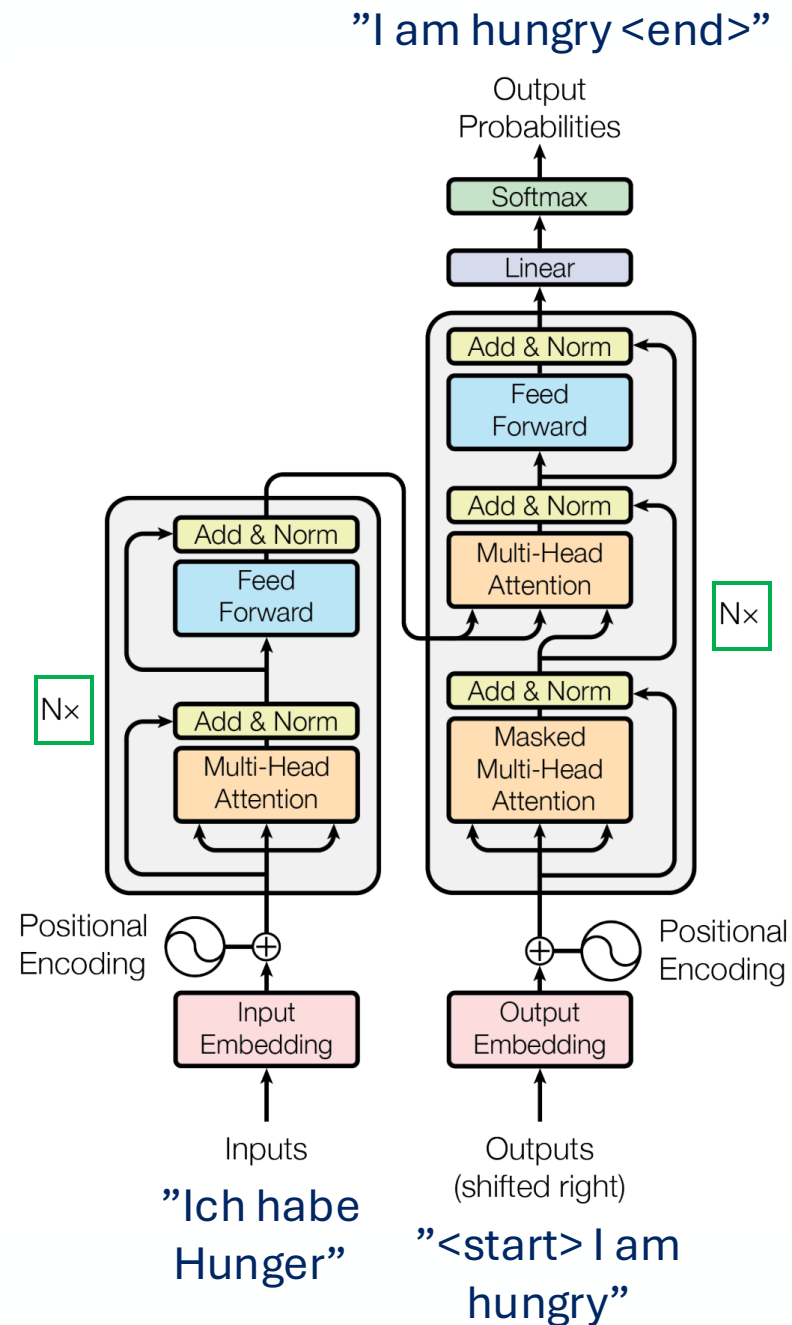
Transformer

- Components:
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding
 - Encoder
 - Decoder
- Originally, $N = 6$, but we can have
 - $N_{\text{encoder}} \neq N_{\text{decoder}}$



Transformer

- Components:
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding
 - Encoder
 - Decoder
- Originally, $N = 6$, but we can have
 - $N_{\text{encoder}} \neq N_{\text{decoder}}$
 - $N \neq 6$



Transformer Variants

- Different kinds of input

Words

Ich habe Hunger

Transformer Variants

- Different kinds of input

Words

Ich habe Hunger

Image



Transformer Variants

- Different kinds of input

Words

Ich habe Hunger

Image



Sound



Transformer Variants

- Different kinds of input

Words

Ich habe Hunger

Image



Sound

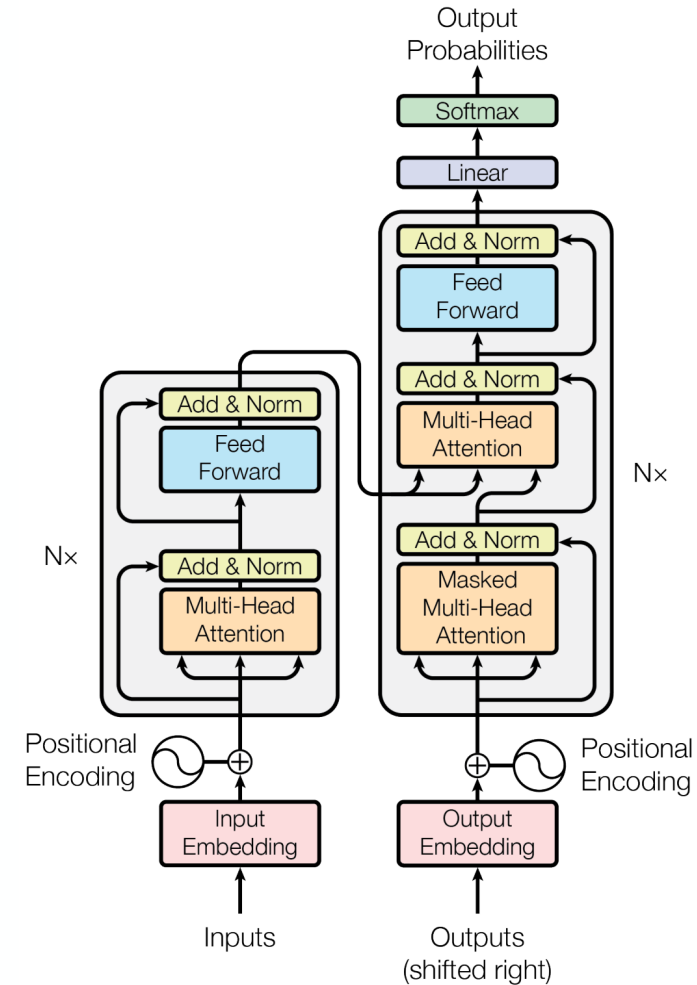


DNA sequence

ATA GCA TGA

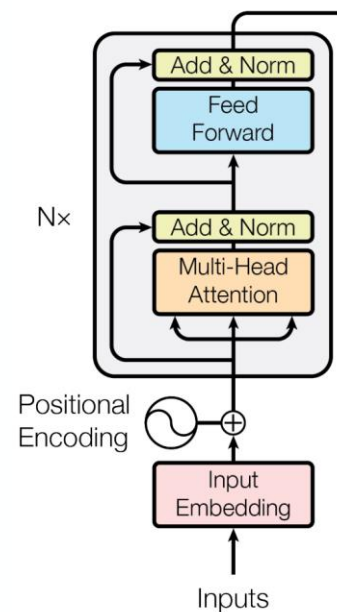
Transformer Variants

- Different kinds of architecture



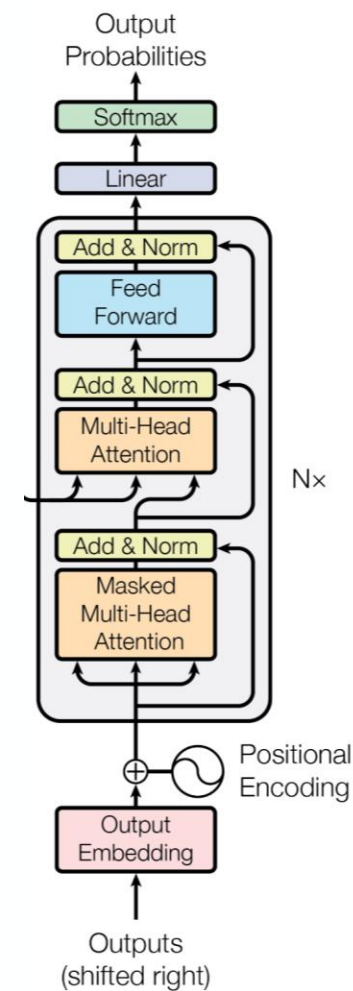
Transformer Variants

- Different kinds of architecture
 - Only encoder
 - E.g., BERT



Transformer Variants

- Different kinds of architecture
 - Only encoder
 - E.g., BERT
 - Only decoder
 - E.g., GPT

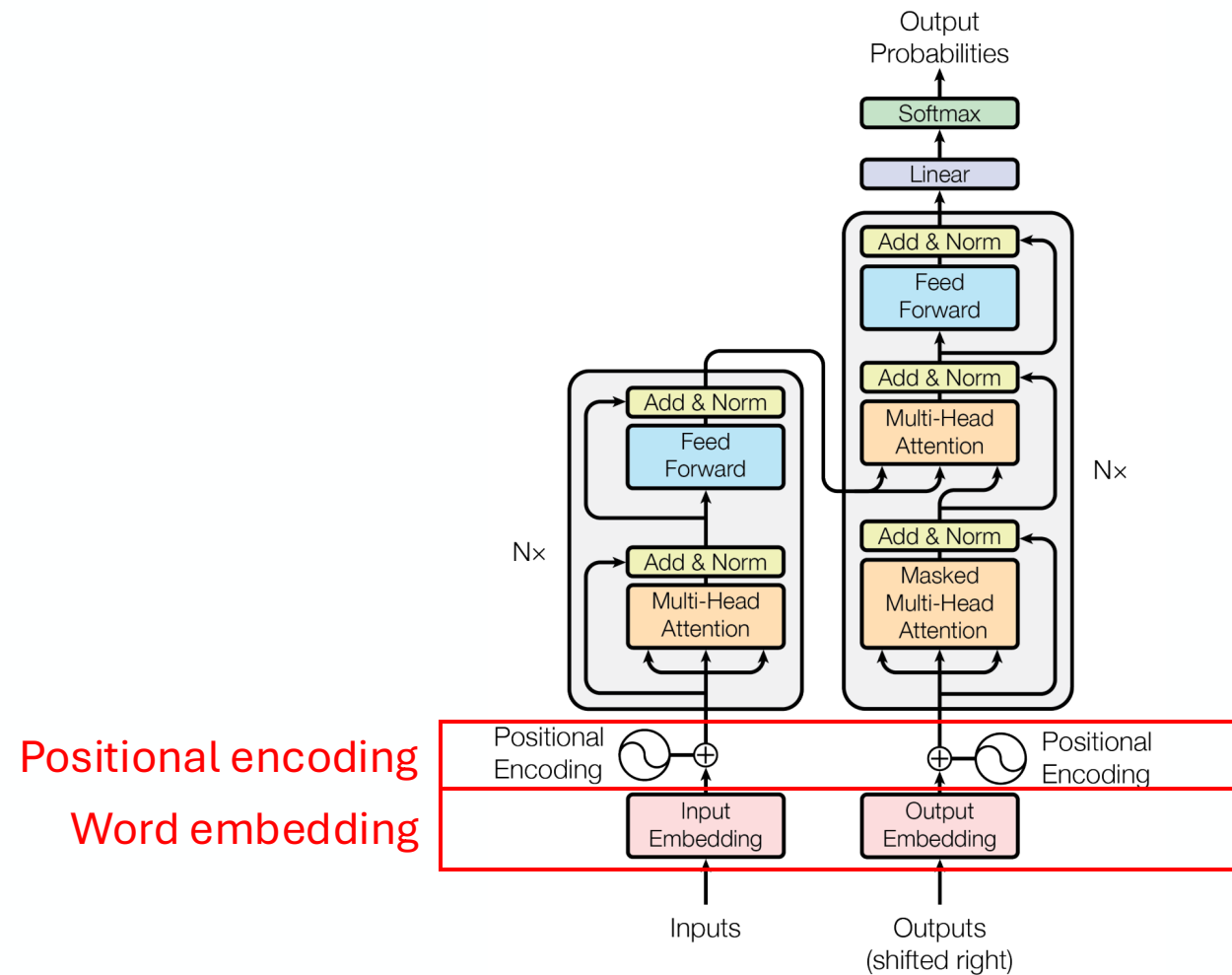


Outline

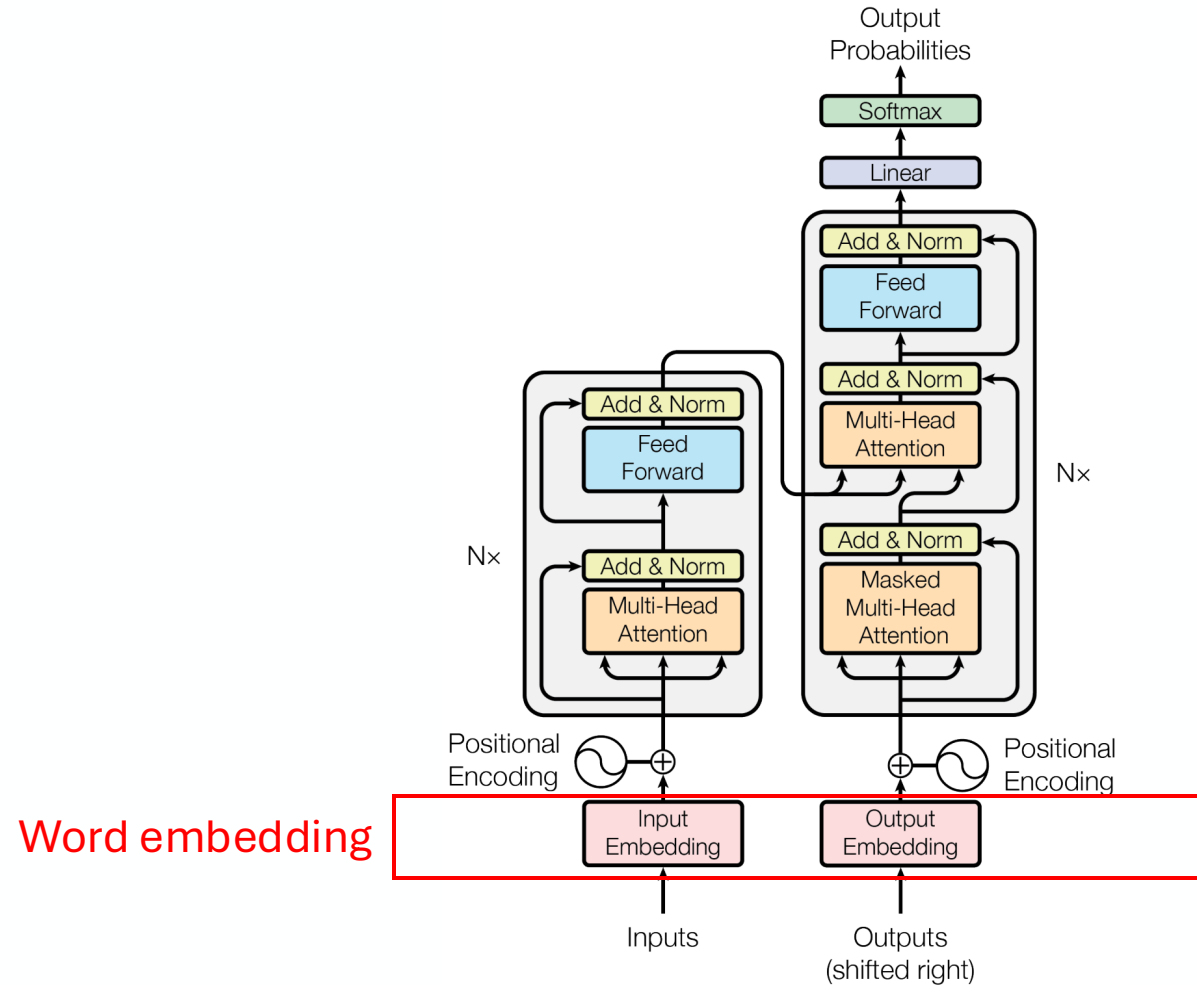
1. Overview
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3. Attention mechanism
4. Putting it all together
5. Variants of Transformer

Transformer Input

- Word embedding
- Positional encoding

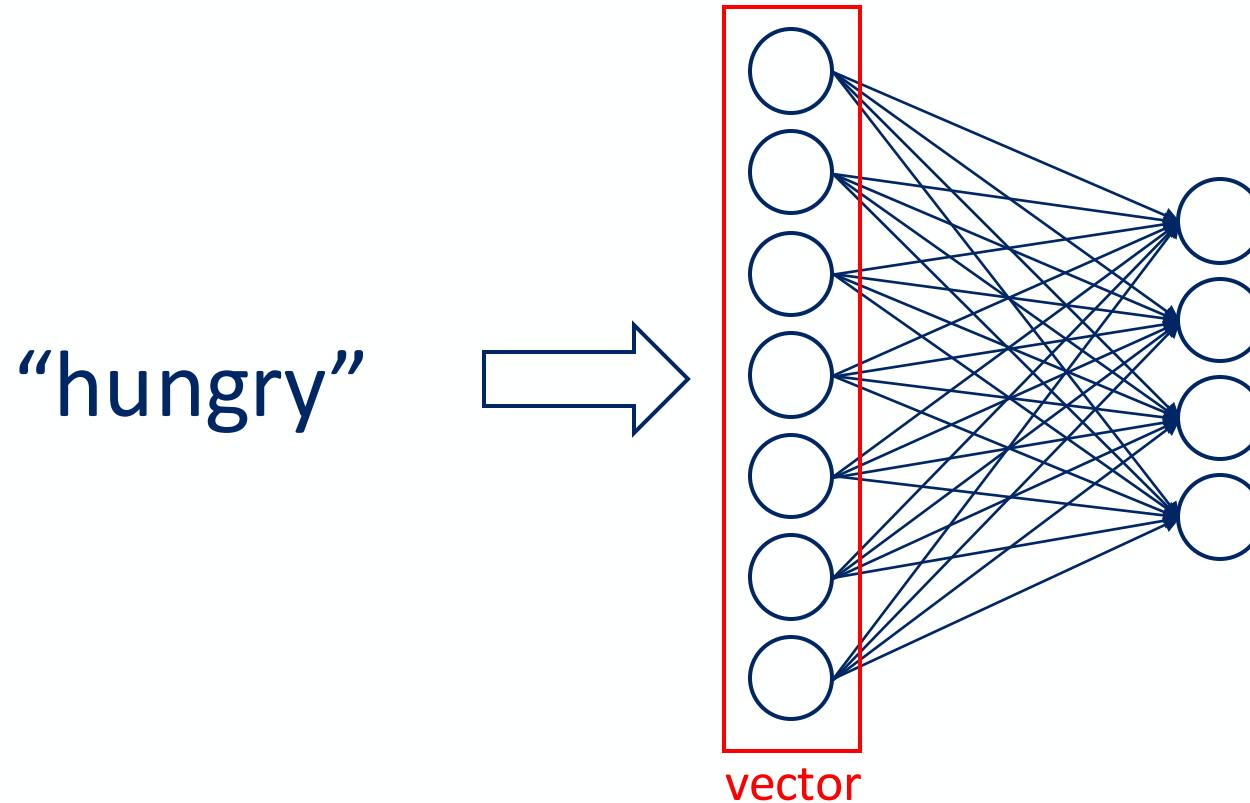


Word Embedding



Word Embedding

- Goal: How to represent a word as a vector



Word Embedding

- The simplest solution:
one-hot vector
 - Length vector = length
dictionary
 - 1 element as 1, others 0

I	1	0	0	0	0	0	0
hungry	0	1	0	0	0	0	0
rice	0	0	1	0	0	0	0
fried	0	0	0	1	0	0	0
chicken	0	0	0	0	1	0	0
eat	0	0	0	0	0	1	0
duck	0	0	0	0	0	0	1

Word Embedding

- The simplest solution: one-hot vector
 - Length vector = length dictionary
 - 1 element as 1, others 0
 - Problem: not that meaningful

Should be dissimilar	I	1	0	0	0	0	0
	hungry	0	1	0	0	0	0
	rice	0	0	1	0	0	0
	fried	0	0	0	1	0	0
Should be similar	chicken	0	0	0	0	1	0
	eat	0	0	0	0	0	1
	duck	0	0	0	0	0	0

Word Embedding

- The simplest solution: one-hot vector
 - Length vector = length dictionary
 - 1 element as 1, others 0
 - Problem: not that meaningful
 - dot product or cosine similarity between each word 0

Should be dissimilar	I	<table><tr><td>1</td><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>0</td></tr></table>	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	Similarity = 0
	1	0	0	0	0	0	0			
	hungry	<table><tr><td>0</td><td>1</td><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>0</td></tr></table>	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	
	0	1	0	0	0	0	0			
rice	<table><tr><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>1</td><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>0</td></tr></table>	0	0	1	0	0	0	0		
0	0	1	0	0	0	0				
fried	<table><tr><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>1</td><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>0</td></tr></table>	0	0	0	1	0	0	0		
0	0	0	1	0	0	0				
Should be similar	chicken	<table><tr><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>1</td><td>0</td><td>0</td></tr></table>	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	Similarity = 0
	0	0	0	0	1	0	0			
	eat	<table><tr><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>1</td><td>0</td></tr></table>	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	
0	0	0	0	0	1	0				
duck	<table><tr><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>0</td><td>1</td></tr></table>	0	0	0	0	0	0	1		
0	0	0	0	0	0	1				

Word Embedding

- Should be meaningful
- Length vector doesn't have to be same as length of dictionary

I	0.1	0.5	-0.5	-0.2	0.4	-0.8	0.5
hungry	0.5	0.7	-0.9	0.5	0.6	0.7	-0.1
rice	0.5	0.4	0.8	-0.7	0.4	-0.7	-0.8
fried	0.6	-0.7	0.8	0.1	0.7	0.6	-0.2
chicken	0.1	0.2	0.5	0.4	0.3	0.5	0.1
eat	-0.2	0.5	0.7	0.4	0.9	0.4	-0.1
duck	0.1	0.3	0.5	0.4	0.4	0.5	0.1

Cosine similarity = -0.39

Cosine similarity = 0.99

Word Embedding

- Other ways:
 - Word2Vec
 - GloVe
 - fastText
 - ELMo
 - BERT
 - PCA

We will not discuss each of this further...

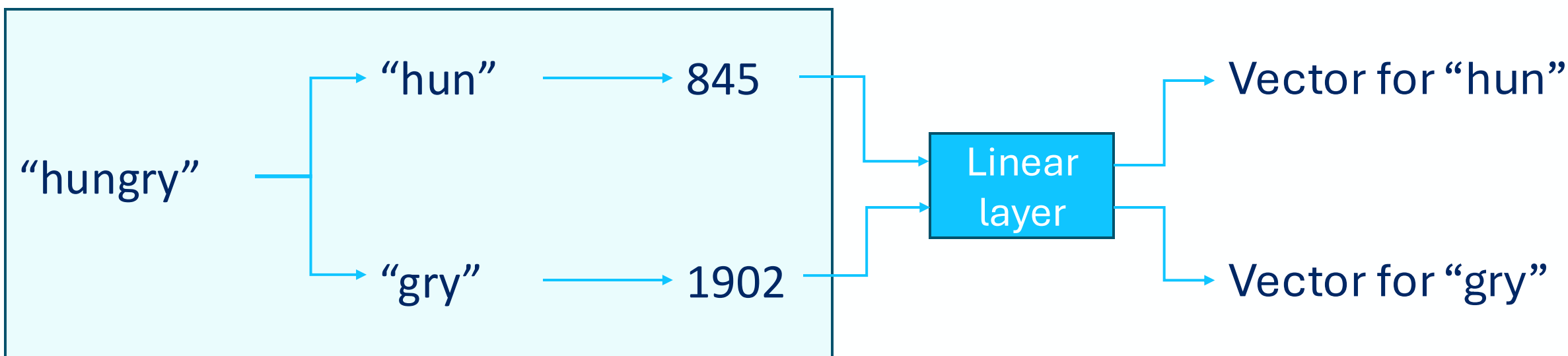
Good Word Embedding

- Ideally, can do vector operation to see relation between words

$$\overrightarrow{queen} - \overrightarrow{woman} + \overrightarrow{man} = \overrightarrow{king}$$

Word Embedding

- What original transformer does: Byte pair encoding + linear layer
 - Byte pair encoding: splitting words and map to a number
 - Linear layer: learnable



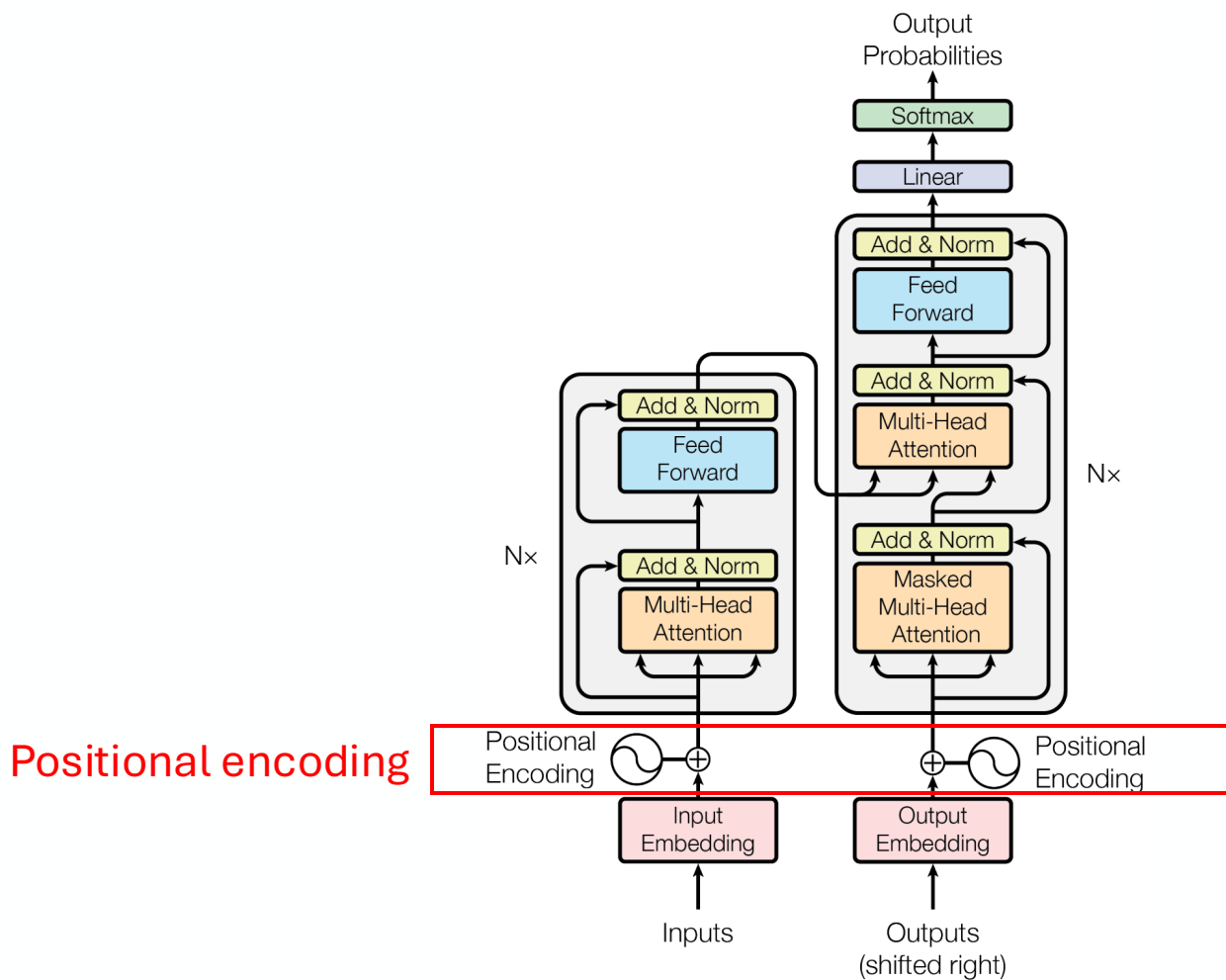
Byte pair encoding

Word Embedding

- What original transformer does: Byte pair encoding + linear layer
 - Probably not the best word embedding
 - “hun-ter” is not similar to “hun-gry”
 - But the transformer will know later with **self-attention** if the “hun” refers to “hunter” or “hungry”
 - And it still offers data efficiency and generalization
 - “walk”, “walk-ed”, “walk-ing”
 - Technically, can also still use other word-embedding methods
 - In this presentation, for simplicity, we will consider vector for each word
 - Not vector for split word

Positional Encoding

- Positional encoding



Positional Encoding

- Motivation: words position is important
 - The order of the words is important for the meaning

“man bites dog”



“dog bites man”



Positional Encoding

- Motivation: Transformer by itself can't encode the position
 - Not sequential

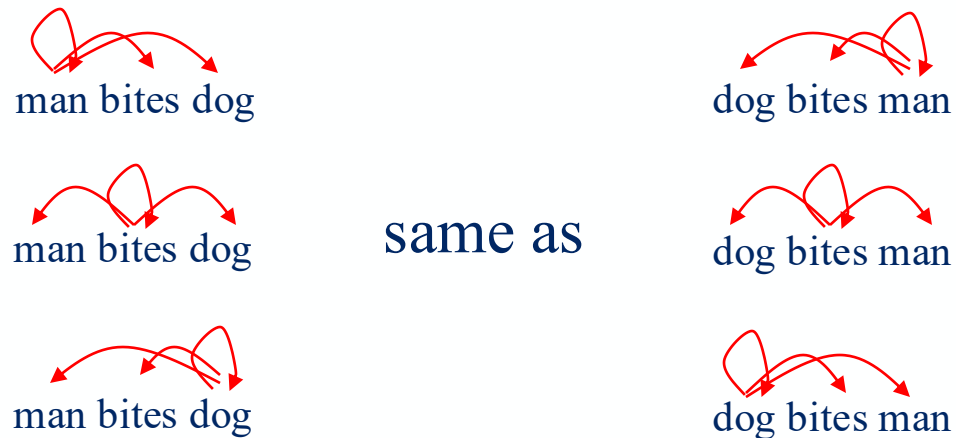


Positional Encoding

- Motivation: Transformer by itself can't encode the position
 - Not sequential

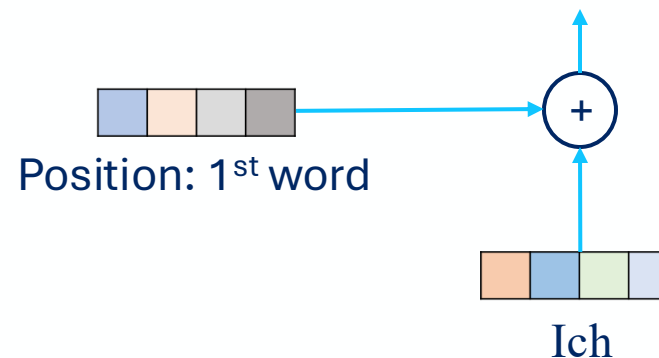
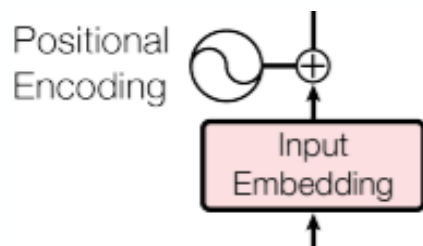


- Self attention can't distinguish word order



Positional Encoding

- Position vector added to word embedding
 - Same size with the word embedding (e.g., size = 4)



Positional Encoding

- Simplest example: binary
 - Limited number of word
 - $\{\text{number of bits}\}^2$

		Binary			
position		encoding			
0:	0	0	0	0	0
1:	0	0	0	0	1
2:	0	0	1	0	0
3:	0	0	1	1	1
4:	0	1	0	0	0
5:	0	1	0	0	1
6:	0	1	1	1	0
7:	0	1	1	1	1
8:	1	0	0	0	0
9:	1	0	0	0	1
10:	1	0	1	1	0
11:	1	0	1	1	1
12:	1	1	0	0	0
13:	1	1	0	0	1
14:	1	1	1	1	0
15:	1	1	1	1	1

Positional Encoding

- Original transformer way

$$\text{PE}_{(\text{pos}, 2i)} = \sin\left(\frac{\text{pos}}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right)$$

$$\text{PE}_{(\text{pos}, 2i+1)} = \cos\left(\frac{\text{pos}}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right)$$

pos

0: [

1: [

2: [

⋮

]

]

]

Positional Encoding

- Original transformer way

$$PE_{(pos,2i)} = \sin\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right)$$

$$PE_{(pos,2i+1)} = \cos\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right)$$

pos	$i = 0$ $PE_{(pos,0)}$	$i = 1$ $PE_{(pos,2)}$	
0:	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right), \right.$	$\left. \sin\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right), \right.$	] sin for the even index
1:	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right), \right.$	$\left. \sin\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right), \right.$	
2:	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right), \right.$	$\left. \sin\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right), \right.$	
⋮	$\vdots$	$\vdots$	

Positional Encoding

- Original transformer way

$$PE_{(pos,2i)} = \sin\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right)$$

$$PE_{(pos,2i+1)} = \cos\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right)$$

	$i = 0$ $PE_{(pos,0)}$	$i = 0$ $PE_{(pos,1)}$	$i = 1$ $PE_{(pos,2)}$	$i = 1$ $PE_{(pos,3)}$
pos				
0:	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right), \cos\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right), \sin\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right), \cos\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right) \right]$			
1:	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right), \cos\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right), \sin\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right), \cos\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right) \right]$			
2:	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right), \cos\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right), \sin\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right), \cos\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right) \right]$			
⋮	⋮	⋮	⋮	⋮

cos for the odd index

Positional Encoding

- Original transformer way

$$PE_{(pos,2i)} = \sin\left(\frac{\text{pos}}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right)$$

$$PE_{(pos,2i+1)} = \cos\left(\frac{\text{pos}}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right)$$

	$i = 0$ $PE_{(pos,0)}$	$i = 0$ $PE_{(pos,1)}$	$i = 1$ $PE_{(pos,2)}$	$i = 1$ $PE_{(pos,3)}$
pos				
0:	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{0}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right), \cos\left(\frac{0}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right), \sin\left(\frac{0}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right), \cos\left(\frac{0}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right) \right]$			
1:	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{1}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right), \cos\left(\frac{1}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right), \sin\left(\frac{1}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right), \cos\left(\frac{1}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right) \right]$			
2:	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{2}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right), \cos\left(\frac{2}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right), \sin\left(\frac{2}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right), \cos\left(\frac{2}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right) \right]$			
⋮	⋮	⋮	⋮	⋮

pos: word position

Positional Encoding

- Original transformer way

$$PE_{(pos,2i)} = \sin\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right)$$

$$PE_{(pos,2i+1)} = \cos\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right)$$

pos	$i = 0$ $PE_{(pos,0)}$	$i = 0$ $PE_{(pos,1)}$	$i = 1$ $PE_{(pos,2)}$	$i = 1$ $PE_{(pos,3)}$
0:	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{0}{10000^{\frac{2i}{4}}}\right), \cos\left(\frac{0}{10000^{\frac{2i}{4}}}\right), \sin\left(\frac{0}{10000^{\frac{2i}{4}}}\right), \cos\left(\frac{0}{10000^{\frac{2i}{4}}}\right) \right]$			
1:	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{1}{10000^{\frac{2i}{4}}}\right), \cos\left(\frac{1}{10000^{\frac{2i}{4}}}\right), \sin\left(\frac{1}{10000^{\frac{2i}{4}}}\right), \cos\left(\frac{1}{10000^{\frac{2i}{4}}}\right) \right]$			
2:	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{2}{10000^{\frac{2i}{4}}}\right), \cos\left(\frac{2}{10000^{\frac{2i}{4}}}\right), \sin\left(\frac{2}{10000^{\frac{2i}{4}}}\right), \cos\left(\frac{2}{10000^{\frac{2i}{4}}}\right) \right]$			
⋮	⋮	⋮	⋮	⋮

d: vector size (our
example = 4)

Positional Encoding

- Original transformer way

$$PE_{(pos, 2i)} = \sin\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right)$$

$$PE_{(pos, 2i+1)} = \cos\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right)$$

pos	$i = 0$ $PE_{(pos,0)}$	$i = 0$ $PE_{(pos,1)}$	$i = 1$ $PE_{(pos,2)}$	$i = 1$ $PE_{(pos,3)}$
0:	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{0}{10000^{\frac{2*0}{4}}}\right), \cos\left(\frac{0}{10000^{\frac{2*0}{4}}}\right), \sin\left(\frac{0}{10000^{\frac{2*1}{4}}}\right), \cos\left(\frac{0}{10000^{\frac{2*1}{4}}}\right) \right]$			
1:	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{1}{10000^{\frac{2*0}{4}}}\right), \cos\left(\frac{1}{10000^{\frac{2*0}{4}}}\right), \sin\left(\frac{1}{10000^{\frac{2*1}{4}}}\right), \cos\left(\frac{1}{10000^{\frac{2*1}{4}}}\right) \right]$			
2:	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{2}{10000^{\frac{2*0}{4}}}\right), \cos\left(\frac{2}{10000^{\frac{2*0}{4}}}\right), \sin\left(\frac{2}{10000^{\frac{2*1}{4}}}\right), \cos\left(\frac{2}{10000^{\frac{2*1}{4}}}\right) \right]$			
⋮	⋮	⋮	⋮	⋮

i : vector index, which
will define the
frequency of the
sin/cos function

Positional Encoding

- Original transformer way

$$PE_{(pos, 2i)} = \sin\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right)$$

$$PE_{(pos, 2i+1)} = \cos\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right)$$

pos	$i = 0$ $PE_{(pos,0)}$	$i = 0$ $PE_{(pos,1)}$	$i = 1$ $PE_{(pos,2)}$	$i = 1$ $PE_{(pos,3)}$
0:	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{0}{10000^{\frac{0}{4}}}\right) \right]$	$\left[\cos\left(\frac{0}{10000^{\frac{0}{4}}}\right) \right]$	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{0}{10000^{\frac{2}{4}}}\right) \right]$	$\left[\cos\left(\frac{0}{10000^{\frac{2}{4}}}\right) \right]$
1:	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{1}{10000^{\frac{0}{4}}}\right) \right]$	$\left[\cos\left(\frac{1}{10000^{\frac{0}{4}}}\right) \right]$	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{1}{10000^{\frac{2}{4}}}\right) \right]$	$\left[\cos\left(\frac{1}{10000^{\frac{2}{4}}}\right) \right]$
2:	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{2}{10000^{\frac{0}{4}}}\right) \right]$	$\left[\cos\left(\frac{2}{10000^{\frac{0}{4}}}\right) \right]$	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{2}{10000^{\frac{2}{4}}}\right) \right]$	$\left[\cos\left(\frac{2}{10000^{\frac{2}{4}}}\right) \right]$
$\vdots$	$\vdots$	$\vdots$	$\vdots$	$\vdots$

Positional Encoding

- Original transformer way

$$PE_{(pos,2i)} = \sin\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right)$$

$$PE_{(pos,2i+1)} = \cos\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right)$$

pos	$i = 0$ $PE_{(pos,0)}$	$i = 0$ $PE_{(pos,1)}$	$i = 1$ $PE_{(pos,2)}$	$i = 1$ $PE_{(pos,3)}$
0:	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{0}{10000^{\frac{0}{4}}}\right) \right]$	$\left[\cos\left(\frac{0}{10000^{\frac{0}{4}}}\right) \right]$	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{0}{10000^{\frac{2}{4}}}\right) \right]$	$\left[\cos\left(\frac{0}{10000^{\frac{2}{4}}}\right) \right]$
1:	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{1}{10000^{\frac{0}{4}}}\right) \right]$	$\left[\cos\left(\frac{1}{10000^{\frac{0}{4}}}\right) \right]$	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{1}{10000^{\frac{2}{4}}}\right) \right]$	$\left[\cos\left(\frac{1}{10000^{\frac{2}{4}}}\right) \right]$
2:	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{2}{10000^{\frac{0}{4}}}\right) \right]$	$\left[\cos\left(\frac{2}{10000^{\frac{0}{4}}}\right) \right]$	$\left[\sin\left(\frac{2}{10000^{\frac{2}{4}}}\right) \right]$	$\left[\cos\left(\frac{2}{10000^{\frac{2}{4}}}\right) \right]$
$\vdots$	$\vdots$	$\vdots$	$\vdots$	$\vdots$

- No maximum limitation on the position

Positional Encoding

- Like having different signal & frequency for each vector position

$$PE_{(pos,2i)} = \sin\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right)$$

$$PE_{(pos,2i+1)} = \cos\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right)$$

pos	$i = 0$ $PE_{(pos,0)}$	$i = 0$ $PE_{(pos,1)}$	$i = 1$ $PE_{(pos,2)}$	$i = 1$ $PE_{(pos,3)}$	$i = 2$ $PE_{(pos,4)}$	$i = 2$ $PE_{(pos,5)}$
0:		,	,	,	,	,
1:		,	,	,	,	,
2:		,	,	,	,	,
3:		,	,	,	,	,
4:		,	,	,	,	,
5:		,	,	,	,	,
⋮						

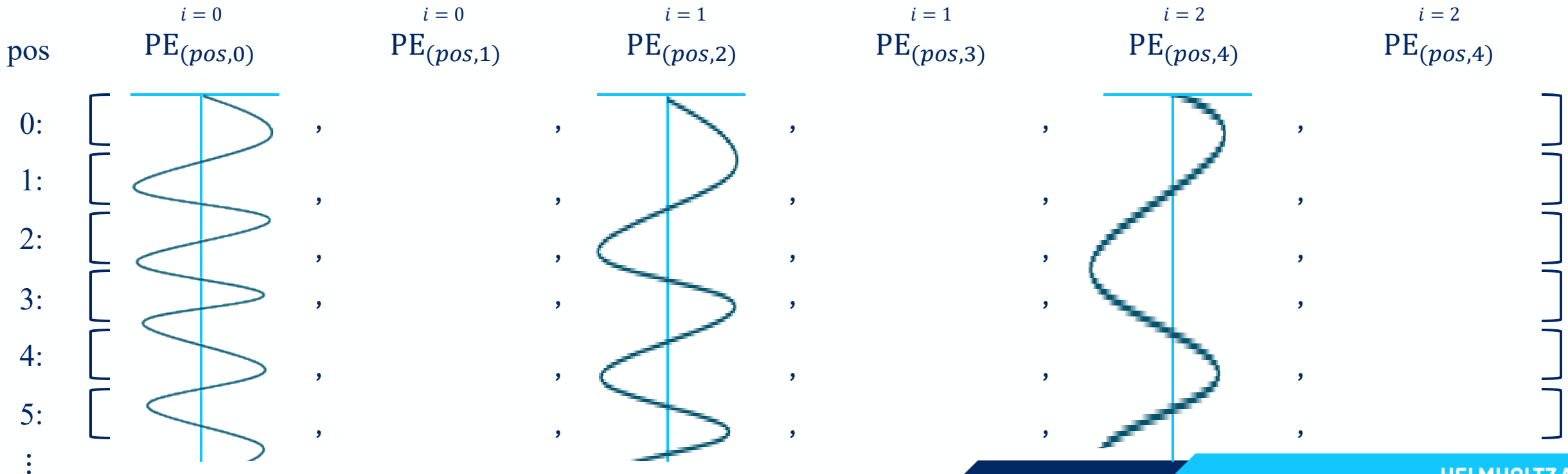
Positional Encoding

- Like having different signal & frequency for each vector position

$$PE_{(pos,2i)} = \sin\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right)$$

$$PE_{(pos,2i+1)} = \cos\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right)$$

For sin...



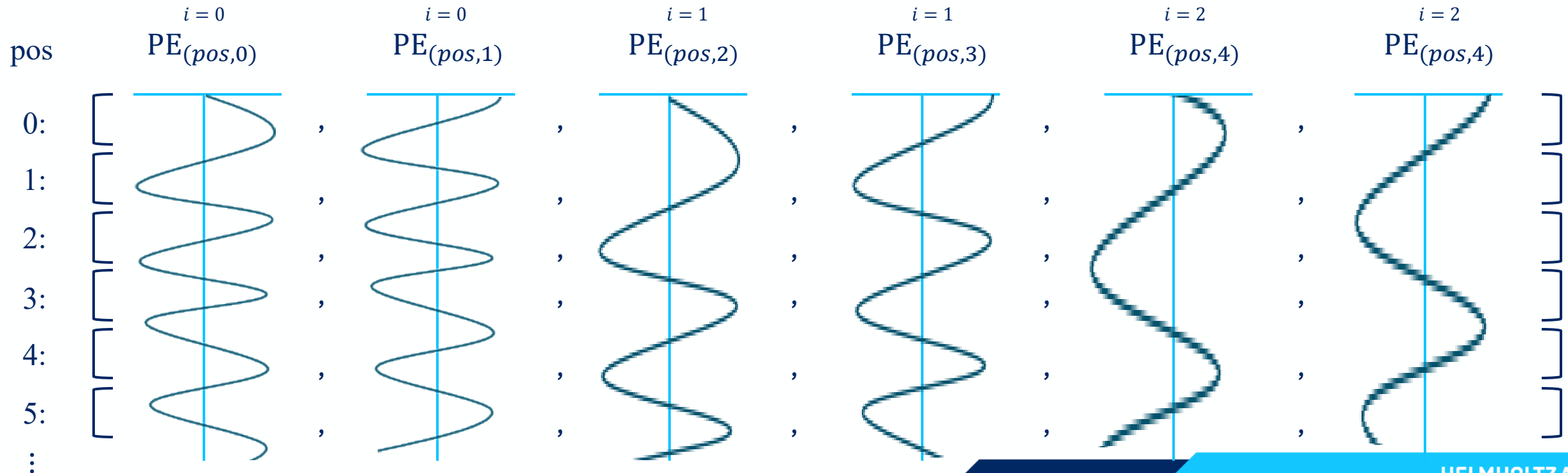
Positional Encoding

- Like having different signal & frequency for each vector position

$$PE_{(pos,2i)} = \sin\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right)$$

$$PE_{(pos,2i+1)} = \cos\left(\frac{pos}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d}}}\right)$$

The rest, cos...



Positional Encoding

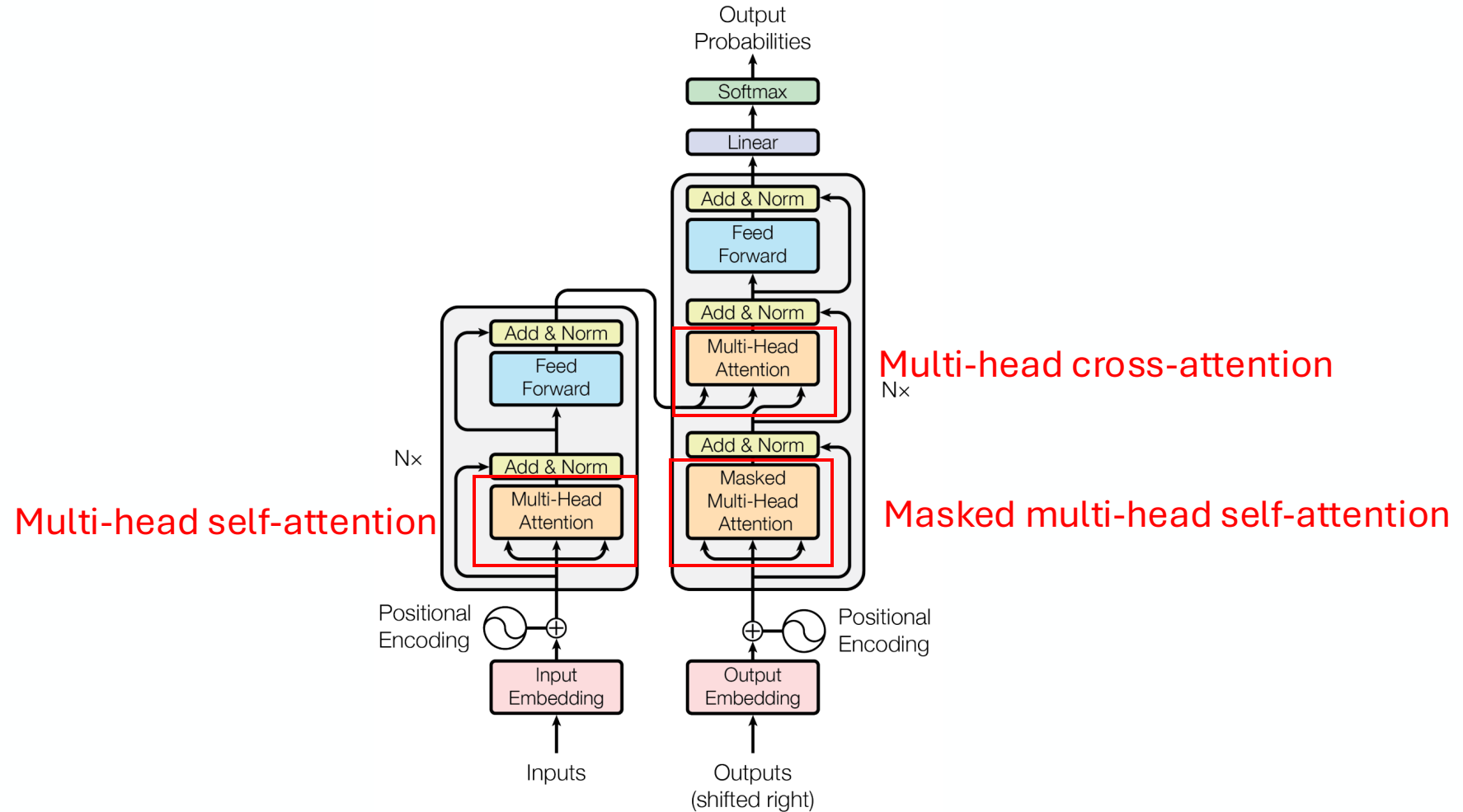
- Other ways
 - Learnable embedding → learn the position vectors
 - Done in Vision Transformer (ViT)
 - Relative positional encoding
 - Rotary Positional Embedding (RoPE)
 - Attention with Linear Biases (ALiBi)
 - etc.

We will not discuss further...

Outline

1. Overview
2. Preprocessing
3. Attention mechanism
4. Putting it all together
5. Variants of Transformer

Attention Mechanism



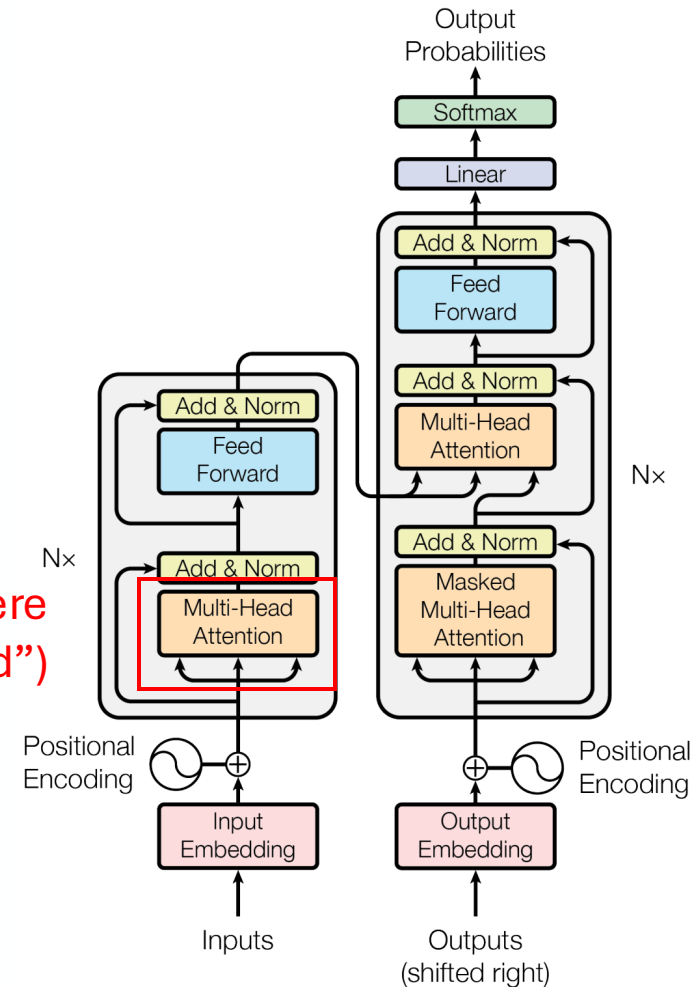
Attention Mechanism

- In this presentation:
 - **Self-attention**
 - **Masked** self-attention
 - **Cross-attention**
 - **Multi-head** self-attention

Self-Attention

- Input:
input word embedding +
positional encoding;
OR
the previous encoder block's
output

Self-attention is here
(we will discuss first without “multi-head”)



Self-Attention

- Motivation: context is important
 - Need to see other words to know context.

“bat”



“The bat flies in
the cave.”



“He swings the bat.”

“right”



“Turn right”



“The right to give
opinions”



“I am right, you are
wrong.”

Self-Attention

- Intuition

“The **bat** flies in the **cave**”

We can know which “bat”
because of “flies” and “cave”

“**He** swings the **bat**”

We can know which “bat” because
of “swings” and “he” (a person do
something)

Self-Attention

- Intuition

“I poured water from the bottle into the cup until **it** was full.”

"it" refers to what?

“I poured water from the bottle into the cup until **it** was empty.”

Self-Attention

- Intuition

“I poured water from the bottle into the **cup** until **it** was full.”

"it" refers to cup

“I poured water from the **bottle** into the cup until **it** was empty.”

"it" refers to bottle

Self-Attention

- Intuition

How can we know?



“I poured water from the bottle into the **cup** until **it** was **full**.”

The diagram shows blue curved arrows representing self-attention weights. A long arrow connects 'I' to 'full'. Another long arrow connects 'bottle' to 'full'. A cluster of four shorter arrows connects 'cup' to 'it', indicating a strong local dependency.

We can know “it” refers to “cup” because something is **poured into cup** until it was **full**



“I poured water **from** the **bottle** into the cup until **it** was **empty**.”

The diagram shows blue curved arrows representing self-attention weights. A long arrow connects 'I' to 'empty'. Another long arrow connects 'bottle' to 'empty'. A cluster of four shorter arrows connects 'from' to 'it', indicating a strong local dependency.

We can know “it” refers to “bottle” to because something is **poured from bottle** until it was **empty**

Self-Attention

- Use "key", "query", "value". The interpretation:

“The **bat** flies in the cave”

Self-Attention

- Use "key", "query", "value". The interpretation:

"The **bat** flies in the cave"

Query: bat

Keys: the, bat, flies, in, the, cave

Self-Attention

- Use "key", "query", "value". The interpretation:

"The **bat** flies in the cave"

Query: bat

Which word is
relevant to me?

Keys: the, bat, flies, in, the, cave

Self-Attention

- Use "key", "query", "value". The interpretation:

"The **bat** flies in the cave"

Query: bat

Which word is
relevant to me?

Keys: the, bat, flies, in, the, cave

ME ME ME ME ME ME

Keys compete for attention

Self-Attention

- Use "key", "query", "value". The interpretation:

"The **bat** flies in the cave"

Query: bat

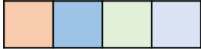
Keys: the, bat, **flies**, in, the, **cave**

Values: the, bat, flies, in, the, cave

)
If I got the attention, this
is the value/information I
will give

Self-Attention

- Step 1: create query, key, value

Ich 

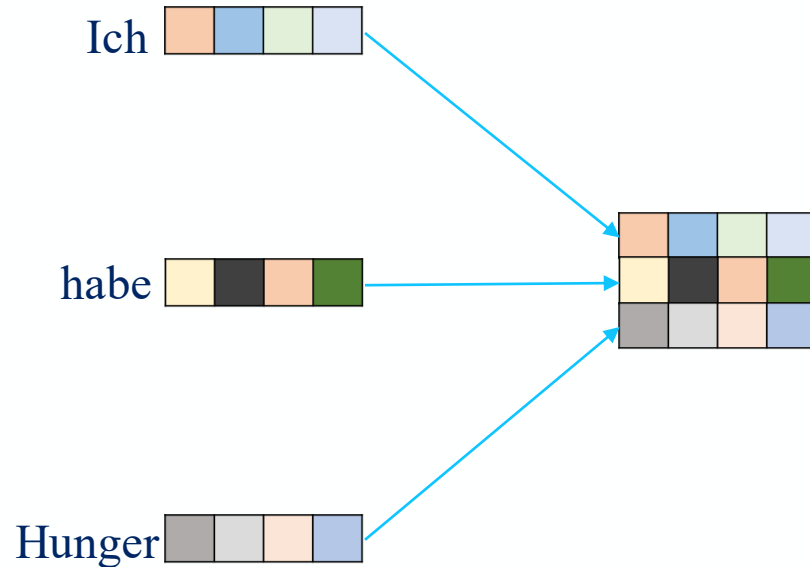
habe 

Hunger 

Vectors from word embedding and positional encoding

Self-Attention

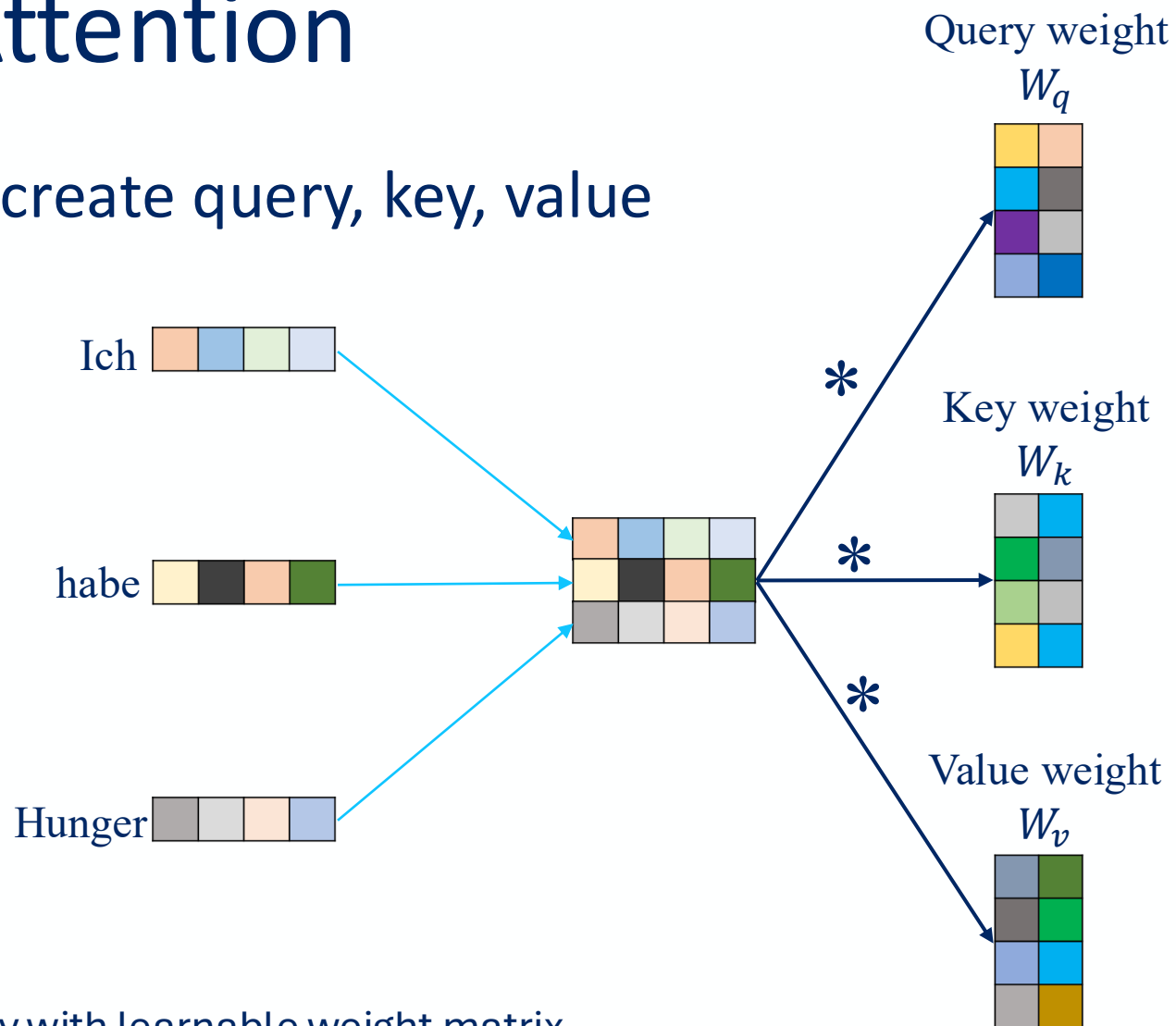
- Step 1: create query, key, value



Combine them to matrix

Self-Attention

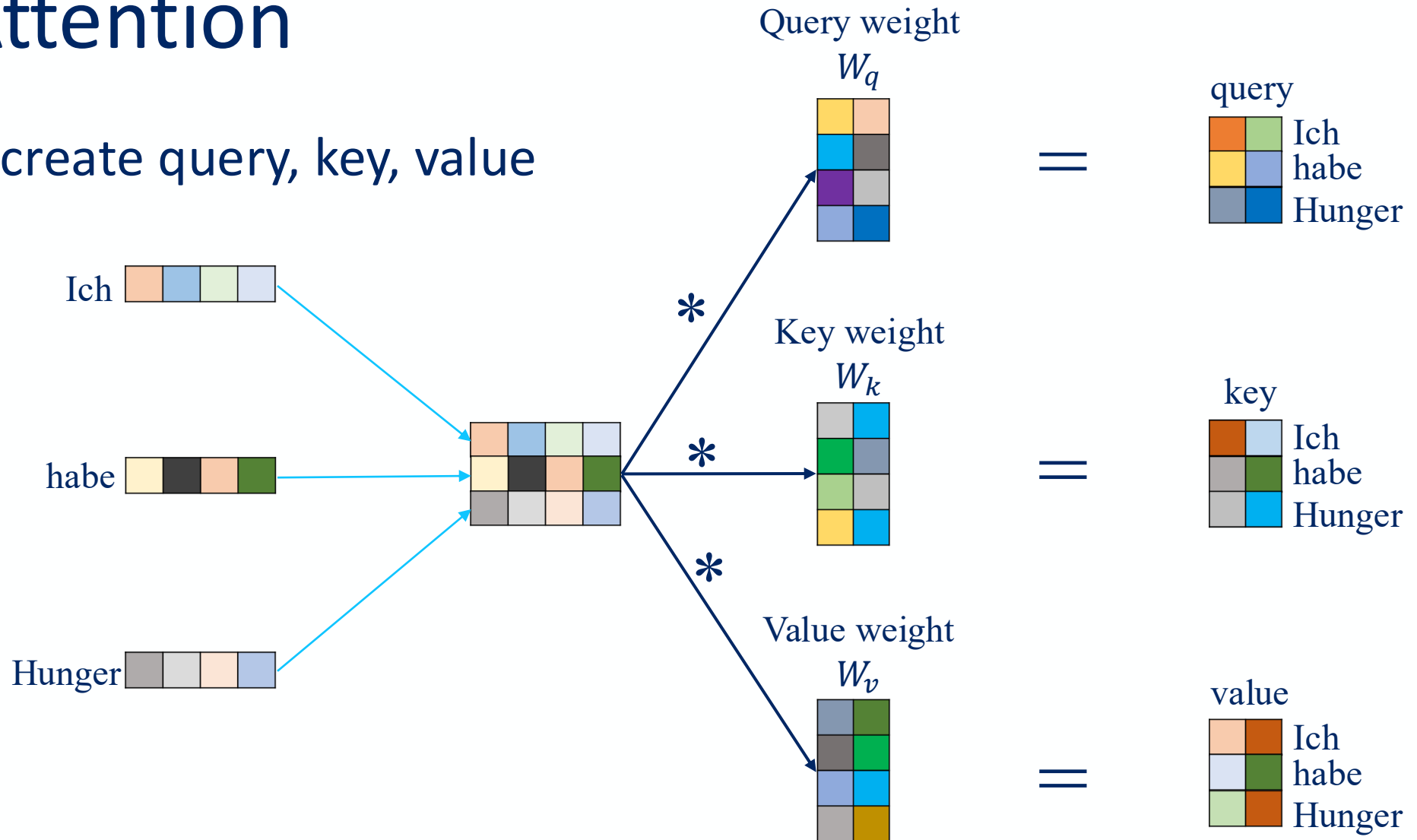
- Step 1: create query, key, value



Multiply with learnable weight matrix

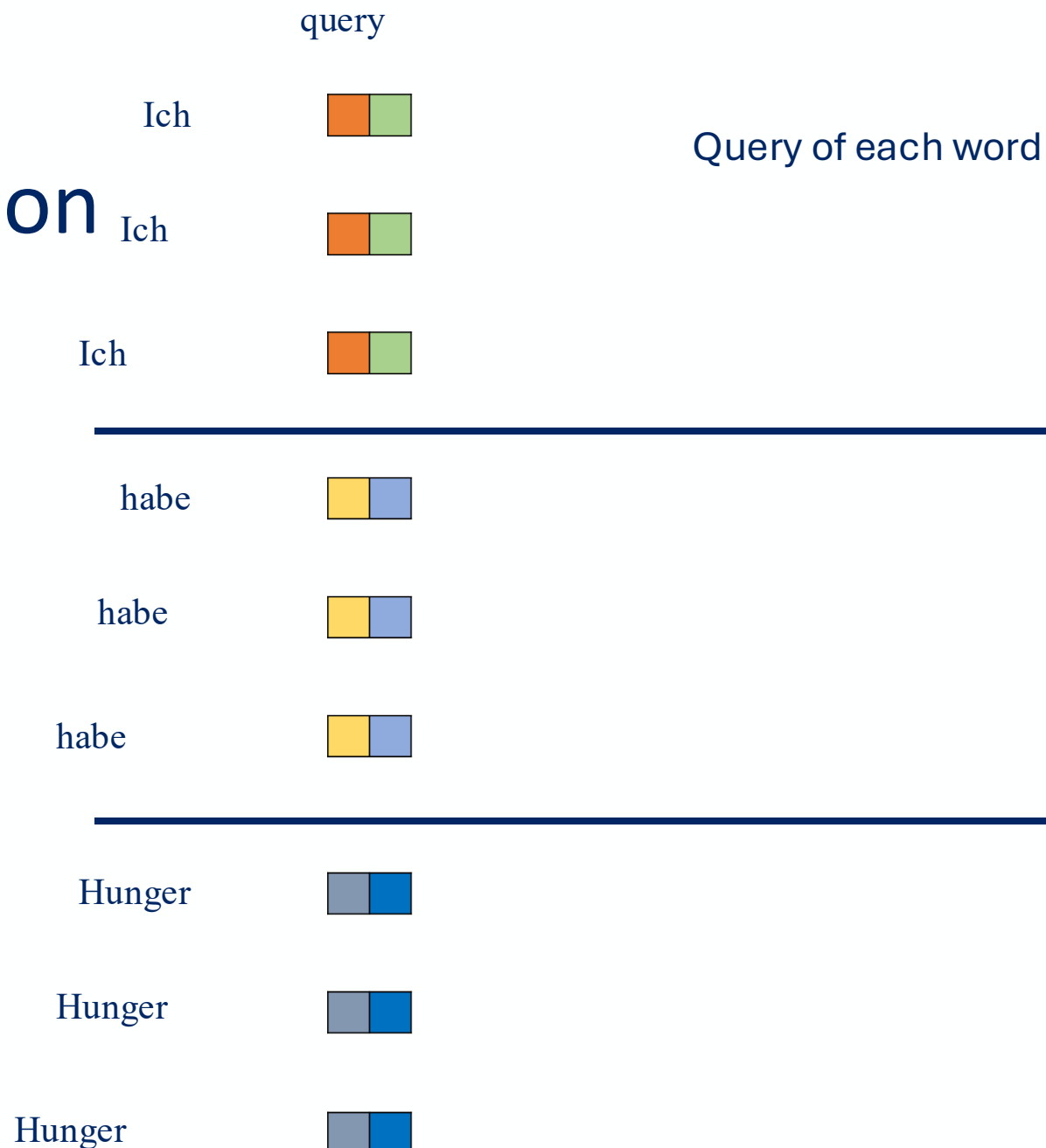
Self-Attention

- Step 1: create query, key, value



Self-Attention

- Step 2:
Finding
attention
between
words



Self-Attention

- Step 2:
Finding
attention
between
words

query * key^T

Multiply query of each word with the transpose of key of all words

Ich * Ich	 	 
Ich * habe	 	 
Ich * Hunger	 	 
habe * Ich	 	 
habe * habe	 	 
habe * Hunger	 	 
Hunger * Ich	 	 
Hunger * habe	 	 
Hunger * Hunger	 	 

query * key^T ➞ Dot product

Self-Attention

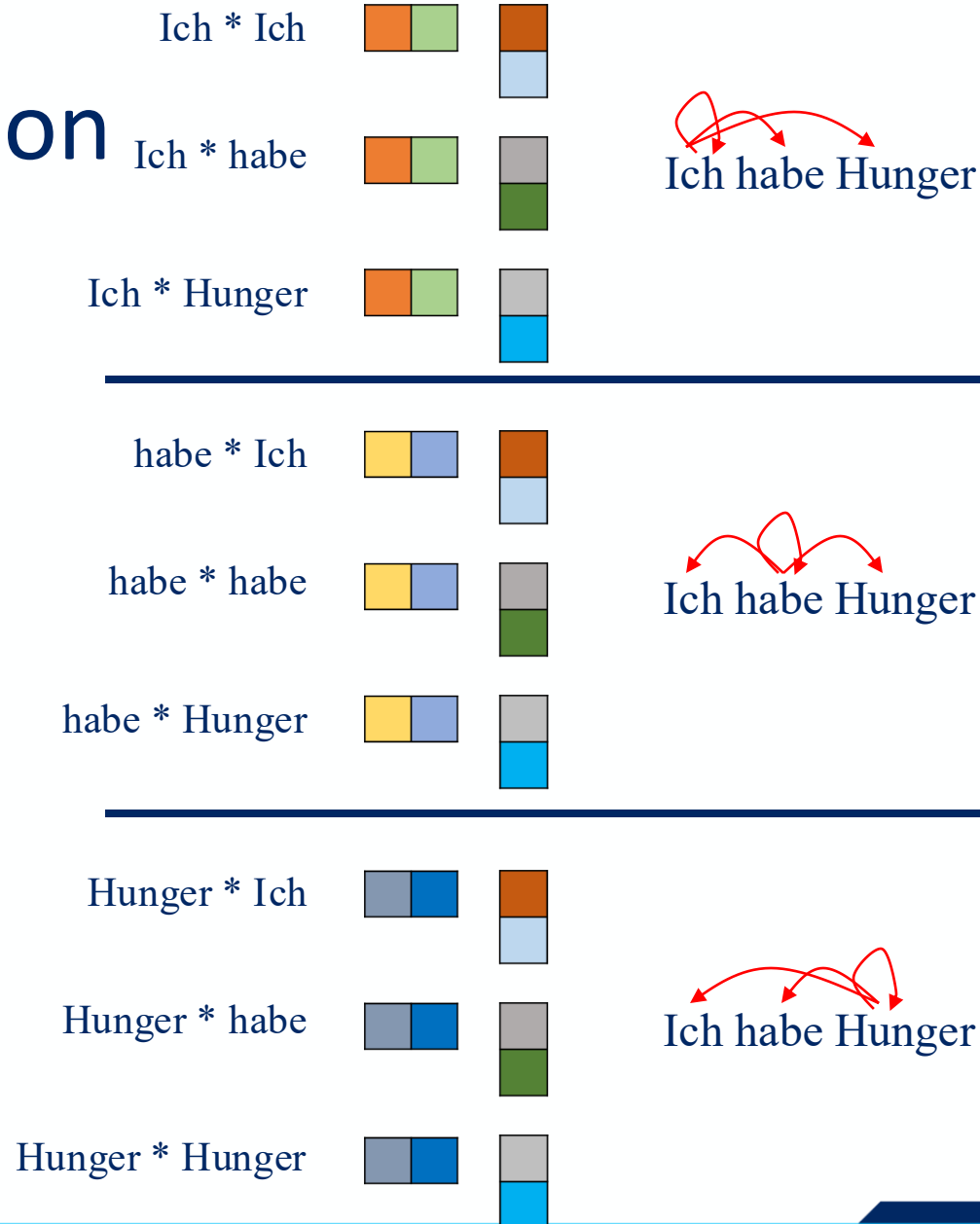
- Step 2:
Finding
attention
between
words

Ich * Ich	 	 
Ich * habe	 	 
Ich * Hunger	 	 
habe * Ich	 	 
habe * habe	 	 
habe * Hunger	 	 
Hunger * Ich	 	 
Hunger * habe	 	 
Hunger * Hunger	 	 

Self-Attention

- Step 2:
Finding
attention
between
words

query * key^T



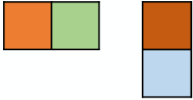
The dot product will build the
“connection” between words

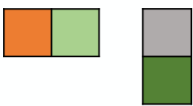
The keys compete for query’s
attention

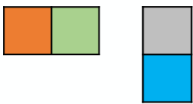
Self-Attention

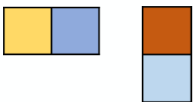
- Step 2:
Finding
attention
between
words

query * key^T

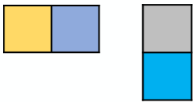
Ich * Ich  = 69

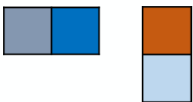
Ich * habe  = 10

Ich * Hunger  = 12

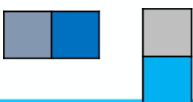
habe * Ich  = 21

habe * habe  = 70

habe * Hunger  = 3

Hunger * Ich  = 11

Hunger * habe  = 5

Hunger * Hunger  = 90

*Disclaimer: not real numbers from a
real model. Only for illustration purpose

Self-Attention

- Step 2:
Finding
attention
between
words

query * key^T

Ich * Ich			= 69 / √2
Ich * habe			= 10 / √2
Ich * Hunger			= 12 / √2
habe * Ich			= 21 / √2
habe * habe			= 70 / √2
habe * Hunger			= 3 / √2
Hunger * Ich			= 11 / √2
Hunger * habe			= 5 / √2
Hunger * Hunger			= 90 / √2

$$\frac{QK^T}{\sqrt{d_k}}$$

Query or key's vector size = 2

Normalize the dot product with
vector size because dot product
value depend on the vector size

*Disclaimer: not real numbers from a
real model. Only for illustration purpose

Self-Attention

- Step 2: Finding attention between words

on

	query * key ^T			softmax	
Ich * Ich			= 69 / √2	0.97	Softmax to get the connection's "probability"
Ich * habe			= 10 / √2	0.01	
Ich * Hunger			= 12 / √2	0.02	
habe * Ich			= 21 / √2	0.03	
habe * habe			= 70 / √2	0.96	
habe * Hunger			= 3 / √2	0.01	
Hunger * Ich			= 11 / √2	0.01	
Hunger * habe			= 5 / √2	0.01	
Hunger * Hunger			= 90 / √2	0.98	

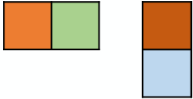
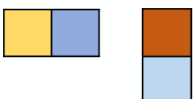
*Disclaimer: not real numbers from a real model. Only for illustration purpose

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*Disclaimer: not real numbers from a real model. Only for illustration purpose

Self-Attention

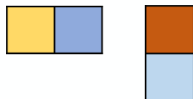
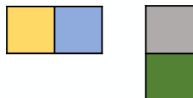
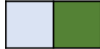
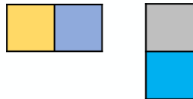
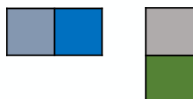
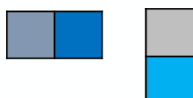
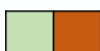
- Step 2: Finding attention between words

	query * key ^T	softmax	The softmax value represents the connection strength between words
Ich * Ich	 = $69 / \sqrt{2}$	0.97	 Ich habe Hunger
Ich * habe	 = $10 / \sqrt{2}$	0.01	
Ich * Hunger	 = $12 / \sqrt{2}$	0.02	
habe * Ich	 = $21 / \sqrt{2}$	0.03	 Ich habe Hunger
habe * habe	 = $70 / \sqrt{2}$	0.96	
habe * Hunger	 = $3 / \sqrt{2}$	0.01	
Hunger * Ich	 = $11 / \sqrt{2}$	0.01	 Ich habe Hunger
Hunger * habe	 = $5 / \sqrt{2}$	0.01	
Hunger * Hunger	 = $90 / \sqrt{2}$	0.98	

Self-Attention

- Step 2: Finding attention between words

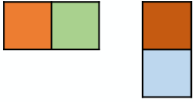
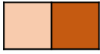
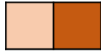
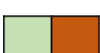
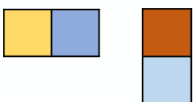
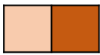
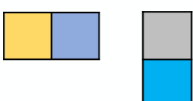
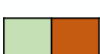
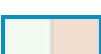
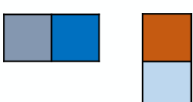
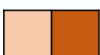
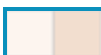
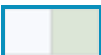
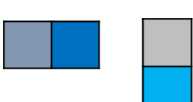
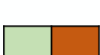
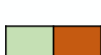
on

	query * key ^T	softmax	* value	
Ich * Ich	 = 69 / √2	0.97	*  Ich	Multiply with value (information each word gives if it got the attention)
Ich * habe	 = 10 / √2	0.01	*  habe	
Ich * Hunger	 = 12 / √2	0.02	*  Hunger	
habe * Ich	 = 21 / √2	0.03	*  Ich	
habe * habe	 = 70 / √2	0.96	*  habe	
habe * Hunger	 = 3 / √2	0.01	*  Hunger	
Hunger * Ich	 = 11 / √2	0.01	*  Ich	
Hunger * habe	 = 5 / √2	0.01	*  habe	
Hunger * Hunger	 = 90 / √2	0.98	*  Hunger	

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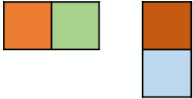
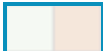
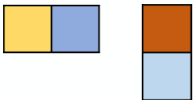
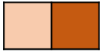
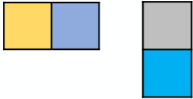
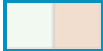
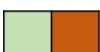
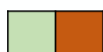
Self-Attention

- Step 2:
Finding
attention
between
words

	query * key ^T	softmax	* value
Ich * Ich	 = $69 / \sqrt{2}$	0.97	*  Ich = 
Ich * habe	 = $10 / \sqrt{2}$	0.01	*  habe = 
Ich * Hunger	 = $12 / \sqrt{2}$	0.02	*  Hunger = 
habe * Ich	 = $21 / \sqrt{2}$	0.03	*  Ich = 
habe * habe	 = $70 / \sqrt{2}$	0.96	*  habe = 
habe * Hunger	 = $3 / \sqrt{2}$	0.01	*  Hunger = 
Hunger * Ich	 = $11 / \sqrt{2}$	0.01	*  Ich = 
Hunger * habe	 = $5 / \sqrt{2}$	0.01	*  habe = 
Hunger * Hunger	 = $90 / \sqrt{2}$	0.98	*  Hunger = 

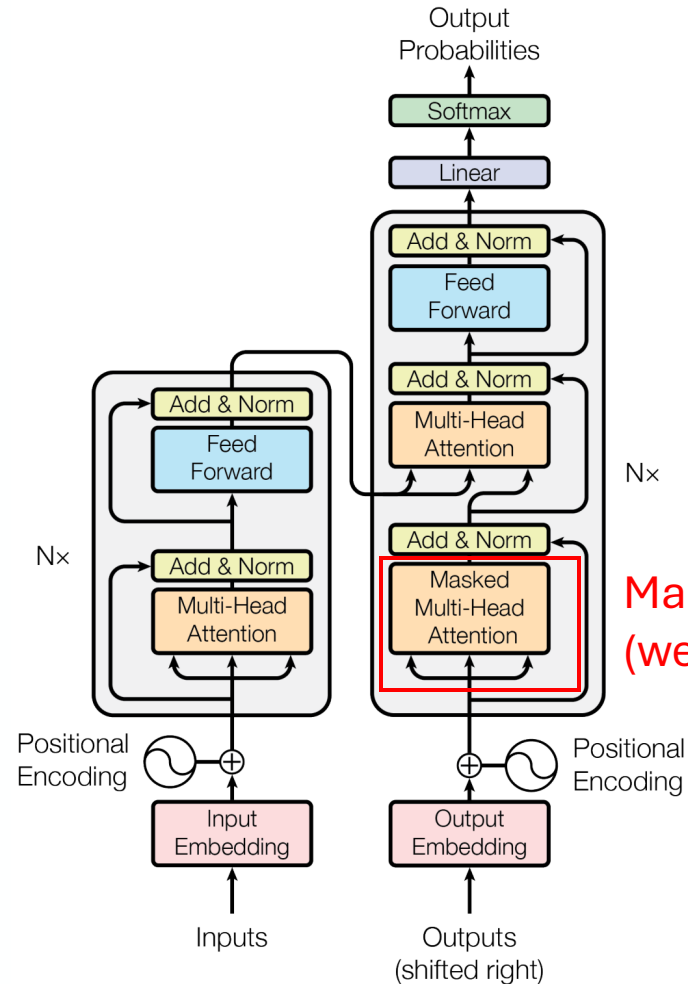
Self-Attention

- Step 2: Finding attention between words

	query * key ^T	softmax	* value	$\sum$
Ich * Ich	 = $69 / \sqrt{2}$	0.97	*  Ich = 	Combine all context  Ich +context
Ich * habe	 = $10 / \sqrt{2}$	0.01	*  habe = 	
Ich * Hunger	 = $12 / \sqrt{2}$	0.02	*  Hunger = 	
habe * Ich	 = $21 / \sqrt{2}$	0.03	*  Ich = 	 habe +context
habe * habe	 = $70 / \sqrt{2}$	0.96	*  habe = 	
habe * Hunger	 = $3 / \sqrt{2}$	0.01	*  Hunger = 	
Hunger * Ich	 = $11 / \sqrt{2}$	0.01	*  Ich = 	 Hunger +context
Hunger * habe	 = $5 / \sqrt{2}$	0.01	*  habe = 	
Hunger * Hunger	 = $90 / \sqrt{2}$	0.98	*  Hunger = 	

Masked Self-Attention

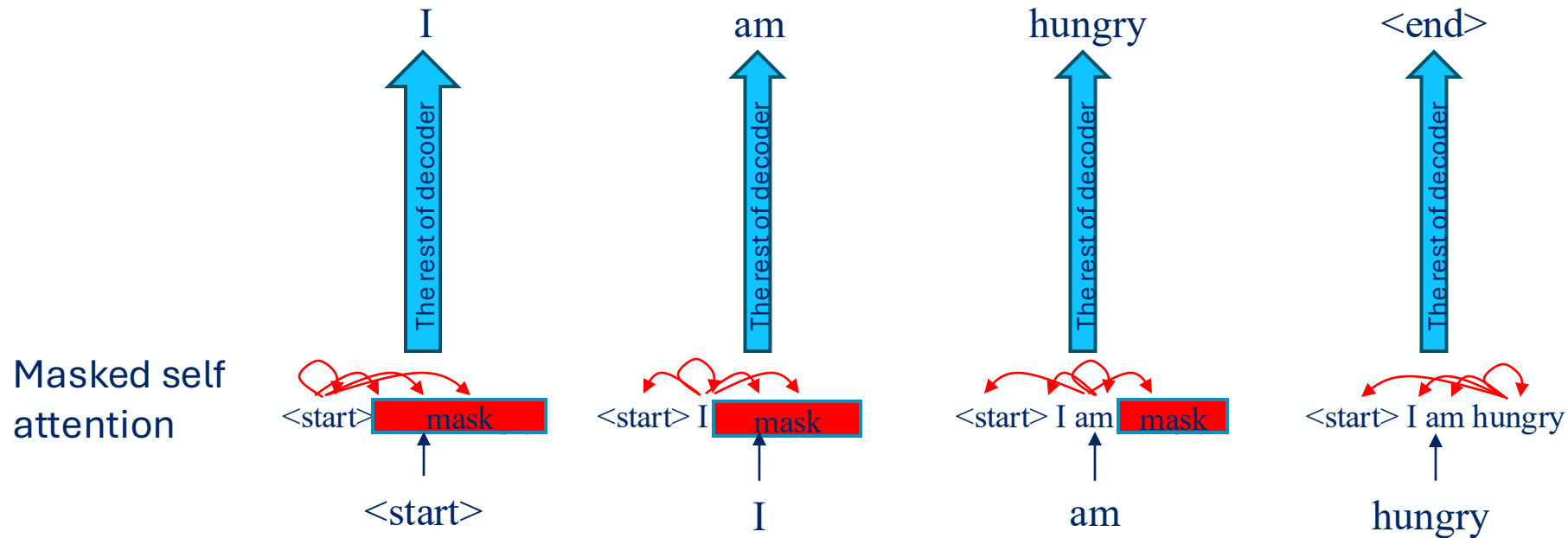
- Input: word embedding of output (ground truth) shifted to right + positional encoding;
OR
previous decoder block's output



Masked self-attention is here
(we will discuss first without “multi-head”)

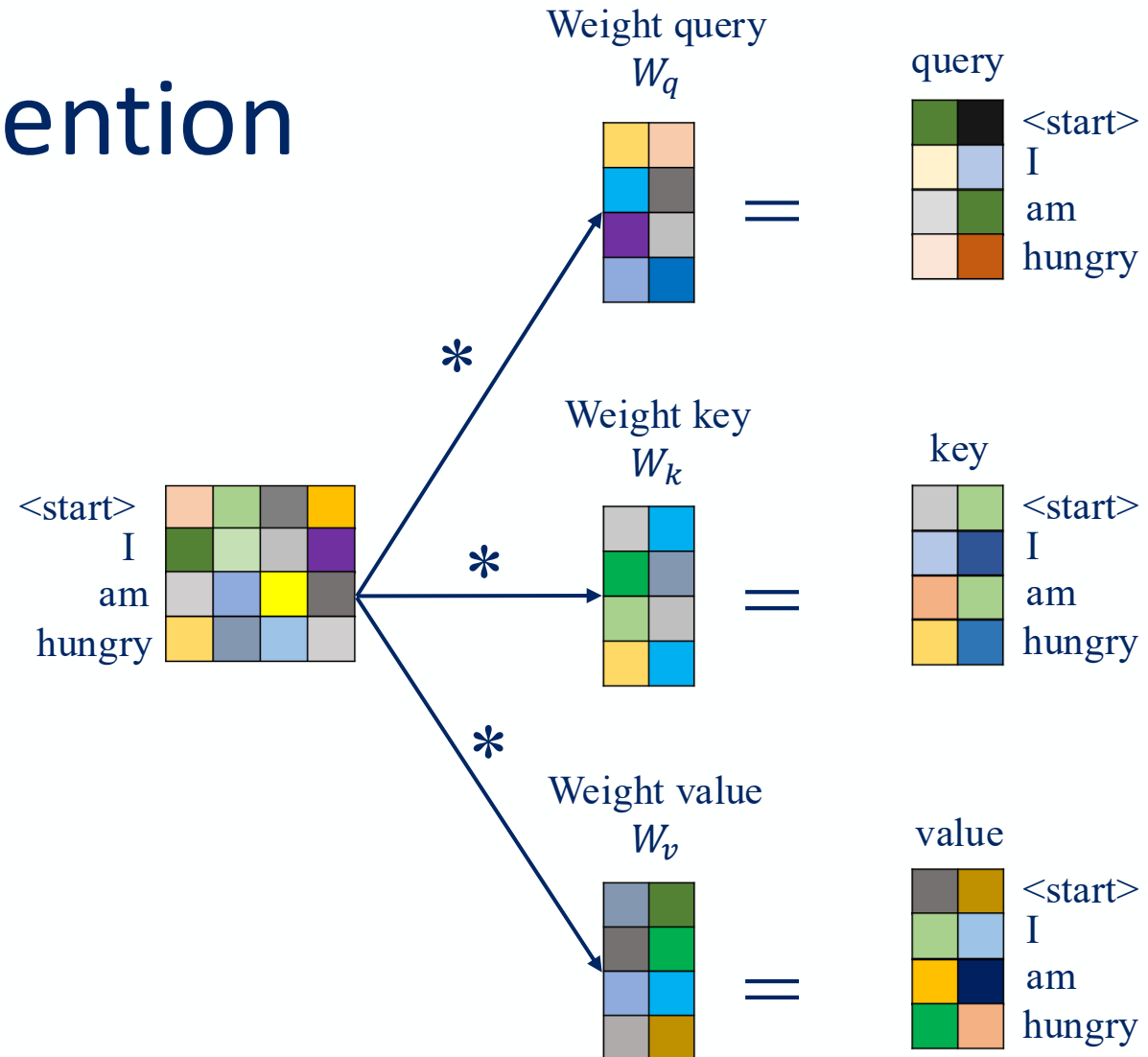
Masked Self-Attention

- Motivation of mask:
 - Decoder's self attention should not see the future words
 - No future words during test time.
 - Still parallelizable during training



Masked Self-Attention

- Step 1: Query, key, value calculation is same as self-attention



Masked Self-Attention

- Step 2: Dot product query and key is same as self-attention

$\text{query} * \text{key}^T$

$\langle \text{start} \rangle * \langle \text{start} \rangle$		
$\langle \text{start} \rangle * \text{I}$		
$\langle \text{start} \rangle * \text{am}$		
$\langle \text{start} \rangle * \text{hungry}$		

$\text{I} * \langle \text{start} \rangle$		
$\text{I} * \text{I}$		
$\text{I} * \text{am}$		
$\text{I} * \text{hungry}$		

Masked Self-Attention

- Step 2: Dot product query and key is same as self-attention

$\text{query} * \text{key}^T$

$\langle \text{start} \rangle * \langle \text{start} \rangle$		
$\langle \text{start} \rangle * \text{I}$		
$\langle \text{start} \rangle * \text{am}$		
$\langle \text{start} \rangle * \text{hungry}$		

$\text{I} * \langle \text{start} \rangle$		
$\text{I} * \text{I}$		
$\text{I} * \text{am}$		
$\text{I} * \text{hungry}$		

$\text{am} * \langle \text{start} \rangle$
 $\text{am} * \text{I}$
 $\text{am} * \text{am}$
 $\text{am} * \text{hungry}$

$\text{hungry} * \langle \text{start} \rangle$
 $\text{hungry} * \text{I}$
 $\text{hungry} * \text{am}$
 $\text{hungry} * \text{hungry}$

We also have these query-key pairs but slide too small ☹️

Masked Self-Attention

- Step 2: Dot product query and key is same as self-attention

query * key^T

<start> * <start>			=	69
<start> * I			=	13
<start> * am			=	12
<start> * hungry			=	19

I * <start>			=	10
I * I			=	43
I * am			=	11
I * hungry			=	8



Disclaimer: the number is not number from a real model.

Masked Self-Attention

- Step 3: For masked words:
 - Replace the dot product results with $-\infty$

query * key^T

<start> * <start>			=	69
<start> * I			=	$-\infty$
<start> * am			=	$-\infty$
<start> * hungry			=	$-\infty$

I * <start>			=	10
I * I			=	43
I * am			=	$-\infty$
I * hungry			=	$-\infty$



Disclaimer: the number is not number from a real model.

Masked Self-Attention

- Step 3: For masked words:
 - Replace the dot product results with $-\infty$
 - Their softmax results will be 0

	query * key ^T			softmax
<start> * <start>		=	69	1
<start> * I		=	$-\infty$	0
<start> * am		=	$-\infty$	0
<start> * hungry		=	$-\infty$	0
I * <start>		=	10	0.02
I * I		=	43	0.98
I * am		=	$-\infty$	0
I * hungry		=	$-\infty$	0

Masked words have 0 attention



Disclaimer: the number is not number from a real model.

The rest is same as self-attention

Masked Self-Attention

- Step 3: For masked words:
 - Replace the dot product results with $-\infty$
 - Their softmax results will be 0

	query * key ^T				softmax	*	value
<start> * <start>			=	69	1	*	
<start> * I			=	$-\infty$	0	*	
<start> * am			=	$-\infty$	0	*	
<start> * hungry			=	$-\infty$	0	*	
I * <start>			=	10	0.02	*	
I * I			=	43	0.98	*	
I * am			=	$-\infty$	0	*	
I * hungry			=	$-\infty$	0	*	

The rest is same as self-attention

Masked Self-Attention

- Step 3: For masked words:
 - Replace the dot product results with $-\infty$
 - Their softmax results will be 0

	query * key ^T			softmax	*	value	
<start> * <start>			= 69	1	*		=
<start> * I			= $-\infty$	0	*		=
<start> * am			= $-\infty$	0	*		=
<start> * hungry			= $-\infty$	0	*		=
I * <start>			= 10	0.02	*		=
I * I			= 43	0.98	*		=
I * am			= $-\infty$	0	*		=
I * hungry			= $-\infty$	0	*		=

Masked Self-Attention

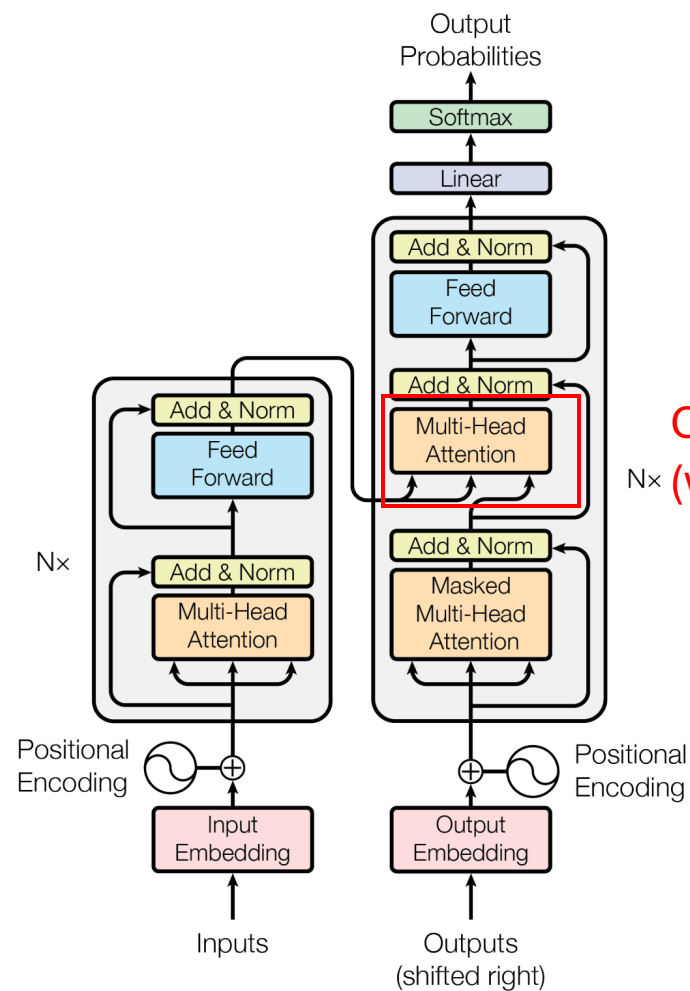
The rest is same as self-attention

- Step 3: For masked words:
 - Replace the dot product results with $-\infty$
 - Their softmax results will be 0

	query * key ^T		softmax	*	value		Σ
<start> * <start>		= 69	1	*		=	 <start> + context from current and past words
<start> * I		= $-\infty$	0	*		=	
<start> * am		= $-\infty$	0	*		=	
<start> * hungry		= $-\infty$	0	*		=	
I * <start>		= 10	0.02	*		=	 I + context from current and past words
I * I		= 43	0.98	*		=	
I * am		= $-\infty$	0	*		=	
I * hungry		= $-\infty$	0	*		=	

Cross-Attention

- Input:
 - Encoder's final output
 - Output of masked self-attention



Cross-attention is here
(we will discuss first without "multi-head")

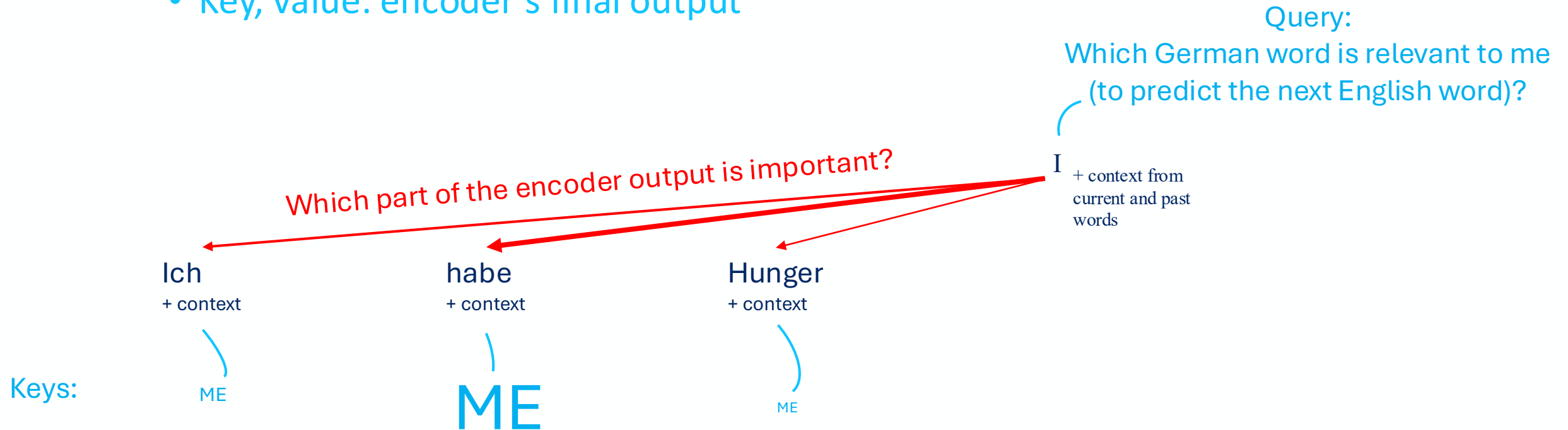
Cross-Attention

- Similar with self-attention, but
 - Query: results of decoder's masked attention
 - Key, value: encoder's final output



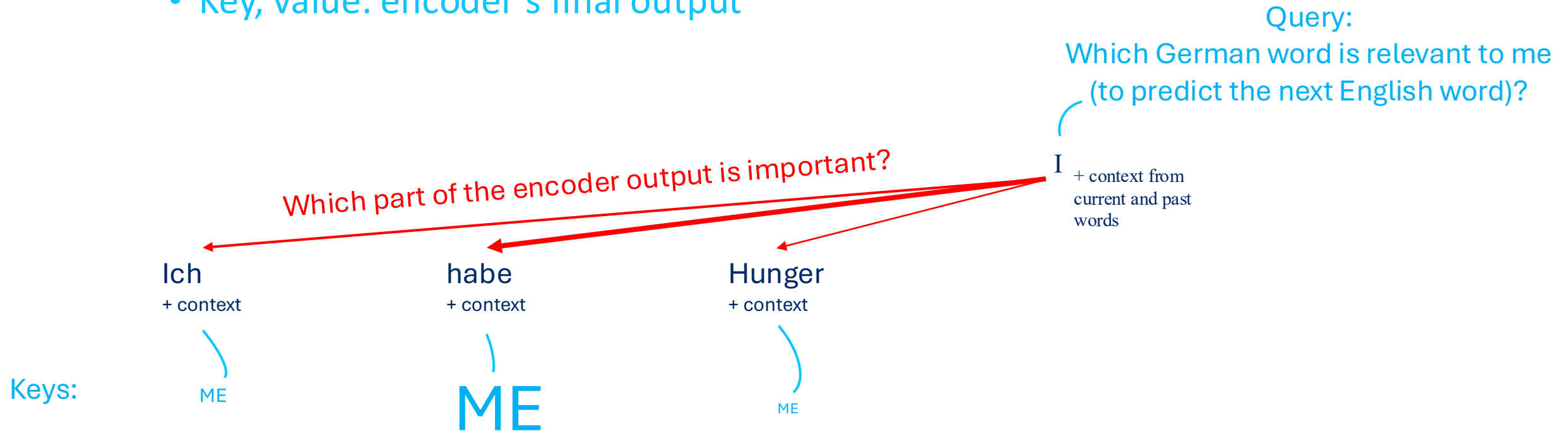
Cross-Attention

- Similar with self-attention, but
 - Query: results of decoder's masked attention
 - Key, value: encoder's final output



Cross-Attention

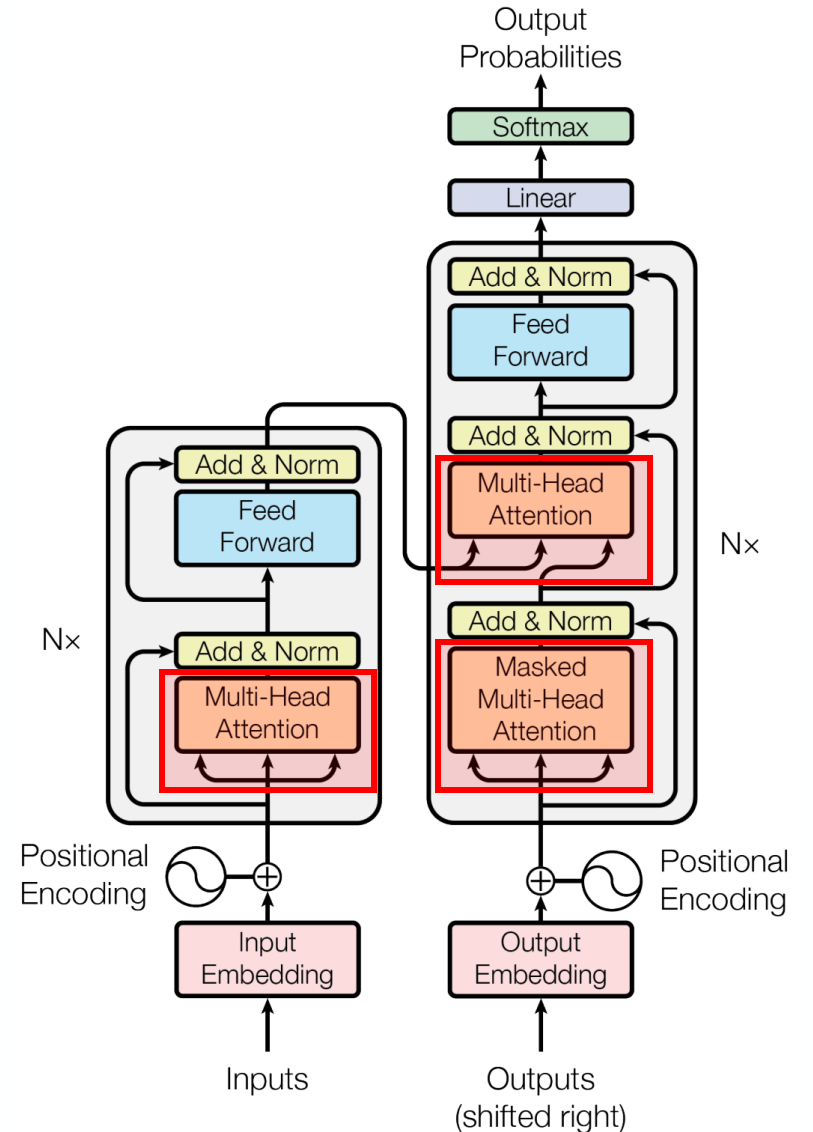
- Similar with self-attention, but
 - Query: results of decoder's masked attention
 - Key, value: encoder's final output



Values: "and here is the information I give if I got the attention"

Multi-Head Attention

- Multi-head self attention in encoder
- Multi-head cross attention in decoder
- Masked multi-head self attention in decoder

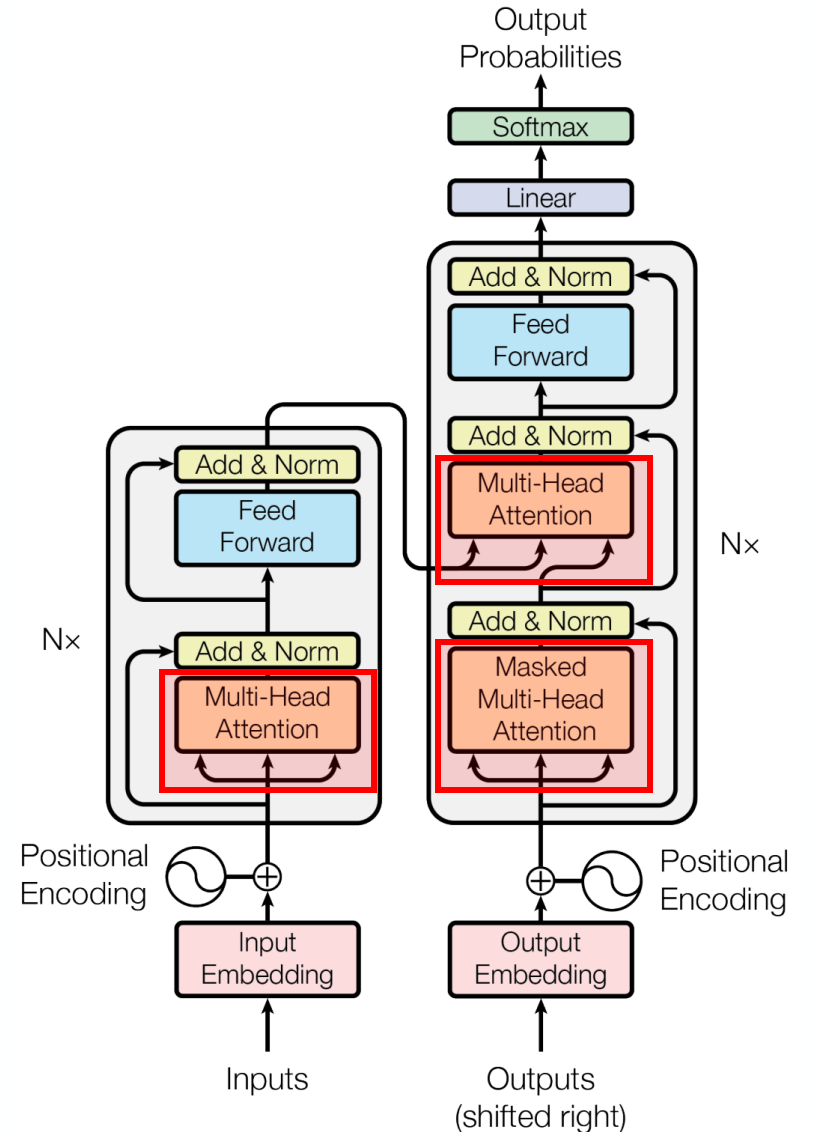


Multi-Head Attention

as an example...

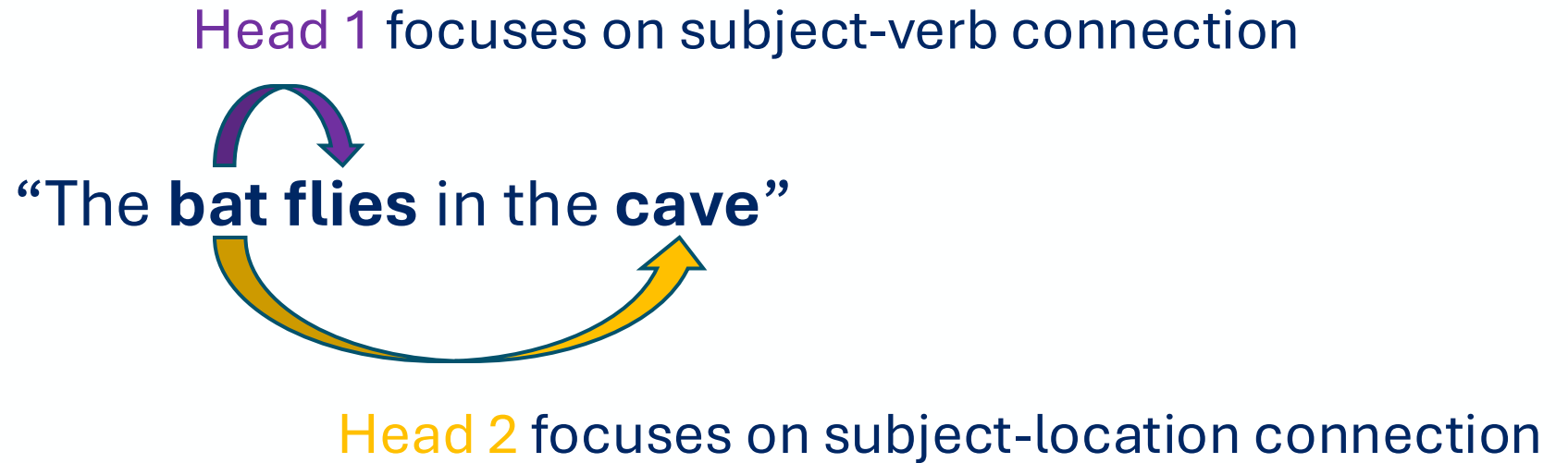
- **Multi-head self attention** in encoder
- Multi-head cross attention in decoder
- Masked multi-head self attention in decoder

The others will have the same concept



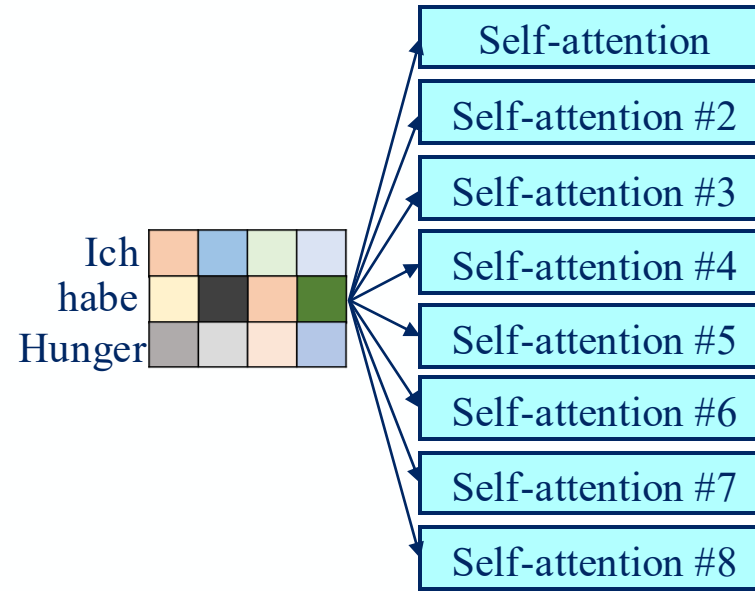
Multi-head Attention

- Motivation of multi-head: to cover different kinds of attention/connection



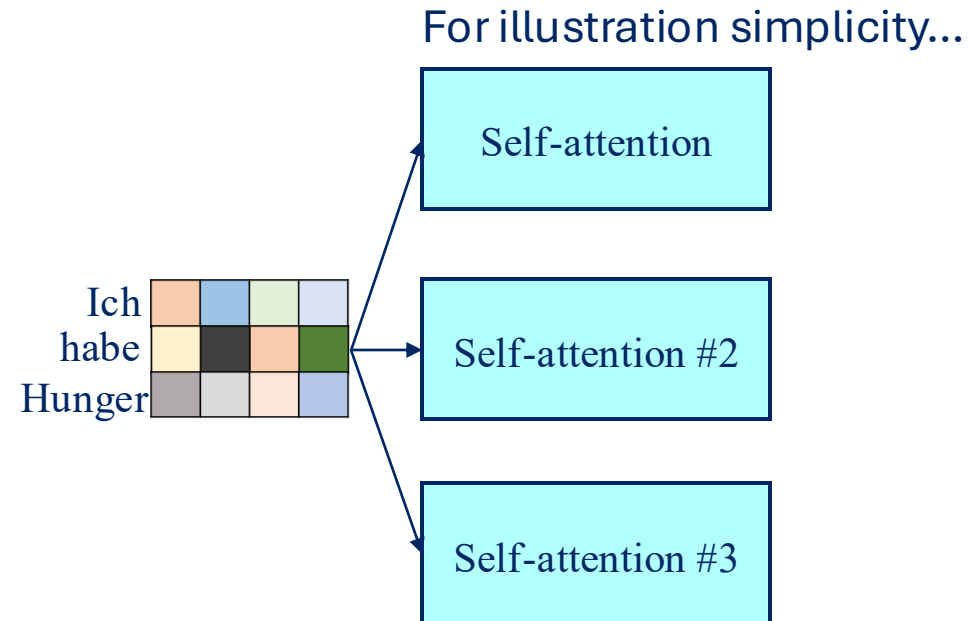
Multi-Head Attention

- More than 1 attentions, done in parallel
 - Originally, 8 attentions



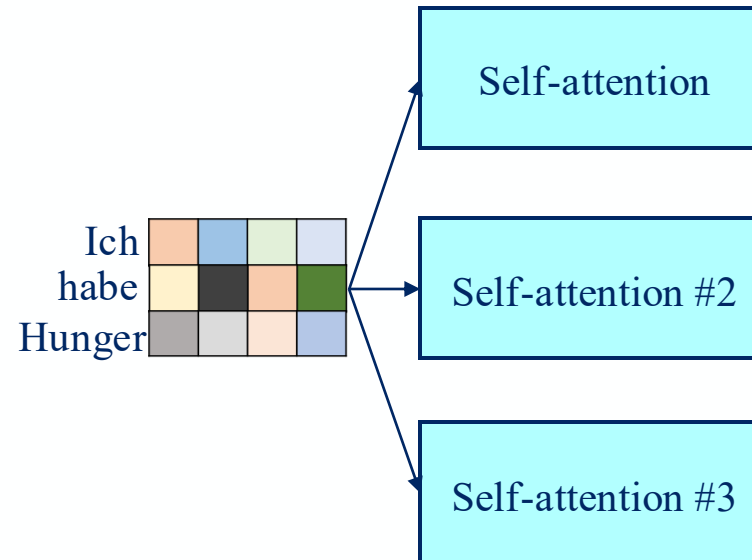
Multi-Head Attention

- More than 1 attentions, done in parallel
 - Originally, 8 attentions



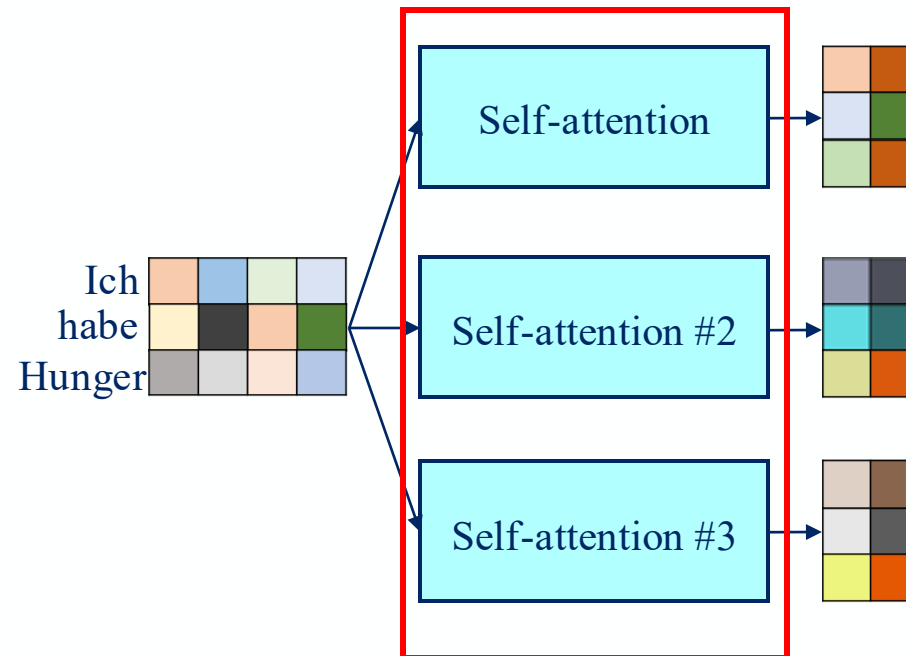
Multi-Head Attention

- More than 1 attentions, done in parallel
 - Originally, 8 attentions
 - Multiple attentions complementing each other



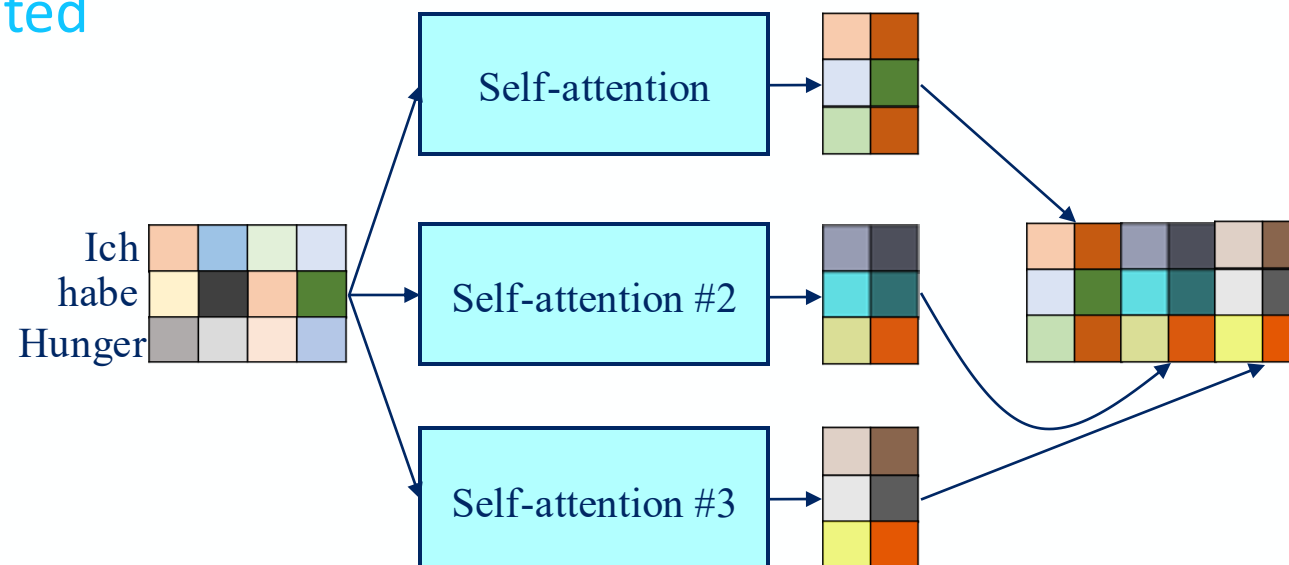
Multi-Head Attention

- More than 1 attentions, done in parallel
 - Originally, 8 attentions
 - Multiple attentions complementing each other → no shared weight



Multi-Head Attention

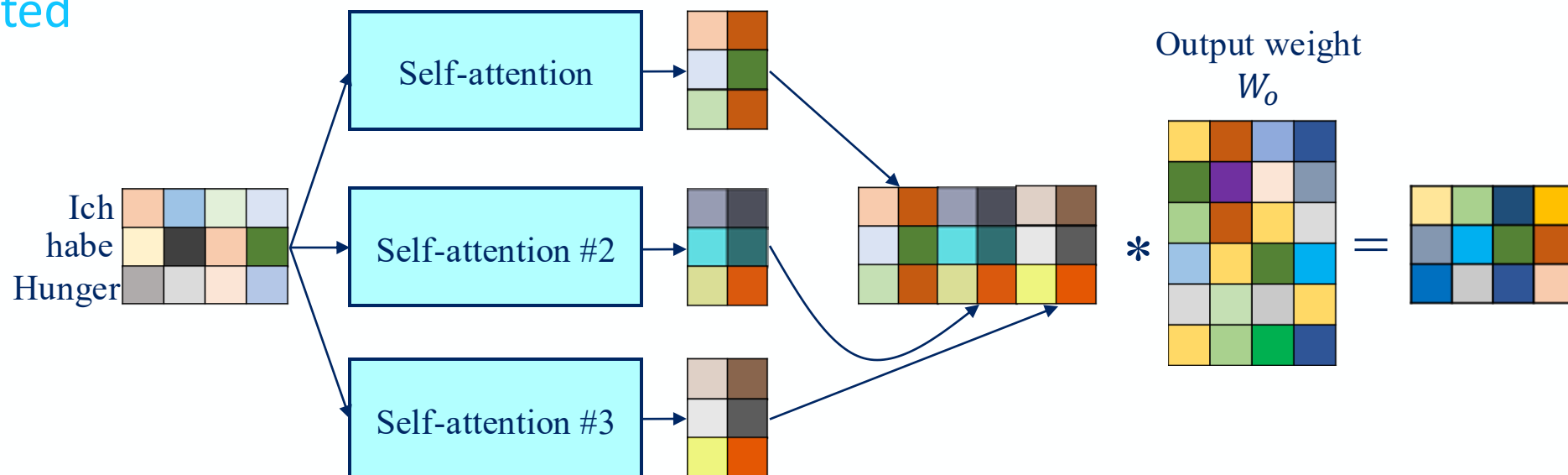
- More than 1 attentions, done in parallel
 - Originally, 8 attentions
 - Multiple attentions complementing each other → no shared weight
 - Concatenated



Multi-Head Attention

- More than 1 attentions, done in parallel
 - Originally, 8 attentions
 - Multiple attentions complementing each other → no shared weight
 - Concatenated

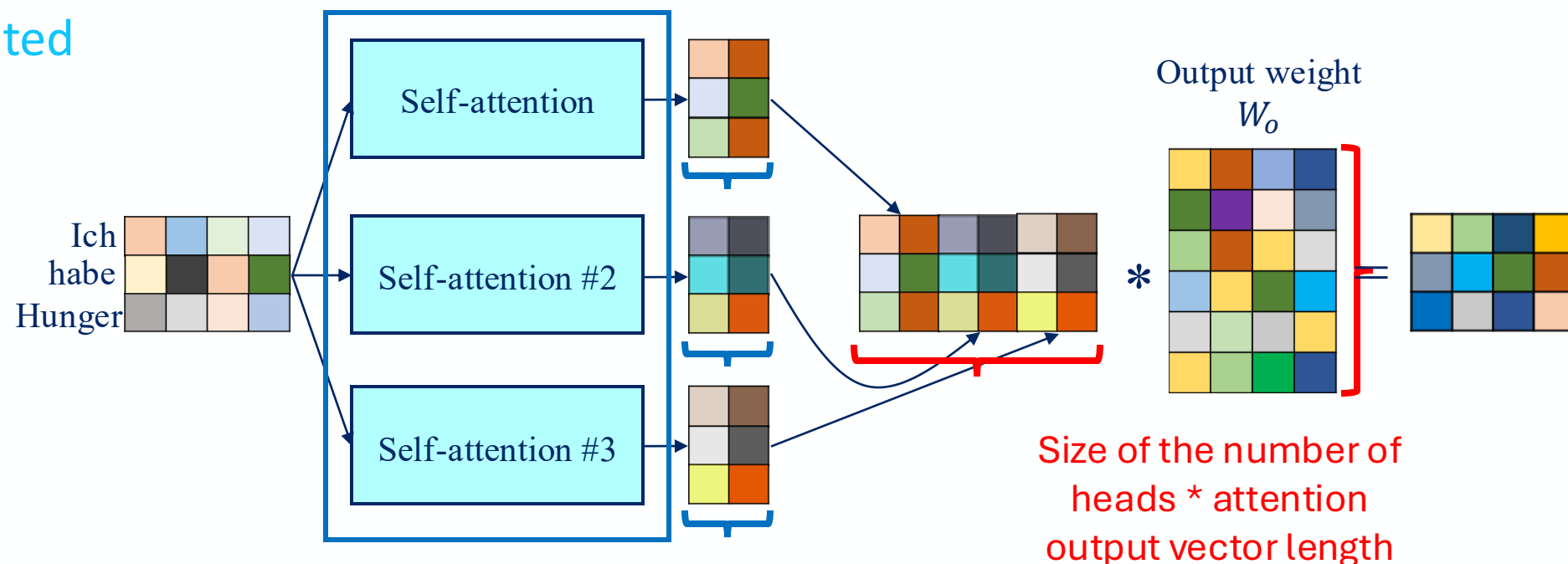
- Learnable output weight



Multi-Head Attention

- More than 1 attentions, done in parallel
 - Originally, 8 attentions
 - Multiple attentions complementing each other → no shared weight
 - Concatenated

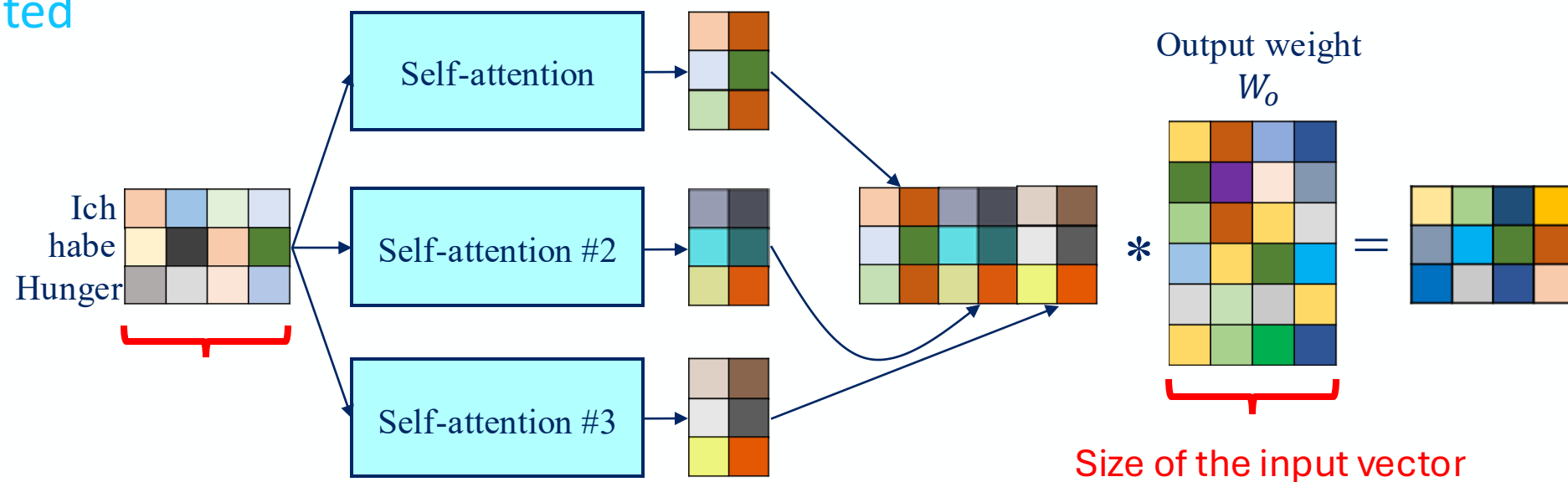
- Learnable output weight



Multi-Head Attention

- More than 1 attentions, done in parallel
 - Originally, 8 attentions
 - Multiple attentions complementing each other → no shared weight
 - Concatenated

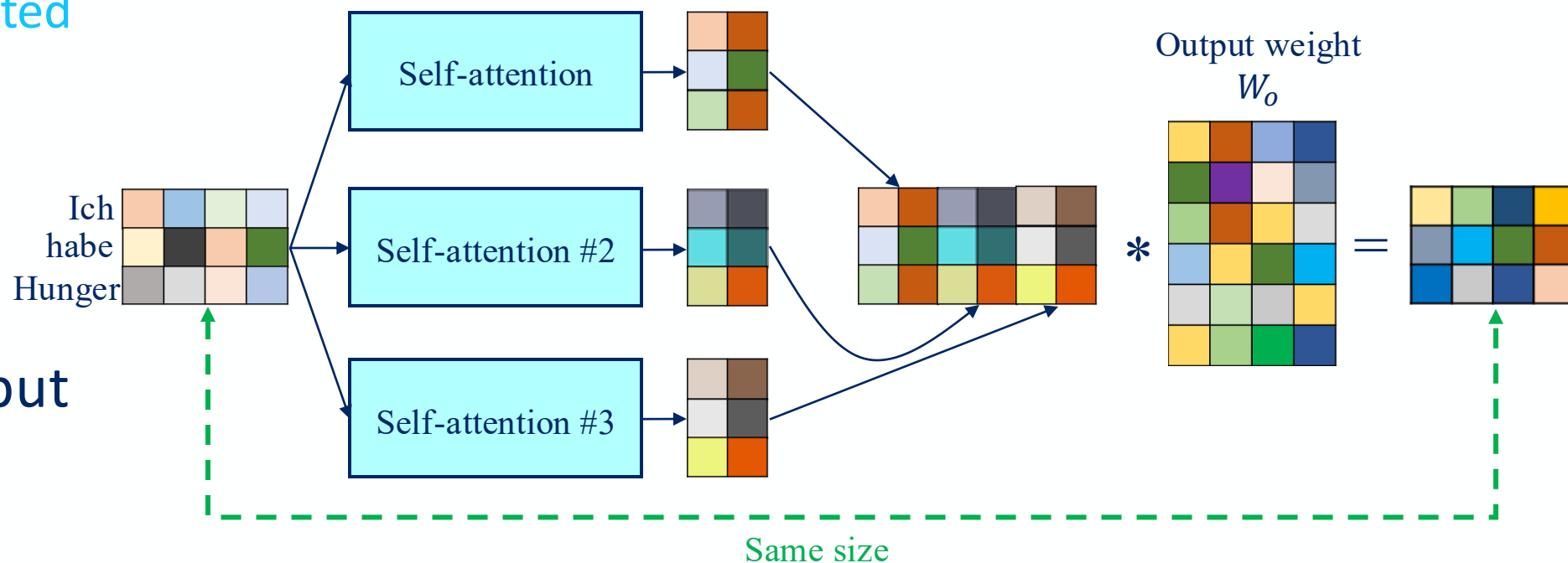
- Learnable output weight



Multi-Head Attention

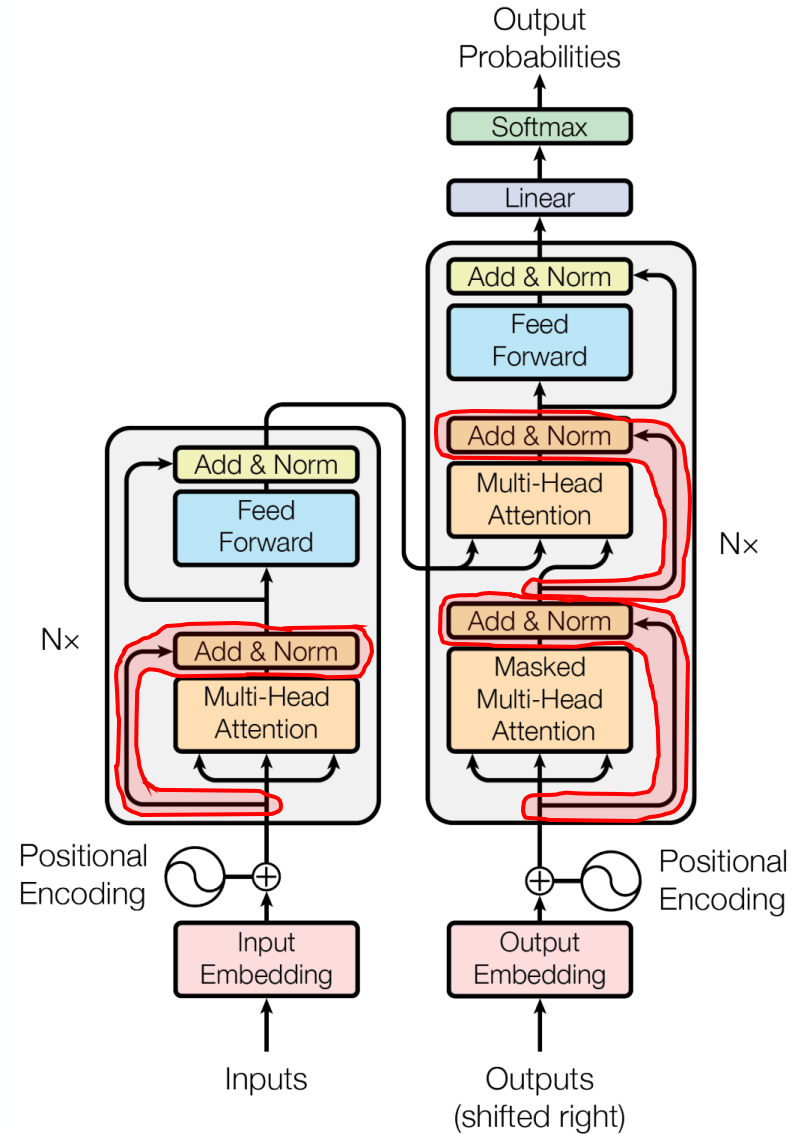
- More than 1 attentions, done in parallel
 - Originally, 8 attentions
 - Multiple attentions complementing each other → no shared weight
 - Concatenated

- Learnable output weight
- Same input & output size



Skip Connection

- Skip connection in each multi-head attention
 - Attention input size need to be same with attention output size

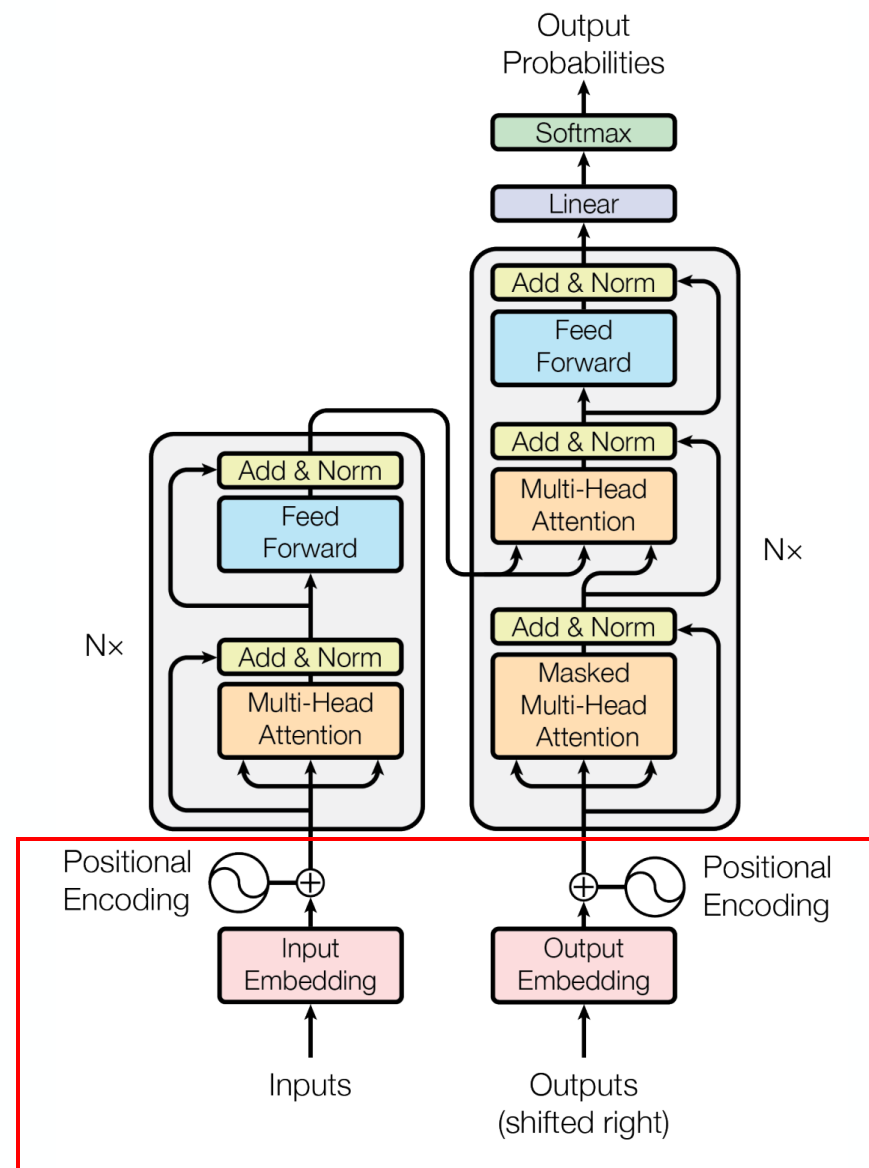


Outline

1. Overview
2. Preprocessing
3. Attention mechanism
4. Putting it all together
5. Variants of Transformer

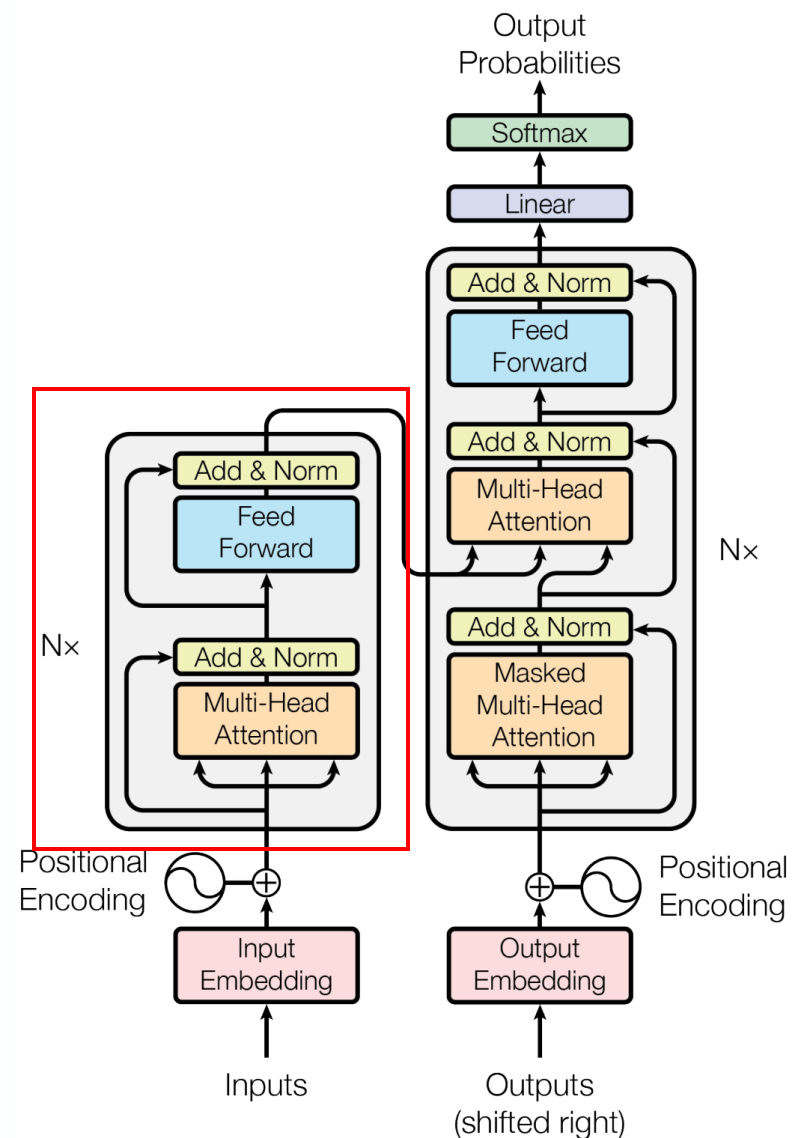
Transformer

- Preprocessing
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding



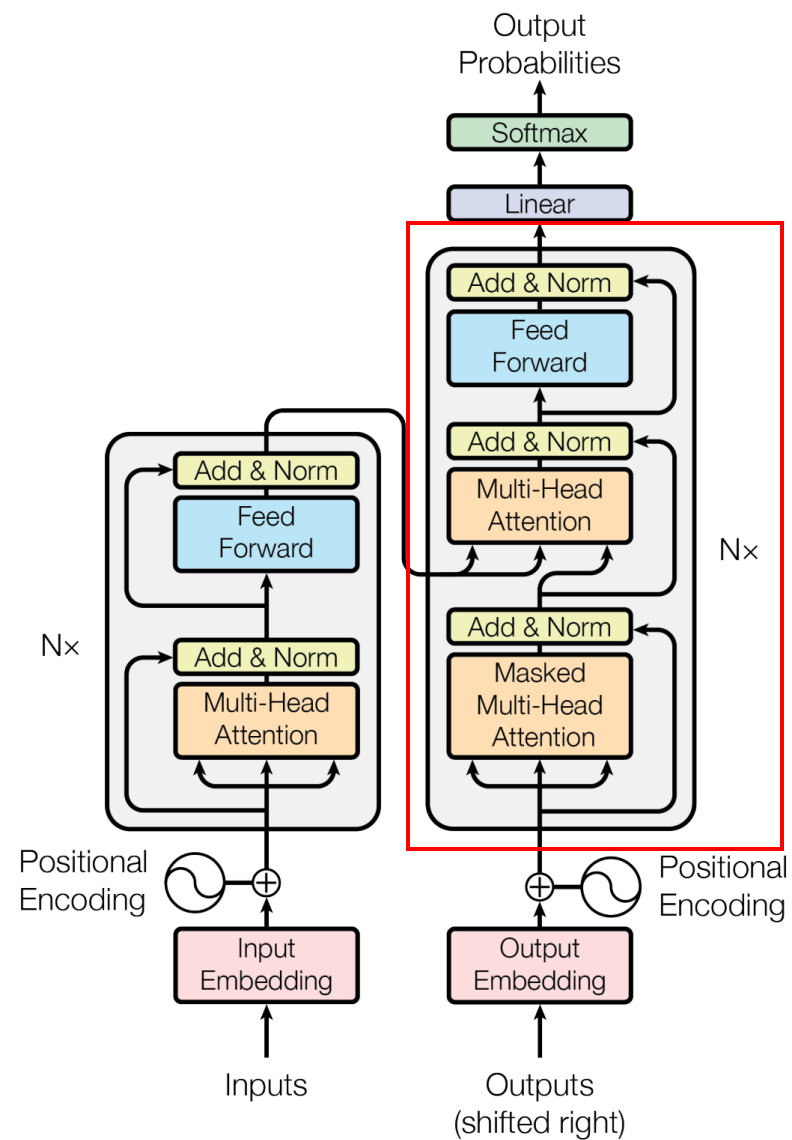
Transformer

- Preprocessing
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding
- Encoder



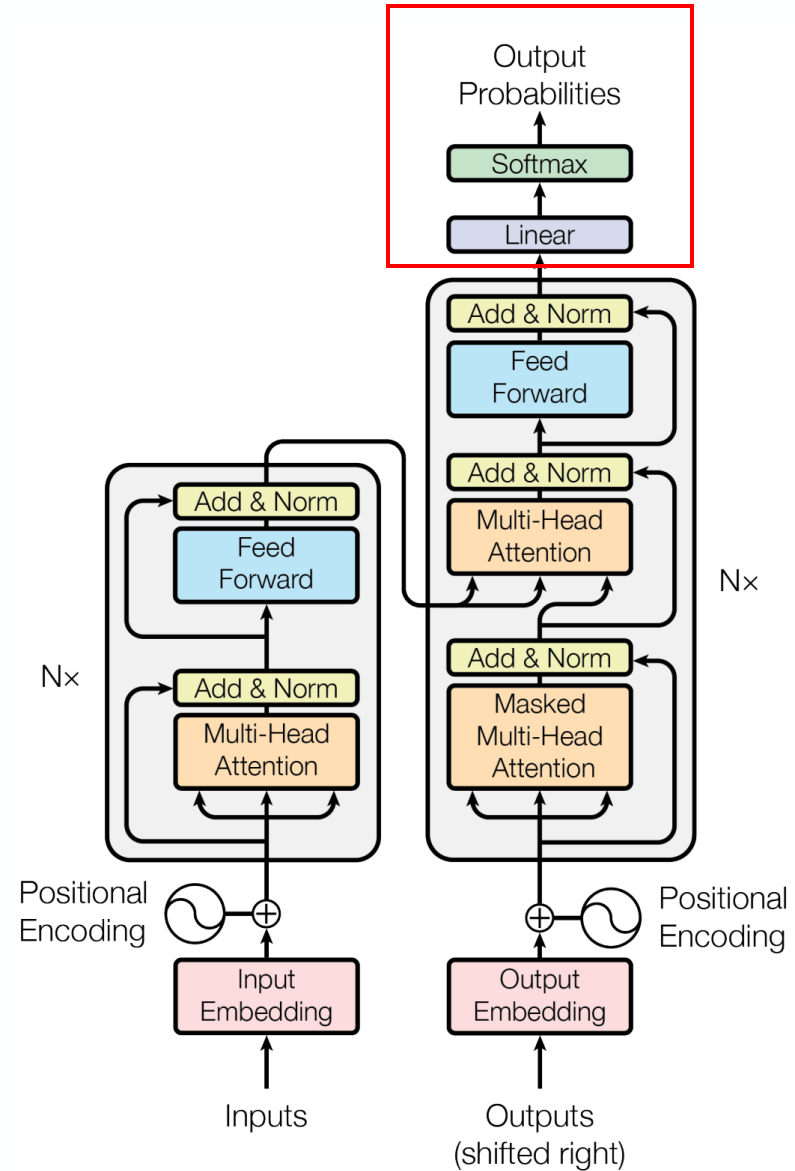
Transformer

- Preprocessing
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding
- Encoder
- Decoder



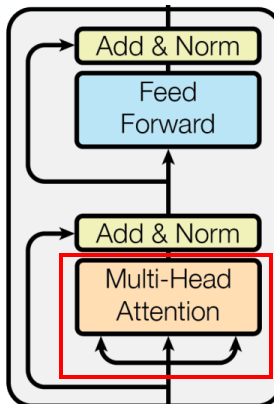
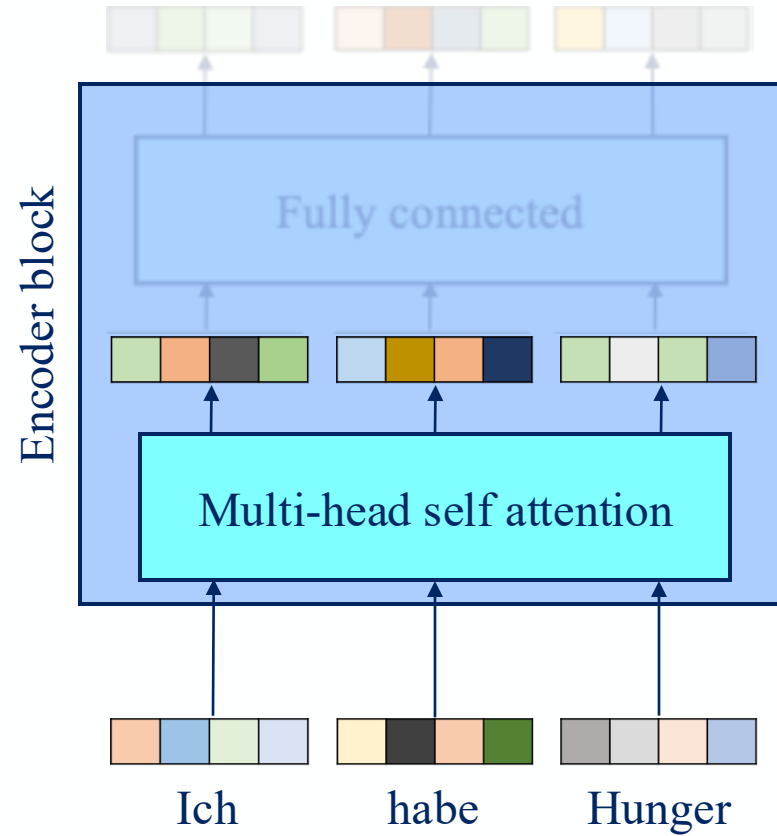
Transformer

- Preprocessing
 - Word embedding
 - Positional encoding
- Encoder
- Decoder
- Output layers
 - Fully connected layers
 - Softmax



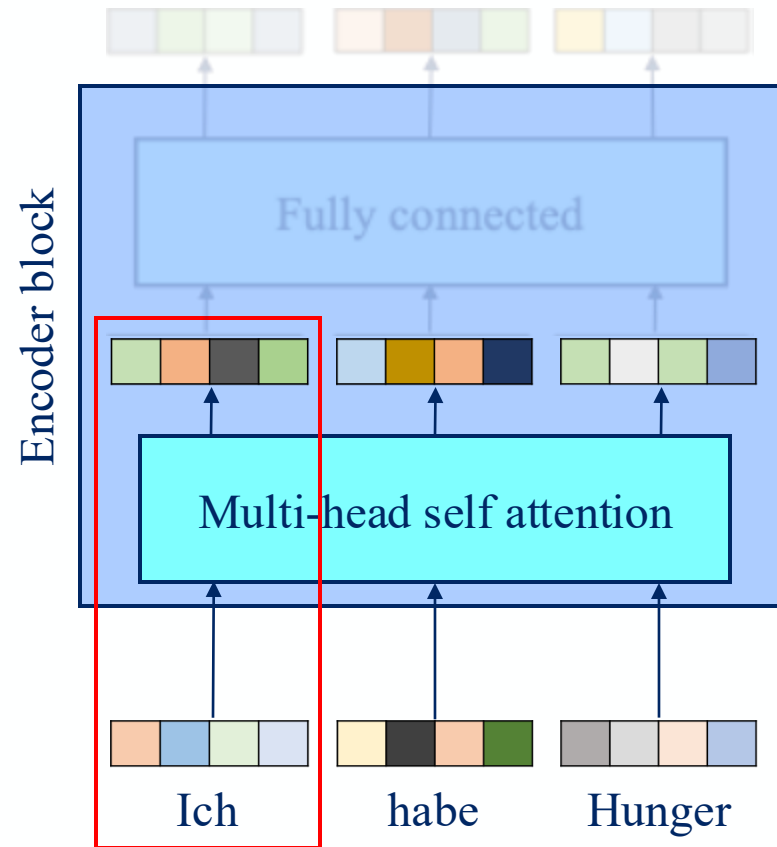
Encoder

- Multi-head self-attention



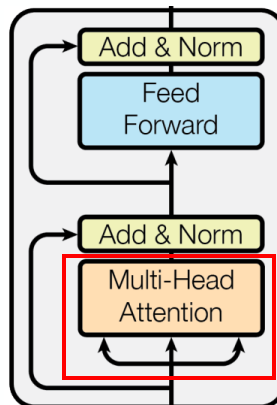
Encoder

- Multi-head self-attention



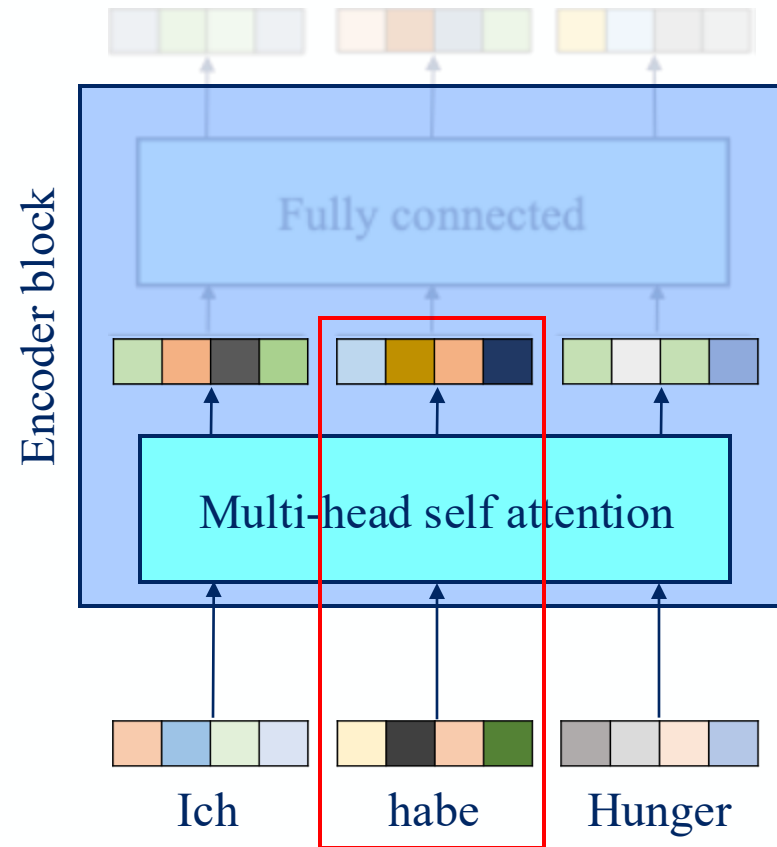
Finding connection
between each word
and all words

Ich *habe* *Hunger*



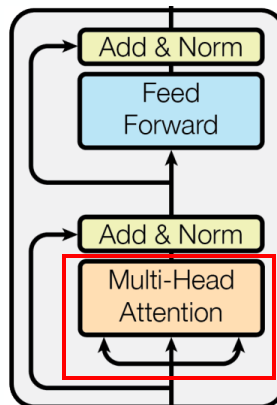
Encoder

- Multi-head self-attention



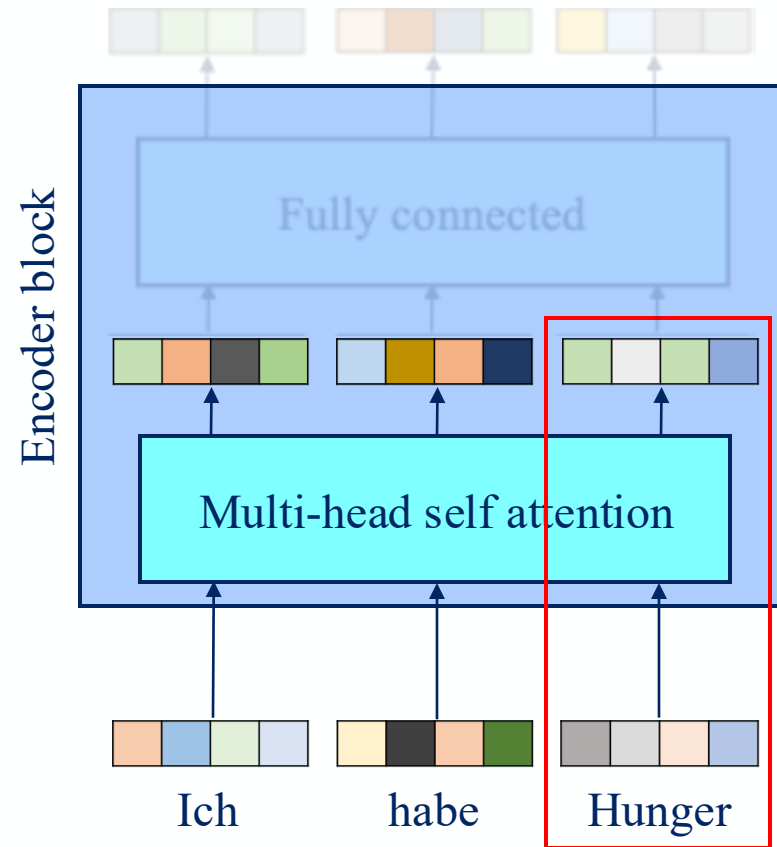
Finding connection
between each word
and all words

Ich habe Hunger



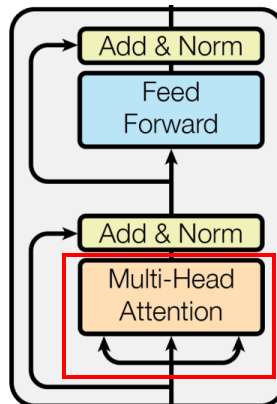
Encoder

- Multi-head self-attention



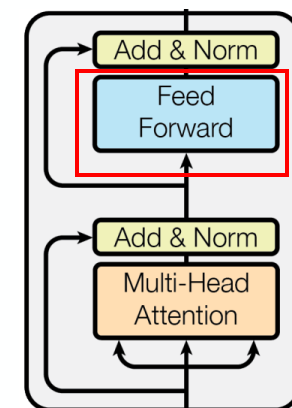
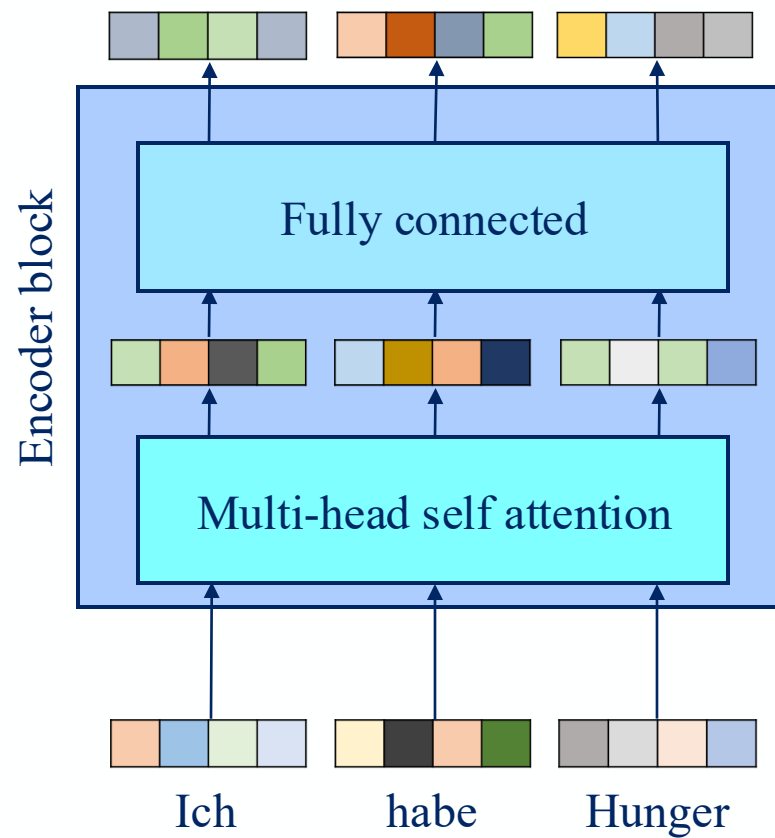
Finding connection
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and all words

Ich habe Hunger



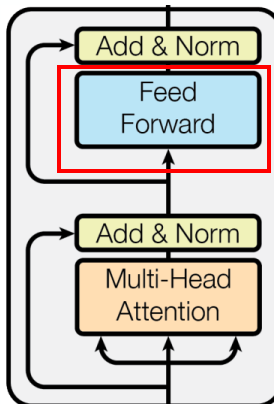
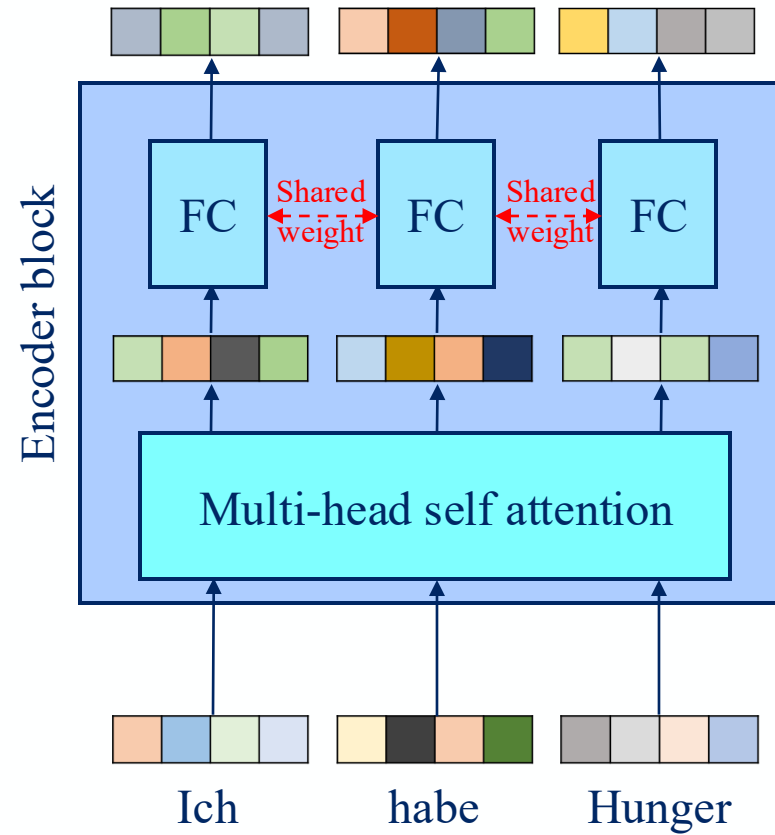
Encoder

- Multi-head self-attention
- Feed forward/fully connected layer



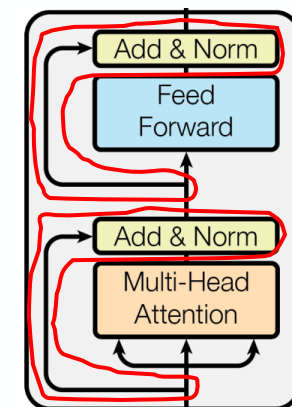
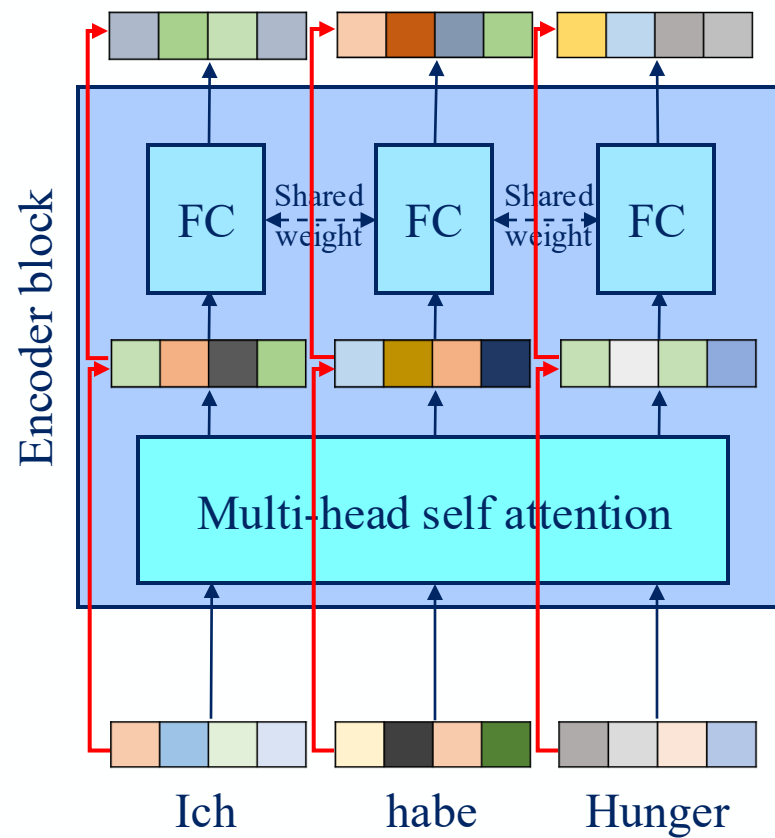
Encoder

- Multi-head self-attention
- Feed forward/fully connected layer
 - Shared weight



Encoder

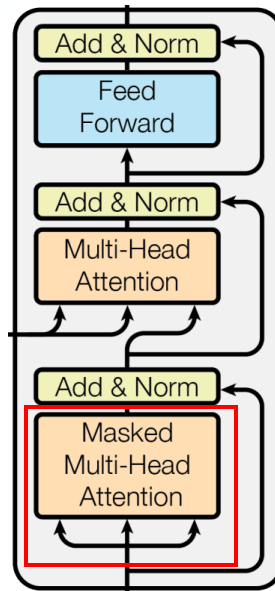
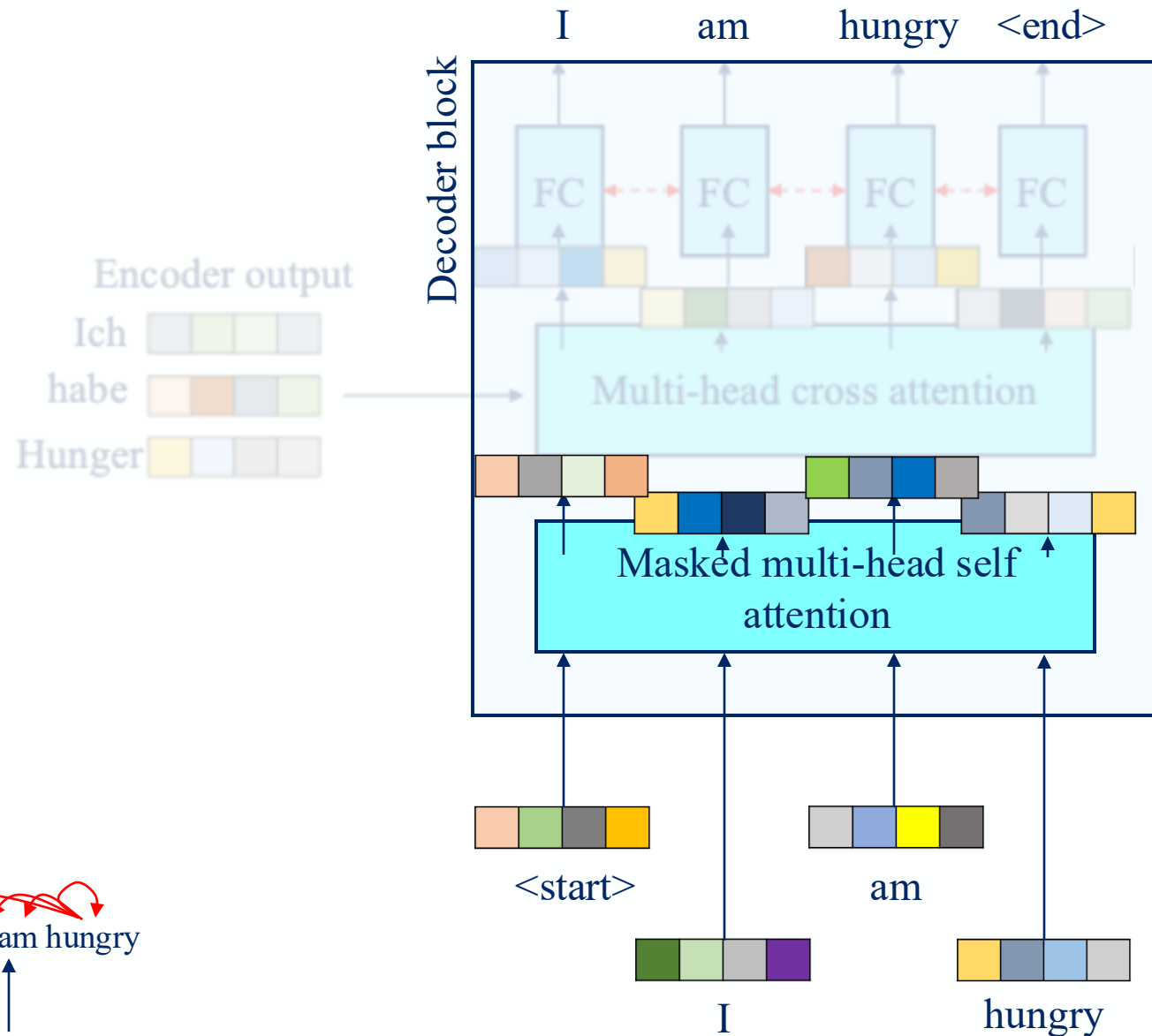
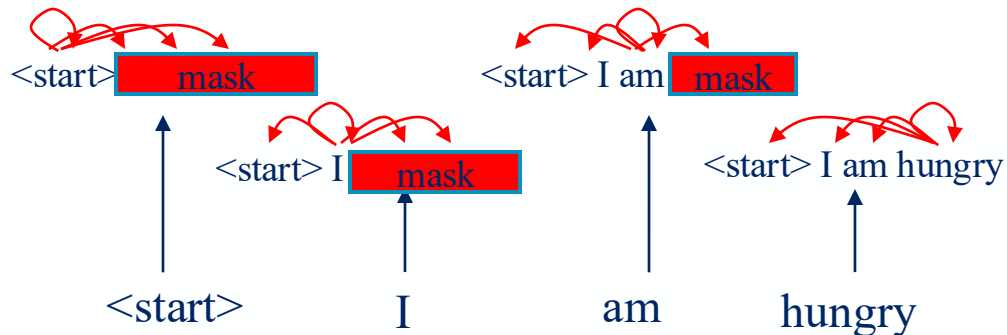
- Multi-head self-attention
- Feed forward/fully connected layer
 - Shared weight
- Residual connection



Decoder

- Masked multi-head self attention

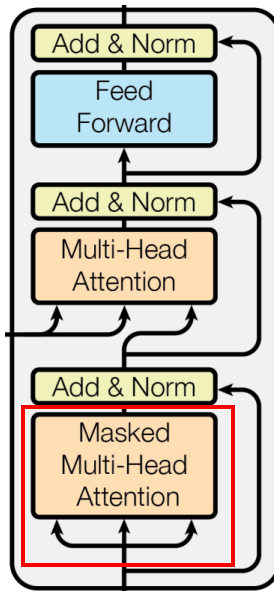
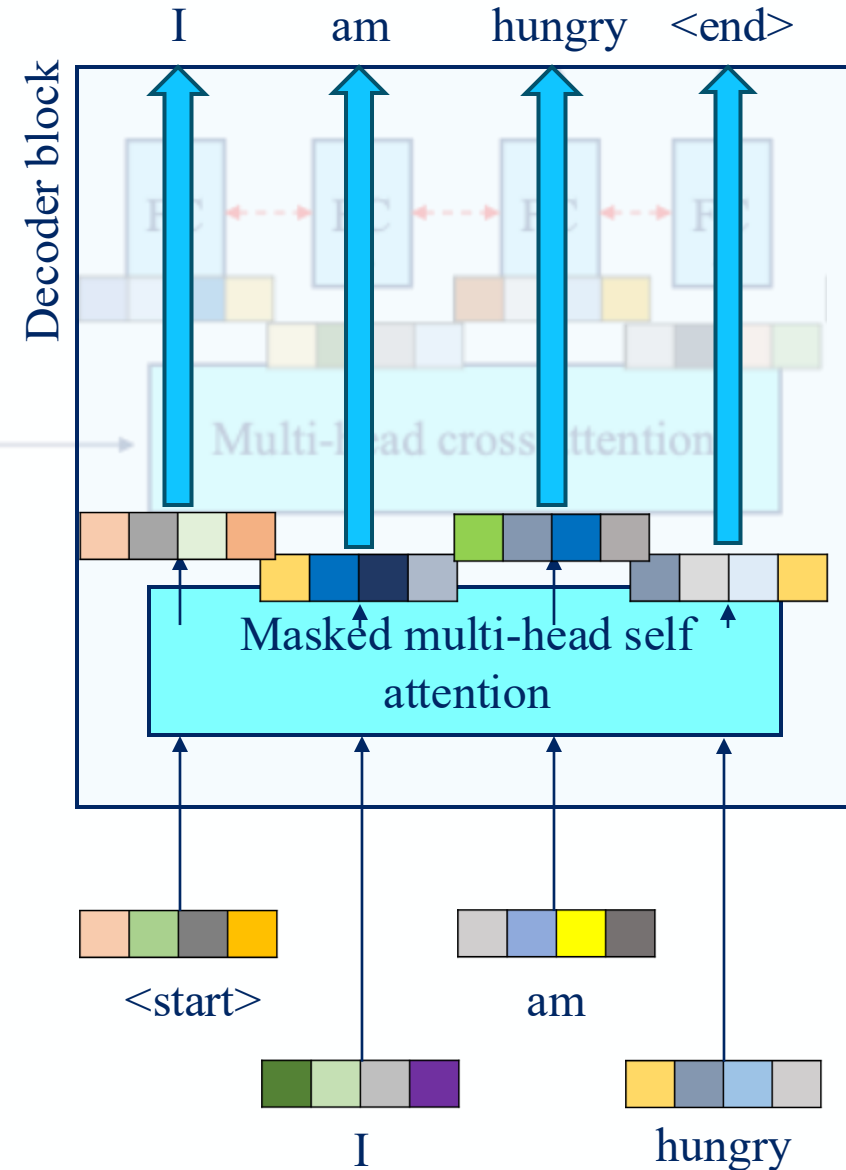
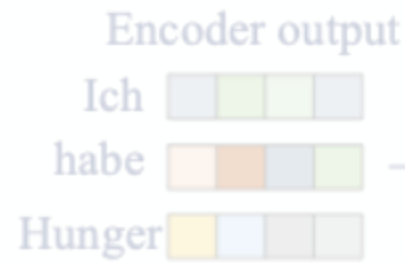
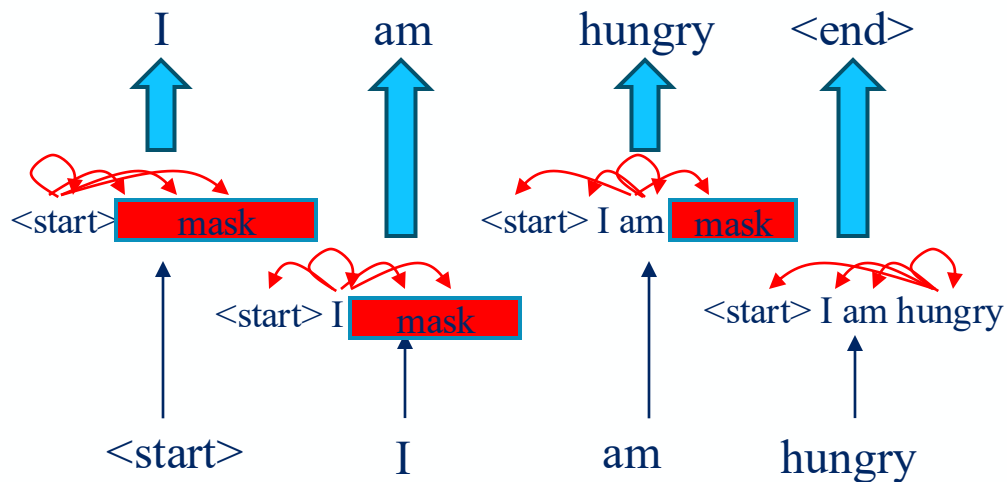
Finding connection between each word and all current & past words



Decoder

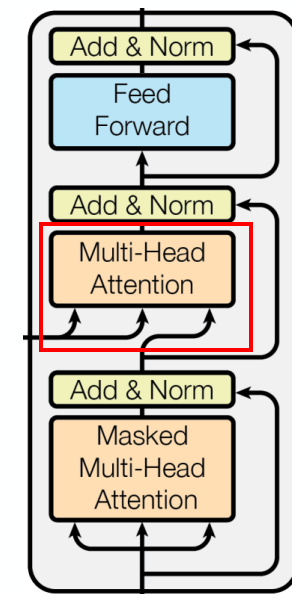
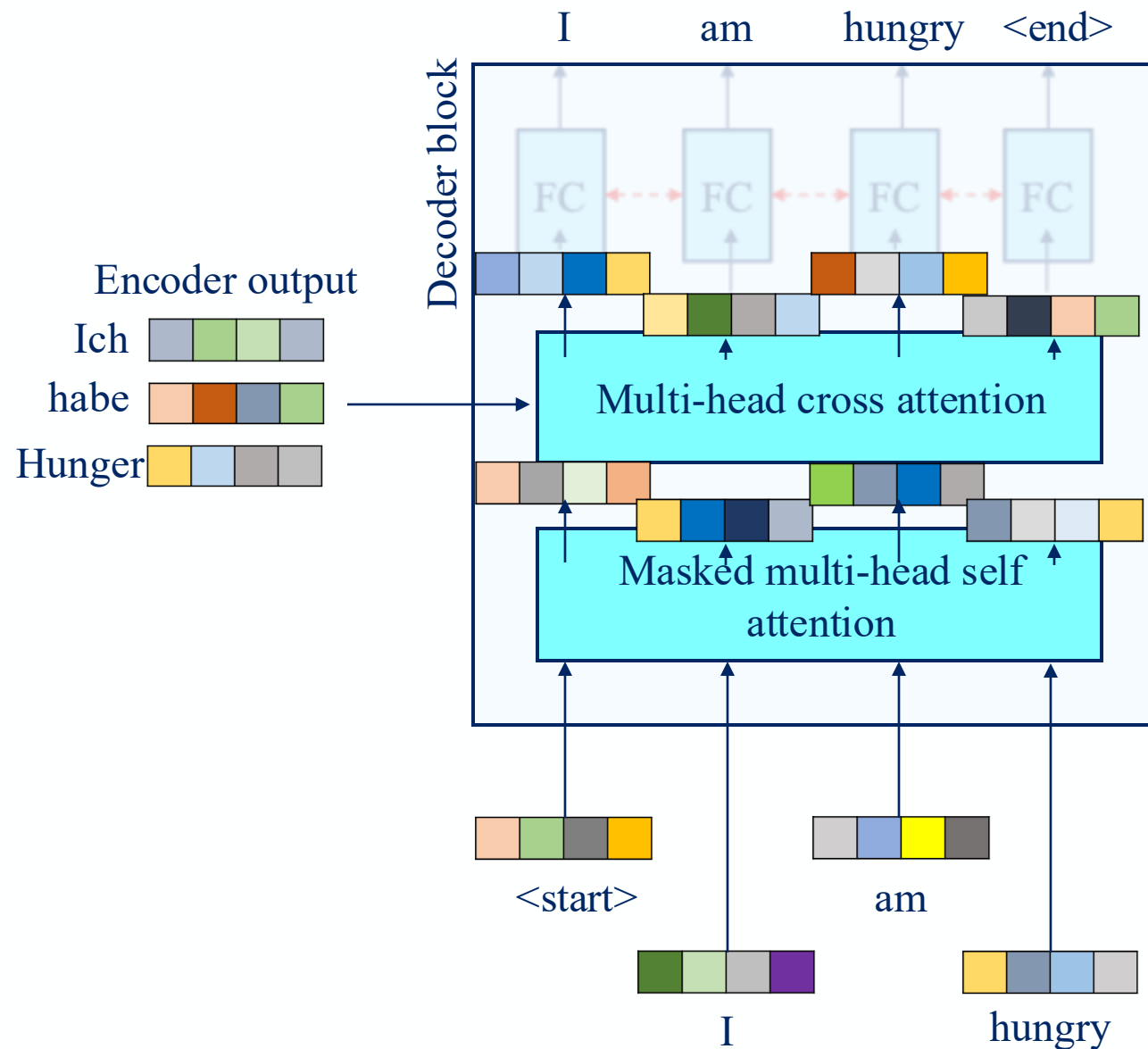
- Masked multi-head self attention

So the rest of the decoder can predict the future word



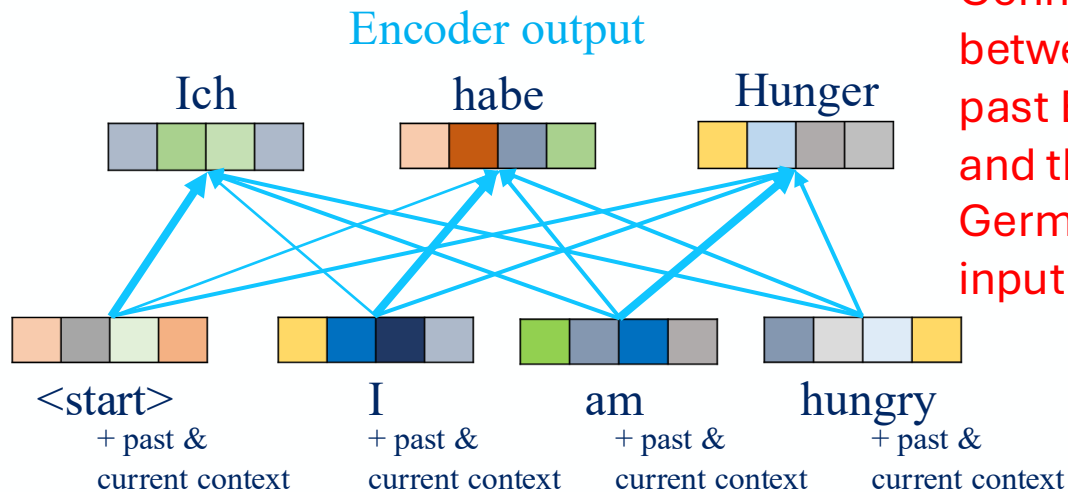
Decoder

- Masked multi-head self attention
- Multi-head cross attention

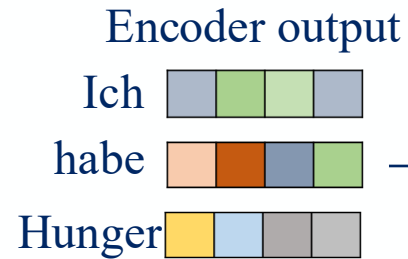


Decoder

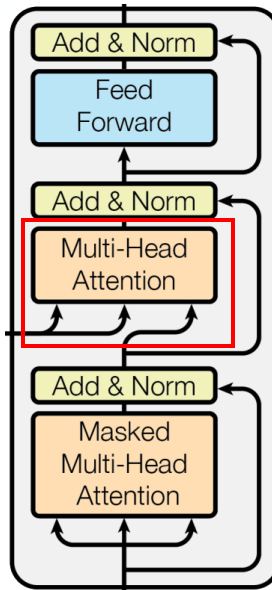
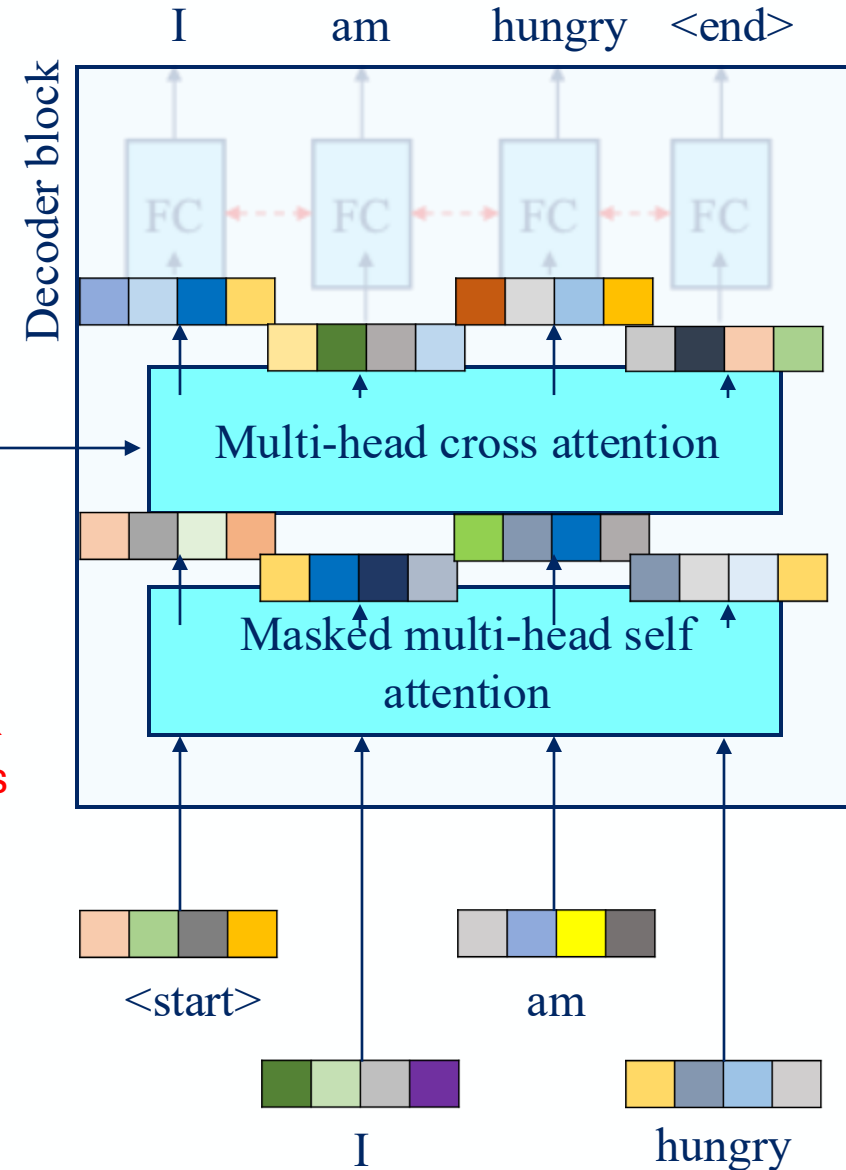
- Masked multi-head self attention
- Multi-head cross attention



Masked multi-head self attention output

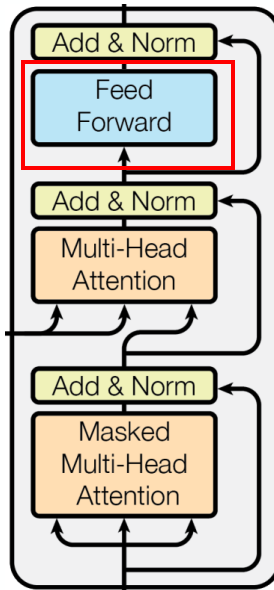
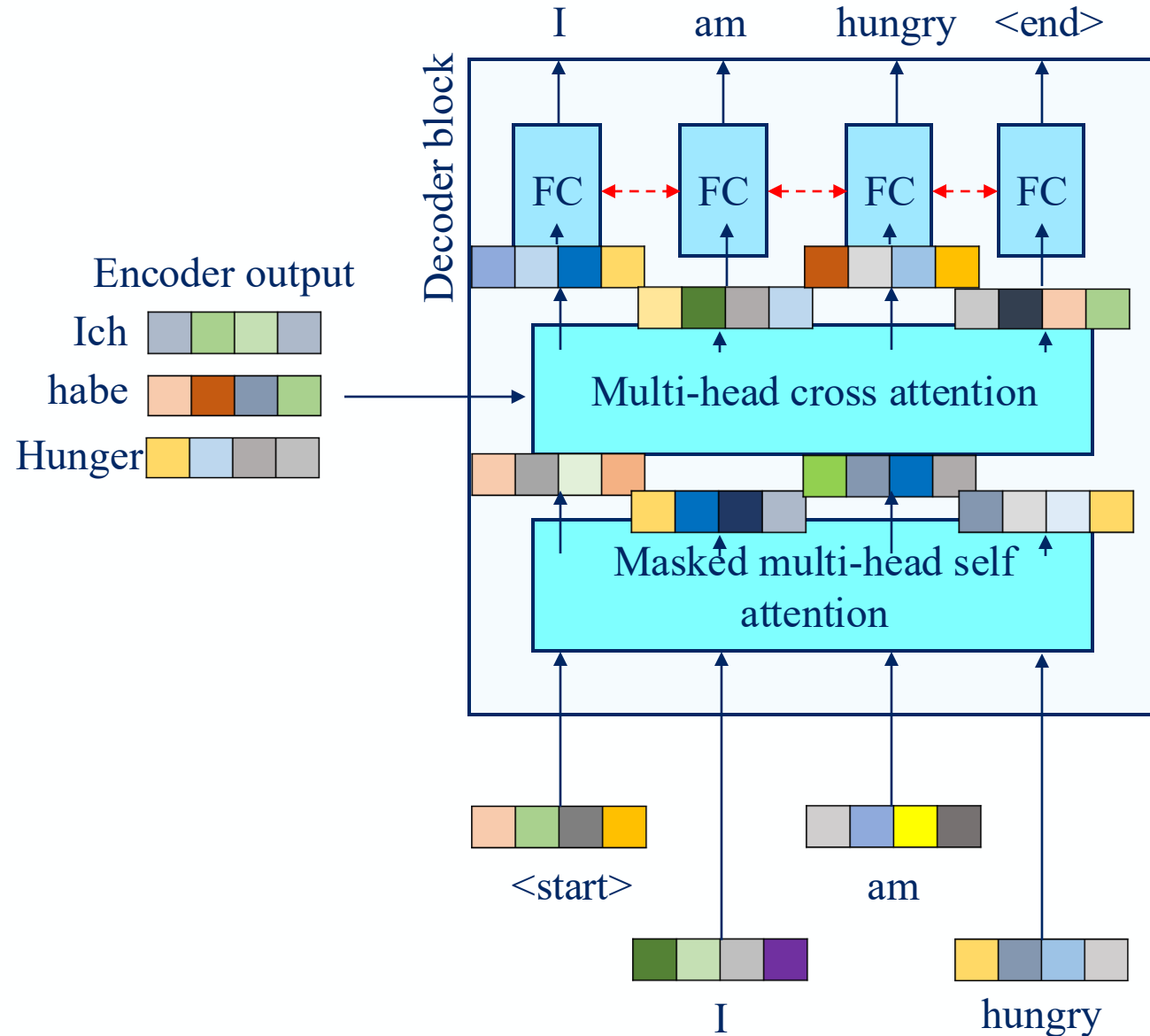


Connection between current & past English words and the encoded German sentence input



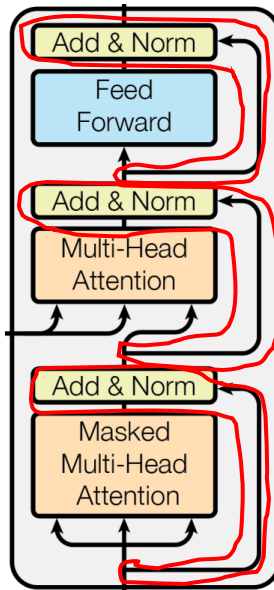
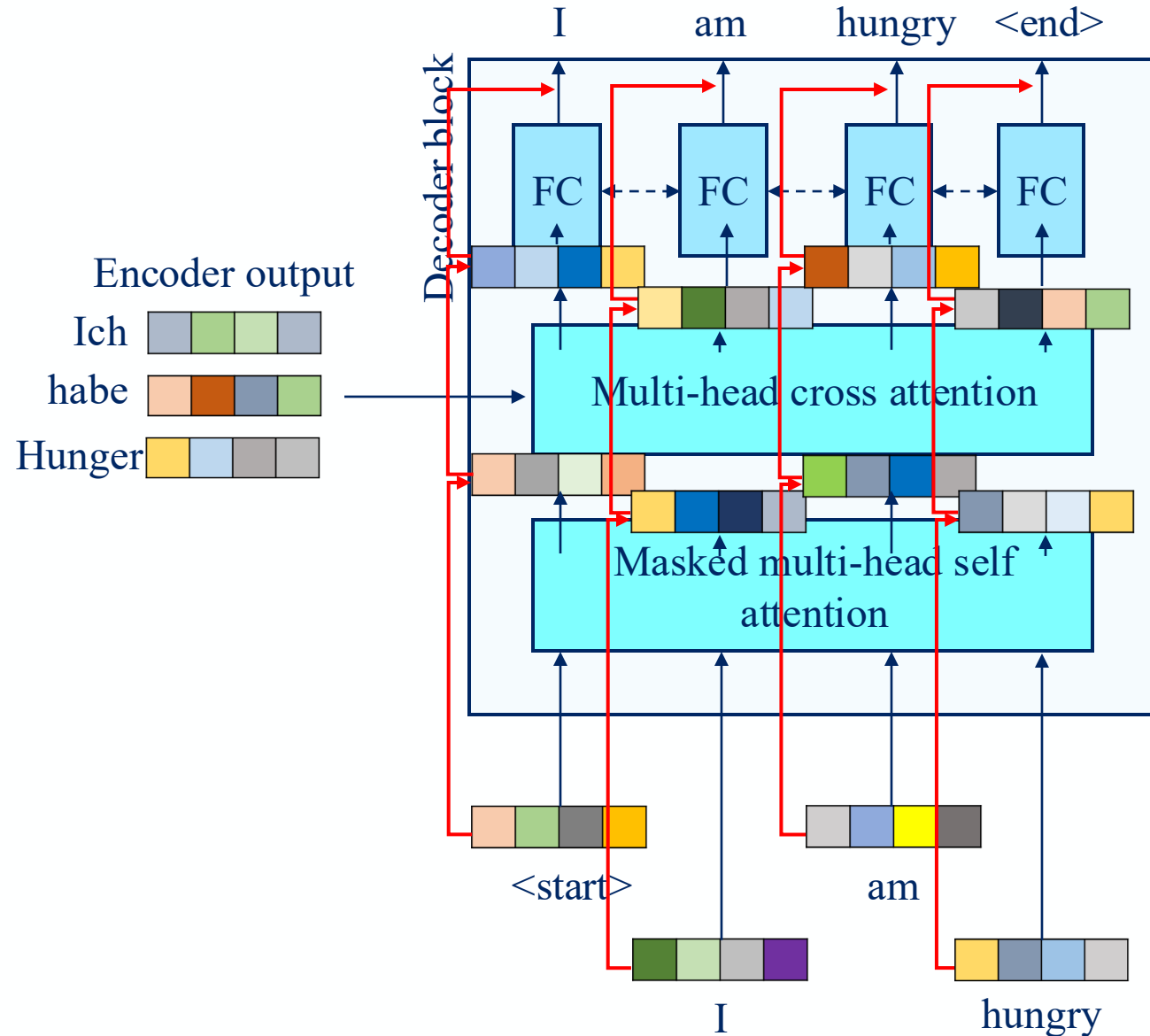
Decoder

- Masked multi-head self attention
- Multi-head cross attention
- Feed forward/fully connected layer
 - Shared weight



Decoder

- Masked multi-head self attention
- Multi-head cross attention
- Feed forward/fully connected layer
 - Shared weight
- Residual connection



Outline

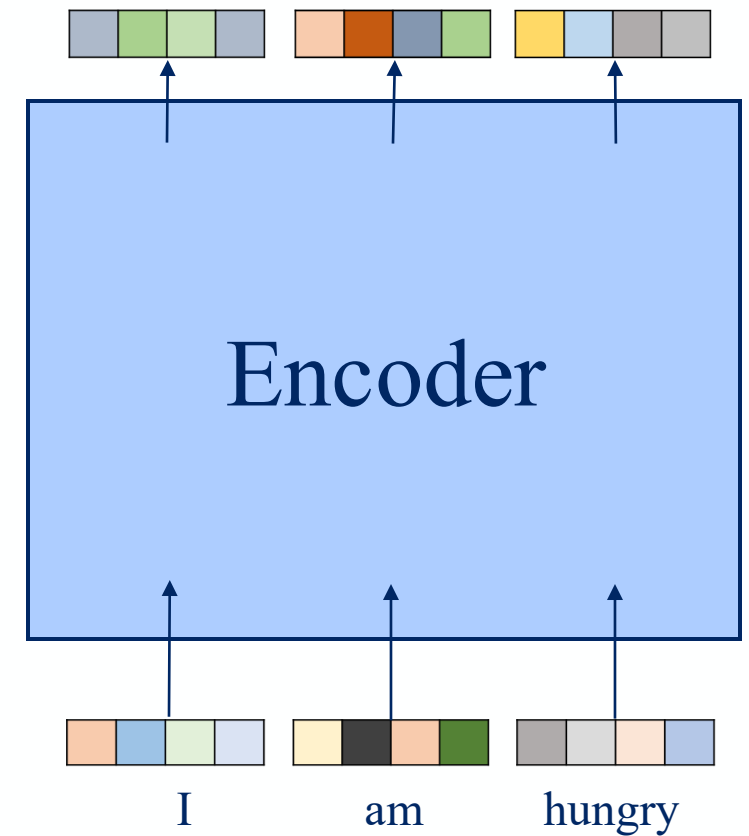
1. Overview
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5. Variants of Transformer

Variants Of Transformer

- Bidirectional Encoder Representations from Transformers (BERT)
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- Vision Transformer (ViT)
 - BERT, but for vision
- Generative Pre-trained Transformer (GPT)
 - Decoder-only architecture

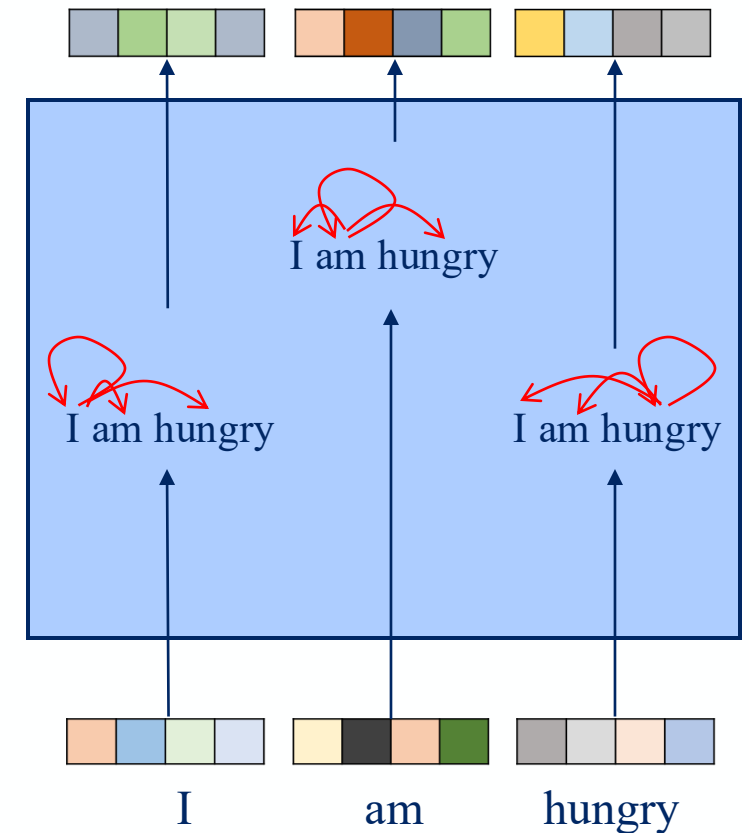
BERT

- Only encoder



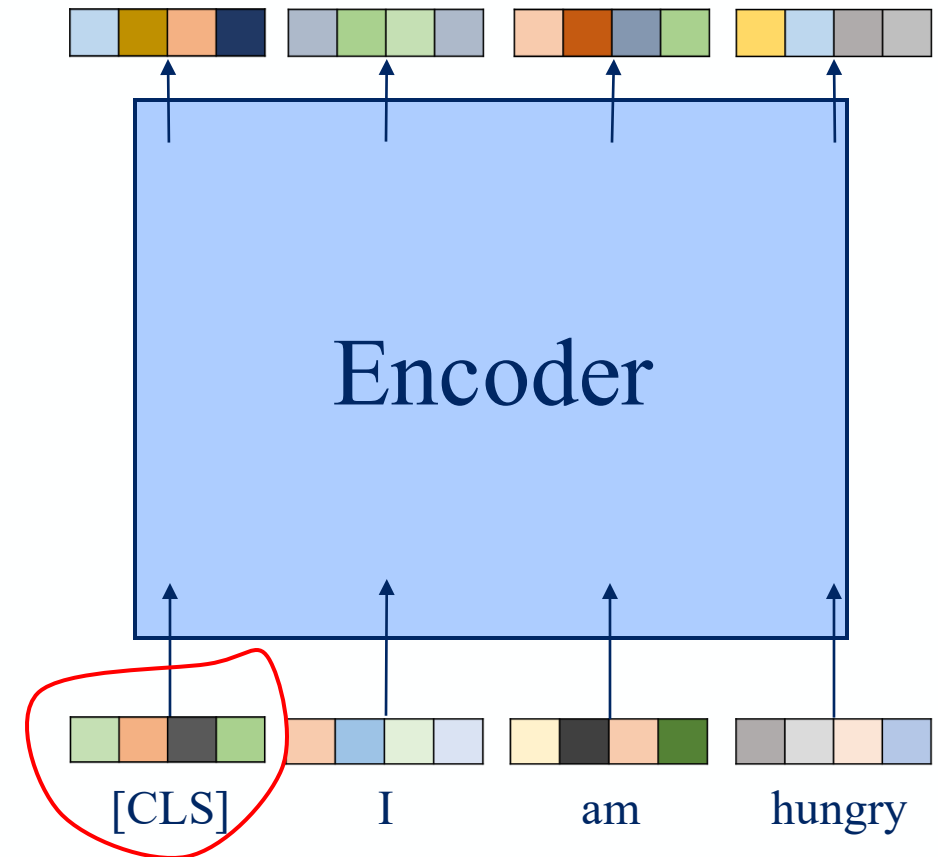
BERT

- Only encoder
- “Bidirectional” with self attention



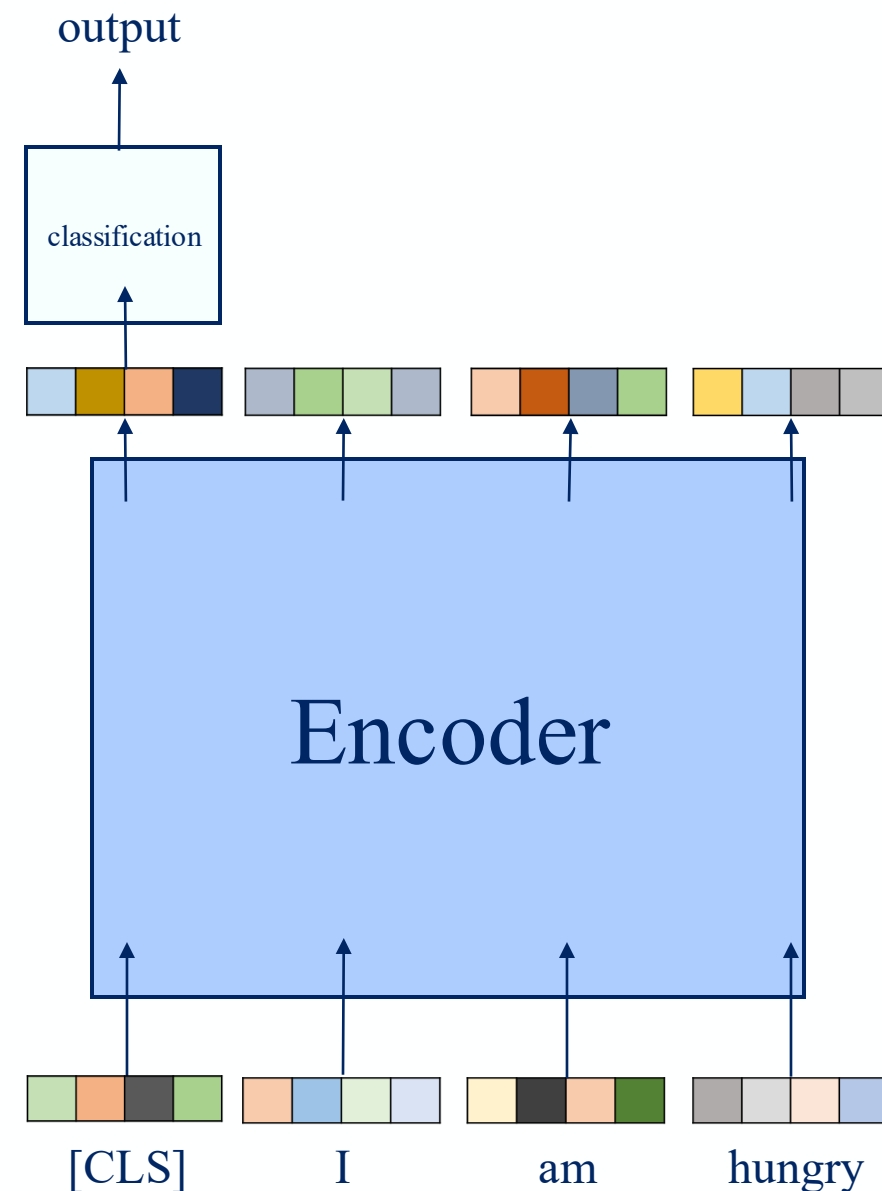
BERT

- Only encoder
- “Bidirectional” with self attention
- Add learnable classification token [CLS]



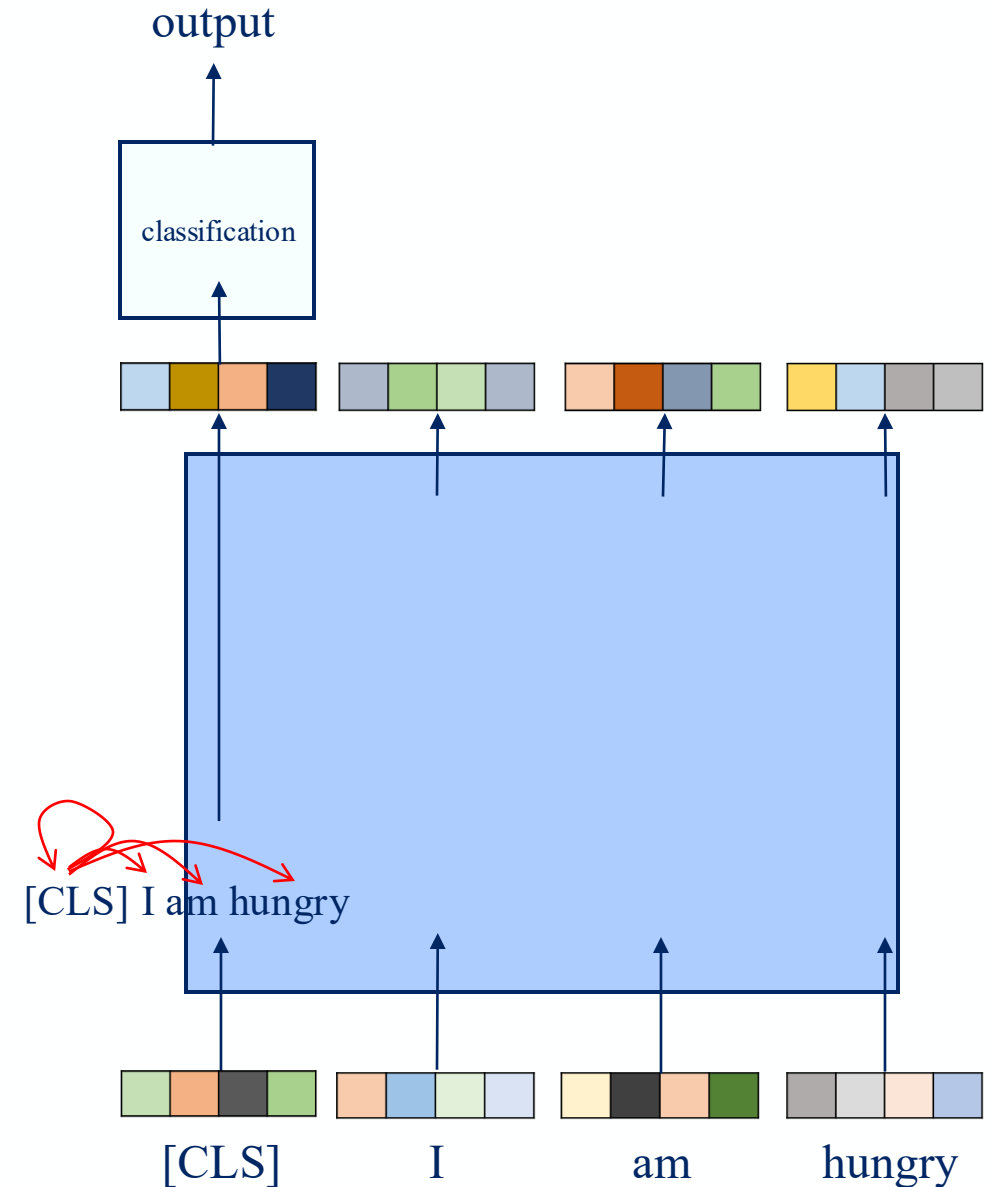
BERT

- Only encoder
- “Bidirectional” with self attention
- Add learnable classification token [CLS]
 - For classification task
 - E.g., spam/not spam, good/neutral/bad sentiment



BERT

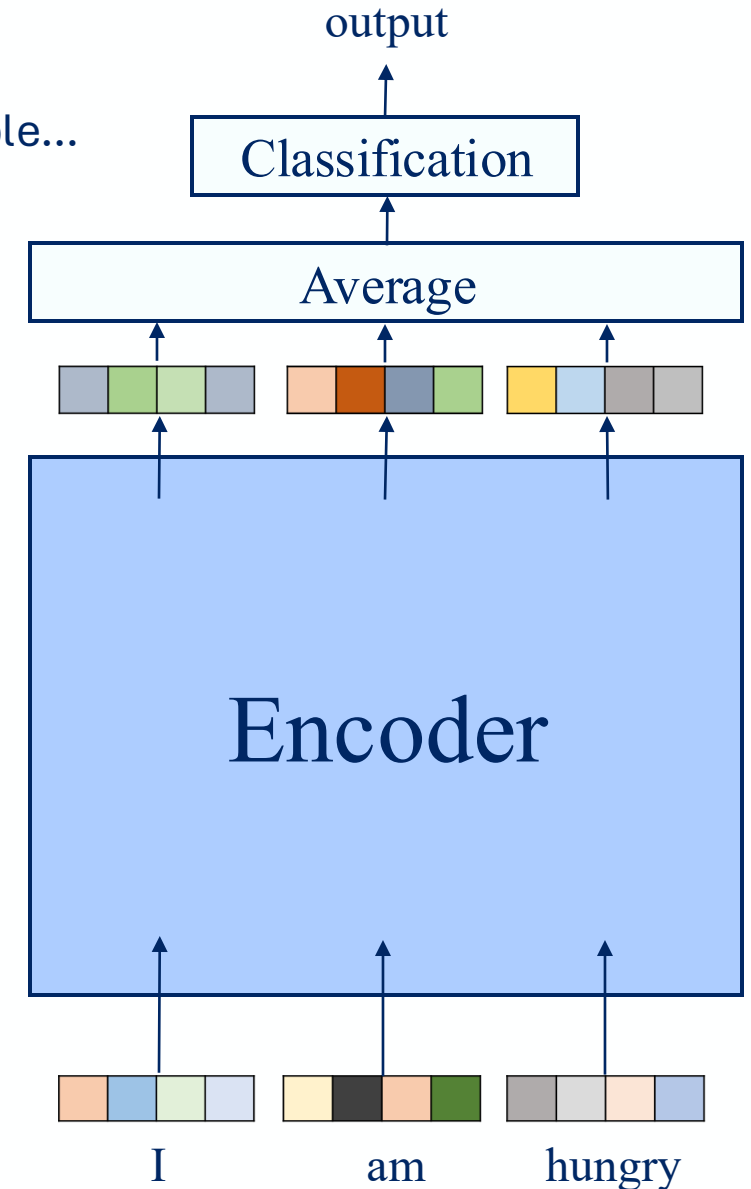
- Only encoder
- “Bidirectional” with self attention
- Add learnable classification token [CLS]
 - For classification task
 - Aggregate information using self attention



BERT

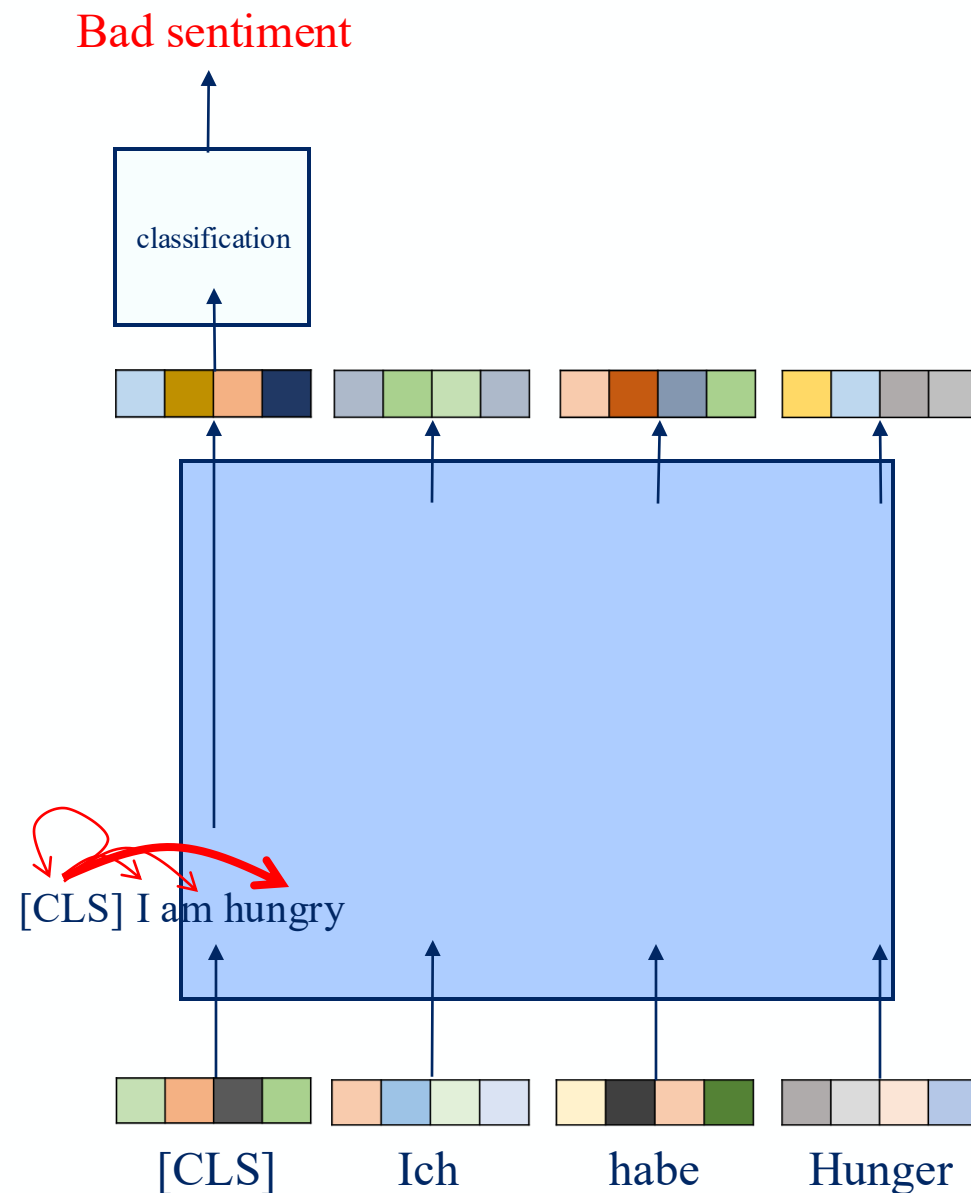
- Only encoder
- “Bidirectional” with self attention
- Add learnable classification token [CLS]
 - For classification task
 - Aggregate information using self attention

Technically possible...



BERT

- Only encoder
- “Bidirectional” with self attention
- Add learnable classification token [CLS]
 - For classification task
 - Aggregate information using self attention
 - Can focus/ignore some words

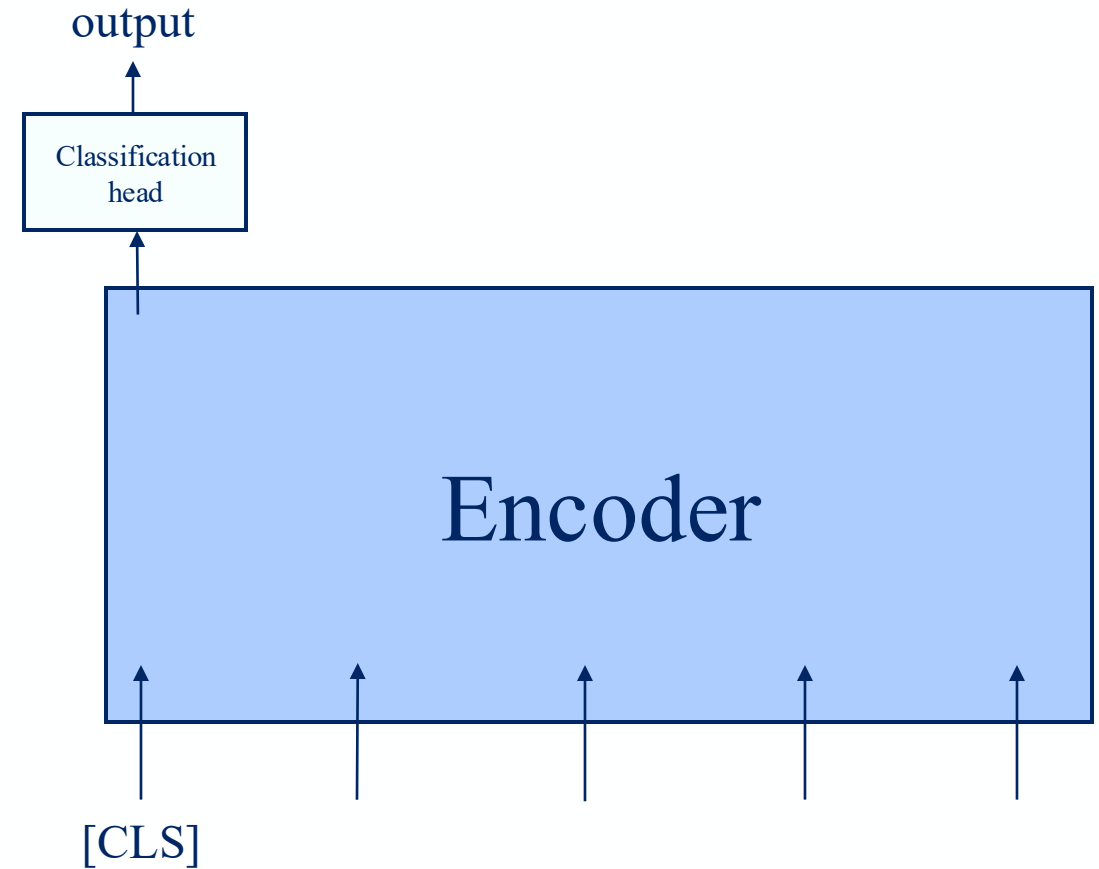


Variants Of Transformer

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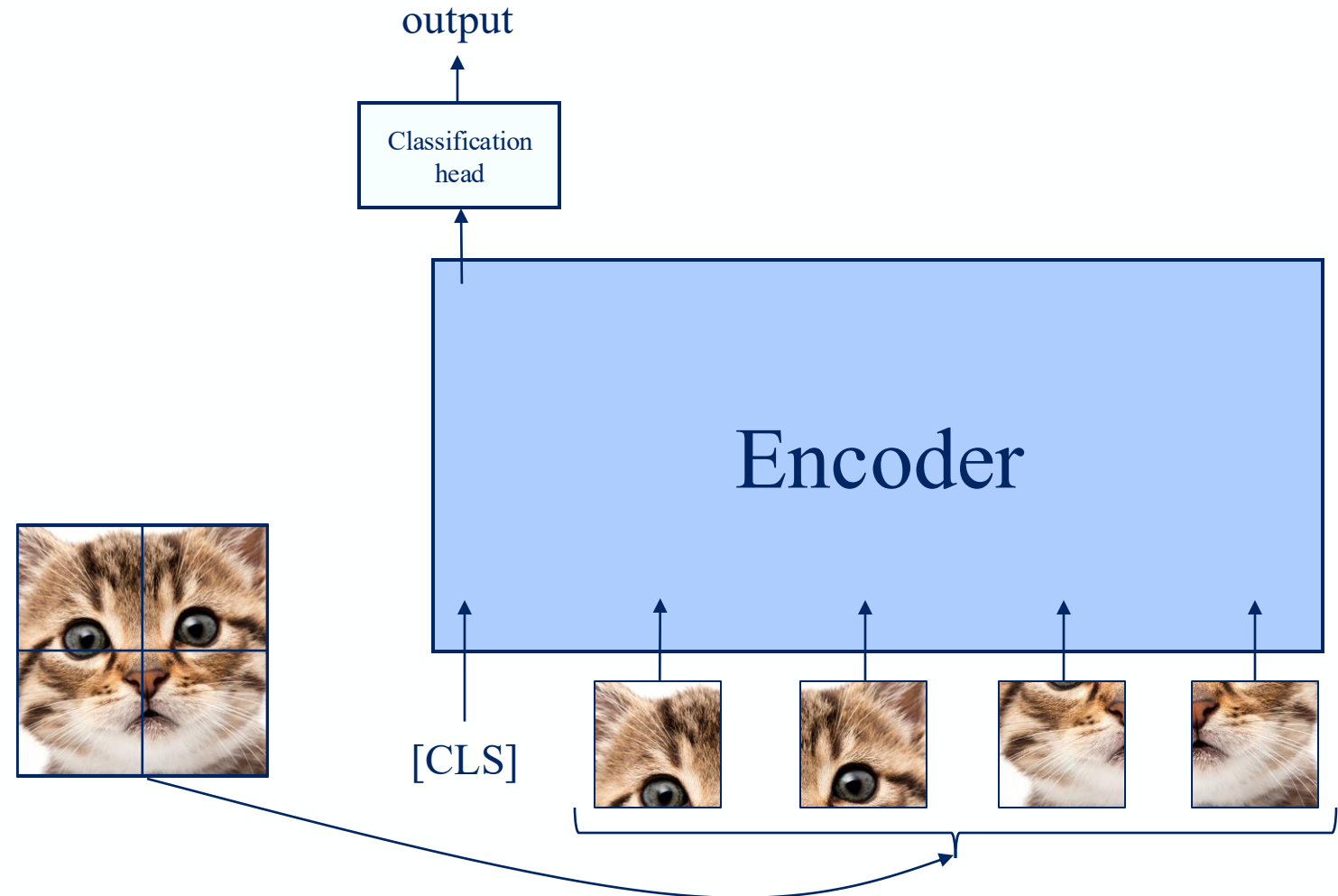
ViT

- Like BERT
 - Only the encoder
 - Learnable class token



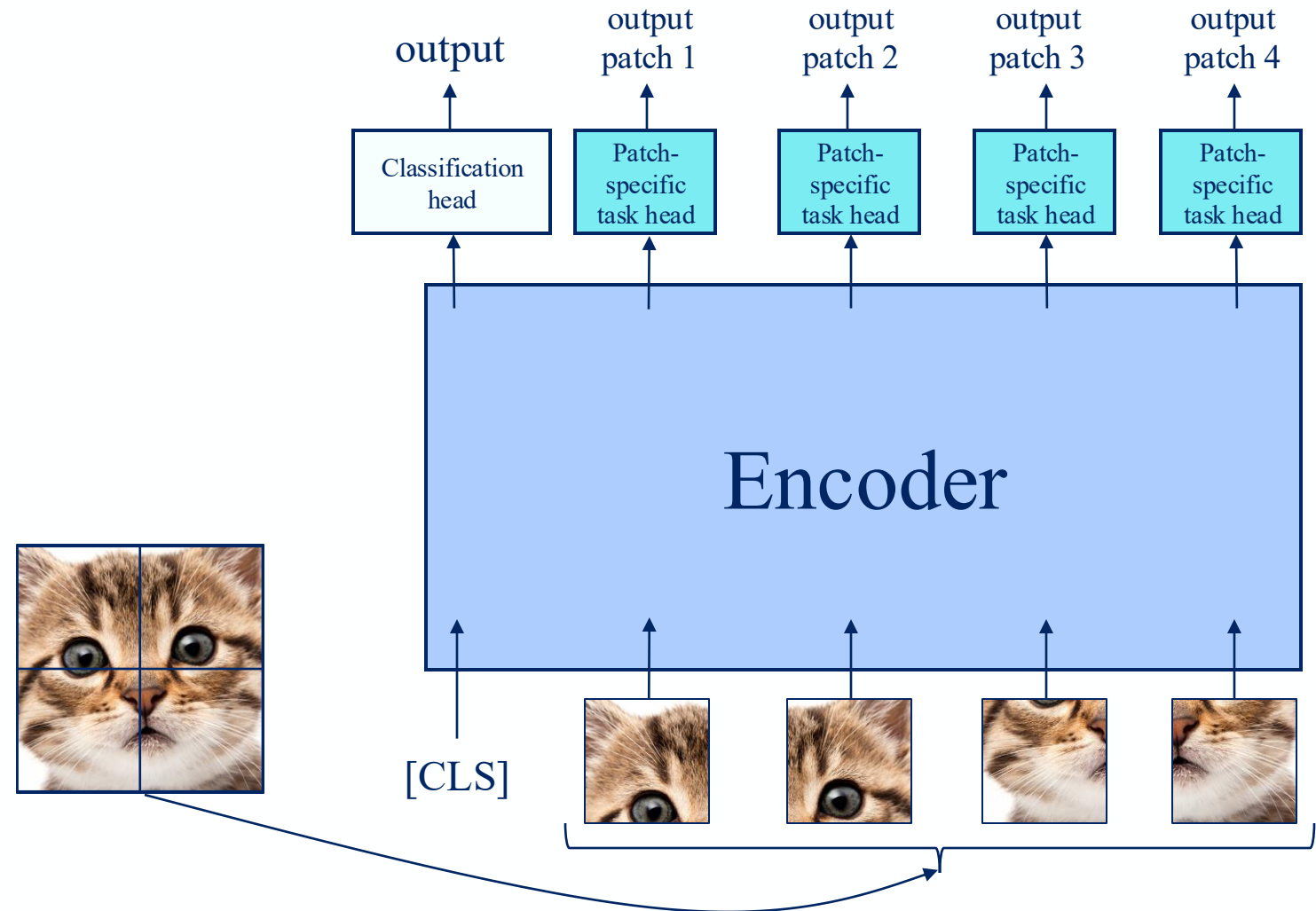
ViT

- Like BERT
 - Only the encoder
 - Learnable class token
- Use image patches



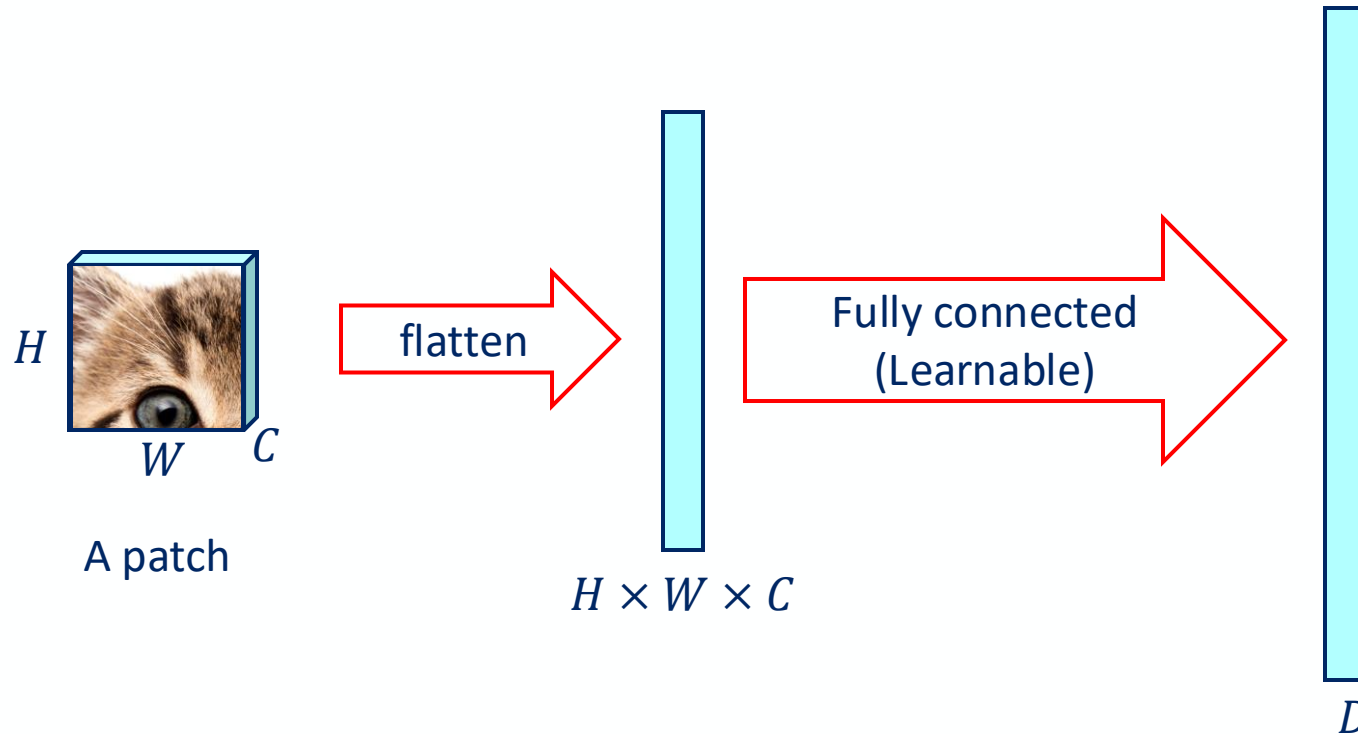
ViT

- Like BERT
 - Only the encoder
 - Learnable class token
- Use image patches
- Patch (not “word”) embedding can also be used
 - Not in original ViT
 - Depending on task



VIT's Patch Embedding

- Converting a patch to a vector
 - Like the word embedding

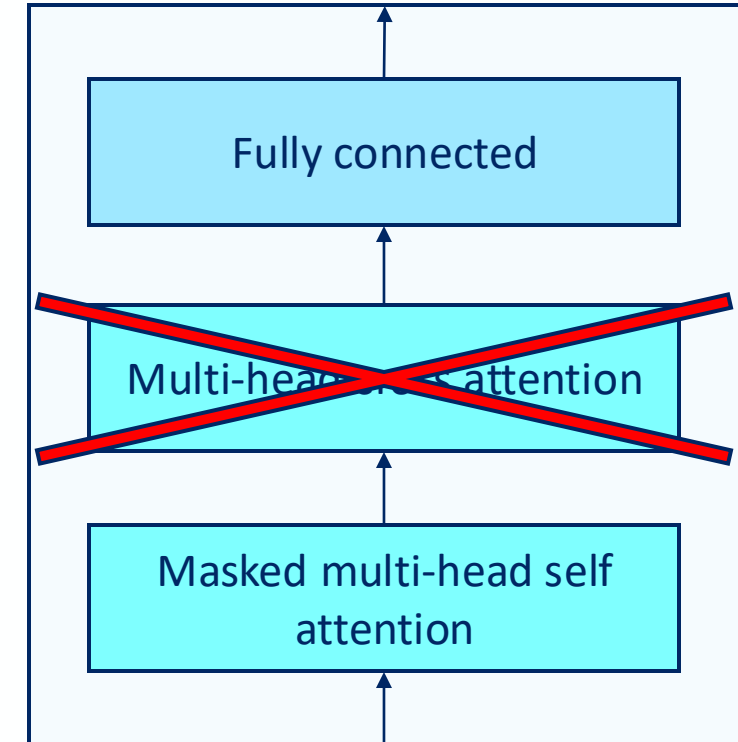


Variants Of Transformer

- Bidirectional Encoder Representations from Transformers (BERT)
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 - BERT, but for vision
- Generative Pre-trained Transformer (GPT)
 - Decoder-only architecture

GPT

- Decoder-only architecture
 - Without cross attention as we don't have encoder



GPT

- For generative purpose
 - Given the past words, predict the next word

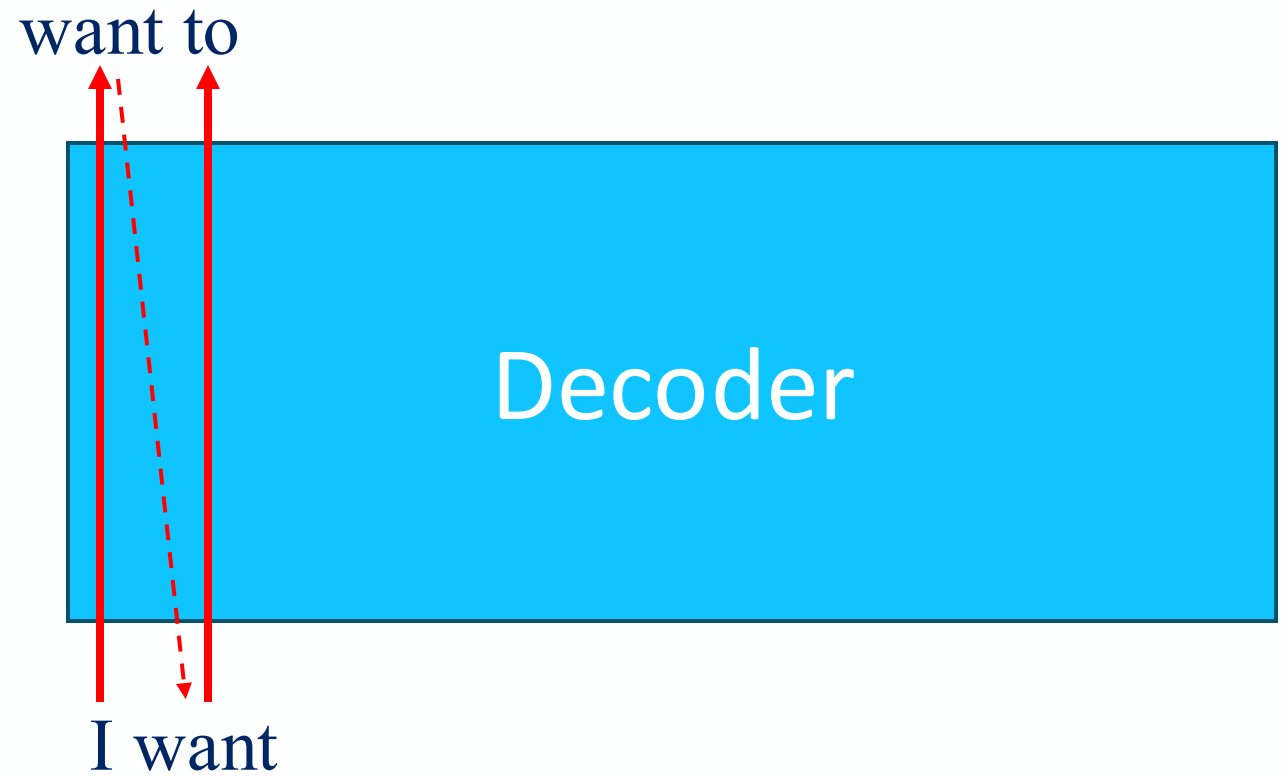
want



I

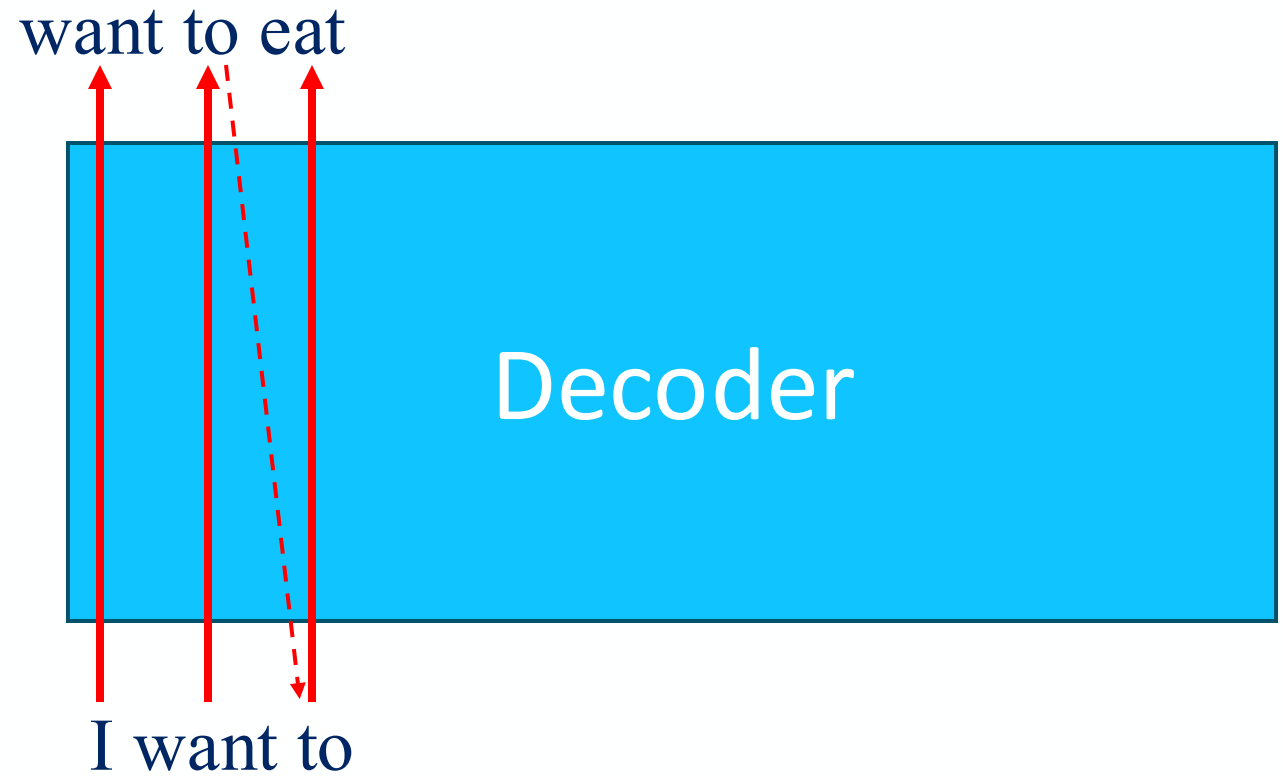
GPT

- For generative purpose
 - Given the past words, predict the next word



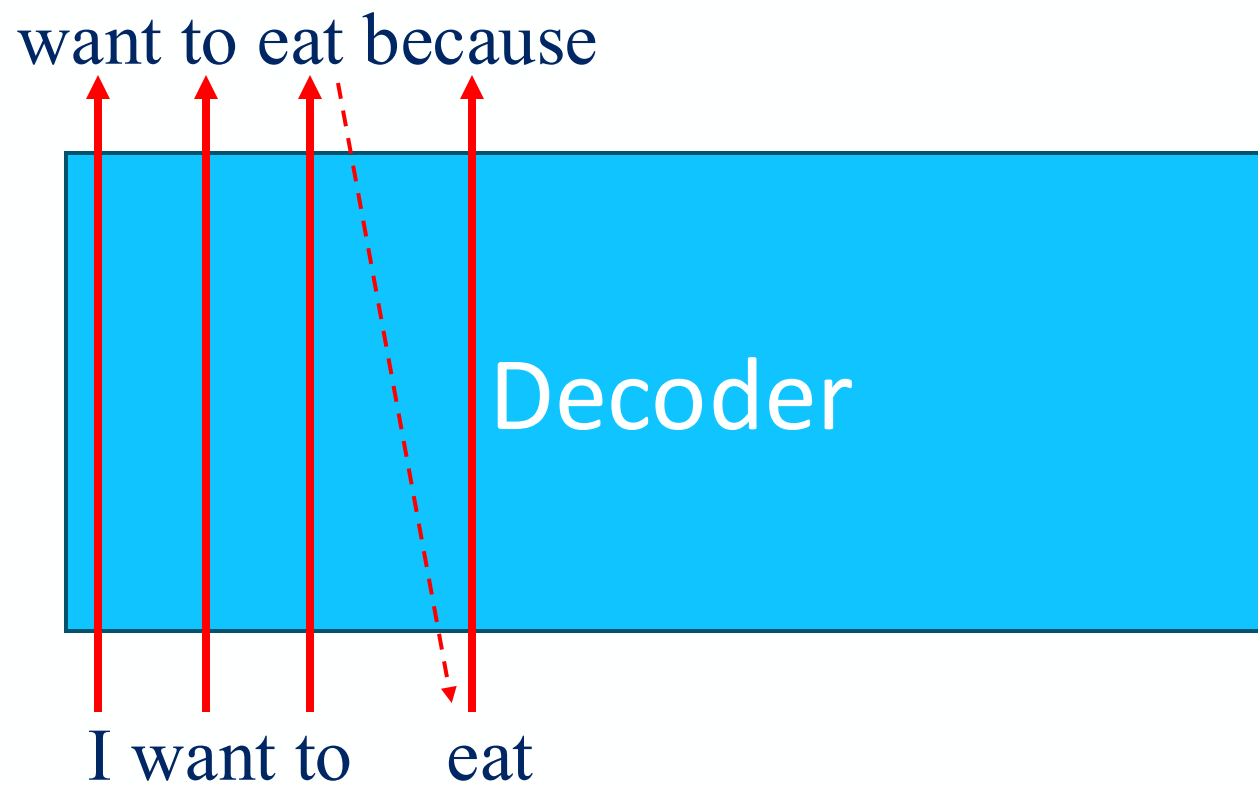
GPT

- For generative purpose
 - Given the past words, predict the next word



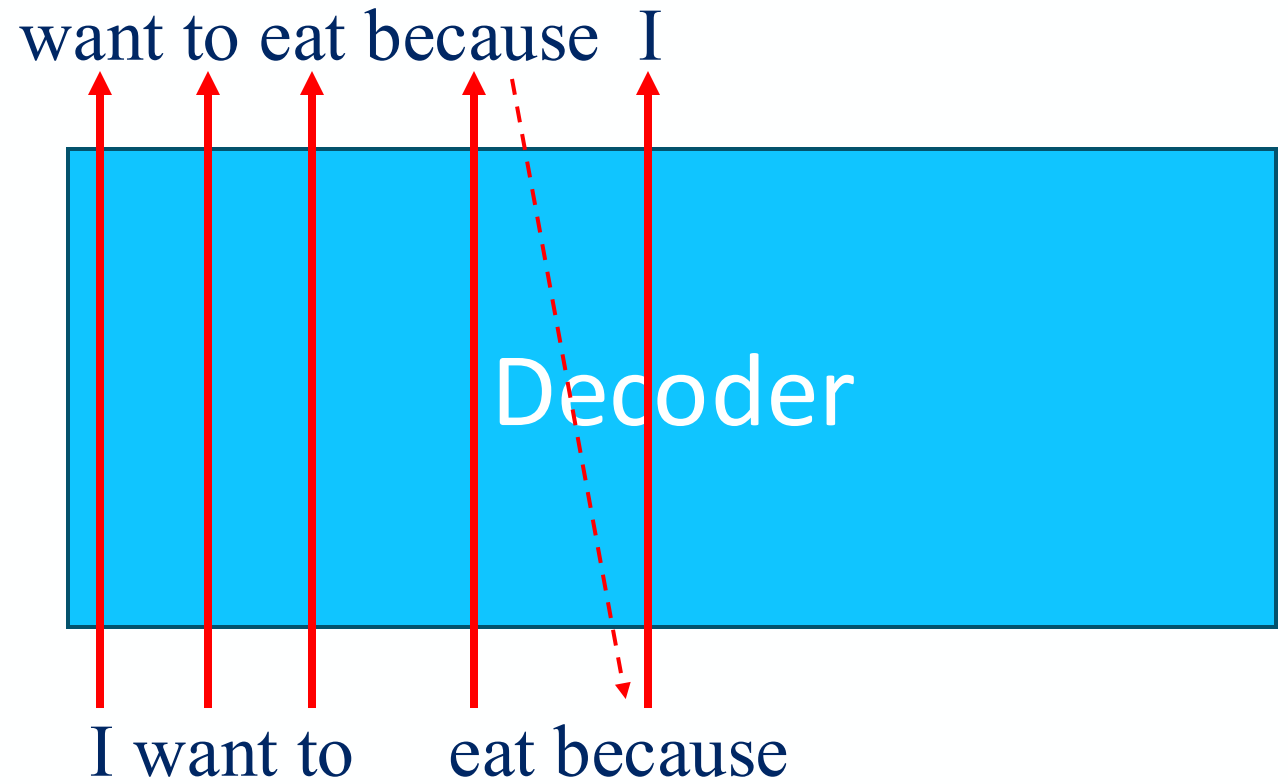
GPT

- For generative purpose
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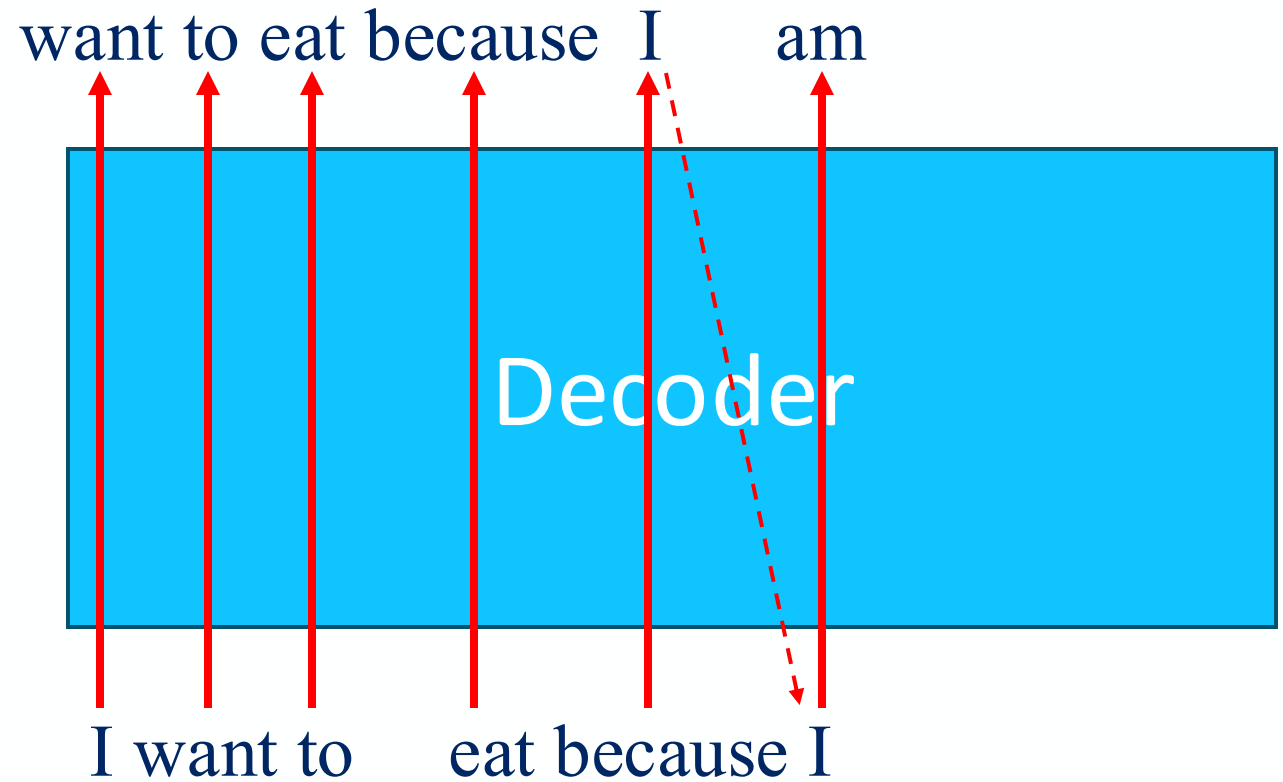
GPT

- For generative purpose
 - Given the past words, predict the next word



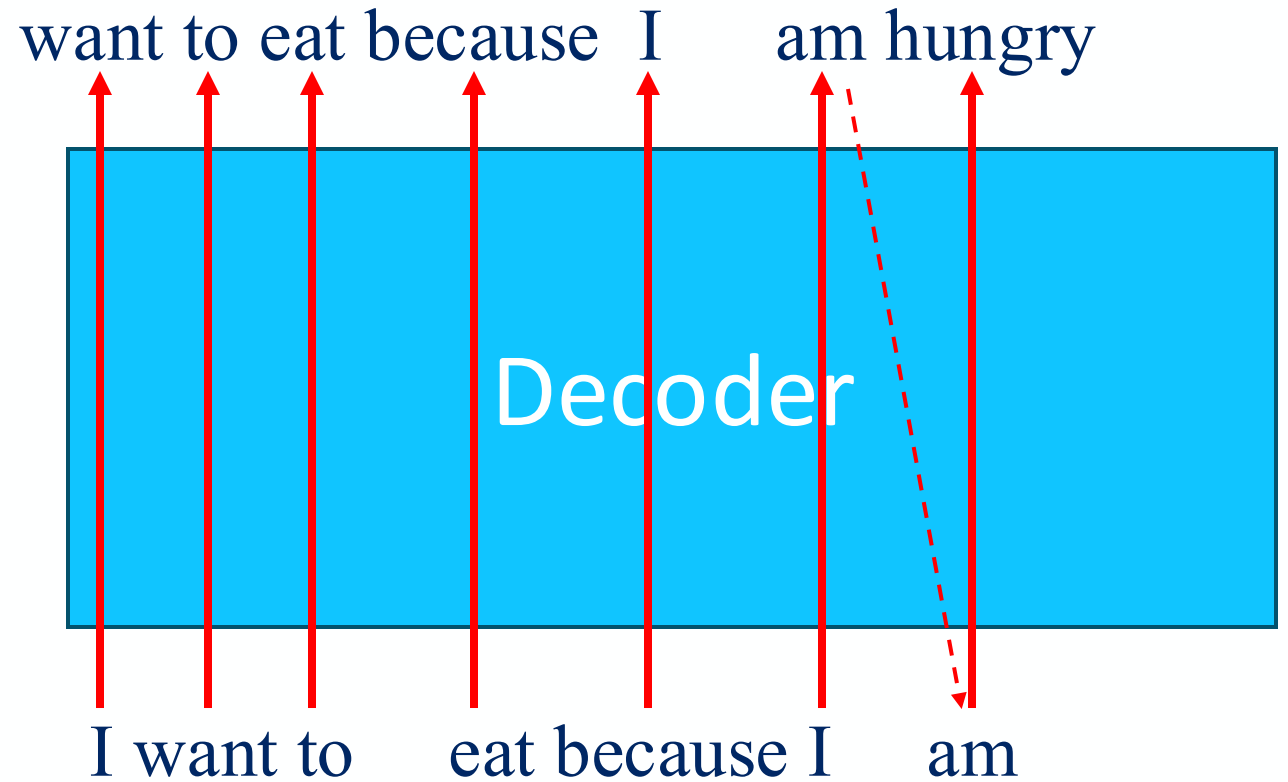
GPT

- For generative purpose
 - Given the past words, predict the next word



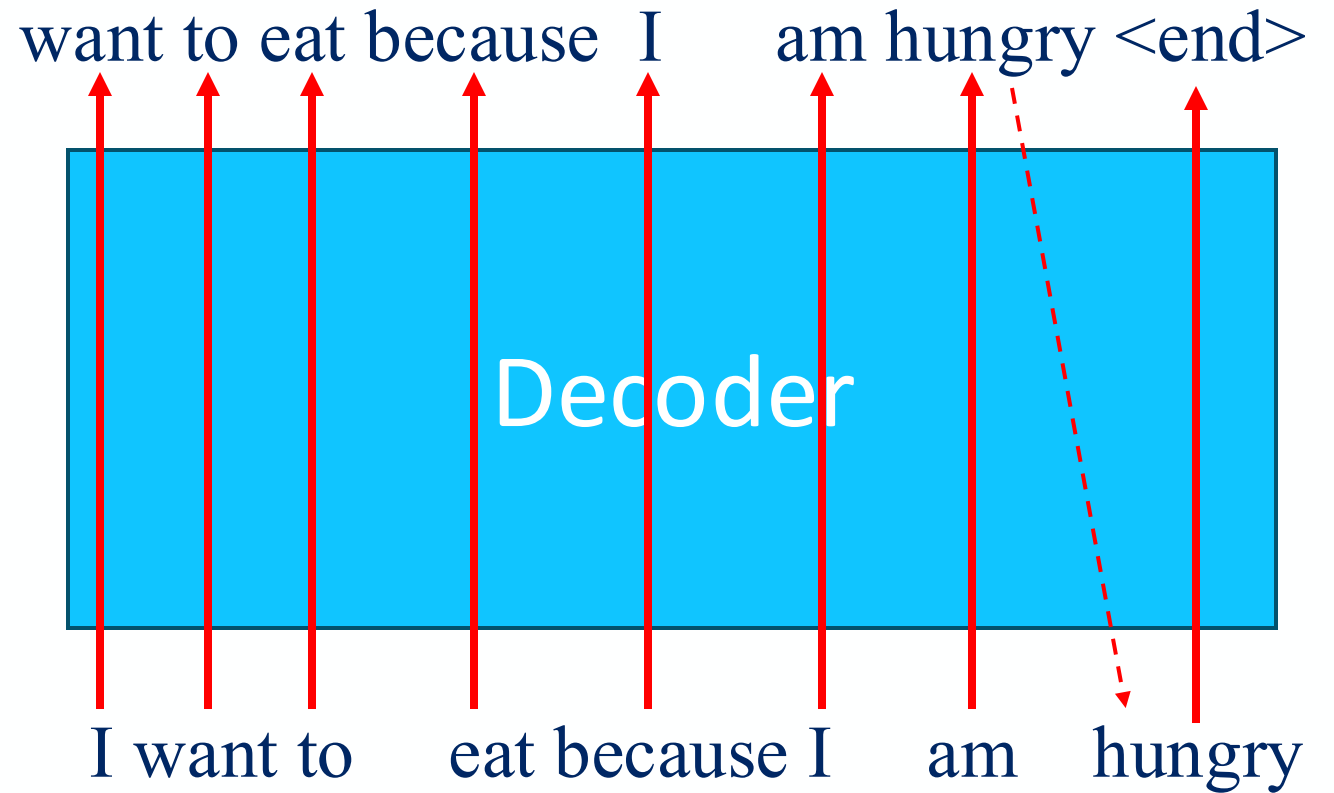
GPT

- For generative purpose
 - Given the past words, predict the next word



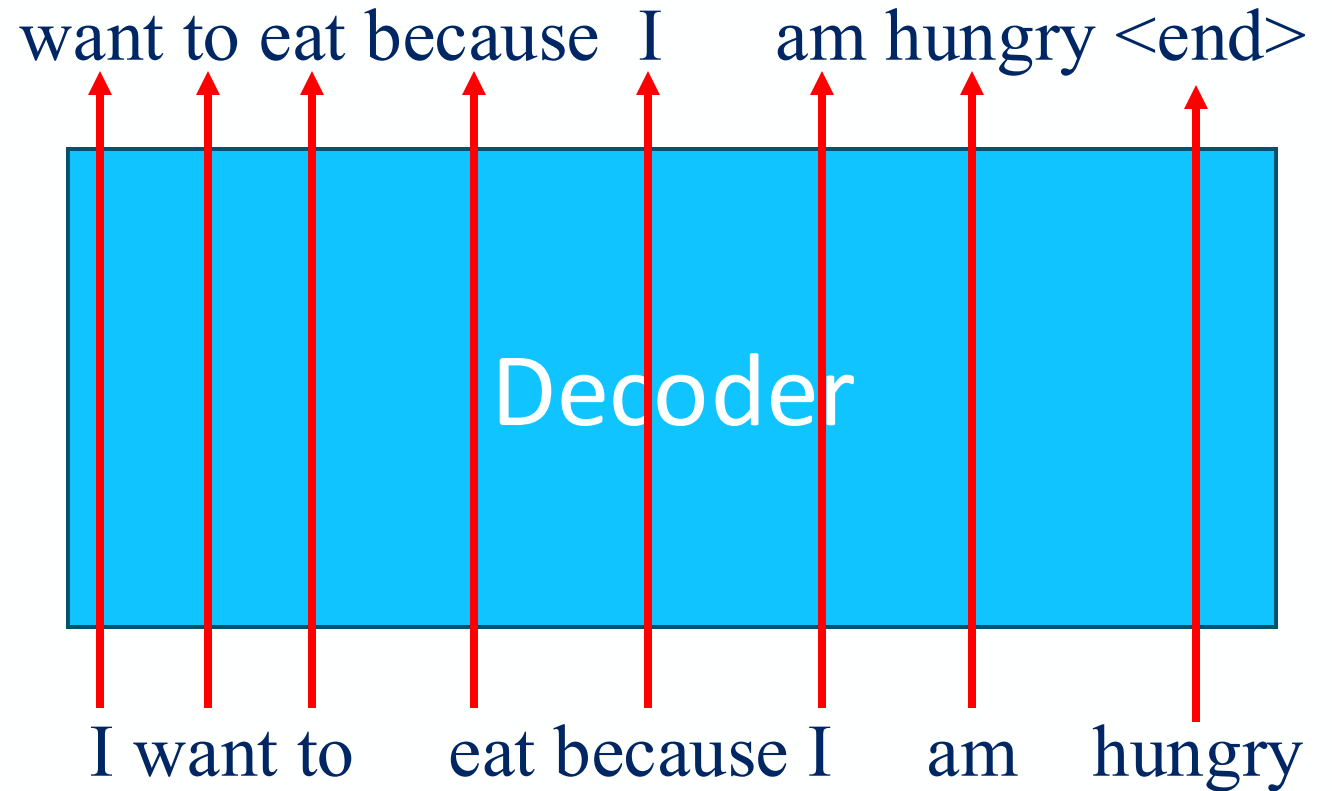
GPT

- For generative purpose
 - Given the past words, predict the next word



GPT

- For generative purpose
 - Given the past words, predict the next word
- Trained in self-supervised way
 - No human label
 - Predict next word of sentences from many articles/books/etc.

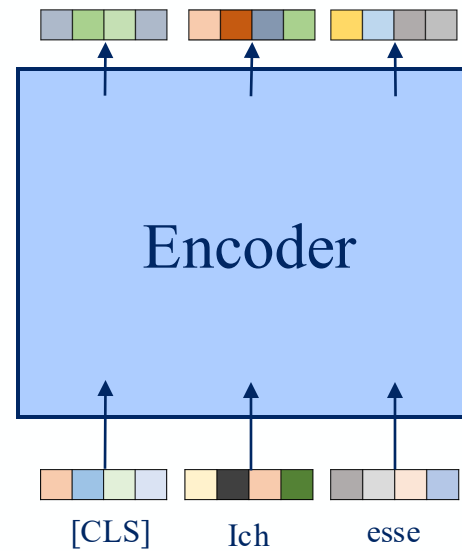


Agenda

- 09:00 - 10:30 Introduction to Language Modeling
- 10:30 - 10:45 Break
- 10:45 - 11:45 Blablador: concept, models description. Optional: integration in VScode
- 11:45 - 12:00 Q&A
- 12:00 - 13:00 Lunch Break
- 13:00 - 14:00 Attention, self-attention, transformer architecture
- 14:00 - 14:15 Pre-training vs fine-tuning and foundation models (intro to the hands-on session)
- 14:15 - 14:30 Break
- 14:30 - 15:30 Hands-on: fine-tune a model on a downstream task
- 15:30 - 16:00 Q&A, Wrap-up, and Conclusion

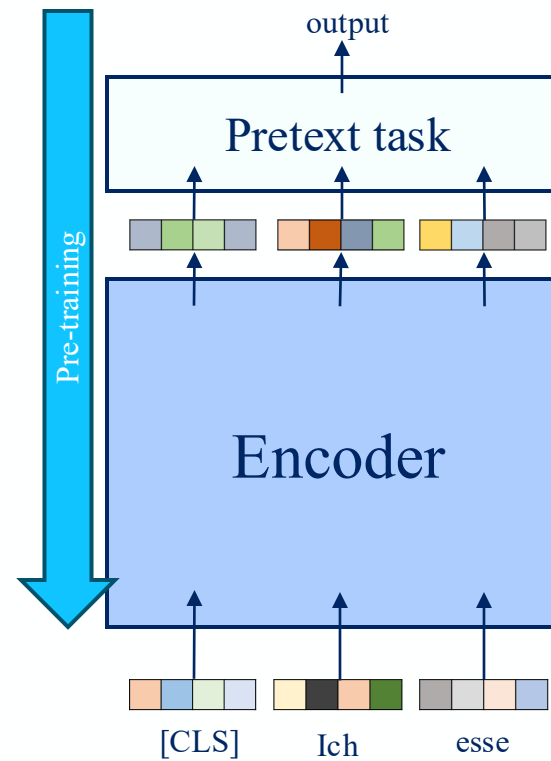
Bert pretraining and fine-tuning

- 2 stages:



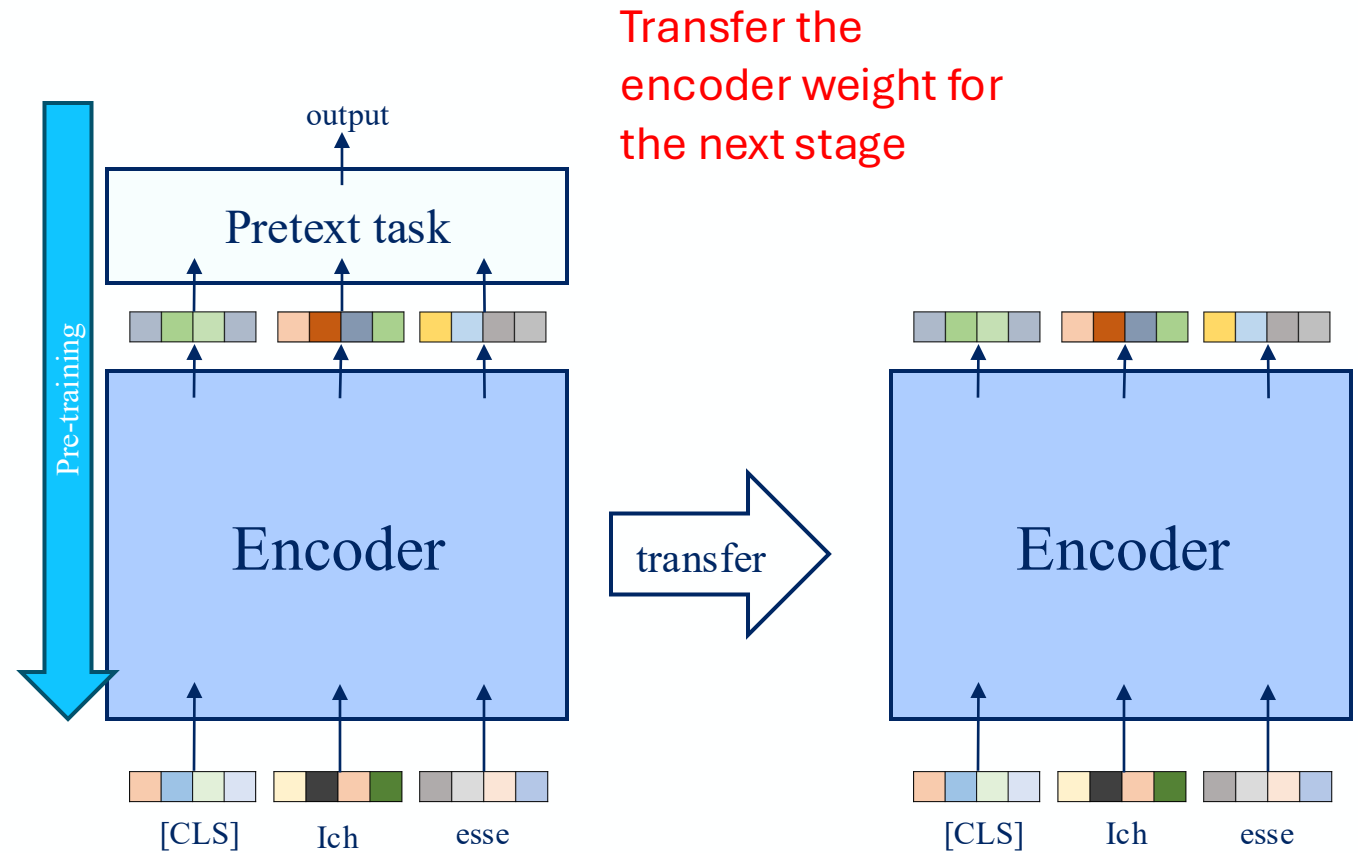
Bert pretraining and fine-tuning

- 2 stages:
 - 1st stage (pretraining): self-supervised learning
 - Without any human label using pretext task



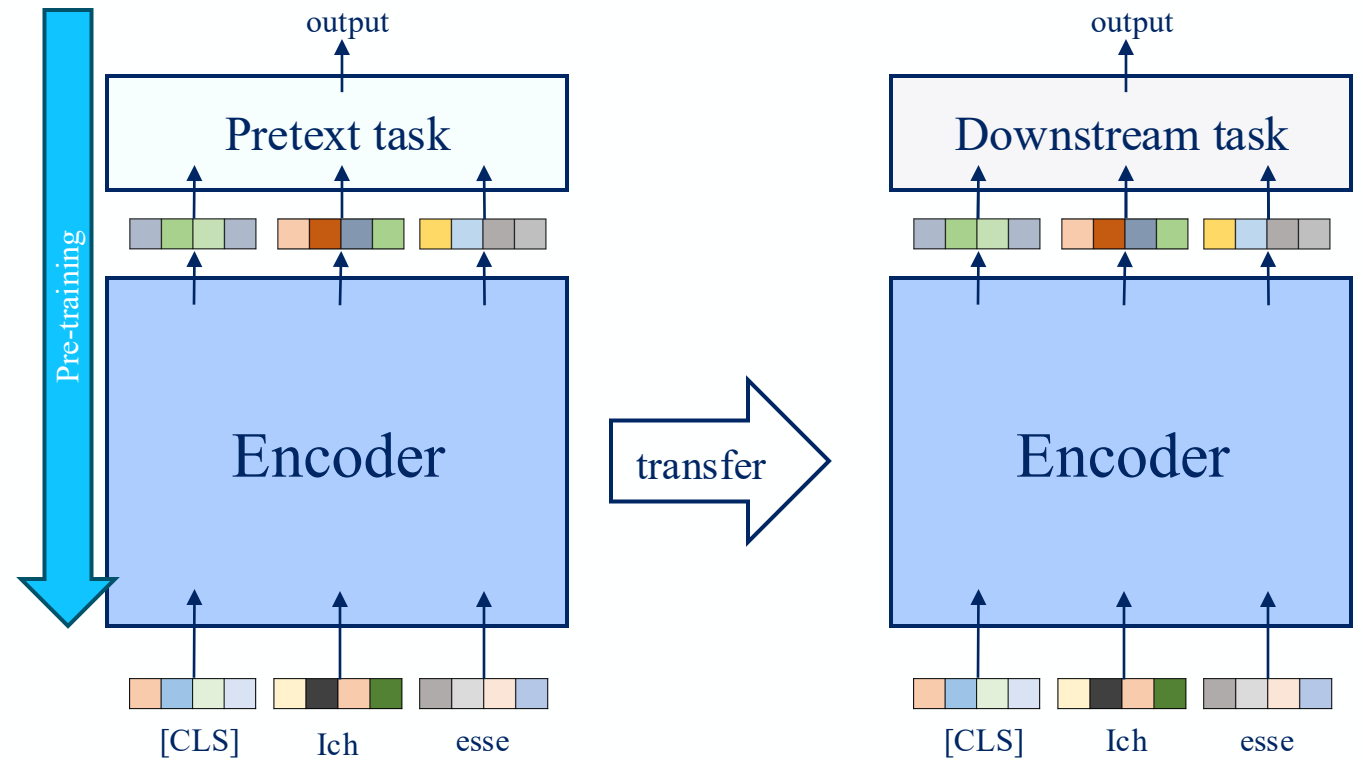
Bert pretraining and fine-tuning

- 2 stages:
 - 1st stage (pretraining): self-supervised learning



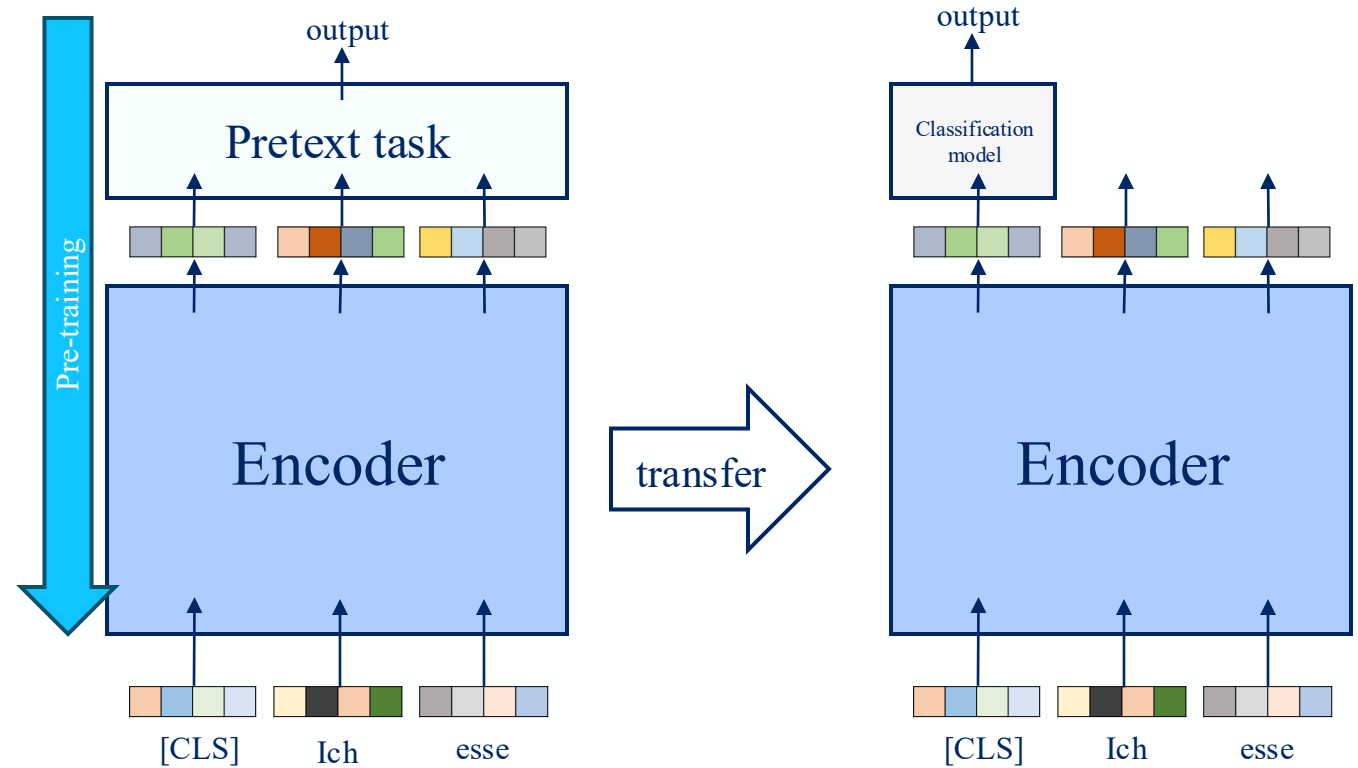
Bert pretraining and fine-tuning

- 2 stages:
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 - 2nd stage (fine-tuning): downstream task



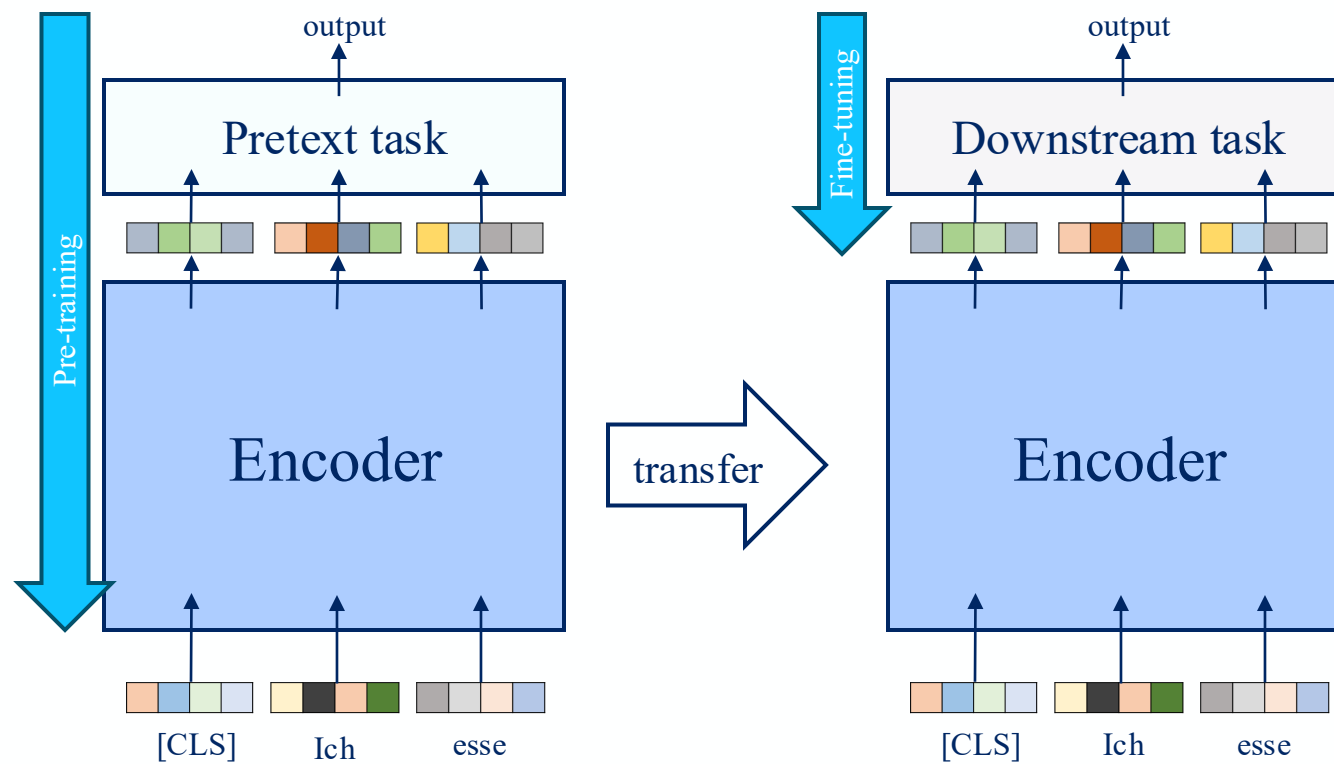
Bert pretraining and fine-tuning

- 2 stages:
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 - 2nd stage (fine-tuning): downstream task (e.g., classification)



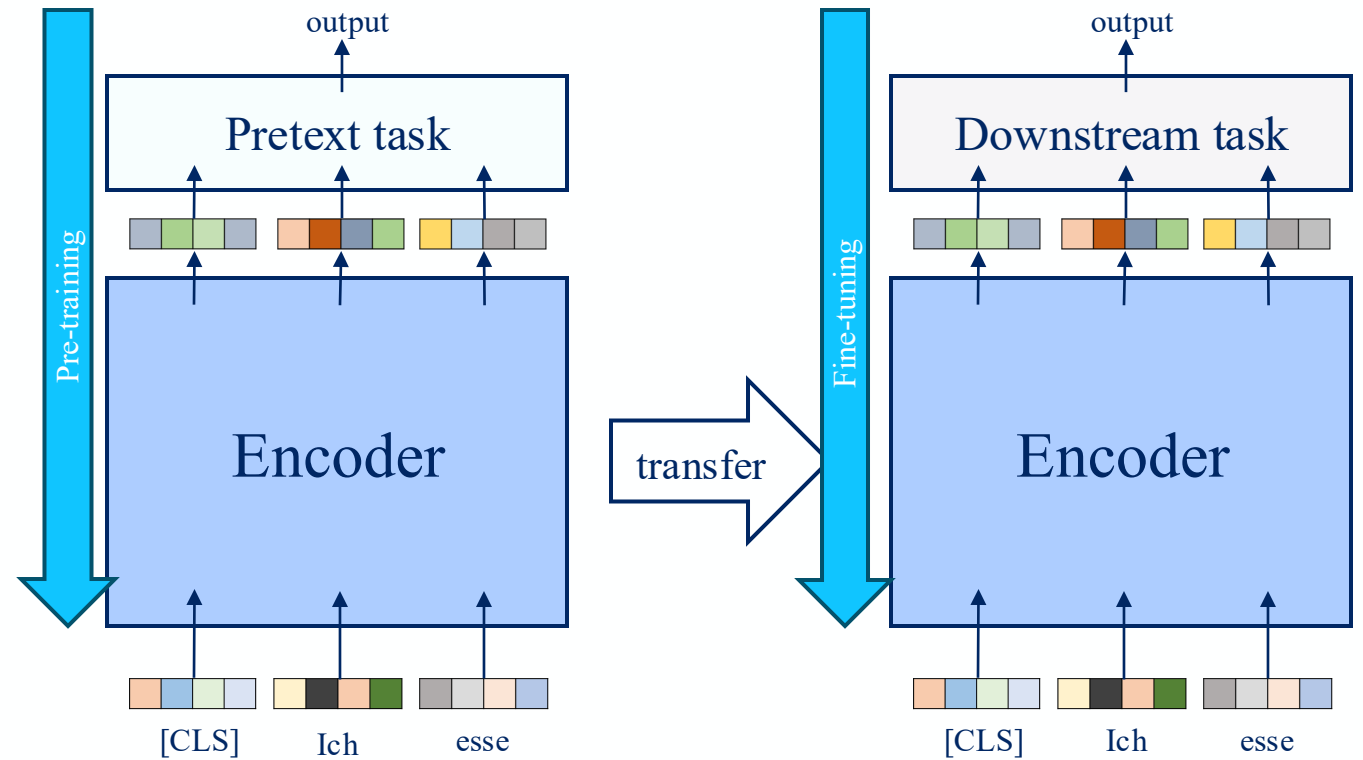
Bert pretraining and fine-tuning

- 2 stages:
 - 1st stage (pretraining): self-supervised learning
 - 2nd stage (fine-tuning): downstream task (e.g., classification)
 - Fine tune partially

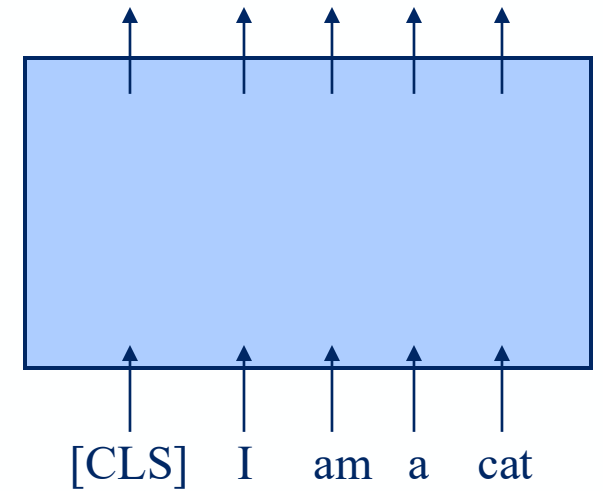


Bert pretraining and fine-tuning

- 2 stages:
 - 1st stage (pretraining): self-supervised learning
 - 2nd stage (fine-tuning): downstream task (e.g., classification)
 - Fine tune partially
 - Fine tune everything

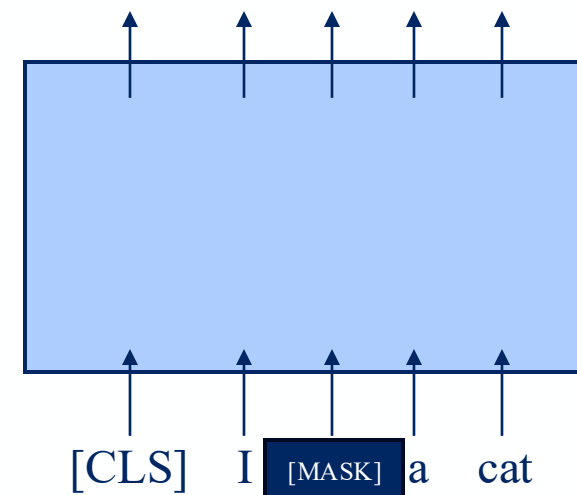


Pretext task: Masked Language Model



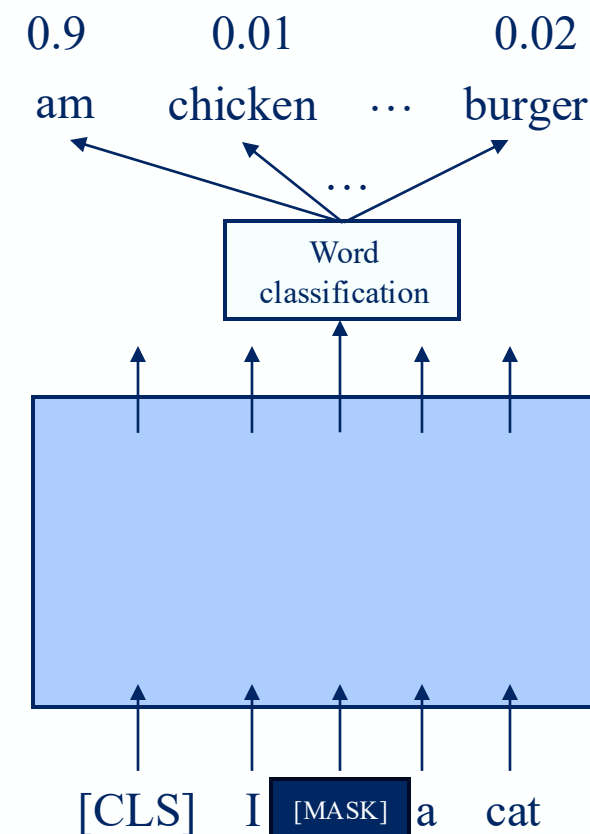
Pretext task: Masked Language Model

- Hide some input with [MASK] token
 - BERT paper: 15% of the input are masked



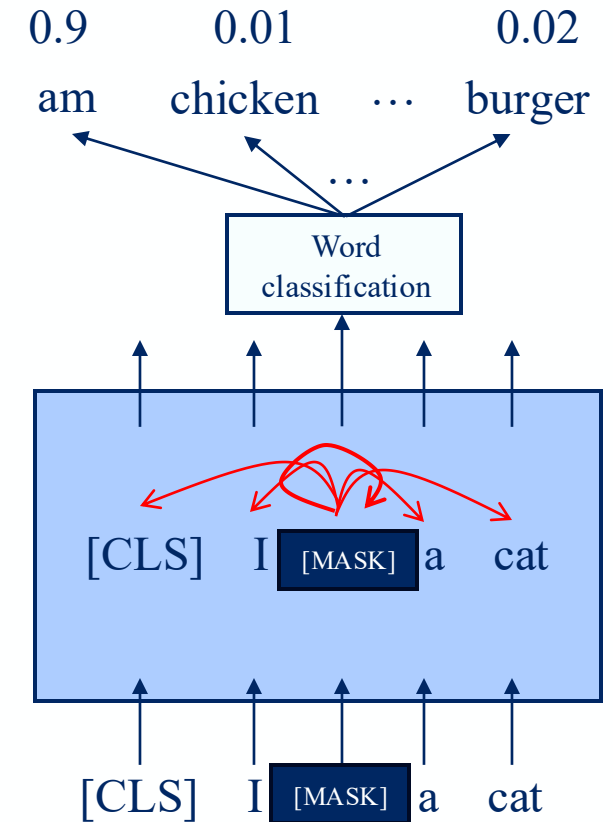
Pretext task: Masked Language Model

- Hide some input with [MASK] token
 - BERT paper: 15% of the input are masked
- Task: classify the masked word



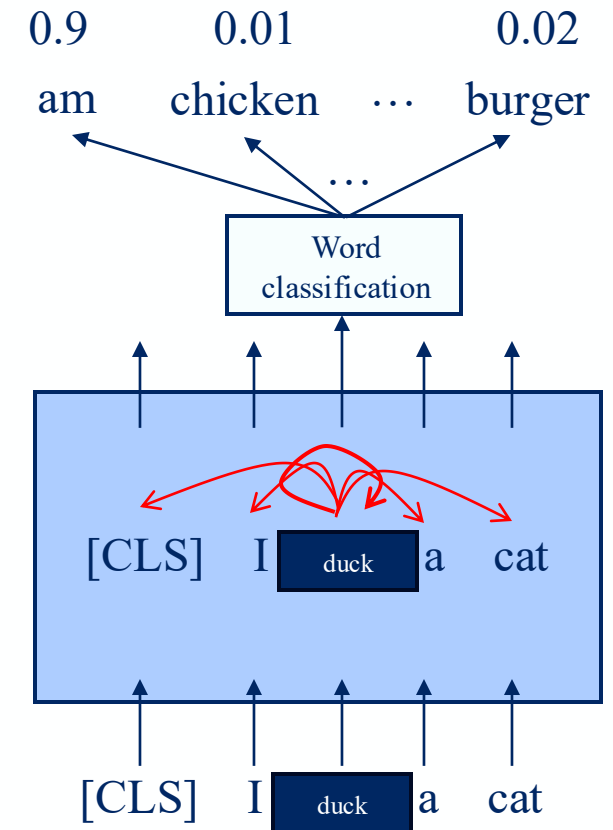
Pretext task: Masked Language Model

- Hide some input with [MASK] token
 - BERT paper: 15% of the input are masked
- Task: classify the masked word
- Model will learn how to see context



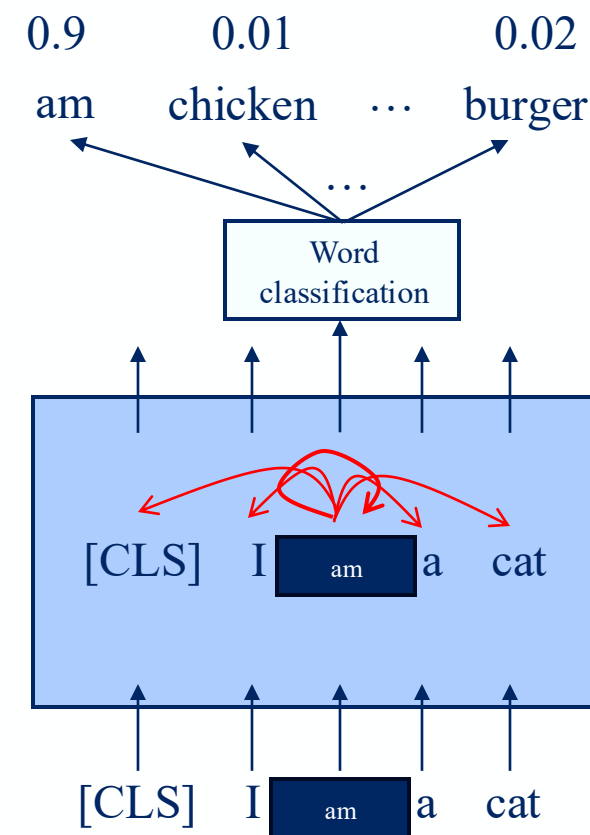
Pretext task: Masked Language Model

- Hide some input with [MASK] token
 - BERT paper: 15% of the input are masked
- Task: classify the masked word
- Model will learn how to see context
- Besides masking:
 - Change to another word

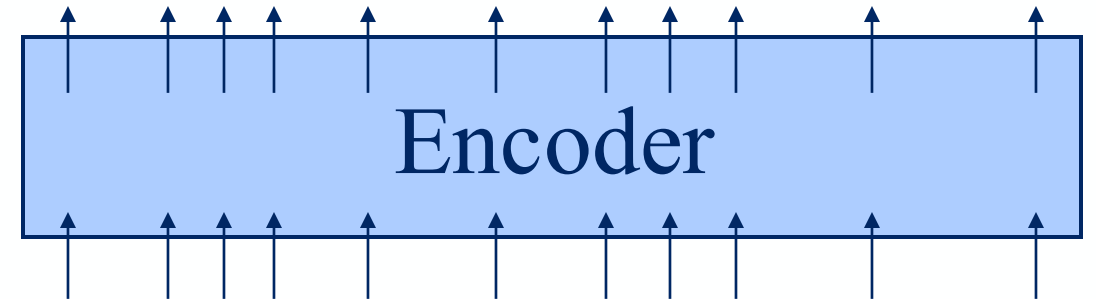


Pretext task: Masked Language Model

- Hide some input with [MASK] token
 - BERT paper: 15% of the input are masked
- Task: classify the masked word
- Model will learn how to see context
- Besides masking:
 - Change to another word
 - Unchanged
 - To not let the model learn trivial solution (i.e, if input token is A the output should not be A → trivial)

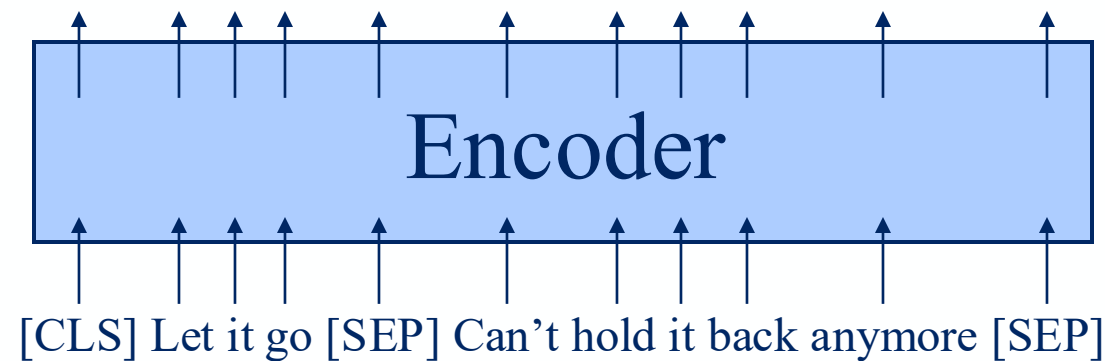


Pretext task: Next Sentence Prediction



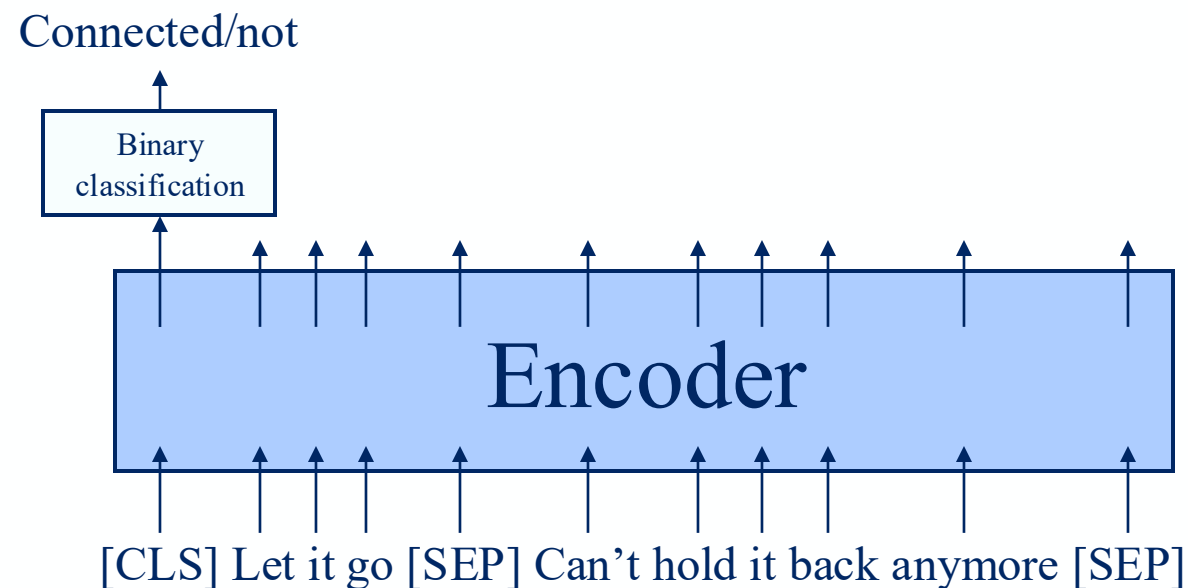
Pretext task: Next Sentence Prediction

- 2 sentences input, separated by [SEP] token



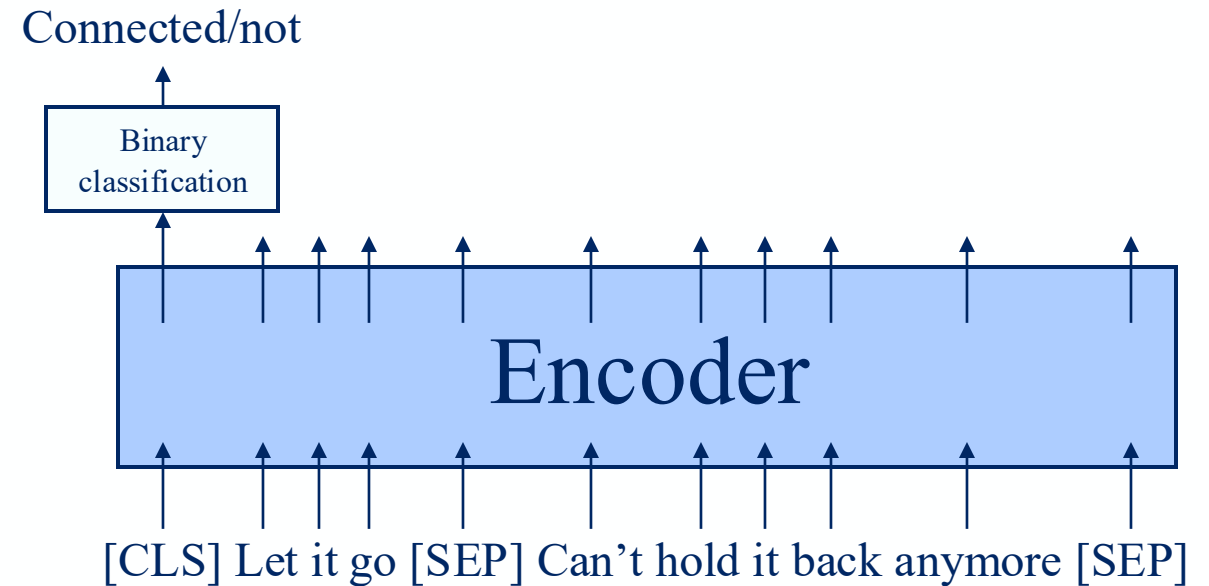
Pretext task: Next Sentence Prediction

- 2 sentences input, separated by [SEP] token
- Task: binary classification, are the 2 sentences connected?



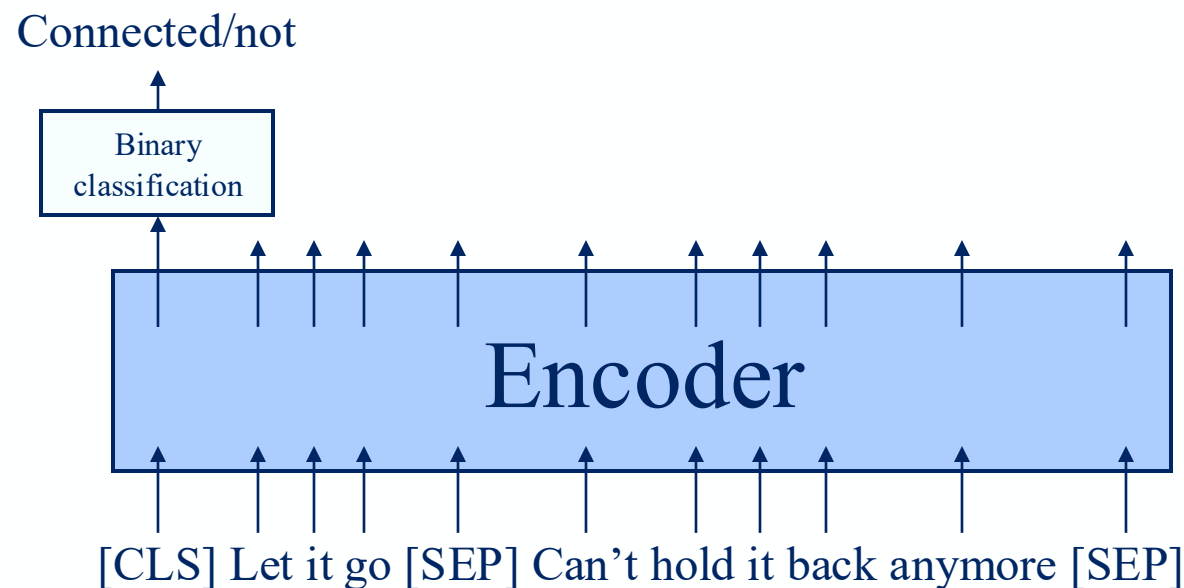
Pretext task: Next Sentence Prediction

- 2 sentences input, separated by [SEP] token
- Task: binary classification, are the 2 sentences connected?
- Model will learn to see connection between 2 sentences



Pretext task: Next Sentence Prediction

- 2 sentences input, separated by [SEP] token
- Task: binary classification, are the 2 sentences connected?
- Model will learn to see connection between 2 sentences
- Good downstream task: question answering
 - Question: 1st sentence
 - Candidate answer: 2nd sentence



Foundation models

Foundation models are *large, pretrained models* that serve as a base (foundation) for many downstream tasks.

- They are pre-trained on *broad and diverse unlabelled data* in a self-supervised manner.
- Extract a generalized representation of the data
- They can be *adapted* (via fine-tuning) to many specific downstream applications.

Bommasani, R., et. Al, *On the Opportunities and Risks of Foundation Models*.

Connection with transformers

Almost all modern foundation models are built using the Transformer architecture.

1. **Scalability:** Transformers train efficiently on massive data and self attention is parallelizable, making it efficient to run on modern GPUs.
2. **Transferability:** Pretrained Transformers adapt well to new task.

Link to the notebook

Next, open this notebook on Google Collab and dive into the hands-on session!



Agenda

- 09:00 - 10:30 Introduction to Language Modeling
- 10:30 - 10:45 Break
- 10:45 - 11:45 Blablador: concept, models description. Optional: integration in VScode
- 11:45 - 12:00 Q&A
- 12:00 - 13:00 Lunch Break
- 13:00 - 14:00 Attention, self-attention, transformer architecture
- 14:00 - 14:15 Pre-training vs fine-tuning and foundation models (intro to the hands-on session)
- 14:15 - 14:30 Break
- 14:30 - 15:30 Hands-on: fine-tune a model on a downstream task
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Practical Usage



Tips on application

- Start with pre-trained foundational models
 - ViT, BERT, GPT,
- Use existing pipelines for quick prototyping
 - HuggingFace pipeline
- Use mature frameworks to save on implementation time
 - HuggingFace, LangChain, OpenMMLab
- Adjust models for hardware limitations
 - Local computation vs cloud resources
 - Larger models can be overkill!

Challenges and Pitfalls

- Transformer models are larger in size
 - Often require GPUs for inference / training
- Large amount of data is usually necessary to train them
 - Fine-tuning is preferred on small datasets
- High computational cost through API calls
 - Always measure token count for cost estimation

Key Takeaways

- Transformers enabled a breakthrough in language processing.
- Attention + Parallelization are key features in Transformers.
- Transformers have a wide range of applications.
- While using them ensure:
 - You're using the correct foundation model (task specific)
 - Fine tune the model on relevant data (domain specific)
 - Be aware of the hardware / data requirements of transformers
 - When using cloud services, estimate cost beforehand (measure tokens)

Questionnaire

- Please take a couple of minutes to provide feedback



References

- https://xai-tutorials.readthedocs.io/en/latest/_ml_basics/transformer.html

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Thank you

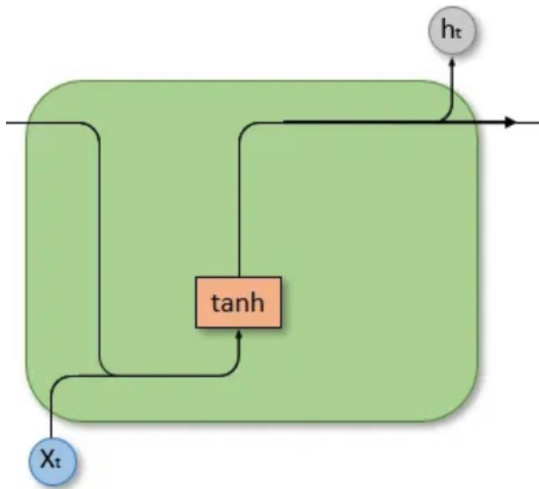


Appendix

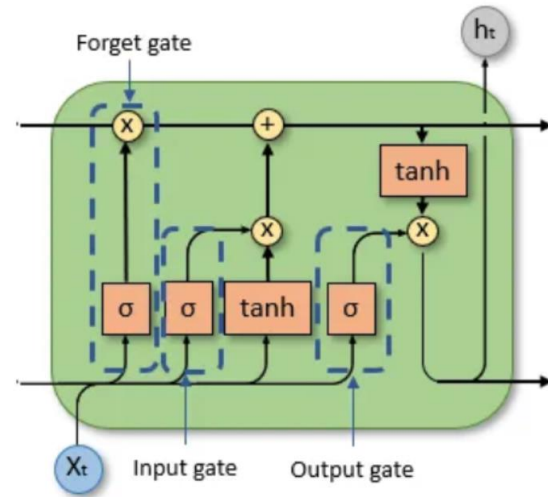


Seq-2-seq models

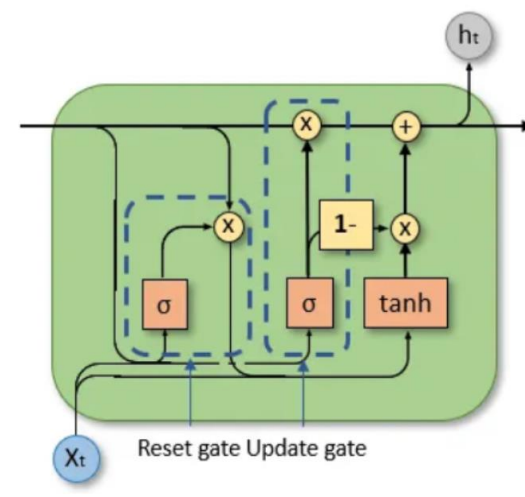
RNN



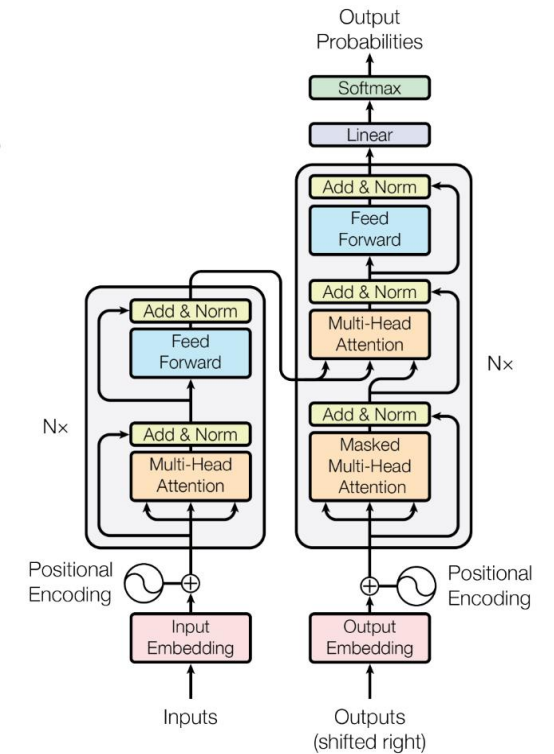
LSTM



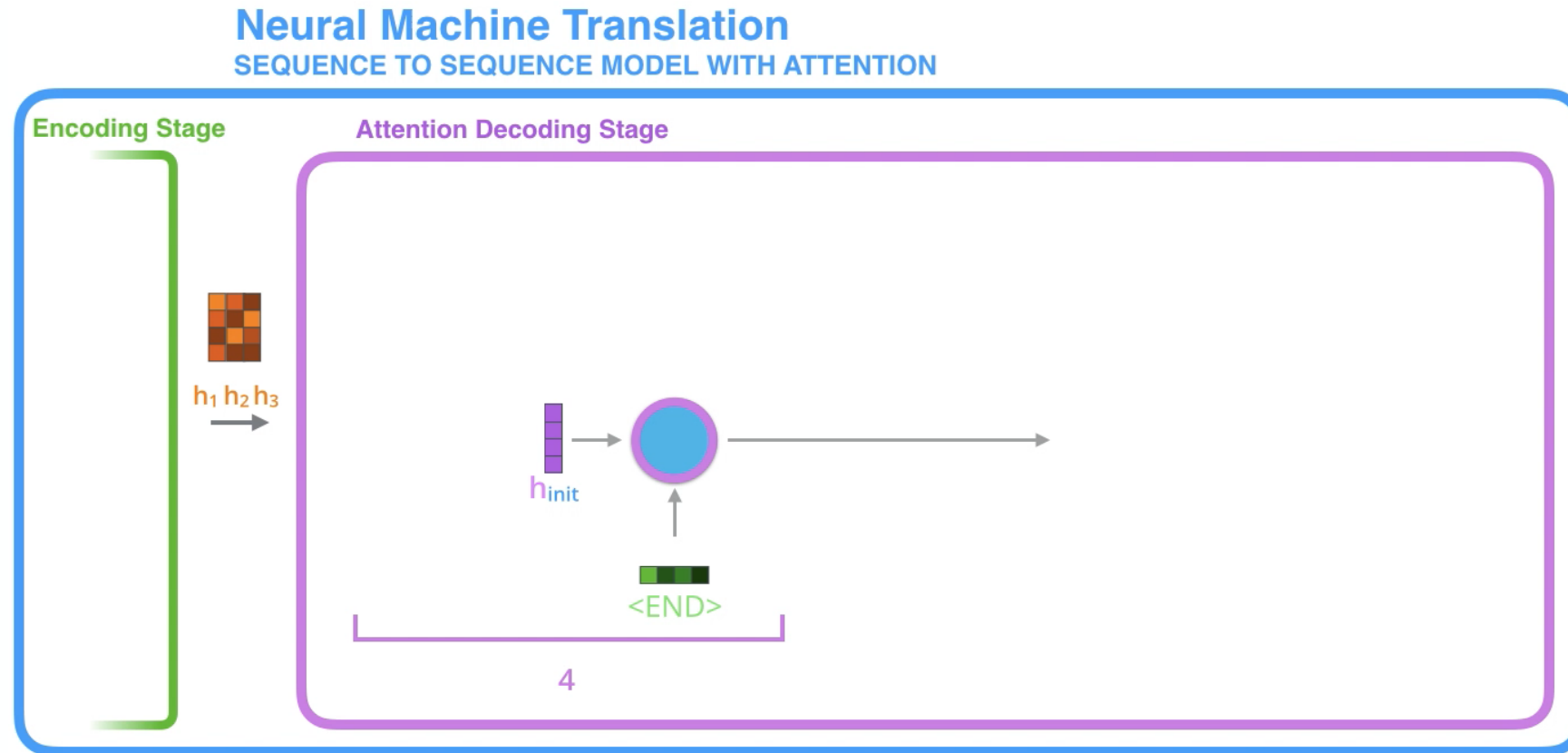
GRU



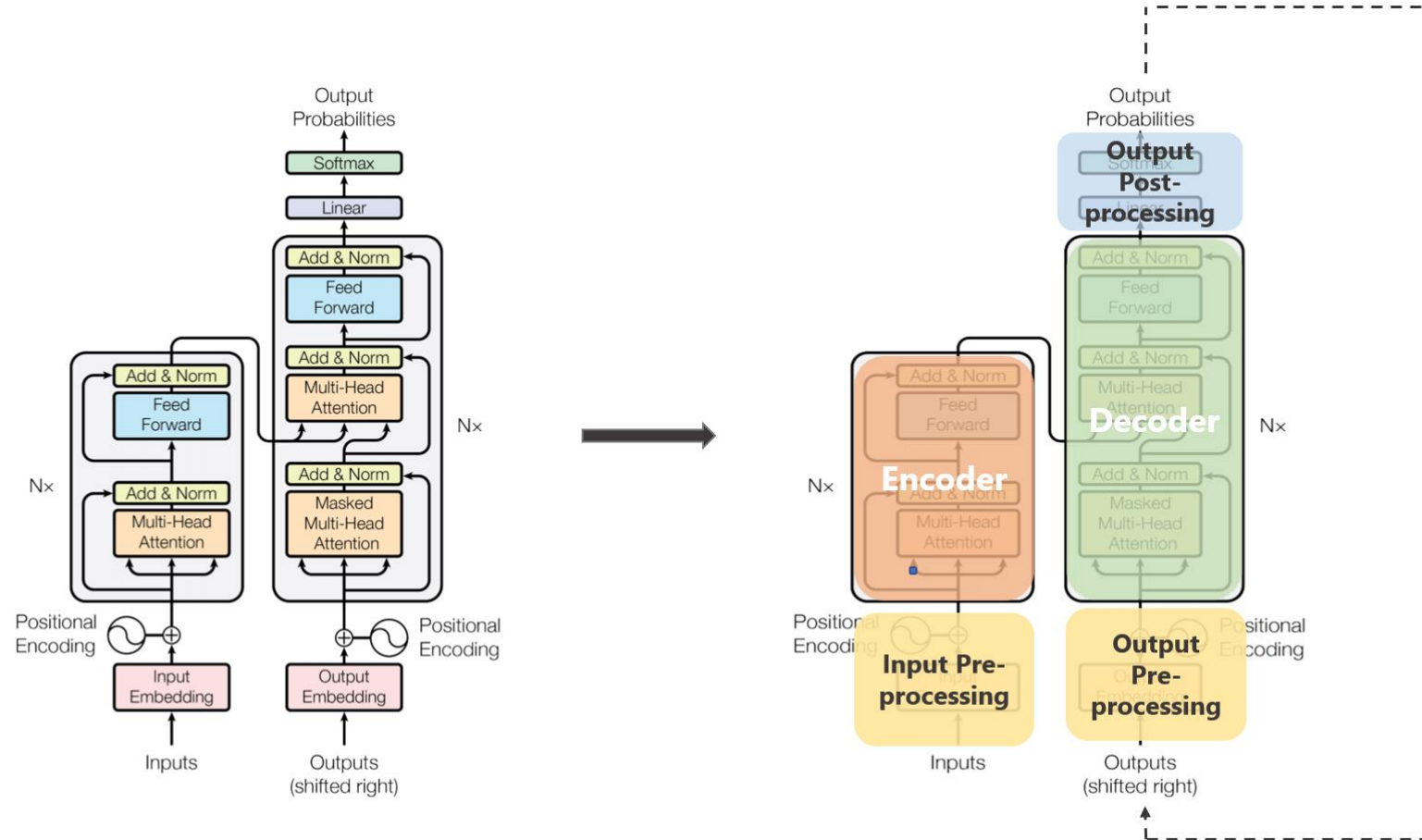
Transformers



Attention Mechanism in RNN



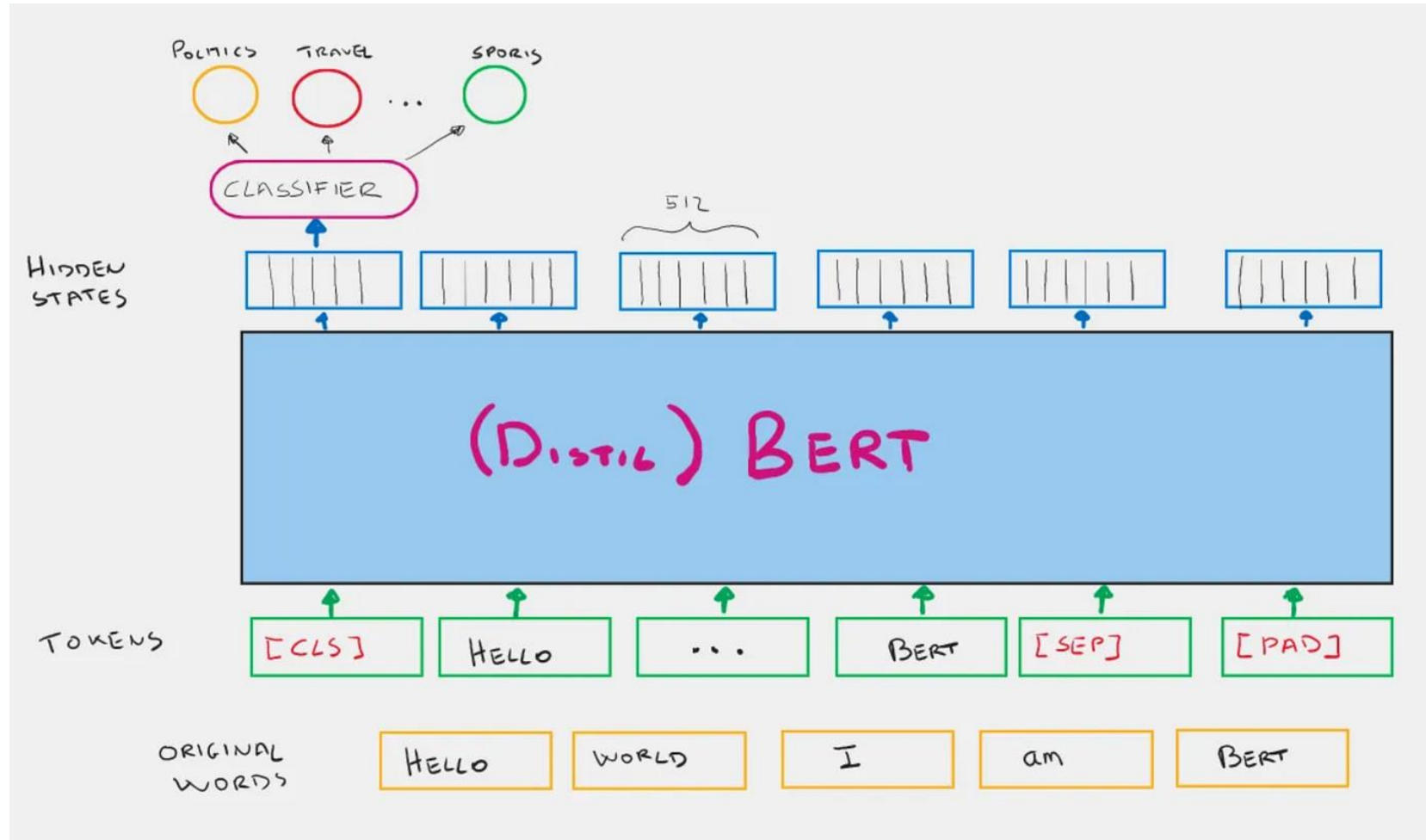
Easy transformer architecture



Question attention

- Attention can learn long term dependencies. Is there a limit to this?
 - How do large conversation models work...
- Why is the attention value scaled?
 - How is this related to batch normalization...
- What is the computation complexity of attention?
 - For a single run, which has higher computational complexity: transformer encoder or RNN encoder

[CLS] token in BERT



Fine-tuning techniques

